

IELTS Speaking vocabulary

1911 entries · meaning, British IPA, stress, example, synonyms and level

Every underlined word in the sample answers opens one of these entries in the app. The meaning is the sense used in the answer (the "as used" column). Please check meanings, IPA and levels; anything you change here we update in the app.

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
a double-edged sword /ə ,dʌbl edʒd 'sɔ:d/ <i>idiom</i> as used: double-edged sword	something that has both advantages and disadvantages <i>Working from home is a double-edged sword, since it saves travel time but can feel very isolating.</i>	a mixed blessing, a trade-off, a two-sided coin	C1
a dying art /ə ,daɪɪŋ 'ɑ:t/ <i>idiom</i> as used: dying art	a skill or activity that fewer and fewer people practise nowadays <i>Writing proper letters by hand seems to be a dying art among people of my generation.</i>	a lost art, a vanishing skill, a fading tradition	C1
a force for good /ə ,fɔ:s fə 'gʊd/ <i>idiom</i> as used: force for good	something or someone that has a positive effect on people or society <i>Used wisely, social media can be a force for good, helping communities raise money for those in need.</i>	a positive influence, a benefit to society, a power for good	C1
a higher moral principle /ə ,haɪər ,mɒrəl 'prɪnsəpl/ <i>collocation</i> as used: higher moral principle	an ethical belief considered more important than ordinary rules or laws <i>Some people refuse unfair orders because they follow a higher moral principle.</i>	greater ethical value, higher law, deeper moral duty	C2
a kernel of truth /ə ,kɜ:nl əv 'tru:θ/ <i>idiom</i> as used: kernel of truth	a small part of an idea or claim that is actually true <i>Most stereotypes contain a kernel of truth, but they exaggerate it until it becomes unfair.</i>	grain of truth, element of truth, some truth	C1
a lump in your throat /ə ,lʌmp ɪn jɔ: 'θrəʊt/ <i>idiom</i> as used: a lump in my throat	a tight feeling in your throat caused by strong emotion, as if you might cry <i>When my brother gave his wedding speech, I had a lump in my throat the whole time.</i>	choked up, overcome with emotion, close to tears	C1
a lump in your throat /ə ,lʌmp ɪn jɔ: 'θrəʊt/ <i>idiom</i> as used: lump in my throat	a tight feeling in the throat caused by strong emotion, as if you might cry <i>Watching my sister say goodbye after her wedding left me with a lump in my throat.</i>	choked up, emotional, close to tears	C1
a rare luxury /ə ,reə 'lʌkʃəri/ <i>collocation</i>	something pleasant and valuable that you are seldom able to have or enjoy <i>With two jobs and a young family, a full night's sleep has become a rare luxury for my cousin.</i>	a rare treat, a real indulgence, a special privilege	C1
a real treat /ə ,rɪəl 'tri:t/ <i>phrase</i>	something special and enjoyable that you do not experience every day <i>Eating out at a proper restaurant was a real treat for us when I was growing up.</i>	a special pleasure, a delight, an indulgence	B2
a sense of agency /ə ,sens əv 'eɪdʒənsi/ <i>collocation</i>	the feeling that you have control over your actions and can influence what happens <i>Volunteering in my neighbourhood gives me a sense of agency that simply complaining about problems never could.</i>	a sense of control, empowerment, self-efficacy	C2
a vast array of /ə ,vɑ:st ə'reɪ əv/ <i>phrase</i>	a very large and varied range of things <i>The city library offers a vast array of books, magazines and online courses, all completely free.</i>	a huge range of, a wide variety of, a great selection of	C1
a welcome escape /ə ,welkəm ɪ'skeɪp/ <i>collocation</i>	a pleasant break from something stressful, boring or routine <i>For me, a weekend trip to the countryside is a welcome escape from the noise of the city.</i>	a pleasant break, a respite, a breather	C1
a world away from /ə ,wɜ:ld ə'weɪ frəm/ <i>idiom</i>	extremely different from something else <i>My grandparents' quiet village is a world away from the crowded streets where I live now.</i>	completely different from, poles apart from, nothing like	C1

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abandon /ə'bəndən/ verb a·BAN·don	to stop doing or following something completely, especially before it is finished <i>Many people abandon their new year's resolutions within a few weeks because the goals are too ambitious.</i>	give up, drop, quit	B2
absorb /əb'zɔ:b/ verb ab·SORB	to take in and learn information, habits or ideas, often without realising it <i>I absorbed a lot of English simply by watching films with subtitles as a teenager.</i>	take in, soak up, pick up	B2
absorbed /əb'zɔ:bd/ adjective ab·SORBED	so interested in something that you do not notice anything else around you <i>My younger sister gets so absorbed in her drawing that she forgets to eat.</i>	engrossed, immersed, captivated	C1
accelerate /æk'seləreɪt/ verb ac·CEL·er·ate as used: accelerates	to make a process or change happen faster <i>Online shopping has accelerated the decline of small local shops in many towns.</i>	speed up, hasten, quicken	C1
accessible /æk'sesəbl/ adjective ac·CES·si·ble	easy for people to obtain, use or take part in <i>Free online courses have made higher learning accessible to people who could never afford university fees.</i>	available, within reach, obtainable	B2
accomplishment /ə'kʌmplɪʃmənt/ noun ac·COM·plish·ment	the feeling of pride and satisfaction that comes from achieving something difficult <i>Finishing my first half marathon gave me a real sense of accomplishment.</i>	achievement, fulfilment, success	C1
accountability /ə'kaʊntə'bɪləti/ noun ac·count·a·BIL·i·ty	the situation of having someone check your progress so you feel responsible for your actions <i>Studying with a partner adds accountability, because you do not want to let the other person down.</i>	responsibility, answerability, obligation	C1
accountable /ə'kaʊntəbl/ adjective ac·COUNT·a·ble	responsible for what you do and expected to explain it to others <i>Sharing my goals with a friend keeps me accountable when my motivation starts to drop.</i>	answerable, responsible, liable	C1
accumulate /ə'kju:mjəleɪt/ verb ac·CU·mu·late	to gradually collect more and more of something over a period of time <i>Without realising it, many of us accumulate clothes we hardly ever wear.</i>	gather, amass, build up, collect	C1
achievable /ə'tʃi:vəbl/ adjective a·CHIEV·a·ble	possible to do or reach with a reasonable amount of effort <i>Breaking a big goal into weekly tasks makes it feel much more achievable.</i>	attainable, realistic, feasible, doable	B2
acknowledge /æk'nɒlɪdʒ/ verb ac·KNOWL·edge	to publicly show that you recognise and appreciate someone's work or help <i>A good manager always acknowledges the effort of junior staff, not just the final results.</i>	recognise, credit, give credit to	B2
acquaintance /ə'kweɪntəns/ noun ac·QUAIN·tance as used: acquaintances	a person you know slightly but who is not a close friend <i>I have plenty of acquaintances from university, but only two or three people I would call close friends.</i>	contact, associate, colleague	B2
across virtually every sector /ə,kɾps 'vɜ:tʃuəli ,evri 'sektə/ phrase	in almost all areas of the economy or all types of industry <i>Digital skills are now in demand across virtually every sector, from farming to finance.</i>	in almost every industry, throughout the economy, across the board	C1

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active /'æktɪv/ adjective AC·tive	doing regular physical exercise and moving around a lot <i>Walking to work is an easy way to stay active without paying for a gym.</i>	energetic, fit, on the move	B2
acute /ə'kju:t/ adjective a·CUTE	very serious or severe, especially when describing a problem <i>The shortage of affordable housing is particularly acute in large cities.</i>	severe, serious, pressing, intense	C1
adaptability /ə,dæptə'bɪləti/ noun a·dapt·a·BIL·i·ty	the ability to change your behaviour or methods to suit new situations <i>Employers increasingly value adaptability, because the skills needed in most jobs keep changing.</i>	flexibility, versatility, resilience	C1
adaptable /ə'dæptəbl/ adjective a·DAPT·a·ble	able to change or adjust easily when conditions or plans change <i>Travelling on a tight budget taught me to be adaptable when things go wrong.</i>	flexible, versatile, adjustable	B2
add to its charm /,æd tə its 'tʃɑ:m/ phrase as used: adds to its charm	to make something more attractive or likeable, often despite a small flaw <i>The old café has creaky wooden floors, but that only adds to its charm.</i>	make it more appealing, enhance its appeal, make it more endearing	C1
add up /,æd 'ʌp/ phrasal verb as used: adds up	when small amounts or actions gradually combine to make a large or important total <i>Buying coffee every day seems cheap, but over a year it really adds up.</i>	mount up, accumulate, build up	B2
addictive /ə'dɪktɪv/ adjective ad·DIC·tive	so enjoyable that it is hard to stop doing it once you start <i>Short videos on social media are designed to be addictive, so hours can disappear without notice.</i>	compulsive, habit-forming, hard to put down	B2
adjustment /ə'dʒʌstmənt/ noun ad·JUST·ment	a change in your habits or situation that takes time to get used to <i>Moving from a village to a big city was a huge adjustment for my parents.</i>	adaptation, change, transition	B2
admirable /'ædmərəbl/ adjective AD·mi·ra·ble	deserving respect and approval because of a good quality <i>It is admirable how my aunt stays calm even when everything around her is going wrong.</i>	commendable, praiseworthy, impressive	B2
advance into leadership /əd,vɑ:ns ,ɪntə 'li:dəʃɪp/ collocation	to be promoted to a senior role where you manage or guide other people <i>Communication skills become essential once you advance into leadership and have a team to motivate.</i>	move up the ladder, step into management, rise to a senior role	C1
advancement /əd'vɑ:nsmənt/ noun ad·VANCE·ment	progress or development in knowledge, society or the economy <i>Public investment in research is essential for scientific advancement in developing countries.</i>	progress, development, improvement	C1
adventurous /əd'ventʃərəs/ adjective ad·VEN·tur·ous	involving new, exciting and sometimes risky experiences <i>When I was younger, my holidays were far more adventurous, with hiking and last-minute trips.</i>	daring, bold, exciting, intrepid	B2
affectionate /ə'fekʃənət/ adjective af·FEC·tion·ate	showing warm feelings of love and fondness <i>My grandmother has an affectionate way of calling everyone in the family by a pet name.</i>	loving, warm, tender, fond	B2

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affirmative action /əˈfɜːmətɪv ˈækʃn/ collocation	a policy of giving extra opportunities to groups that have been treated unfairly in the past <i>Some universities use affirmative action to increase the number of students from poorer rural areas.</i>	positive discrimination, positive action, equal opportunity policy	C2
affirming /əˈfɜːmɪŋ/ adjective af·FIRM·ing	making you feel valued, confident and accepted as a person <i>Receiving a thoughtful thank-you note from a student was a genuinely affirming moment for her.</i>	validating, encouraging, uplifting	C2
affordably /əˈfɔːdəbli/ adverb af·FORD·a·bly	in a way that does not cost too much money <i>Buying seasonal vegetables from the market is the best way to eat affordably.</i>	cheaply, economically, inexpensively	C1
age-appropriate /ˌeɪdʒ əˈprəʊpriət/ adjective age·ap·PRO·pri·ate	suitable for a child of a particular age <i>Parents should choose age-appropriate games that match their child's maturity and interests.</i>	suitable, age-suitable, fitting	C1
agenda-setting /əˈdʒendə ˌsetɪŋ/ adjective a·GEN·da·set·ting	having the power to decide which issues people think about and discuss <i>The media plays an agenda-setting role by choosing which stories appear on the front page.</i>	influential, opinion-shaping, trend-setting	C2
agile /ˈædʒaɪl/ adjective AG·ile	able to respond and adapt quickly to change <i>Small companies are often more agile than large corporations when the market suddenly shifts.</i>	nimble, flexible, responsive, adaptable	C1
agonising /ˈæɡənəɪzɪŋ/ adjective AG·o·nis·ing	causing great mental pain and worry, especially when making a decision <i>Choosing between two universities was an agonising decision that kept me awake for nights.</i>	painful, excruciating, torturous, distressing	C1
airy /ˈeəri/ adjective AIR·y	having plenty of space and fresh air, so it feels light and open <i>I prefer airy cafés with big windows to dark, crowded ones.</i>	spacious, light, open, well-ventilated	C1
alarming /əˈlɑːmɪŋ/ adjective a·LARM·ing	worrying and frightening because something bad may happen <i>The amount of plastic washing up on our beaches is genuinely alarming.</i>	worrying, disturbing, shocking, frightening	B2
algorithmic bias /ˌælgəˌrɪðmɪk ˈbaɪəs/ collocation	unfair results from a computer system because its data or design favours certain groups <i>Algorithmic bias in hiring software could quietly reject qualified candidates from certain backgrounds.</i>	machine bias, AI bias, data bias	C2
alien /ˈeɪliən/ adjective A·li·en	strange and unfamiliar, and therefore difficult to understand or accept <i>The idea of eating dinner alone in front of a screen feels alien to my grandparents.</i>	foreign, unfamiliar, strange, incomprehensible	C1
alienating /ˈeɪliəneɪtɪŋ/ adjective A·li·en·at·ing	making people feel isolated, lonely or that they do not belong <i>Starting at a large new school can be alienating if nobody makes an effort to include you.</i>	isolating, estranging, off-putting	C1
all the more rewarding /ˌɔːl ðə ˌmɔː rɪˈwɔːdɪŋ/ phrase	even more satisfying than usual, because of a particular reason <i>Passing the exam was all the more rewarding because I had failed it the first time.</i>	even more satisfying, especially fulfilling, doubly worthwhile	C1

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all walks of life /ˌɔːl ˈwɔːks əv ˈlaɪf/ idiom	people of every social class, job and background <i>The festival attracts people from all walks of life, from students to retired farmers.</i>	every background, all backgrounds, every section of society	C1
all-consuming /ˌɔːl kənˈsjuːmɪŋ/ adjective all·con·SUM·ing	so strong or demanding that it takes up all your time, energy and attention <i>Preparing for the final exams became all-consuming, and I barely saw my friends for months.</i>	overwhelming, obsessive, consuming, overpowering	C2
alternative protein /ɔːlˌtɜːnətɪv ˈprəʊtɪːn/ collocation as used: alternative proteins	a source of protein that replaces meat, such as plants, insects or lab-grown products <i>Supermarkets now stock more alternative proteins, so vegetarians have far more choice than before.</i>	meat substitute, plant-based protein, meat alternative	C1
altruistic /ˌæltruˈɪstɪk/ adjective al·tru·IS·tic	caring about other people's needs and helping them without expecting anything back <i>My uncle is so altruistic that he spends every weekend teaching poor children for free.</i>	selfless, unselfish, generous, charitable	C2
ambitious /æmˈbɪʃəs/ adjective am·BI·tious	needing a lot of effort, skill or money to achieve successfully <i>Opening my own bakery within two years is an ambitious plan, but I am determined to try.</i>	challenging, demanding, bold, daring	B2
amenity /əˈmiːnəti/ noun a·MEN·i·ty as used: amenities	a useful service or facility, such as a shop, park or hospital, that makes life easier <i>Our new neighbourhood has excellent amenities, including a gym, a library and several parks.</i>	facility, service, convenience	C1
amicably /ˈæmɪkəbli/ adverb AM·i·ca·bly	in a friendly and polite way, without arguing or ill feeling <i>My flatmate and I settled our disagreement about the bills amicably over a cup of tea.</i>	cordially, peacefully, harmoniously, on good terms	C2
amplify /ˈæmplɪfaɪ/ verb AM·pli·fy as used: amplified	to make a feeling or pressure stronger and more intense <i>Constant comparison on social media can amplify feelings of stress among teenagers.</i>	intensify, heighten, magnify	C1
amplify /ˈæmplɪfaɪ/ verb AM·pli·fy as used: amplifies	to increase the size or strength of an effect or influence <i>Sharing a campaign online amplifies its message far beyond what posters alone could achieve.</i>	increase, magnify, boost, multiply	C1
amplify /ˈæmplɪfaɪ/ verb AM·pli·fy	to make a difference or problem bigger or more noticeable <i>Unequal access to the internet may amplify the gap between rich and poor students.</i>	widen, increase, deepen, exacerbate	C1
amusing /əˈmjuːzɪŋ/ adjective a·MUS·ing	funny and entertaining, making you smile or laugh <i>My grandfather tells amusing stories about his school days that we never get tired of hearing.</i>	funny, entertaining, comical, humorous	B2
an informal education /ən ɪnˌfɔːml ˌedʒuˈkeɪʃn/ collocation	knowledge and understanding gained from everyday experience or people rather than from school <i>Working in my father's shop gave me an informal education in dealing with customers.</i>	practical learning, real-world learning, learning by experience	C1
an instant rapport /ən ˌɪnstənt ræˈpɔː/ collocation	an immediate feeling of understanding and friendly connection with someone you have just met <i>My new colleague and I had an instant rapport because we share the same sense of humour.</i>	an immediate connection, instant chemistry, an immediate bond	C1

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analytical /ˌænəˈlɪtɪkl/ adjective an·a·LYT·i·cal	examining things carefully and logically in order to understand them <i>Studying economics has made me more analytical when I read news about prices and jobs.</i>	logical, methodical, systematic, rational	C1
ancestry /ˈænsɛstri/ noun AN·ces·try	the family members who lived long before you, and the background they give you <i>Many people now use online records to trace their ancestry back several generations.</i>	heritage, lineage, roots, descent	C1
anonymous /əˈnɒnɪməs/ adjective a·NON·y·mous	not known or noticed by other people, as if you had no identity <i>In a huge crowd at a concert, you can feel pleasantly anonymous and free.</i>	unknown, faceless, unnoticed, nameless	B2
anticipation /ænˌtɪsɪˈpeɪʃn/ noun an·tic·i·PA·tion	a feeling of excitement about something that is going to happen <i>The anticipation before a family wedding is almost as enjoyable as the day itself.</i>	excitement, expectation, eagerness	C1
anticipatory /ænˌtɪsɪˈpeɪtəri/ adjective an·tic·i·PA·to·ry	able to predict what someone will need and act before they ask <i>Modern apps are becoming anticipatory, suggesting routes to work before you even open the map.</i>	predictive, proactive, forward-looking	C2
antisocial behaviour /ˌæntɪˌsəʊfl bɪˈheɪvjə/ collocation	actions that harm or disturb other people in a community, such as vandalism or noise <i>Better street lighting and youth clubs can reduce antisocial behaviour in city neighbourhoods.</i>	disorderly conduct, delinquency, vandalism	C1
anxiety-inducing /æŋˈzaɪəti ɪnˌdʒuːsɪŋ/ adjective anx·i·e·ty·in·duc·ing	causing feelings of worry and nervousness <i>Waiting for exam results can be far more anxiety-inducing than sitting the exam itself.</i>	stressful, nerve-racking, worrying	C1
apathy /ˈæpəθi/ noun AP·a·thy	a lack of interest or concern, so that people make no effort to act <i>Low turnout in local elections is often blamed on apathy among young voters.</i>	indifference, lack of interest, passivity	C2
apologetic /əˌpɒləˈdʒetɪk/ adjective a·pol·o·GET·ic	showing or saying that you are sorry for causing a problem <i>The waiter was so apologetic about the delay that we didn't mind waiting at all.</i>	sorry, regretful, remorseful, contrite	C1
appeal /əˈpiːl/ noun ap·PEAL	the quality that makes something attractive or interesting to people <i>Traditional board games still have a lot of appeal for families who want time away from screens.</i>	attraction, charm, allure, attractiveness	B2
appealing /əˈpiːlɪŋ/ adjective ap·PEAL·ing	attractive or interesting, making you want to do or have it <i>Working from home sounds appealing, but it can feel lonely after a while.</i>	attractive, tempting, inviting, enticing	B2
appliance /əˈplaɪəns/ noun ap·PLI·ance	a machine used in the home for a particular job, such as cooking or cleaning <i>A rice cooker is the most useful kitchen appliance in almost every home I know.</i>	device, machine, gadget	B2
applicable /əˈplɪkəbl/ adjective ap·PLIC·a·ble	relevant and useful in a particular situation or area of life <i>The problem-solving skills I learned at university are applicable to almost any job.</i>	relevant, useful, transferable, pertinent	C1
appreciative /əˈpriːʃətɪv/ adjective ap·PRE·cia·tive	recognising the value of something and feeling grateful for it <i>Living abroad made me far more appreciative of my mother's home cooking.</i>	grateful, thankful, admiring	C1

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apprehension /ˌæprɪˈhenʃn/ noun ap·pre·HEN·sion	a feeling of worry or nervousness about something that is going to happen <i>I felt some apprehension before my first flight, but it turned out to be surprisingly relaxing.</i>	anxiety, unease, nervousness, worry	C1
apprehensive /ˌæprɪˈhensɪv/ adjective ap·pre·HEN·sive	worried or nervous that something bad might happen <i>Many students feel apprehensive about speaking English in front of their classmates.</i>	nervous, anxious, uneasy, worried	C1
approachable /əˈprəʊtʃəbl/ adjective ap·PROACH·a·ble	friendly and easy to talk to <i>My favourite teacher was very approachable, so we never felt embarrassed asking questions.</i>	friendly, accessible, easy-going, welcoming	C1
aptitude /ˈæptɪtjuːd/ noun AP·ti·tude	a natural ability to do something well or learn it quickly <i>My sister has a real aptitude for languages and picked up French in a single year.</i>	talent, gift, flair, knack	C1
aquatic ecosystem /əˌkwætɪk ˈiːkəʊsɪstəm/ collocation as used: aquatic ecosystems	the community of plants and animals living together in a river, lake or sea <i>Chemical waste from factories can destroy aquatic ecosystems that fishing villages depend on.</i>	marine environment, freshwater habitat, water ecosystem	C1
arduous /ˈɑːdʒuəs/ adjective AR·du·ous	very difficult and tiring, needing a lot of effort over a long time <i>Learning to drive in heavy city traffic was an arduous process for me.</i>	gruelling, demanding, exhausting, tough	C2
aromatic /ˌærəˈmætɪk/ adjective ar·o·MAT·ic	having a strong, pleasant smell <i>The kitchen fills with an aromatic mix of spices whenever my mother cooks biryani.</i>	fragrant, scented, sweet-smelling, spicy	C1
articulate /ɑːˈtɪkjələt/ adjective ar·TIC·u·late	able to express ideas clearly and effectively in speech <i>Joining the debating club made me far more articulate in job interviews.</i>	eloquent, fluent, expressive, well-spoken	C1
artisan /ˌɑːtɪˈzæn/ noun ar·ti·SAN as used: artisans	a skilled worker who makes things by hand using traditional methods <i>Local artisans sell handwoven scarves and pottery at the weekend craft market.</i>	craftsperson, craftsman, maker	C1
ascend /əˈsend/ verb as·CEND	to rise to a higher position or level of importance in an organisation <i>She ascended quickly through the company thanks to her strong people skills.</i>	rise, climb, advance, progress	C2
aspiration /ˌæspəˈreɪʃn/ noun as·pi·RA·tion as used: aspirations	a strong hope or wish to achieve something important in life <i>Most parents share the same aspiration, that their children will have a better life than they did.</i>	ambition, dream, goal, hope	C1
aspire to /əˈspaɪə tuː/ phrasal verb	to have a strong wish to achieve or have something <i>Many young people aspire to a career that combines a good salary with creative freedom.</i>	aim for, hope for, long for, strive for	C1
asset /ˈæset/ noun AS·set	something or someone that is very useful and brings benefits <i>Being able to speak three languages is a real asset in the tourism industry.</i>	advantage, benefit, strength, plus	B2

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at a considerable price /ət ə kənˌsɪdərəbl 'praɪs/ phrase	achieved only by losing or paying a lot, such as money, time or comfort <i>Fast career success sometimes comes at a considerable price in terms of health and family time.</i>	at great cost, at a high cost, with major sacrifices	C1
at an alarming rate /ət ən əˌlɑːmɪŋ 'reɪt/ phrase as used: alarming rate	very quickly, in a way that causes worry <i>Forests in the region are disappearing at an alarming rate because of illegal logging.</i>	worryingly fast, at a frightening speed, rapidly	B2
at its source /ət ɪts 'sɔːs/ phrase	at the place or point where a problem starts <i>The best way to tackle plastic waste is to deal with it at its source, by producing less.</i>	at the root, at the origin, from the start	C1
at one with /æt 'wʌn wɪð/ idiom	feeling completely peaceful and in harmony with something <i>Sitting quietly by the lake at dawn, I felt at one with nature.</i>	in harmony with, in tune with, connected to	C2
at peace /ət 'piːs/ phrase	feeling calm, relaxed and free from worry <i>My grandmother seems most at peace when she is working in her garden.</i>	calm, content, serene, tranquil	B2
at the cost of /ət ðə 'kɒst əv/ phrase	causing the loss of something valuable in order to gain something else <i>Some students chase top grades at the cost of their sleep and social lives.</i>	at the expense of, in exchange for, by sacrificing	C1
at the expense of /ət ði ɪk'spens əv/ phrase	in a way that harms or neglects something else in order to get what you want <i>Cities should not grow at the expense of their parks and green spaces.</i>	at the cost of, to the detriment of, by sacrificing	C1
at your disposal /ət ʃɔː dɪ'spəʊzl/ phrase as used: at their disposal	available for you to use whenever and however you need <i>Students today have huge online resources at their disposal, so there are few excuses for not studying.</i>	available, on hand, within reach, accessible	C1
at-risk /ət 'rɪsk/ adjective at·RISK	likely to suffer harm or get into trouble because of their situation <i>Free after-school clubs can give at-risk teenagers a safe place to spend their evenings.</i>	vulnerable, endangered, disadvantaged	C1
atmospheric /ˌætˈmɒs'ferɪk/ adjective at·mos·PHER·ic	creating a special mood or feeling, often mysterious or romantic <i>The old library, with its dim lamps and wooden shelves, is wonderfully atmospheric.</i>	evocative, moody, dramatic, haunting	C1
attached /ə'tætʃt/ adjective at·TACHED	feeling strong affection for someone or something <i>I became so attached to my first bicycle that I still keep it in my parents' garage.</i>	fond of, devoted, close	B2
attainable /ə'teɪnəbl/ adjective at·TAIN·a·ble	possible to achieve with effort <i>Setting attainable daily goals helps me stay motivated when preparing for exams.</i>	achievable, realistic, reachable, feasible	C1
attention span /ə'tenʃn spæn/ collocation as used: attention spans	the length of time a person can concentrate on something before losing interest <i>Teachers now use short activities because young learners often have short attention spans.</i>	concentration, focus, ability to concentrate	C1
attentive /ə'tentɪv/ adjective at·TEN·tive	paying close attention to others and ready to notice and help with their needs <i>The nurses were very attentive, checking on my grandfather every hour.</i>	observant, considerate, caring, watchful	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
attributable /əˈtrɪbjətəbl/ adjective at·TRIB·u·ta·ble	caused by or resulting from a particular person or thing <i>Much of my confidence in public speaking is attributable to the drama classes I took.</i>	due to, owing to, caused by, down to	C2
augment /ɔːg'ment/ verb aug·MENT	to add to something in order to make it bigger, better or more effective <i>Online tutorials can augment classroom teaching, but they cannot fully replace a good teacher.</i>	enhance, supplement, boost, complement	C2
authentic /ɔː'θentɪk/ adjective au·THEN·tic	real and sincere, not artificial or made only for commercial purposes <i>I prefer small family restaurants because the food tastes more authentic than in tourist places.</i>	genuine, real, original, true	B2
authenticity /ɔːθen'tɪsəti/ noun au·then·TIC·i·ty	the quality of being real, genuine and true to its origins <i>Travellers increasingly look for authenticity, such as staying with local families rather than in big hotels.</i>	genuineness, originality, realness	C1
authoritarian /ɔː,θɒrɪ'teəriən/ adjective au·thor·i·TAR·i·an	demanding strict obedience and not allowing people freedom to make their own choices <i>An authoritarian teacher may keep the class quiet but rarely inspires genuine curiosity.</i>	strict, dictatorial, domineering, controlling	C2
automate /'ɔːtəmeɪt/ verb AU·to·mate	to make a process work by machines or computers instead of people <i>Many banks have automated simple tasks, so customers rarely need to visit a branch.</i>	mechanise, computerise, digitise	C1
autonomous /ɔː'tɒnəməs/ adjective au·TON·o·mous	able to operate by itself without being controlled by a person <i>Autonomous delivery robots are already being tested on university campuses.</i>	self-driving, self-operating, independent	C1
autonomy /ɔː'tɒnəmi/ noun au·TON·o·my	the freedom to make your own decisions without being controlled by others <i>Teenagers need a degree of autonomy to learn how to manage their own time.</i>	independence, freedom, self-determination	C1
avant-garde /,ævɔ̃ 'ɡɑːd/ adjective a·vant·GARDE	new, experimental and very different from traditional styles <i>The gallery shows avant-garde paintings that many older visitors find hard to understand.</i>	experimental, innovative, cutting-edge, unconventional	C2
away from it all /əˌweɪ frəm ɪt 'ɔːl/ idiom	in a quiet place, far from the stress and pressure of normal life <i>Once a year, my family rents a cottage by the sea to get away from it all.</i>	off the beaten track, in peace and quiet, far from the crowds	C1
awe-inspiring /'ɔːr ɪnˌspəɪərɪŋ/ adjective AWE·in·spir·ing	so impressive or beautiful that it fills you with wonder and respect <i>Seeing the Himalayas from the plane window was an awe-inspiring experience.</i>	breathtaking, magnificent, stunning, spectacular	C1
awestruck /'ɔːstrʌk/ adjective AWE·struck	filled with great wonder and admiration <i>The children stood awestruck in front of the huge dinosaur skeleton at the museum.</i>	amazed, astonished, wonderstruck, in awe	C2
awkwardness /'ɔːkwədnes/ noun AWK·ward·ness	an uncomfortable, embarrassed feeling in a social situation <i>A shared joke quickly broke the awkwardness of our first team meeting.</i>	embarrassment, discomfort, unease	C1
back from the brink /ˌbæk frəm ðə 'brɪŋk/ idiom	saved from a situation that was very close to disaster or destruction <i>Strict fishing limits helped bring the river's fish population back from the brink.</i>	saved from disaster, rescued, revived	C2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
backbone /'bækbəʊn/ noun BACK·bone	the most important part of something, which supports everything else <i>Small family businesses are the backbone of the economy in my hometown.</i>	foundation, mainstay, cornerstone, core	C1
backlash /'bæklæʃ/ noun BACK·lash	a strong, negative reaction from many people against something <i>The brand faced a huge backlash online after posting an insensitive advertisement.</i>	criticism, outcry, hostile reaction	C1
baffled /'bæfld/ adjective BAF·fled	completely unable to understand or explain something <i>I was baffled by the instructions for the new printer, so my nephew set it up for me.</i>	confused, puzzled, bewildered, perplexed	C1
bankrupt /'bæŋkrʌpt/ verb BANK·rupt as used: bankrupted	to make a person or organisation lose all their money so they cannot pay their debts <i>Without insurance, a single serious operation could bankrupt an ordinary family.</i>	ruin, impoverish, break, cripple financially	C1
basic necessity /,beɪsɪk nə'sesəti/ collocation	something that everyone needs in order to live a normal life <i>Clean drinking water should be treated as a basic necessity, not a luxury.</i>	essential, fundamental need, must-have, requirement	C1
be caught up in /bi ,kɔ:t 'ʌp ɪn/ phrase as used: caught up in	to be so busy with something that you do not notice other things <i>It is easy to be caught up in exam stress and forget to call your friends.</i>	absorbed in, preoccupied with, wrapped up in	C1
be drawn back to /bi ,drɔ:n 'bæk tə/ phrase as used: drawn back to	to feel a strong wish to return to a place or activity again and again <i>However far I travel, I'm always drawn back to the quiet riverside where I grew up.</i>	return to, gravitate back to, be pulled back to	C1
be fixated on /bi fɪk'seɪtɪd ɒn/ phrase as used: fixated on	to think about one thing so much that you cannot pay attention to anything else <i>Some parents are so fixated on exam results that they forget to ask whether their child is happy.</i>	be obsessed with, be preoccupied with, be hung up on	C2
be rightly proud of /bi ,raɪtli 'praʊd əv/ phrase as used: rightly be proud of	to have good reason to feel pleased and satisfied about something <i>Our town can be rightly proud of how clean and well organised its riverside market has become.</i>	be justifiably proud of, be deservedly proud of, take pride in	C1
be swept along /bi ,swept ə'lon/ phrasal verb as used: swept along	to be carried forward by a crowd or strong feeling without resisting <i>At the Pohela Boishakh procession, I was swept along by the music and colour of the crowd.</i>	be carried along, be caught up, be borne along	C1
be under no illusion /bi ,ʌndə nəʊ ɪ'lu:ʒn/ idiom as used: under no illusion	to understand a situation clearly and realistically, without any false hopes <i>I am under no illusion about how hard it will be to study abroad on a limited budget.</i>	fully aware, realistic, clear-eyed, in no doubt	C2
bear responsibility /,beə rɪ'spɒnsə'bɪləti/ collocation as used: bear some responsibility	to be partly to blame for something or to have a duty to deal with it <i>Parents bear some responsibility for how much time their children spend online.</i>	share the blame, be accountable, take responsibility	C1
beautifully shot /,bjʊ:tɪfli 'ʃɒt/ collocation	filmed or photographed in a very skilful and attractive way <i>The documentary about the Sundarbans was beautifully shot, with stunning scenes of the mangrove forest.</i>	well filmed, visually stunning, gorgeously photographed	C1

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bedrock /'bedrɒk/ noun BED·rock	the basic principles or facts on which something is built and depends <i>Trust is the bedrock of any lasting friendship.</i>	foundation, cornerstone, basis, backbone	C2
befriending scheme /bɪ'frendɪŋ ski:m/ collocation as used: befriending schemes	an organised programme in which volunteers regularly visit or phone lonely people <i>Our local council runs a befriending scheme that pairs students with elderly residents living alone.</i>	companionship programme, outreach programme, visiting service	C2
belonging /bɪ'lɒŋɪŋ/ noun be·LONG·ing	a feeling of being accepted and at home as part of a group or place <i>Joining the local football club gave me a real sense of belonging in a new city.</i>	acceptance, attachment, connection, inclusion	B2
beneficial /,benɪ'fɪʃl/ adjective ben·e·FI·cial	having a good or helpful effect <i>A short walk after lunch is beneficial for both your digestion and your concentration.</i>	helpful, advantageous, good for you, valuable	B2
benevolence /bə'nevələns/ noun be·NEV·o·lence	the quality of being kind and wanting to help others <i>The old doctor was known for his benevolence, often treating poor patients without charge.</i>	kindness, generosity, goodwill, compassion	C2
benevolent /bə'nevələnt/ adjective be·NEV·o·lent	kind and intended to help or protect someone rather than harm them <i>Her small lie about liking the gift was benevolent, meant only to spare her friend's feelings.</i>	kind, well-meaning, good-natured, charitable	C2
betray someone's trust /bɪ'treɪ ,sʌmwʌnz 'trʌst/ collocation as used: betray his trust	to disappoint someone who relied on you by doing something dishonest or careless <i>Sharing a friend's secret with others is the quickest way to betray their trust.</i>	let someone down, break someone's trust, deceive	C1
bind /baɪnd/ verb BIND	to unite people and make them feel closely connected <i>Shared meals and festivals bind families together, even when they live far apart.</i>	unite, connect, tie, join	C1
binding /'baɪndɪŋ/ adjective BIND·ing	having legal force, so that people must obey it <i>Once you sign a rental agreement, it becomes a binding contract.</i>	obligatory, legally enforceable, compulsory, mandatory	C2
binge-watch /'bɪndʒ wɒtʃ/ verb BINGE·watch	to watch many episodes of a television series one after another in a short time <i>During the holidays, my cousins and I binge-watched an entire crime drama in two days.</i>	marathon, watch back to back, devour	C1
binge-watching /'bɪndʒ wɒtʃɪŋ/ noun BINGE·watch·ing	the habit of watching many episodes of a series one after another <i>Binge-watching late at night is one of the main reasons many students feel tired in class.</i>	marathon viewing, back-to-back viewing, screen marathons	C1
biodiversity /,baɪəʊdaɪ'vɜ:səti/ noun bi·o·di·VER·si·ty	the wide variety of plants and animals living in a particular area <i>Protecting wetlands is vital for biodiversity, because so many birds and fish depend on them.</i>	variety of life, range of species, ecological diversity	C1
bite your tongue /baɪt jɔ: 'tʌŋ/ idiom as used: bite my tongue	to stop yourself from saying something that might upset someone or cause trouble <i>When my uncle criticises young people, I usually bite my tongue to avoid an argument.</i>	hold your tongue, keep quiet, hold back	C1

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bite-sized /'baɪt saɪzd/ adjective BITE--sized	small and short enough to be dealt with or learned easily <i>Language apps break grammar into bite-sized lessons you can finish on the bus.</i>	short, manageable, compact, small	C1
bitterly regret /,bɪtəli rɪ'ɡret/ collocation	to feel extremely sorry and disappointed about something you did or did not do <i>I bitterly regret not learning to play an instrument when I had more free time.</i>	deeply regret, be full of remorse, rue	C1
blanket ban /,blæŋkɪt 'bæn/ collocation	a rule that completely stops something in all situations, without exceptions <i>A blanket ban on phones in schools may be unfair to students who need them for safety.</i>	total ban, complete prohibition, outright ban	C1
blanket statement /,blæŋkɪt 'steɪtmənt/ collocation	a general claim that ignores exceptions or differences between cases <i>Saying that all young people are lazy is a blanket statement that simply isn't true.</i>	generalisation, sweeping statement, broad claim	C1
bleed into /'bli:d ɪntə/ phrasal verb	to spread gradually into another area where it does not belong <i>When I study late, my revision starts to bleed into time I should spend sleeping.</i>	spill over into, seep into, encroach on	C2
blend /blend/ noun BLEND	a mixture of different things combined together <i>My city offers a blend of modern shopping centres and traditional street markets.</i>	mixture, combination, mix, fusion	B2
blended family /,blendɪd 'fæməli/ collocation as used: blended families	a family in which parents live with children from their previous relationships <i>In blended families, it can take time for step-siblings to feel comfortable with each other.</i>	stepfamily, reconstituted family, patchwork family	C1
blind obedience /,blaɪnd ə'bi:diəns/ collocation	following orders or rules without thinking about whether they are right <i>Good schools teach students to question ideas rather than show blind obedience to authority.</i>	unquestioning obedience, blind loyalty, submissiveness	C1
blindly /'blaɪndli/ adverb BLIND·ly	without thinking carefully or checking whether something is correct <i>People shouldn't blindly follow advice from influencers without checking the facts themselves.</i>	unquestioningly, uncritically, without thinking	C1
blissfully /'blɪsfəli/ adverb BLISS·ful·ly	in an extremely happy and peaceful way <i>We spent a blissfully quiet week in the hills with no internet connection at all.</i>	wonderfully, delightfully, perfectly, happily	C1
blossom /'blɒsəm/ verb BLOS·som	to develop in a positive and successful way <i>Their business partnership blossomed into a close friendship over the years.</i>	flourish, develop, grow, bloom	C1
blur /blɜ:/ verb BLUR	to become less clear or distinct, so two things are hard to separate <i>Working from home can blur the line between office hours and family time.</i>	fade, merge, become indistinct	C1
blurred /blɜ:d/ adjective BLURRED	no longer clear or easy to separate <i>For many freelancers, the distinction between weekdays and weekends has become blurred.</i>	unclear, indistinct, fuzzy, hazy	C1

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bombard /bɒmˈbɑːd/ verb bom·BARD as used: bombarded	to direct a constant and overwhelming amount of information or messages at someone <i>Shoppers are bombarded with special offers the moment they walk into a shopping centre.</i>	flood, overwhelm, inundate, swamp	C1
boundary /ˈbaʊndri/ noun BOUND·a·ry as used: boundaries	a limit on acceptable behaviour that helps protect time, privacy or wellbeing <i>I set clear boundaries with colleagues, so I don't answer work emails after eight.</i>	limit, rule, line, guideline	B2
boundless /ˈbaʊndləs/ adjective BOUND·less	seeming to have no limits or end <i>Young children have boundless energy and curiosity about the world around them.</i>	limitless, endless, infinite, unlimited	C2
brain drain /ˈbreɪn dreɪn/ collocation	the movement of highly skilled and educated people from one country to another for better opportunities <i>Many developing countries suffer a brain drain when their doctors move abroad for higher salaries.</i>	exodus of talent, talent loss, skilled emigration	C1
break down stereotypes /ˌbreɪk daʊn ˈsteriətaɪps/ collocation	to reduce fixed and unfair ideas people have about a group <i>Student exchange programmes help break down stereotypes by letting young people meet face to face.</i>	challenge preconceptions, dispel myths, combat prejudice	C1
breakneck pace /ˌbreɪknek ˈpeɪs/ collocation	an extremely fast and sometimes dangerous speed <i>My city is developing at a breakneck pace, with new towers appearing every few months.</i>	lightning speed, rapid pace, frantic speed	C2
breakthrough /ˈbreɪkθruː/ noun BREAK·through	a sudden important discovery or success after a period of difficulty <i>After weeks of struggling with grammar, I had a breakthrough and suddenly everything made sense.</i>	advance, leap forward, discovery, progress	B2
breathtaking /ˈbreɪtkeɪɪŋ/ adjective BREATH·tak·ing	extremely beautiful or impressive, so that you feel amazed <i>The view from the top of the hill at sunrise was absolutely breathtaking.</i>	stunning, spectacular, magnificent, awe-inspiring	B2
breed corruption /ˌbriːd kəˈrʌpʃn/ collocation as used: breeds corruption	to create conditions in which dishonest behaviour by people in power becomes common <i>A lack of transparency in public spending tends to breed corruption at every level.</i>	foster corruption, encourage dishonesty, give rise to corruption	C2
breed insecurity /ˌbriːd ˌɪnsɪˈkjʊərəti/ collocation	to cause people to feel unsure of themselves and lacking in confidence <i>Comparing yourself with edited photos online can easily breed insecurity about your appearance.</i>	create self-doubt, foster insecurity, undermine confidence	C2
breed social tension /ˌbriːd ˌsəʊʃl ˈtenʃn/ collocation	to create conflict and bad feeling between different groups in society <i>Unfair housing policies can breed social tension between long-term residents and newcomers.</i>	cause unrest, create friction, stir up conflict	C2
breeding programme /ˈbriːdɪŋ ˌprəʊgræm/ collocation as used: breeding programmes	a planned scheme to help rare animals produce young, often in zoos or reserves <i>A successful breeding programme has helped increase the number of Bengal tigers in the reserve.</i>	captive breeding scheme, conservation breeding, reproduction programme	C1
bridge /brɪdʒ/ verb BRIDGE	to reduce or remove a difference or division between two groups <i>Grandparents learning to use video calls can help bridge the gap between generations.</i>	close, narrow, span, overcome	C1

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bridge the gap /ˌbrɪdʒ ðə 'ɡæp/ <i>idiom</i> as used: bridging the gap	to reduce the difference or separation between two groups or things <i>Internship schemes are useful for bridging the gap between classroom theory and real work.</i>	close the gap, narrow the divide, connect	C1
broad-minded /ˌbrɔːd 'maɪndɪd/ <i>adjective</i> broad-MIND-ed	willing to accept other people's opinions and ways of life that differ from your own <i>Travelling widely has made my father far more broad-minded than he was in his youth.</i>	open-minded, tolerant, liberal, unprejudiced	C1
broaden /'brɔːdn/ <i>verb</i> BROAD-en	to increase the range of your knowledge or experience <i>Reading international news helps me broaden my understanding of global issues.</i>	expand, widen, extend, enlarge	B2
broaden /'brɔːdn/ <i>verb</i> BROAD-en as used: broadening	to make your knowledge or experience wider or more varied <i>Documentaries are an enjoyable way of broadening your general knowledge in the evenings.</i>	expanding, widening, extending, increasing	B2
broaden horizons /ˌbrɔːdn hə'reɪznz/ <i>idiom</i> as used: broadens horizons	to widen people's knowledge, experience and understanding of the world <i>Learning a foreign language broadens horizons by opening doors to other cultures.</i>	opens minds, widens outlooks, expands perspectives	C1
broaden one's horizons /ˌbrɔːdn wʌnz hə'reɪznz/ <i>idiom</i>	to gain new experiences and knowledge that change the way you see the world <i>Volunteering abroad is a great way to broaden one's horizons while helping others.</i>	expand one's outlook, open one's eyes, widen one's experience	C1
broaden the mind /ˌbrɔːdn ðə 'maɪnd/ <i>idiom</i> as used: broadens the mind	to make you more tolerant and understanding by showing you new things <i>People often say that travel broadens the mind, and my trip to Nepal certainly proved it.</i>	opens the mind, enlightens, expands one's outlook	C1
broaden your horizons /ˌbrɔːdn jɔː hə'reɪznz/ <i>idiom</i> as used: broadened my horizons	to gain new experiences that increase your knowledge and understanding of the world <i>Working in an international team has broadened my horizons more than any textbook.</i>	open your eyes, expand your outlook, enrich your experience	C1
broaden your perspective /ˌbrɔːdn jɔː pə'spektɪv/ <i>collocation</i>	to help you understand things from a wider range of viewpoints <i>Talking with people from different generations can really broaden your perspective on life.</i>	widen your outlook, open your mind, expand your viewpoint	C1
brownfield site /'braʊnfɪːld saɪt/ <i>collocation</i> as used: brownfield sites	land previously used for industry or building that can be developed again <i>Building homes on brownfield sites protects the countryside around growing cities.</i>	former industrial land, derelict land, previously developed land	C2
browse /braʊz/ <i>verb</i> BROWSE as used: browses	to look through items or information online in a relaxed way, without a fixed plan <i>My mother browses cooking websites every evening for new recipes to try.</i>	look through, scroll through, scan, skim	B2
browse /braʊz/ <i>verb</i> BROWSE as used: browsing	to look around shops casually, without necessarily intending to buy anything <i>I love browsing in second-hand bookshops, even when I leave without buying anything.</i>	window-shopping, looking around, wandering round	B2
brutal /'bruːtl/ <i>adjective</i> BRU-tal	extremely unpleasant and difficult to deal with <i>The summer heat in Dhaka can be brutal, so I avoid going out at midday.</i>	harsh, tough, punishing, gruelling	C1

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brutally honest /ˌbruːtəli ˈɒnɪst/ collocation	telling the complete truth even when it is unpleasant or hurtful to hear <i>My best friend is brutally honest about my cooking, which is exactly why I trust her opinion.</i>	blunt, frank, candid, straight-talking	C1
bucket list /'bʌkɪt lɪst/ collocation	a list of things you hope to do or experience during your lifetime <i>Seeing the northern lights has been on my bucket list since I was a child.</i>	wish list, life goals, dream list	B2
budge /bʌdʒ/ verb BUDGE	to change your opinion or position, usually used in negative sentences <i>My father would not budge on his decision, however hard I tried to persuade him.</i>	give way, yield, compromise, back down	C1
budget airline /ˌbʌdʒɪt ˈeəlaɪn/ collocation as used: budget airlines	an airline offering cheap tickets with few extra services <i>Budget airlines have made short holidays abroad affordable for many students.</i>	low-cost airline, no-frills airline, cheap carrier	B2
burden /'bɜːdn/ noun BUR·den	a duty or responsibility that causes worry, stress or hard work <i>Caring for elderly relatives can become a heavy burden when there is no support.</i>	load, weight, strain, responsibility	C1
burden-sharing /'bɜːdn ˌʃeərɪŋ/ noun BUR·den--shar·ing	the fair division of costs or responsibilities among several groups or countries <i>Fair burden-sharing among housemates prevents arguments about who pays for what.</i>	cost-sharing, shared responsibility, division of labour	C2
buried in /'berɪd ɪn/ phrase	hidden among a large amount of other things, so it is hard to find <i>The important email was buried in hundreds of unread messages in my inbox.</i>	hidden in, lost among, tucked away in	C1
burn the midnight oil /ˌbɜːn ðə ˌmɪdnɑːt ˈɔɪl/ idiom	to work or study until very late at night <i>Before my university finals, I had to burn the midnight oil for weeks.</i>	stay up late, pull an all-nighter, work late	C1
burnout /'bɜːnaʊt/ noun BURN·out	a state of physical and mental exhaustion caused by working too hard for too long <i>Taking regular holidays is one of the simplest ways to avoid burnout.</i>	exhaustion, fatigue, breakdown	C1
bustling /'bʌslɪŋ/ adjective BUS·tling	full of busy people and activity <i>The old part of the city is bustling with rickshaws, traders and shoppers from dawn to dusk.</i>	busy, lively, crowded, thronging	C1
buzzing /'bʌzɪŋ/ adjective BUZZ·ing	full of excitement, activity and lively noise <i>The stadium was buzzing long before the match started.</i>	lively, vibrant, electric, humming	C1
by-product /'baɪ ˌprɒdʌkt/ noun BY--prod·uct	an unplanned result or side effect that happens because of something else <i>Better sleep was a welcome by-product of giving up late-night coffee.</i>	side effect, consequence, spin-off, result	C1
calming /'kɑːmɪŋ/ adjective CALM·ing	making you feel relaxed and peaceful <i>I find the sound of rain on the roof incredibly calming after a busy day.</i>	soothing, relaxing, peaceful, restful	B2
camaraderie /ˌkæməˈrɑːdəri/ noun cam·a·RA·de·rie	a feeling of friendship and trust among people who spend time or work together <i>The camaraderie in our study group made long revision sessions far more bearable.</i>	friendship, fellowship, team spirit, companionship	C2

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can only do so much /kən ˌəʊnli duː 'səʊ mʌtʃ/ idiom as used: only do so much	there is a limit to what someone is able to achieve alone <i>Teachers can only do so much if parents do not support learning at home.</i>	have limited power, be limited, have limits	C1
candid /'kændɪd/ adjective CAN·did	honest and direct, even about difficult or personal things <i>My manager gave me candid feedback that was hard to hear but very useful.</i>	frank, open, honest, straightforward	C1
capable /'keɪpəbl/ adjective CA·pa·ble	having the ability and skill to do something well <i>Leading the project showed me that I was capable of managing a team.</i>	competent, able, skilled, proficient	B2
capital /'kæpɪtl/ noun CAP·i·tal	money used to start or grow a business <i>My cousin raised the capital for her small bakery by saving for five years.</i>	funds, money, finance, investment	C1
capitalise on /'kæpɪtəlaɪz ɒn/ phrasal verb	to use a situation or advantage to gain something useful for yourself <i>Local shops capitalise on the festival season by offering special discounts.</i>	take advantage of, make the most of, exploit, cash in on	C1
captivated /'kæptɪveɪtɪd/ adjective CAP·ti·vat·ed	so interested or charmed by something that you give it all your attention <i>The audience was captivated by the storyteller's vivid description of village life.</i>	enchanted, fascinated, spellbound, entranced	C1
captivating /'kæptɪveɪtɪŋ/ adjective CAP·ti·vat·ing	extremely interesting or attractive, so it holds your attention completely <i>The novel was so captivating that I finished it in a single evening.</i>	fascinating, enchanting, gripping, compelling	C1
captivity /kæp'tɪvəti/ noun cap·TIV·i·ty	the situation of an animal being kept in a cage or enclosed area rather than living freely <i>Elephants kept in captivity often show signs of stress and boredom.</i>	confinement, enclosure, imprisonment	C1
capture /'kæptʃə/ verb CAP·ture as used: capturing	to record something in a photograph or video so it can be kept <i>My father loves capturing family moments with his old camera rather than his phone.</i>	record, photograph, film, preserve	B2
carbon footprint /,kɑːbən 'fʊtprɪnt/ collocation	the amount of carbon dioxide released because of a person's or organisation's activities <i>Taking the train instead of flying is one simple way to reduce your carbon footprint.</i>	environmental impact, emissions, carbon emissions	B2
carbon labelling /,kɑːbən 'leɪbəlɪŋ/ collocation	showing on a product how much greenhouse gas was produced in making and transporting it <i>Carbon labelling on food packaging would help shoppers make greener choices quickly.</i>	emissions labelling, eco-labelling, climate labelling	C2
carbon pricing /,kɑːbən 'praɪsɪŋ/ collocation	a policy that makes companies pay for the carbon dioxide they release <i>Carbon pricing encourages factories to switch to cleaner energy because pollution becomes expensive.</i>	carbon tax, emissions trading, pollution pricing	C2
career progression /kəˌrɪə prəˈɡreʃn/ collocation	moving up to more senior and better-paid positions in your job over time <i>Many graduates choose employers that offer clear career progression and training opportunities.</i>	promotion, career advancement, career development	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
carefree /'keəfri:/ adjective CARE-free	having no worries or responsibilities <i>Summer holidays at my grandparents' village were the most carefree weeks of my childhood.</i>	untroubled, relaxed, light-hearted, happy-go-lucky	C1
carelessly /'keələsli/ adverb CARE-less-ly	without enough thought or attention, so mistakes or waste happen <i>I used to spend money carelessly on snacks until I started tracking my expenses.</i>	thoughtlessly, recklessly, wastefully, without care	B2
carve out /,kɑ:v 'aʊt/ phrasal verb as used: carving out	to deliberately create time or space for something through effort <i>I try to carve out an hour every Sunday for reading, away from my phone.</i>	set aside, make time for, create, reserve	C1
catch somebody off guard /,kætʃ 'sʌmbədi ɒf 'gɑ:d/ idiom as used: off guard	to surprise someone when they are not prepared <i>The examiner's question about my home town caught me off guard, but I managed to answer calmly.</i>	take by surprise, catch unawares, catch napping	C1
cater to /'keɪtə tu:/ phrasal verb as used: caters to	to provide what a particular group of people needs or wants <i>The new library caters to both young children and elderly readers.</i>	serve, provide for, accommodate, suit	C1
caveat /'kæviæt/ noun CAV-e-at	a warning or condition that should be considered before accepting something <i>I would recommend online courses, with one caveat, that you need strong self-discipline.</i>	proviso, qualification, condition, warning	C2
censorship /'sensəʃɪp/ noun CEN-sor-ship	the practice of controlling or removing information and opinions that authorities dislike <i>Strict censorship of the press makes it difficult for citizens to find out what is really happening.</i>	suppression, restriction, control of information	C1
centred /'sentəd/ adjective CEN-tred	feeling calm, balanced and emotionally in control <i>A few minutes of quiet breathing each morning helps me feel centred before work.</i>	grounded, balanced, composed, calm	C2
centrepiece /'sentəpi:s/ noun CEN-tre-piece	the most important or attractive part of an event or occasion <i>The fireworks display was the centrepiece of our city's new year celebrations.</i>	highlight, focal point, main attraction, heart	C1
challenging /'tʃælɪndʒɪŋ/ adjective CHAL-leng-ing	difficult in a way that tests your ability and determination <i>Learning to cook for a family of six was more challenging than I expected.</i>	demanding, difficult, tough, testing	B2
champion /'tʃæmpiən/ verb CHAM-pi-on	to publicly support and fight for a cause or group <i>Several young athletes now champion mental health awareness on social media.</i>	support, promote, advocate, stand up for	C1
chaos /'keɪɒs/ noun CHA-os	a state of complete confusion and disorder <i>A single broken traffic light caused total chaos on the main road this morning.</i>	disorder, confusion, mayhem, turmoil	B2
chaotic /'keɪ'ɒtɪk/ adjective cha-OT-ic	very busy, noisy and disorganised <i>Our house gets rather chaotic during Eid, with relatives arriving from every direction.</i>	disorganised, hectic, frantic, messy	B2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
character /'kærəktə/ noun CHAR·ac·ter	the moral qualities of a person, such as honesty, courage and reliability <i>How someone treats waiters and cleaners says a lot about their character.</i>	integrity, moral strength, nature, personality	B2
character-building /'kærəktə ,bɪldɪŋ/ adjective CHAR·ac·ter--build·ing	helping to develop good personal qualities such as patience and determination <i>Part-time jobs during university can be character-building, even when the work is dull.</i>	formative, strengthening, developmental	C1
charisma /kə'rizmə/ noun cha·RIS·ma	a strong personal charm that attracts and inspires other people <i>Our head teacher had such charisma that the whole school listened when she spoke.</i>	charm, presence, magnetism, appeal	C1
charm /tʃɑ:m/ noun CHARM	a pleasing quality that makes something attractive or likeable <i>The narrow lanes and old houses give the town a special charm.</i>	appeal, attraction, allure, character	B2
charming /'tʃɑ:mɪŋ/ adjective CHARM·ing	pleasant and attractive in a gentle, often old-fashioned way <i>We stayed in a charming guesthouse with a small garden full of flowers.</i>	delightful, lovely, quaint, enchanting	B2
cherished /'tʃerɪʃt/ adjective CHER·ished	loved and valued very much <i>My grandfather's old watch is one of my most cherished possessions.</i>	treasured, beloved, precious, dear	C1
chiefly /'tʃi:flɪ/ adverb CHIEF·ly	mainly, or more than anything else <i>I use my tablet chiefly for reading, though I occasionally watch films on it.</i>	mainly, mostly, primarily, principally	C1
chilling effect /,tʃɪlɪŋ ɪ'fekt/ collocation	a situation where fear of punishment stops people from speaking or acting freely <i>Harsh online abuse can have a chilling effect, discouraging people from sharing their views.</i>	deterrent effect, silencing effect, intimidating effect	C2
chip away at /,tʃɪp ə'weɪ æt/ phrasal verb as used: chipped away at	to gradually reduce something through small, repeated efforts <i>Speaking to one new person every day chipped away at my shyness over time.</i>	gradually reduce, wear down, erode, whittle away	C2
chronic /'krɒnɪk/ adjective CHRON·ic	continuing for a long time or happening again and again, usually as a problem <i>Chronic lack of sleep can seriously affect your concentration and mood.</i>	persistent, long-term, constant, ongoing	C1
chronically /'krɒnɪkli/ adverb CHRON·i·cal·ly	in a way that continues for a long time and is difficult to change <i>Many hospitals are chronically understaffed, so doctors work extremely long hours.</i>	persistently, constantly, continually, permanently	C1
churn out /,tʃɜ:n 'aʊt/ phrasal verb as used: churned out	to produce large amounts of something quickly, without much care or quality <i>Fast fashion brands churn out cheap clothes that often fall apart after a few washes.</i>	mass-produce, turn out, crank out	C2
circular economy /,sɜ:kjələr ɪ'kɒnəmi/ collocation	an economic system that reduces waste by reusing, repairing and recycling materials <i>Repair cafés are a small but practical example of the circular economy in action.</i>	sustainable economy, zero-waste economy, closed-loop system	C1

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citizenship /'sɪtɪzənʃɪp/ noun CIT·i·zen·ship	the way a person behaves as a responsible, active member of society <i>Volunteering teaches young people good citizenship and a sense of duty to their community.</i>	civic responsibility, civic duty, public spirit	C1
civil disobedience /,sɪvl ,dɪsə'bi:diəns/ collocation	peacefully refusing to obey certain laws as a form of political protest <i>Many historic reforms began with ordinary people practising civil disobedience against unfair laws.</i>	peaceful protest, non-violent resistance, passive resistance	C2
civilised /'sɪvəlaɪzd/ adjective CIV·i·lised	fair, humane and reasonable, as expected in an advanced society <i>A civilised society should look after its elderly and disabled citizens properly.</i>	humane, enlightened, decent, cultured	C1
clash /klæʃ/ noun CLASH as used: clashes	a short argument or disagreement between people with different opinions <i>There were a few clashes between my brother and me over how to plan our parents' anniversary.</i>	disagreement, conflict, argument, quarrel	C1
clear conscience /,klɪə 'kɒŋfəns/ collocation	the feeling that you have done nothing wrong and have no reason to feel guilty <i>I returned the extra change to the shopkeeper so I could leave with a clear conscience.</i>	peace of mind, clean hands, guilt-free mind	C1
clear the air /,klɪə ði 'eə/ idiom as used: cleared the air	to talk openly about a problem in order to end a disagreement or bad feeling <i>After a week of silence, my flatmate and I finally sat down and cleared the air.</i>	patch things up, settle differences, make peace	C1
clear-headed /,klɪə 'hedɪd/ adjective clear·-HEAD·ed	able to think clearly and sensibly <i>A good night's sleep before an exam keeps you calm and clear-headed.</i>	alert, focused, sharp, lucid	C1
climate refugee /,klaɪmət ,refju'dʒi:/ collocation as used: climate refugees	a person forced to leave their home because of the effects of climate change <i>Rising floods in coastal villages could turn thousands of farmers into climate refugees.</i>	environmental migrant, climate migrant, displaced person	C1
close-knit /,kləʊs 'nɪt/ adjective close·-KNIT	closely connected, with members who support and care about each other <i>I grew up in a close-knit neighbourhood where everyone knew each other's names.</i>	tight-knit, united, intimate, closely bonded	C1
clumsy /'klʌmzi/ adjective CLUM·sy	lacking skill or ease when learning or doing something practical, so you make awkward mistakes <i>I was so clumsy in the kitchen at first that I broke two glasses in a single week.</i>	awkward, inept, ham-fisted	B2
co-living /,kəʊ'li:vɪŋ/ noun co·-LIV·ing	a type of housing where people rent private rooms but share kitchens, living areas and facilities <i>Co-living appeals to young professionals who want affordable rent and a ready-made social circle in a new city.</i>	shared living, house sharing, communal housing	C1
coexist /,kəʊɪg'zɪst/ verb co·ex·IST	to exist together at the same time or in the same place <i>Old traditions and modern lifestyles coexist quite comfortably in most Bangladeshi towns.</i>	exist side by side, live together, co-occur	C1
coherent /kəʊ'hɪərənt/ adjective co·HER·ent	clear, logical and well organised, so that the parts fit together sensibly <i>In the exam, it helps to give a coherent answer with a clear main point and a supporting example.</i>	logical, clear, well-structured, lucid	C1

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cohesion /kəʊ'hi:ʒn/ noun co·HE·sion	the state of people in a group being united and getting on well together <i>Shared festivals and public celebrations can strengthen social cohesion in diverse neighbourhoods.</i>	unity, solidarity, togetherness	C1
cohesive /kəʊ'hi:sɪv/ adjective co·HE·sive	united, with people or parts that fit and work well together <i>A cohesive team usually solves problems faster because everyone trusts one another.</i>	united, unified, close-knit	C1
collaborative /kə'læbəreɪtɪv/ adjective col·LAB·o·ra·tive	involving people working together and sharing ideas to achieve something <i>Many universities now favour collaborative projects, where students work in small groups rather than alone.</i>	cooperative, joint, team-based	C1
collapse /kə'læps/ verb col·LAPSE as used: collapsed	(of a business or plan) to fail suddenly and completely <i>Many small shops collapsed during the pandemic because they could no longer pay their rent.</i>	fail, fold, go under, break down	B2
collective /kə'lektɪv/ adjective col·LEC·tive	shared or done by all the members of a group together <i>Cleaning up the riverbank was a collective effort involving almost everyone in the neighbourhood.</i>	shared, communal, joint, common	B2
collective good /kə'lektɪv 'gʊd/ collocation	the benefit or welfare of society as a whole, rather than of individuals <i>Paying taxes can feel painful, but it funds schools and hospitals that serve the collective good.</i>	common good, public interest, general welfare	C1
come down to /kʌm 'daʊn tuː/ phrasal verb as used: comes down to	to depend mainly on one particular factor <i>In the end, choosing a university often comes down to cost and location.</i>	depend on, boil down to, hinge on	C1
come down with /kʌm 'daʊn wɪð/ phrasal verb as used: came down with	to become ill with a particular illness, usually not a serious one <i>I came down with a cold the day before my interview and had to speak with a hoarse voice.</i>	catch, develop, pick up, fall ill with	B2
come out of your shell /kʌm ,aʊt əv ʃɔ: 'ʃel/ idiom as used: come out of my shell	to become less shy and more confident with other people <i>Joining the university debating club really helped my younger sister come out of her shell.</i>	open up, gain confidence, become more outgoing	C1
come to appreciate /kʌm tu ə'pri:ʃieɪt/ phrase	to gradually begin to value or understand something over time <i>Living away from home, many students come to appreciate their parents' cooking far more.</i>	grow to value, learn to value, begin to recognise	B2
come to terms with /kʌm tə 'tɜ:mz wɪð/ idiom	to gradually accept a sad or difficult situation <i>It took my grandfather a long time to come to terms with giving up his old routines.</i>	accept, make peace with, reconcile yourself to, get over	C1
comfort zone /'kʌmfət zəʊn/ noun	a familiar situation where you feel safe and relaxed but are not challenged <i>Giving a presentation in English pushed me well outside my comfort zone.</i>	familiar territory, safe space, routine	B2
comforting /'kʌmfətiŋ/ adjective COM·fort·ing	making you feel calm, safe and less worried or sad <i>On a rainy evening, a cup of sweet milky tea is incredibly comforting.</i>	soothing, reassuring, consoling, heart-warming	B2

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commemorate /kə'meməreɪt/ verb com·MEM·o·rate as used: commemorates	to honour and remind people of an important past event or person <i>The national monument commemorates those who lost their lives during the Liberation War.</i>	honour, remember, pay tribute to, mark	C1
commendable /kə'mendəbl/ adjective com·MEND·a·ble	deserving praise and approval because it is good or admirable <i>It is commendable that so many young volunteers help clean the beaches every year.</i>	praiseworthy, admirable, laudable	C1
commercial trappings /kə,mɜːʃl 'træpɪŋz/ collocation	the shopping, advertising and spending that surround an event but are not its real purpose <i>For me, Eid is about family and prayer, not the commercial trappings of new clothes and gadgets.</i>	commercialism, consumer extras, materialistic trimmings	C2
commercialised /kə'mɜːʃəlaɪzd/ adjective com·MER·cial·ised	focused mainly on making money and selling things rather than on original meaning <i>Some people feel that weddings have become too commercialised, with families spending far more than they can afford.</i>	profit-driven, commodified, materialistic	C1
commitment /kə'mɪtmənt/ noun com·MIT·ment	willingness to give your time and energy to something you believe in <i>Learning a language to a high level takes years of commitment and regular practice.</i>	dedication, devotion, determination	B2
committed /kə'mɪtɪd/ adjective com·MIT·ted	loyal and willing to work hard for a particular aim <i>The most committed volunteers turned up every weekend, even during the monsoon.</i>	dedicated, devoted, wholehearted	B2
commodification /kə,mɒdɪfɪ'keɪʃn/ noun com·mod·i·fi·CA·tion	treating something, such as culture, as a product to be bought and sold <i>Some critics worry about the commodification of traditional crafts, which are now mass-produced for souvenir shops.</i>	commercialisation, marketisation, monetisation	C2
commodity /kə'mɒdəti/ noun com·MOD·i·ty	a product that is bought and sold mainly for profit <i>When housing is treated purely as a commodity, ordinary families can be priced out of their own cities.</i>	product, asset, goods, merchandise	C1
commonplace /'kɒmənpleɪs/ adjective COM·mon·place	happening or seen so often that it is considered normal <i>Video calls with relatives abroad have become commonplace, even among older people.</i>	common, widespread, routine, everyday	C1
communal /'kɒmjənəl/ adjective COM·mu·nal	shared and enjoyed by a group of people together <i>Iftar during Ramadan is often a communal meal, shared with neighbours as well as family.</i>	shared, collective, joint	C1
companionship /kəm'pæniənʃɪp/ noun com·PAN·ion·ship	the pleasant feeling of having friendly company and not being alone <i>Many elderly people keep pets mainly for companionship.</i>	company, friendship, fellowship	C1
compare yourself /kəm,peə ʃɜː'self/ phrase as used: compare themselves	to judge your own life, looks or success against other people's <i>Teenagers who compare themselves to influencers often end up feeling that their own lives are dull.</i>	measure yourself against, benchmark yourself, weigh yourself against	B2
compassion /kəm'pæʃn/ noun com·PAS·sion	a strong feeling of sympathy for people who are suffering and a wish to help them <i>Nurses need technical skills, but compassion matters just as much when patients are frightened.</i>	kindness, sympathy, empathy, care	C1

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compel /kəm'pel/ verb com·PEL as used: compels	to force or strongly push someone to do something <i>Rising rents compel many young people to share flats well into their thirties.</i>	force, oblige, drive, push	C1
compelling /kəm'pelɪŋ/ adjective com·PEL·ɪŋ	so convincing that you feel you must accept or believe it <i>There are compelling reasons to learn a second language, from better job prospects to easier travel.</i>	convincing, persuasive, powerful, strong	C1
compensate /'kɒmpenseɪt/ verb COM·pen·sate	to make up for something bad or missing by providing something good <i>No amount of money can compensate for spending too little time with your family.</i>	make up for, offset, counterbalance, balance out	C1
competence /'kɒmpɪtəns/ noun COM·pe·tence	the ability to do something well and effectively <i>Interviews are designed to test a candidate's competence as well as their personality.</i>	ability, skill, capability, proficiency	C1
competency /'kɒmpɪtənsɪ/ noun COM·pe·ten·cy as used: competencies	a particular skill or ability needed to do something well <i>Teamwork and communication are key competencies that many employers look for in graduates.</i>	skill, capability, ability	C1
competitive edge /kəm,petətɪv 'edʒ/ collocation	an advantage that makes you more likely to succeed than others <i>Speaking a second foreign language can give graduates a competitive edge in the job market.</i>	advantage, upper hand, head start	C1
complacency /kəm'pleɪnsɪ/ noun com·PLA·cen·cy	a feeling of being too satisfied with your situation, so you stop trying to improve <i>Winning easily can breed complacency, so good coaches keep pushing their players.</i>	smugness, self-satisfaction, laziness	C2
complacent /kəm'pleɪsnt/ adjective com·PLA·cent	too satisfied with yourself, so you stop making an effort <i>After passing the first round, I became complacent and hardly prepared for the final interview.</i>	smug, self-satisfied, overconfident	C1
complement /'kɒmplɪment/ verb COM·ple·ment	to go well with something else and make it look or seem better <i>A simple white shirt can complement almost any colour of trousers.</i>	go with, suit, enhance, set off	C1
complement /'kɒmplɪment/ verb COM·ple·ment as used: complementing	to add to something in a way that improves it or makes it complete <i>Online resources are excellent for complementing what students learn in the classroom.</i>	supplement, enhance, support, round off	C1
complementary /,kɒmplɪ'mentri/ adjective com·ple·MEN·ta·ry	different but working well together, each adding what the other lacks <i>Online lessons and classroom teaching can be complementary rather than competing approaches.</i>	mutually supportive, compatible, matching	C1
complex web /,kɒmpleks 'web/ collocation	a complicated set of closely connected things that influence each other <i>Traffic problems in big cities result from a complex web of planning, population and economic issues.</i>	tangle, network, intricate mix	C1
compliance /kəm'plaɪəns/ noun com·PLI·ance	the act of obeying a rule, order or person <i>Regular fines have improved compliance with helmet laws among motorcyclists.</i>	obedience, conformity, submission	C1

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composed /kəm'pəʊzd/ adjective com·POSED	calm and in control of your feelings <i>Despite her nerves, she stayed composed throughout the job interview.</i>	calm, collected, self-possessed, unflustered	C1
composure /kəm'pəʊʒə(r)/ noun com·PO·sure	the state of staying calm and in control, especially in a difficult situation <i>The captain kept his composure even when the team was losing badly.</i>	calmness, self-control, poise, equanimity	C2
comprehensive /ˌkɒmprɪ'hensɪv/ adjective com·pre·HEN·sive	including all or nearly all the parts or aspects of something <i>Tackling obesity requires a comprehensive plan covering diet, exercise and education.</i>	thorough, all-inclusive, wide-ranging, complete	B2
compromise /'kɒmprəmaɪz/ verb COM·pro·mise	to accept less than you want so that an agreement can be reached <i>My sister and I compromised by taking turns to choose what to watch on TV.</i>	meet halfway, give and take, reach an agreement	B2
compulsion /kəm'pʌlʃn/ noun com·PUL·sion	a strong urge to do something that is hard to control <i>I feel a compulsion to check my phone the moment it vibrates, even during meals.</i>	urge, impulse, drive, need	C1
compulsively /kəm'pʌlsɪvli/ adverb com·PUL·sive·ly	in a way you cannot easily control, often without real need <i>Some people shop compulsively online, buying things they never actually use.</i>	obsessively, uncontrollably, habitually	C1
computer-centric /kəm.pju:tə'sentrɪk/ adjective com·pu·ter·CEN·tric	based mainly on work done using computers <i>Accounting has become a highly computer-centric profession in recent decades.</i>	computer-based, digital, screen-based, tech-focused	C1
conceal /kən'si:l/ verb con·CEAL as used: concealing	to hide something so that others cannot see or know about it <i>He tried to conceal his disappointment, but his face gave him away.</i>	hide, cover up, keep secret, disguise	C1
concentrate /'kɒnsntreɪt/ verb CON·cen·trate	to give all your attention to what you are doing <i>I find it hard to concentrate when there is loud traffic outside my window.</i>	focus, pay attention, apply yourself	B2
concentrate wealth /ˌkɒnsntreɪt 'welθ/ collocation as used: concentrates wealth	to put more and more money and resources into the hands of a small group <i>Critics say that some economic policies concentrate wealth among a small elite.</i>	accumulate wealth, centralise wealth, enrich a few	C1
concerted effort /kən,sɜ:tɪd 'efət/ collocation	a determined effort made by several people or groups working together <i>Cleaning up polluted rivers will require a concerted effort from government and local communities.</i>	joint effort, united effort, coordinated push	C1
conductive /kən'dju:sɪv/ adjective con·DU·cive	providing the right conditions for something good to happen <i>A tidy, quiet room is far more conducive to studying than a busy café.</i>	favourable, helpful, beneficial	C1
confidant /'kɒnfɪdənt/ noun CON·fi·dant as used: confidants	a trusted friend you can talk to about private feelings and problems <i>My elder sister has always been my closest confidant, even now that she lives in Dhaka.</i>	trusted friend, close friend, intimate	C2

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confident /'kɒnfɪdənt/ adjective CON·fi·dent	feeling sure of yourself and comfortable about how you look or act <i>Practising in front of a mirror helped me feel more confident before my speaking test.</i>	self-assured, self-confident, poised	B2
conform /kən'fɔ:m/ verb con·FORM	to behave in the way most people in a group expect <i>Teenagers often feel pressure to conform to their friends' tastes in clothes and music.</i>	fit in, comply, go along with, follow the crowd	C1
confront something head-on /kən,frʌnt ,sʌmθɪŋ ,hed 'ɒn/ idiom as used: confront them head-on	to deal with a problem or fear directly and boldly instead of avoiding it <i>If you are nervous about public speaking, the best cure is to confront it head-on by volunteering to present.</i>	face up to, tackle directly, meet head-on	C1
congested /kən'dʒestɪd/ adjective con·GEST·ed	so full of traffic or people that movement is very slow <i>The roads out of Dhaka are heavily congested in the days before Eid.</i>	crowded, jammed, gridlocked, overcrowded	C1
congestion charging /kən'dʒestʃən ,tʃɑ:dʒɪŋ/ noun	a system where drivers pay a fee to drive into a busy city area <i>Congestion charging could reduce traffic in city centres, but it might be unfair on lower-income drivers.</i>	road pricing, congestion charge, road toll	C1
connectivity /,kənek'tɪvəti/ noun con·nec·TIV·i·ty	the state of being connected to the internet and to other people through technology <i>Mobile connectivity has transformed rural life, allowing farmers to check market prices on their phones.</i>	being online, access, availability	C1
conscious /'kɒnʃəs/ adjective CON·scious	aware of and concerned about an issue, such as the environment <i>Young shoppers are increasingly conscious of how and where their clothes are made.</i>	aware, mindful, concerned	B2
conscious consumer /,kɒnʃəs kən'sju:mə(r)/ collocation as used: conscious consumers	a shopper who thinks carefully about the social and environmental effects of what they buy <i>Conscious consumers often choose locally made products to reduce transport emissions.</i>	ethical shopper, mindful buyer, green consumer	C1
conscious effort /,kɒnʃəs 'efət/ collocation	a deliberate attempt to do something you would not do naturally <i>I make a conscious effort to call my grandparents every weekend.</i>	deliberate effort, determined attempt, concerted effort	B2
consciously /'kɒnʃəsli/ adverb CON·scious·ly	deliberately and with full awareness of what you are doing <i>I consciously avoid checking emails after nine o'clock at night.</i>	deliberately, intentionally, mindfully, knowingly	C1
conserve /kən'sɜ:v/ verb con·SERVE	to protect something, such as an old building, from harm, damage or loss <i>Local volunteers are working to conserve the old mansions near my hometown.</i>	preserve, protect, maintain, safeguard	C1
conserve /kən'sɜ:v/ verb con·SERVE as used: conserves	to use less of something so that it lasts longer and is not wasted <i>Switching off lights in empty rooms is a simple way to conserve electricity.</i>	save, preserve, use sparingly	B2
considerably /kən'sɪdərəbli/ adverb con·SID·er·a·bly	by a large amount or to a great degree <i>Getting around Dhaka has become considerably easier for some commuters since the metro rail opened.</i>	significantly, substantially, markedly, greatly	B2

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considerate /kən'sɪdərət/ adjective con·SID·er·ate	kind and thoughtful about other people's needs and feelings <i>It was very considerate of my neighbour to keep the music down while I was studying.</i>	thoughtful, kind, caring	B2
consideration /kən,sɪdə'reɪʃn/ noun con·sid·er·A·tion	careful thought about other people's wishes and feelings <i>Showing consideration for older passengers, such as offering your seat, is still expected in Bangladesh.</i>	thoughtfulness, care, kindness, regard	B2
considered consumption /kən,sɪdəd kən'sʌmpʃn/ collocation	buying things only after careful thought about need, quality and impact <i>Considered consumption means buying fewer, better-made clothes instead of cheap fashion that falls apart.</i>	mindful consumption, conscious buying, responsible spending	C2
consistency /kən'sɪstənsi/ noun con·SIS·ten·cy	the quality of always performing or behaving to the same good standard <i>Consistency matters more than intensity when you are learning a language.</i>	reliability, steadiness, dependability	C1
consistent /kən'sɪstənt/ adjective con·SIS·tent	always behaving in the same way, whatever the situation <i>Good parents are consistent, so children know exactly what to expect.</i>	steady, unchanging, reliable, constant	B2
consistently /kən'sɪstəntli/ adverb con·SIS·tent·ly	in the same way every time, over a long period <i>She has consistently achieved top marks throughout her university course.</i>	regularly, reliably, steadily, always	B2
consolidate /kən'sɒlɪdeɪt/ verb con·SOL·i·date as used: consolidates	to combine several things into one more effective whole <i>The new banking app consolidates all my accounts in one place.</i>	combine, unify, bring together, merge	C1
constant connectivity /,kɒnstənt ,kɒnek'tɪvəti/ collocation	being online and reachable all the time through phones and other devices <i>Constant connectivity makes it hard for many workers to switch off at the weekend.</i>	always-on culture, permanent availability, being always online	C1
constant pull /,kɒnstənt 'pʊl/ collocation	a continuous attraction that keeps drawing your attention towards something <i>Many students struggle to resist the constant pull of social media while revising.</i>	constant lure, ongoing attraction, persistent draw	C1
constant temptation /,kɒnstənt temp'teɪʃn/ collocation	something always nearby that makes you want to do what you are trying to avoid <i>Working next to a sweet shop is a constant temptation when you are trying to eat healthily.</i>	continual lure, ever-present distraction, persistent enticement	C1
constrained /kən'streɪnd/ adjective con·STRAINED	limited or restricted, so that it cannot grow or increase freely <i>With a constrained budget, many families have to choose between private tuition and other essentials.</i>	limited, restricted, restrained	C1
constructive /kən'strʌktɪv/ adjective con·STRUC·tive	useful and helpful, leading to improvement rather than damage <i>A constructive discussion with my manager helped us agree on clearer deadlines.</i>	helpful, productive, positive, useful	C1
constructive criticism /kən,ʃtrʌktɪv 'krɪtɪsɪzəm/ collocation	helpful comments about someone's work that aim to help them improve <i>My teacher's constructive criticism made my essays much clearer and better organised.</i>	helpful feedback, useful advice, positive feedback	B2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
consume /kən'sju:m/ verb con·SUME	to take up all of someone's time, energy or attention <i>Preparing for exams can consume students completely if they do not take regular breaks.</i>	take over, absorb, dominate, eat up	C1
consumed /kən'sju:md/ adjective con·SUMED	completely controlled or taken over by something, such as a feeling or activity <i>He was so consumed by his online games that he forgot to eat dinner.</i>	obsessed, absorbed, preoccupied, taken over	C1
consumerism /kən'sju:mərizəm/ noun con·SUM·er·ism	a culture that focuses too much on buying and owning things <i>Huge seasonal sales are often criticised as a symbol of modern consumerism.</i>	materialism, commercialism, shopping culture	C1
contactable /'kɒntæktəbl/ adjective CON·tact·a·ble	able to be reached by phone, message or email <i>My manager expects me to be contactable during office hours, even when I work from home.</i>	reachable, available, accessible, on call	C1
contain /kən'teɪn/ verb con·TAIN	to keep something harmful under control and stop it spreading <i>Firefighters worked through the night to contain the blaze before it reached nearby homes.</i>	control, limit, restrain, check	C1
contamination /kən,tæmɪ'neɪʃn/ noun con·tam·i·NA·tion	the state of being mixed with dirty or unwanted material that spoils something <i>Food waste in recycling bins causes contamination, so whole loads of paper may be thrown away.</i>	pollution, impurity, spoiling, adulteration	C1
content /kən'tent/ adjective con·TENT	happy and satisfied with what you have <i>My grandfather seems perfectly content with a simple life in the village.</i>	satisfied, happy, fulfilled, at ease	B2
contentment /kən'tentmənt/ noun con·TENT·ment	a calm feeling of being happy and satisfied <i>Sitting by the river with a cup of tea gives me a deep sense of contentment.</i>	satisfaction, happiness, fulfilment, peace	C1
continuity /,kɒntɪ'nju:əti/ noun con·ti·NU·i·ty	a feeling of connection between the past, present and future <i>Family recipes passed down through generations give a comforting sense of continuity.</i>	connection, permanence, link with the past	C1
convenient /kən'vi:niənt/ adjective con·VE·ni·ent	useful and easy, saving you time or effort <i>Online banking is so convenient that I rarely need to visit a branch.</i>	handy, practical, easy, time-saving	B2
convey /kən'veɪ/ verb con·VEY	to express a feeling, idea or message so that others understand it <i>Good photographs can convey the atmosphere of a place better than words.</i>	express, communicate, get across, put across	C1
conviction /kən'vɪkʃn/ noun con·VIC·tion	a strong, sincere belief in something <i>She spoke with such conviction that the whole audience was persuaded.</i>	belief, certainty, faith, commitment	C1
convivial /kən'vɪviəl/ adjective con·VIV·i·al	friendly, lively and pleasant, where people enjoy each other's company <i>The wedding dinner had a convivial atmosphere, with relatives laughing and chatting for hours.</i>	friendly, sociable, jovial, cheerful	C2
cool prices /,ku:l 'praɪsɪz/ collocation	to make prices rise more slowly or fall slightly after rising fast <i>Building more affordable flats is one practical way to cool prices in an overheated housing market.</i>	moderate prices, bring prices down, ease prices	C1

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coordination failure /kəʊˌɔːdɪˈneɪʃn ˌfeɪljə(r)/ <i>collocation</i> as used: coordination failures	a situation where groups fail to act together, so everyone ends up worse off <i>Climate talks often stall because of coordination failure, as each country waits for others to act first.</i>	lack of cooperation, collective inaction, breakdown in cooperation	C2
cordial /'kɔːdiəl/ <i>adjective</i> COR·di·al	friendly and polite, but not very close <i>Relations between the two families remained cordial even after the business deal fell through.</i>	friendly, polite, amicable, civil	C1
cornerstone /'kɔːnəstəʊn/ <i>noun</i> COR·ner·stone	the most important part on which everything else is built <i>Trust is the cornerstone of any strong friendship.</i>	foundation, basis, bedrock, pillar	C1
corrective /kə'rektɪv/ <i>noun</i> cor·REC·tive	something that is meant to fix an unfair or harmful situation <i>Scholarships for rural students can act as a corrective to unequal access to education.</i>	remedy, correction, counterbalance, cure	C2
corrosive /kə'rəʊsɪv/ <i>adjective</i> cor·RO·sive	gradually damaging or weakening something <i>Constant gossip can have a corrosive effect on trust within a workplace.</i>	damaging, destructive, harmful, undermining	C2
cosy /'kəʊzi/ <i>adjective</i> CO·sy	warm, comfortable and relaxing, making you feel safe at home <i>Our living room feels especially cosy on rainy monsoon evenings.</i>	snug, comfortable, homely, warm	B2
counsel /'kaʊnsəl/ <i>noun</i> COUN·sel	advice, especially from someone older or more experienced <i>I always seek my father's counsel before making big decisions about my career.</i>	advice, guidance, wisdom	C2
counterproductive /,kaʊntəprə'dʌktɪv/ <i>adjective</i> coun·ter·pro·DUC·tive	having the opposite effect to the one you intended <i>Studying all night before an exam is often counterproductive, because you feel exhausted the next day.</i>	self-defeating, unhelpful, damaging	C1
courtesy /'kɜːtəsi/ <i>noun</i> COUR·te·sy	polite, respectful and considerate behaviour towards others <i>Simple courtesy, like thanking the rickshaw driver, costs nothing but brightens someone's day.</i>	politeness, respect, good manners, civility	C1
crack down on /,kræk 'dʌʊn ɒn/ <i>phrasal verb</i> as used: cracking down on	to start dealing with an illegal or harmful activity much more strictly <i>The police have started to crack down on drivers who use their phones at the wheel.</i>	clamp down on, tackle, punish severely	C1
craftsmanship /'krɑːftsmənʃɪp/ <i>noun</i> CRAFTS·man·ship	the skill involved in making things carefully and beautifully by hand <i>The craftsmanship of traditional nakshi kantha quilts is admired by visitors from all over the world.</i>	skill, artistry, workmanship, handiwork	C1
craving /'kreɪvɪŋ/ <i>noun</i> CRAV·ing as used: cravings	a very strong desire for something, especially a particular food <i>During Ramadan, I often have a craving for sweets just before iftar.</i>	longing, desire, urge, hunger	C1
creative outlet /kriːɪtɪv 'aʊtlet/ <i>collocation</i>	an activity that lets you express your ideas and feelings in an imaginative way <i>Photography has become a great creative outlet for me after long days at the office.</i>	means of expression, creative channel, hobby	C1

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credentials /krə'denʃlz/ noun cre·DEN·tials	qualifications and achievements that show you are suitable for a job <i>Her international credentials helped her secure a teaching post at a leading university.</i>	qualifications, certificates, track record	C1
crestfallen /'krestfɔ:lən/ adjective CREST·fall·en	sad and disappointed because something has gone wrong <i>My little nephew looked crestfallen when his cricket match was rained off.</i>	dejected, downcast, disheartened, disappointed	C2
crisp /krɪsp/ adjective CRISP	(of air or weather) pleasantly cold, dry and fresh <i>On a crisp winter morning, the fields near our village are covered in mist.</i>	fresh, cool, bracing, brisk	B2
critically /'krɪtɪkli/ adverb CRIT·i·cal·ly	in a way that carefully judges the good and bad points of something <i>Students should learn to read news articles critically rather than accepting everything they see.</i>	analytically, carefully, sceptically	C1
critically acclaimed /,krɪtɪkli ə'kleɪmd/ collocation	praised highly by professional reviewers and critics <i>The novel was critically acclaimed but sold relatively few copies.</i>	highly praised, well reviewed, celebrated	C1
cross-check /,krɒs 'tʃek/ verb cross·CHECK	to check information by comparing it with another source <i>Before advising students, I always cross-check visa rules on the official embassy website.</i>	verify, double-check, confirm	C1
crowd out /,kraʊd 'aʊt/ phrasal verb	to take up so much space or time that there is no room for other things <i>Homework and tuition can crowd out time for play in many children's lives.</i>	squeeze out, push aside, displace	C1
crowning moment /,kraʊnɪŋ 'məʊmənt/ collocation	the best or most successful part of an experience <i>Graduating with my family watching was the crowning moment of my university years.</i>	highlight, high point, peak, climax	C1
crucial /'kru:ʃl/ adjective CRU·cial	extremely important, because it affects what happens next <i>The first few weeks at a new job are crucial for making a good impression.</i>	vital, critical, decisive, key	B2
crushing disappointment /,krʌʃɪŋ ,dɪsə'pɔɪntmənt/ collocation	a very strong feeling of sadness when something you hoped for does not happen <i>Missing out on the scholarship by a single mark was a crushing disappointment.</i>	bitter blow, huge letdown, heartbreak	C1
culinary /'kʌlɪnəri/ adjective CUL·i·na·ry	connected with cooking and food <i>Old Dhaka is famous for its culinary traditions, especially biryani and kebabs.</i>	cooking, gastronomic, food-related	C1
cultivate /'kʌltɪveɪt/ verb CUL·ti·vate	to develop a quality, skill or attitude in yourself through effort <i>Reading widely is a good way to cultivate patience and imagination.</i>	develop, foster, nurture, build	C1
cultivate /'kʌltɪveɪt/ verb CUL·ti·vate as used: cultivated	to develop a quality or ability gradually through effort and practice <i>Good listening skills can be cultivated by paying full attention to others in conversation.</i>	develop, nurture, foster	C1
cultivate /'kʌltɪveɪt/ verb CUL·ti·vate as used: cultivates	to encourage a quality or habit to grow and develop in someone <i>Team sports cultivate cooperation and a sense of fair play in children.</i>	foster, encourage, promote, develop	C1

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cultivate /'kʌltɪveɪt/ verb CUL·ti·vate as used: cultivating	to gradually build up a good habit or attitude over time <i>I am trying to cultivate a habit of reading for half an hour before bed.</i>	develop, build, form, establish	C1
cultural exchange /,kʌltʃərəl ɪks'tʃeɪndʒ/ collocation	the sharing of ideas, customs and traditions between people from different cultures <i>Student exchange programmes promote cultural exchange and often lead to lasting friendships.</i>	intercultural contact, cross-cultural sharing, cultural interaction	B2
cultural immersion /,kʌltʃərəl ɪ'mɜːʃn/ collocation	living fully in another culture so that you experience its daily life and language <i>Staying with a host family offers a level of cultural immersion that hotels simply cannot.</i>	total immersion, living like a local, deep cultural experience	C1
cultural phenomenon /,kʌltʃərəl fə'nɒmɪnən/ collocation	something that becomes extremely popular and influences how many people behave <i>Street food vlogging has become a real cultural phenomenon among young Bangladeshis.</i>	trend, craze, sensation	C1
cultural roots /,kʌltʃərəl 'ruːts/ collocation	the traditions and history of the community you originally come from <i>Celebrating Pohela Boishakh helps city children stay connected to their cultural roots.</i>	heritage, origins, background, traditions	B2
cumbersome /'kʌmbəsəm/ adjective CUM·ber·some	slow, awkward and difficult to use <i>The old application process was cumbersome, with forms that had to be posted by hand.</i>	awkward, unwieldy, clunky, inconvenient	C1
curate /'kjʊə'reɪt/ verb cu·RATE	to carefully choose and arrange content to create a particular impression <i>Many influencers curate their feeds so that every photo shows a perfect lifestyle.</i>	select, arrange, edit, shape	C1
curb /'kɜːb/ verb CURB	to control or limit something harmful <i>The government introduced new rules to curb noise pollution in residential areas.</i>	restrict, limit, control, rein in	C1
curiously /'kjʊəriəsli/ adverb CU·ri·ous·ly	in a way that is strange or surprising <i>Curiously, the busiest shop on our street is also the oldest and least modern.</i>	strangely, oddly, surprisingly, interestingly	C1
cursory /'kɜːsəri/ adjective CUR·so·ry	quick and not thorough, without much attention to detail <i>Most people give the terms and conditions only a cursory glance before clicking accept.</i>	superficial, brief, hasty, perfunctory	C2
cushion /'kʊʃn/ verb CUSH·ion	to reduce the bad effects of something on people <i>Savings can cushion a family against the shock of a sudden job loss.</i>	soften, protect, lessen the impact of, buffer	C1
customary /'kʌstəməri/ adjective CUS·təm·a·ry	usual because it is a tradition in a particular society or family <i>It is customary in Bangladesh to remove your shoes before entering someone's home.</i>	traditional, usual, conventional, habitual	C1
cut back /,kʌt 'bæk/ phrasal verb	to reduce how much of something you eat, use or do <i>My doctor advised me to cut back on sugar in my tea.</i>	cut down, reduce, scale back	B2

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cut-throat /'kʌt θrəʊt/ adjective CUT-throat	extremely competitive, with people determined to win at any cost <i>The job market for graduates has become cut-throat in big cities.</i>	fiercely competitive, ruthless, dog-eat-dog	C1
cyberbullying /'saɪbəʊlɪŋ/ noun CY-ber-bul-ly-ing	using the internet or phones to hurt, threaten or embarrass someone <i>Schools now run workshops to help pupils recognise and report cyberbullying.</i>	online harassment, online bullying, trolling	B2
cynicism /'sɪnɪsɪzəm/ noun CYN-i-cism	a belief that people are only interested in themselves and cannot be trusted <i>Broken election promises have created widespread cynicism about politics among young voters.</i>	distrust, scepticism, suspicion, disillusionment	C1
daunting /'dɔːntɪŋ/ adjective DAUNT-ing	making you feel nervous or less confident because it seems difficult <i>Moving to a foreign country alone can seem daunting at first.</i>	intimidating, overwhelming, scary, formidable	C1
dawdle /'dɔːdl/ verb DAW-dle	to walk or do something slowly, taking more time than necessary <i>We used to dawdle at the tea stall after Friday prayers, chatting with neighbours.</i>	linger, dally, take your time, stroll	C2
deafening /'defnɪŋ/ adjective DEAF-en-ing	so extremely loud that you can hardly hear anything else <i>The cheers in the stadium were deafening when Bangladesh hit the winning run.</i>	ear-splitting, thunderous, very loud	C1
deception /dɪ'seɪʃn/ noun de-CEP-tion	the act of deliberately making someone believe something untrue <i>Online shopping scams rely on deception, such as fake reviews and misleading photos.</i>	deceit, trickery, dishonesty, fraud	C1
decisive /dɪ'saɪsɪv/ adjective de-Cl-sive	strong and quick, leading to a clear result <i>Decisive action by the local council saved the old market from demolition.</i>	firm, resolute, determined, bold	C1
decisively /dɪ'saɪsɪvli/ adverb de-Cl-sive-ly	quickly and firmly, without hesitation <i>A good manager needs to act decisively when a problem arises.</i>	firmly, resolutely, promptly	C1
decompress /dɪ:kəm'pres/ verb de-com-PRESS	to relax and let go of stress after a busy or difficult period <i>After a long week, I decompress by walking along the riverbank.</i>	unwind, relax, switch off, chill out	C1
dedicated /'dedɪkeɪtɪd/ adjective DED-i-cat-ed	working very hard at something because you care about it <i>My younger sister is so dedicated to her studies that she revises even on holidays.</i>	committed, devoted, hard-working, wholehearted	B2
dedication /,dedɪ'keɪʃn/ noun ded-i-CA-tion	a lot of hard work and time given to something because you care about it <i>Becoming a professional cricketer takes years of dedication and sacrifice.</i>	commitment, devotion, perseverance	B2
deep-seated /,di:p 'siːtɪd/ adjective deep-SEAT-ed	strongly held and very difficult to change <i>Some families have a deep-seated belief that only medicine or engineering are respectable careers.</i>	ingrained, entrenched, deep-rooted, firmly held	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
deepen /ˈdiːpən/ verb DEEP·en as used: deepening	to become stronger, closer or more serious <i>Our friendship deepened during the months we spent revising together.</i>	grow stronger, strengthen, intensify	C1
deepen inequality /ˈdiːpən ˌɪnɪˈkwɒləti/ collocation	to make the gap between rich and poor people greater <i>Expensive private tuition can deepen inequality, since poorer families cannot afford it.</i>	widen inequality, increase the gap, worsen disparity	C1
deeply attached /ˈdiːpli əˈtætʃt/ collocation	feeling strong love and emotional connection towards someone or something <i>My grandmother is deeply attached to her old village house and refuses to move.</i>	very fond of, devoted to, emotionally bound	B2
deeply cherished /ˈdiːpli ˈtʃerɪʃt/ collocation	loved and valued very much <i>My grandfather's old watch is a deeply cherished family possession.</i>	treasured, much-loved, highly valued	C1
deeply ingrained /ˈdiːpli ɪnˈɡreɪnd/ collocation	so firmly established that it is very difficult to change <i>Respect for elders is deeply ingrained in Bangladeshi culture.</i>	deep-rooted, entrenched, embedded	C1
deeply rooted /ˈdiːpli ˈruːtɪd/ collocation	firmly established and forming a basic part of something <i>Hospitality is deeply rooted in village life, where guests are always offered food.</i>	deep-seated, ingrained, embedded, entrenched	C1
deeply woven into /ˈdiːpli ˈwəʊvən ˌɪntuː/ phrase	closely mixed into something so that it becomes an essential part of it <i>Music is deeply woven into every Bengali wedding, from the henna night to the reception.</i>	embedded in, integral to, part and parcel of	C1
defensively /dɪˈfensɪvli/ adverb de·FEN·sive·ly	in a way that shows you feel criticised and want to protect yourself <i>When his manager questioned the report, he answered defensively instead of listening.</i>	protectively, guardedly, touchily	C1
defuse /ˈdiːfjuːz/ verb de·FUSE as used: defuses	to make a difficult or angry situation calmer <i>A calm tone of voice often defuses an argument before it gets out of hand.</i>	calm, ease, settle, smooth over	C1
defuse tension /ˈdiːfjuːz ˈtenʃn/ collocation	to make a tense or difficult situation calmer and less likely to become angry <i>A well-timed joke can defuse tension during a heated family discussion.</i>	calm things down, ease tension, smooth things over	C1
degradation /ˌdeɡrəˈdeɪʃn/ noun deg·ra·DA·tion	the process of the natural environment becoming damaged and worse in quality <i>Deforestation often leads to soil degradation and more frequent landslides.</i>	deterioration, damage, destruction, decline	C1
dejected /dɪˈdʒektɪd/ adjective de·JECT·ed	sad and disappointed, especially after a failure or setback <i>The players looked dejected as they left the field after the defeat.</i>	downcast, despondent, crestfallen, low	C1
delayed gratification /dɪˌleɪd ˌɡrætɪfɪˈkeɪʃn/ collocation	choosing to wait for a bigger reward later instead of taking a smaller one now <i>Saving for a year to buy a laptop taught me the value of delayed gratification.</i>	patience, self-restraint, self-discipline	C2
delectable /dɪˈlektəbl/ adjective de·LEC·ta·ble	extremely delicious and very pleasant to eat <i>My aunt makes a delectable rice pudding every Eid, and it disappears within minutes.</i>	delicious, mouth-watering, scrumptious, tasty	C2

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deliberate /dɪˈlɪbəreɪt/ adjective de·LIB·er·ate	done carefully and on purpose, not by chance <i>Staying in touch with old classmates takes deliberate effort once everyone starts working.</i>	intentional, conscious, planned, purposeful	C1
deliberate choice /dɪˈlɪbəreɪt ˈtʃɔɪs/ collocation as used: deliberate choices	a decision made carefully and on purpose, with a clear aim <i>Healthy eating comes down to deliberate choices, like cooking at home instead of ordering takeaways.</i>	conscious decision, intentional choice, considered decision	C1
deliberate cultural shift /dɪˈlɪbəreɪt ˌkʌltʃərəl ˈʃɪft/ collocation	an intentional change in the attitudes and habits of a society or organisation <i>Reducing plastic use will need a deliberate cultural shift, not just new laws.</i>	intentional change in attitudes, planned change of mindset, conscious social change	C2
deliberately /dɪˈlɪbəreɪtli/ adverb de·LIB·er·ate·ly	carefully and on purpose, with a particular aim <i>Some cafés deliberately use warm lighting and soft music to make customers feel relaxed.</i>	intentionally, purposely, consciously, carefully	B2
deliberation /dɪˈlɪbəˈreɪʃn/ noun de·lib·er·A·tion	long and careful thought before making a decision <i>After much deliberation, I decided to accept the job in my hometown.</i>	consideration, reflection, thought, contemplation	C1
delicate /ˈdelɪkət/ adjective DEL·i·cate	needing to be handled carefully to avoid upsetting people <i>Discussing money with relatives is always a delicate matter.</i>	sensitive, tricky, awkward, touchy	C1
delicate balance /ˈdelɪkət ˈbæləns/ collocation	a situation where different parts must stay in careful proportion, or problems will result <i>Working parents must maintain a delicate balance between their careers and family life.</i>	fine balance, fragile equilibrium, balancing act	C1
delight /dɪˈlaɪt/ noun de·LIGHT	something that gives great pleasure <i>Visiting the tea gardens of Sylhet was an absolute delight.</i>	pleasure, joy, treat, thrill	B2
delighted /dɪˈlaɪtɪd/ adjective de·LIGHT·ed	very pleased and happy about something that has happened <i>My mother was delighted when I surprised her with flowers on her birthday.</i>	thrilled, overjoyed, pleased, elated	B2
deliver on /dɪˈlɪvər ɒn/ phrasal verb	to do what you have promised or were expected to do <i>Voters lose patience with politicians who fail to deliver on their election promises.</i>	fulfil, keep, honour, carry out	C1
demanding /dɪˈmɑːndɪŋ/ adjective de·MAND·ing	needing a lot of time, effort or energy <i>Nursing is a demanding profession, both physically and emotionally.</i>	challenging, tough, taxing, exhausting	B2
democratise /dɪˈmɒkrətaɪz/ verb de·MOC·ra·tise	to make something available to everyone, not only to a privileged group <i>Smartphones have helped democratise photography, since almost anyone can now take good pictures.</i>	open up, make accessible, widen access to	C2
democratise /dɪˈmɒkrətaɪz/ verb de·MOC·ra·tise as used: democratised	to make something, such as knowledge, available to ordinary people rather than a small elite <i>Free online courses have democratised access to university-level learning.</i>	open up, make accessible, popularise	C2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
demonise /ˈdiː.mənaɪz/ verb DE·mon·ise as used: demonising	to present something as completely bad or dangerous, often unfairly <i>It is unfair to demonise video games, since many of them encourage problem-solving.</i>	vilify, condemn, stigmatise, attack	C2
demonstrable /dɪˈmɒnstrəbl/ adjective de·MON·stra·ble	able to be clearly shown or proved <i>Candidates with demonstrable experience in customer service are more likely to be hired.</i>	provable, evident, verifiable, clear	C2
demoralised /dɪˈmɒrəlaɪzd/ adjective de·MOR·al·ised	having lost confidence and hope, so you no longer want to try <i>Staff became demoralised after months of long hours and no recognition.</i>	disheartened, discouraged, dispirited	C1
demoralising /dɪˈmɒrəlaɪzɪŋ/ adjective de·MOR·al·is·ing	making people lose confidence and hope <i>Being rejected by several universities in a row can be very demoralising.</i>	disheartening, discouraging, dispiriting	C1
dependability /dɪˌpendəˈbɪləti/ noun de·pend·a·BIL·i·ty	the quality of being someone you can always trust and rely on <i>Employers value dependability as much as talent, because they need people who turn up and deliver.</i>	reliability, trustworthiness, consistency	C1
dependable /dɪˌpendəbl/ adjective de·PEND·a·ble	able to be trusted to do what is expected <i>My old bicycle is not fast, but it is very dependable.</i>	reliable, trustworthy, steady	B2
dependence /dɪˌpendəns/ noun de·PEND·ence	the state of needing something so much that it is hard to manage without it <i>Our growing dependence on smartphones means many of us panic when the battery dies.</i>	reliance, addiction, need	C1
deplete /dɪˈpliːt/ verb de·PLETE as used: depleting	to reduce the amount of something until very little is left <i>Overfishing can quickly deplete fish stocks in rivers and seas.</i>	use up, exhaust, drain, run down	C1
derail /dɪˈreɪl/ verb de·RAIL	to stop a plan or process from continuing as intended <i>A sudden illness can derail even the most carefully planned exam preparation.</i>	disrupt, wreck, sabotage, throw off course	C1
desensitise /ˌdiːˈsensətaɪz/ verb de·SEN·si·tise	to make someone react less strongly to something because they see it so often <i>Watching violent films regularly may desensitise young viewers to real suffering.</i>	numb, harden, dull	C2
designate /ˈdeɪzɪneɪt/ verb DES·ig·nate as used: designating	to officially choose something for a particular purpose <i>We designate Friday evenings as family time, with no phones at the dinner table.</i>	assign, set aside, allocate, earmark	C1
despair /dɪˈspeə(r)/ noun de·SPAIR	the feeling of having lost all hope <i>After failing his driving test three times, he was close to despair.</i>	hopelessness, desperation, misery, anguish	C1
despair of /dɪˈspeər əv/ phrasal verb as used: despaired of	to feel that someone will never improve or behave as you hope <i>My teachers almost despaired of my handwriting, which was barely readable.</i>	give up on, lose hope in, lose patience with	C2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
detached /dɪ'tætʃt/ adjective de·TACHED	not feeling emotionally involved or connected <i>Living far from home, some students feel detached from family news and celebrations.</i>	distant, removed, disconnected, aloof	C1
deter /dɪ'tɜ:(r)/ verb de·TER	to make someone decide not to do something by making them afraid of the consequences <i>Speed cameras deter many drivers from breaking the limit.</i>	discourage, put off, dissuade, prevent	C1
deteriorate /dɪ'tɪəriəreɪt/ verb de·TE·ri·o·rate as used: deteriorates	to become gradually worse in quality or condition <i>Air quality in big cities often deteriorates during the dry winter months.</i>	worsen, decline, degenerate, go downhill	C1
deteriorate /dɪ'tɪəriəreɪt/ verb de·TE·ri·o·rate as used: deteriorating	to become worse in quality or condition over time <i>Many old buildings in Old Dhaka are deteriorating because their owners cannot afford repairs.</i>	worsen, decline, decay, crumble	C1
determination /dɪ,tɜ:mɪ'neɪʃn/ noun de·ter·mi·NA·tion	the quality of continuing to try to achieve something even when it is difficult <i>Her determination to pass the IELTS test meant she practised speaking every single day.</i>	resolve, perseverance, persistence, willpower	B2
determined /dɪ'tɜ:mɪnd/ adjective de·TER·mɪnd	having made a firm decision and not letting anything stop you <i>My younger sister is determined to become a doctor, however long it takes.</i>	resolute, single-minded, committed, set on	B2
detrimental /,detrɪ'mentl/ adjective det·ri·MEN·tal	causing harm or damage to someone or something <i>Sitting at a desk all day can be detrimental to your posture and health.</i>	harmful, damaging, bad, destructive	C1
devaluation /,di:vælju'eɪʃn/ noun de·val·u·A·tion	a fall in how much something is valued or respected <i>Some employers worry about the devaluation of bachelor's degrees as more people earn them.</i>	depreciation, loss of value, decline in worth	C2
devastated /'devəsteɪtɪd/ adjective DEV·as·tat·ed	extremely shocked and upset because something bad has happened <i>She was devastated when her flight was cancelled and she missed her cousin's wedding.</i>	heartbroken, crushed, distraught, shattered	B2
developmental /dɪ,veləp'mentl/ adjective de·vel·op·MEN·tal	connected with how a person grows and develops, especially in childhood <i>Play has important developmental benefits, helping children build social and problem-solving skills.</i>	growth-related, formative, educational	C1
developmental stage /dɪ,veləp,mentl 'steɪdʒ/ collocation	a particular period in a child's physical, mental or emotional growth <i>Toys should suit a child's developmental stage, not just their age.</i>	stage of development, phase of growth, maturity level	C1
dexterity /dek'sterəti/ noun dex·TER·i·ty	skill and speed in using your hands <i>Traditional embroidery requires great patience and manual dexterity.</i>	nimbleness, deftness, skill, agility	C2
digital divide /,dɪdʒɪtl dɪ'vaɪd/ collocation	the gap between people who have access to modern technology and people who do not <i>During online schooling, the digital divide left many rural pupils without proper lessons.</i>	technology gap, access gap, unequal access	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
digital native /ˌdɪdʒɪtl 'neɪtɪv/ <i>collocation</i> as used: digital natives	a person who has grown up using computers and the internet from an early age <i>My four-year-old nephew is a true digital native who can unlock a phone faster than his grandfather.</i>	tech-savvy youngster, child of the internet age, screen generation	C1
dignity /'dɪɡnəti/ <i>noun</i> DIG·ni·ty	calm, serious and respectful behaviour that earns other people's respect <i>She accepted the disappointing result with great dignity and congratulated the winner.</i>	grace, poise, self-respect, composure	C1
dilemma /dɪ'lemə/ <i>noun</i> di·LEM·ma as used: dilemmas	a difficult situation where you must choose between options that all have problems <i>Many graduates face the dilemma of staying near family or moving abroad for better pay.</i>	quandary, predicament, difficult choice	C1
diligence /'dɪlɪdʒəns/ <i>noun</i> DIL·i·gence	careful and steady hard work <i>Her diligence in checking every application made her invaluable to the office.</i>	hard work, conscientiousness, industriousness, care	C1
dilute /daɪ'lu:t/ <i>verb</i> di·LUTE	to make something weaker or less effective by adding other things <i>Adding too many modern elements can dilute the charm of a traditional village fair.</i>	weaken, water down, diminish	C1
dilution /daɪ'lu:ʃn/ <i>noun</i> di·LU·tion	the process of something becoming weaker or less distinctive <i>Some elders fear the dilution of local dialects as young people use more standard Bengali.</i>	weakening, watering down, erosion	C2
diminish /dɪ'mɪnɪʃ/ <i>verb</i> di·MIN·ish	to become smaller, weaker or less <i>The noise from the building site should diminish once the main work is finished.</i>	decrease, lessen, decline, shrink	C1
diminish /dɪ'mɪnɪʃ/ <i>verb</i> di·MIN·ish as used: diminishing	to gradually become smaller or less important <i>The number of cinema halls in small towns has been diminishing for years.</i>	decline, shrink, dwindle	C1
diminish sharply /dɪ'mɪnɪʃ 'ʃɑ:pli/ <i>collocation</i> as used: diminishes sharply	to become much smaller or weaker very quickly <i>Interest in a new app often diminishes sharply after the first few weeks.</i>	drop steeply, fall dramatically, decline rapidly	C1
diminished /dɪ'mɪnɪʃt/ <i>adjective</i> di·MIN·ished	made smaller, weaker or less than before <i>After the injury, he played with diminished confidence for months.</i>	reduced, weakened, lessened	C1
diminishing returns /dɪ'mɪnɪʃɪŋ rɪ'tɜ:nz/ <i>collocation</i>	a situation where extra effort or money produces smaller and smaller benefits <i>After six hours of revision, I hit diminishing returns and simply stopped absorbing anything.</i>	decreasing benefits, smaller gains, less reward for effort	C2
din /dɪn/ <i>noun</i> DIN	a loud, unpleasant noise that continues for a long time <i>It is hard to hear anything over the din of traffic horns in central Dhaka.</i>	racket, noise, clamour, uproar	C2
diplomacy /dɪ'pləʊməsi/ <i>noun</i> di·PLO·ma·cy	skill in dealing with people politely without upsetting them <i>It takes a lot of diplomacy to tell a friend you do not like their business idea.</i>	tact, sensitivity, discretion, tactfulness	C1

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direct exposure /də'rekt ɪk'spəʊʒə(r)/ collocation	coming into contact with something harmful without any protection <i>Workers in tanneries often face direct exposure to toxic chemicals.</i>	contact, first-hand exposure, being exposed	C1
directionless /də'rekʃənləs/ adjective di-REC-tion-less	without clear aims or purpose <i>After graduating, I felt directionless for a few months until I found my current job.</i>	aimless, purposeless, lost, adrift	C1
disadvantage /,dɪsəd'vɑ:ntɪdʒ/ verb dis-ad-VAN-tage	to put someone in a worse position than other people <i>Exams held only in English may disadvantage students from rural schools.</i>	handicap, hinder, penalise, hamper	C1
disadvantaged /,dɪsəd'vɑ:ntɪdʒd/ adjective dis-ad-VAN-taged	(the disadvantaged) people who lack the money, education or opportunities that others have <i>Several charities provide free tutoring for disadvantaged children in city slums.</i>	underprivileged, deprived, poor, needy	B2
disarm /dɪs'ɑ:m/ verb dis-ARM as used: disarmed	to make someone feel less angry, suspicious or critical <i>The student's honest apology disarmed the angry teacher straight away.</i>	win over, charm, soften, placate	C2
discard /dɪ'skɑ:d/ verb dis-CARD	to get rid of something because it is no longer useful or wanted <i>Many people discard old phones that could easily be repaired or recycled.</i>	throw away, abandon, drop, get rid of	C1
discerning /dɪ'sɜ:nɪŋ/ adjective dis-CERN-ing	able to judge well what is good, true or valuable <i>Discerning readers check the source of a news story before sharing it.</i>	shrewd, perceptive, judicious, selective	C2
discernment /dɪ'sɜ:nmənt/ noun dis-CERN-ment	the ability to judge people and things well <i>Choosing trustworthy friends requires a certain amount of discernment.</i>	judgement, insight, perception, wisdom	C2
discipline /'dɪsəplɪn/ noun DIS-ci-pline	the ability to control your behaviour and keep doing what you should <i>Getting up early to exercise every morning takes a lot of discipline.</i>	self-control, self-discipline, willpower	B2
disciplined /'dɪsəplɪnd/ adjective DIS-ci-plined	able to control your behaviour and keep to a routine <i>Disciplined students review their notes a little every day rather than cramming.</i>	self-controlled, organised, methodical, focused	C1
disconcerting /,dɪskən'sɜ:tɪŋ/ adjective dis-con-CERT-ing	making you feel slightly worried, confused or uneasy <i>It was disconcerting to return to my old school and find the playground turned into a car park.</i>	unsettling, unnerving, worrying, troubling	C2
disconnect /,dɪskə'nekt/ verb dis-con-NECT	to stop using phones, computers or the internet for a period <i>On holiday, I try to disconnect completely and leave my laptop at home.</i>	switch off, unplug, go offline, log off	C1
disconnected /,dɪskə'nektɪd/ adjective dis-con-NECT-ed	not linked or related to something in a logical way <i>Some celebrity earnings seem completely disconnected from the value of their work to society.</i>	separate, unrelated, detached, divorced	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
disconnected from /ˌdɪskəˈnektɪd frəm/ phrase	no longer feeling close to or involved with something <i>Many city children grow up disconnected from where their food actually comes from.</i>	cut off from, detached from, removed from, out of touch with	C1
discourage /dɪsˈkʌrɪdʒ/ verb dis·COUR·age	to try to stop people doing something by making it harder or less attractive <i>Higher taxes on cigarettes are meant to discourage young people from smoking.</i>	deter, put off, dissuade, prevent	B2
discouraged /dɪsˈkʌrɪdʒd/ adjective dis·COUR·aged	having lost confidence or enthusiasm to continue <i>Don't be discouraged if your first attempt at writing an essay gets a low mark.</i>	disheartened, demoralised, dispirited, downhearted	B2
discouraging /dɪsˈkʌrɪdʒɪŋ/ adjective dis·COUR·ag·ing	making you feel less confident or hopeful <i>Receiving no replies after sending dozens of job applications can be very discouraging.</i>	disheartening, demoralising, off-putting	B2
discreetly /dɪˈskriːtli/ adverb dis·CREET·ly	quietly and carefully, so that other people do not notice <i>My father discreetly paid for our neighbour's medicine without telling anyone.</i>	quietly, privately, tactfully, unobtrusively	C1
disempowering /ˌdɪsɪmˈpaʊəɪŋ/ adjective dis·em·POW·er·ing	making someone feel they have less control or ability to change things <i>Constantly being told what to do can feel disempowering for teenagers.</i>	discouraging, undermining, demotivating	C2
disheartening /dɪsˈhɑːtɪnɪŋ/ adjective dis·HEART·en·ing	making you lose hope or enthusiasm <i>It is disheartening to see litter on the beach at Cox's Bazar after a holiday weekend.</i>	discouraging, demoralising, dispiriting, depressing	C1
dismantle /dɪsˈmæntl/ verb dis·MAN·tle as used: dismantled	to end a system or set of rules gradually and deliberately <i>Campaigners hope to dismantle the barriers that stop girls from finishing school.</i>	abolish, remove, tear down, break down	C1
dismantle /dɪsˈmæntl/ verb dis·MAN·tle as used: dismantling	to remove obstacles or restrictions, often one by one <i>Governments should focus on dismantling the red tape that slows down new businesses.</i>	remove, eliminate, break down, do away with	C1
dismissive /dɪsˈmɪsɪv/ adjective dis·MIS·sive	showing that you think something is not important or worth considering <i>Some people are dismissive of online degrees, but many are highly respected.</i>	disregarding, scornful, contemptuous, indifferent	C1
disorder /dɪsˈɔːdə(r)/ noun dis·OR·der	a situation in which people behave in an uncontrolled or chaotic way <i>Without traffic police at the junction, the evening rush quickly descends into disorder.</i>	chaos, confusion, unrest, lawlessness	C1
disoriented /dɪsˈɔːrientɪd/ adjective dis·O·ri·ent·ed	confused and unsure of where you are or which direction to go <i>Coming out of the underground station, I felt completely disoriented in the unfamiliar city.</i>	lost, confused, bewildered, disorientated	C1
disorienting /dɪsˈɔːrientɪŋ/ adjective dis·OR·i·ent·ing	making you feel confused and unsure of where you are or what is happening <i>Arriving in a huge airport late at night, with signs in a language I couldn't read, was quite disorienting.</i>	confusing, bewildering, unsettling	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
disparity /dɪ'spærəti/ noun dis·PAR·i·ty as used: disparities	an unfair difference between groups, for example in income, opportunities or treatment <i>There are still huge disparities between the quality of schools in cities and in rural villages.</i>	inequality, gap, imbalance	C1
dispersed /dɪ'spɜːst/ adjective dis·PERSED	spread out over a wide area instead of living or being close together <i>My cousins are now dispersed across three continents, so we only meet online for birthdays.</i>	scattered, spread out, far-flung	C1
displace /dɪs'pleɪs/ verb dis·PLACE	to take the place of people, especially workers, so that they lose their position <i>Many people fear that self-service machines will displace cashiers in supermarkets within a decade.</i>	replace, supplant, push out	C1
disposable /dɪ'spəʊzəbl/ adjective dis·POS·a·ble	intended to be used for a short time and then thrown away <i>I try to avoid disposable coffee cups and carry a reusable flask to work instead.</i>	throwaway, single-use, short-lived	B2
disproportionate /,dɪsprə'pɔːʃənət/ adjective dis·pro·POR·tion·ate	too large or too small when compared with something else, and so seeming unfair <i>Young people often spend a disproportionate amount of their income on rent in big cities.</i>	excessive, unbalanced, out of proportion	C1
disruption /dɪs'rʌpʃn/ noun dis·RUP·tion	problems and interruptions that stop normal life or activities from continuing as usual <i>The roadworks near my office caused months of disruption for commuters and local shopkeepers.</i>	disturbance, interruption, upheaval	C1
disruptive /dɪs'rʌptɪv/ adjective dis·RUP·tive	causing problems that stop something from continuing normally <i>Moving house in the middle of exam season would be far too disruptive for my younger brother.</i>	unsettling, troublesome, disturbing	C1
dissolve /dɪ'zɒlv/ verb dis·SOLVE	to make a problem or barrier gradually disappear or come to an end <i>Sharing a meal together can dissolve the awkwardness between people who have only just met.</i>	remove, break down, eliminate	C1
distance /'dɪstəns/ verb DIS·tance as used: distanced	to make people feel less emotionally close or involved with each other <i>Constantly checking our phones at dinner has distanced us from the people sitting right beside us.</i>	separate, estrange, drive apart	C1
distinctive /dɪ'stɪŋktɪv/ adjective dis·TINC·tive	having a special quality that makes it easy to recognise and different from others <i>The old part of the city has a distinctive smell of spices and fresh bread in the mornings.</i>	characteristic, unique, unmistakable	B2
distort /dɪ'stɔːt/ verb dis·TORT	to change something so that it becomes false, unhealthy or no longer what it should be <i>Spending hours on social media can distort young people's idea of what a normal body looks like.</i>	warp, twist, skew	C1
distraction /dɪ'strækʃn/ noun dis·TRAC·tion	something enjoyable that takes your mind off work or worries for a short time <i>Doing a crossword on the train is a pleasant distraction from the stress of the day.</i>	diversion, amusement, pastime	B2
distraught /dɪ'strɔːt/ adjective dis·TRAUGHT	extremely upset and anxious, so that you cannot think clearly <i>My aunt was distraught when her cat went missing, and she searched the neighbourhood for days.</i>	heartbroken, devastated, beside yourself	C2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
distrust /dɪs'trʌst/ noun dis·TRUST	a feeling that you cannot believe or rely on someone or something <i>Repeated scandals have created a deep distrust of politicians among many young voters.</i>	mistrust, suspicion, scepticism	C1
disused /ˌdɪs'juːzd/ adjective dis·USED	no longer used for its original purpose <i>A disused factory near my home has been turned into a lively arts centre with a café.</i>	abandoned, derelict, unused	C1
diverge /daɪ'vɜːdʒ/ verb di·VERGE	to become different from each other and develop in separate directions <i>My brother and I had the same upbringing, but our political opinions began to diverge at university.</i>	differ, separate, go separate ways	C1
diversity /daɪ'vɜːsəti/ noun di·VER·si·ty	a wide range of different things, such as ideas, opinions or people <i>What I love about my university is the diversity of backgrounds among the students.</i>	variety, range, mix	B2
do not respect borders /duː nɒt rɪ'spekt 'bɔːdəz/ idiom	used to say a problem spreads freely between countries, so no nation can stop it alone <i>Air pollution and infectious diseases do not respect borders, so neighbouring countries must work together.</i>	cross borders freely, are global in nature, know no boundaries	C1
dominant model /'dɒmɪnənt 'mɒdl/ collocation	the most common or widespread way of organising or doing something <i>Online shopping may soon replace the high street as the dominant model of retail in my country.</i>	prevailing approach, main pattern, standard way	C1
dominate /'dɒmɪneɪt/ verb DOM·i·nate	to take up most of something, such as your time or attention, and control it <i>I try not to let work dominate my weekends, so I switch off my laptop on Friday evening.</i>	take over, control, monopolise	B2
dominate /'dɒmɪneɪt/ verb DOM·i·nate as used: dominated	to be the most powerful or noticeable influence in a particular area <i>The music charts these days are dominated by a handful of international artists.</i>	control, rule, prevail over	B2
double-edged /ˌdʌbl 'edʒd/ adjective dou·ble·EDGED	having both positive and negative effects at the same time <i>Fame is double-edged, because it brings money and attention but takes away your privacy.</i>	mixed, two-sided, ambivalent	C1
down-to-earth /ˌdaʊn tu 'ɜːθ/ adjective down·to·EARTH	practical, sensible and friendly, without pretending to be more important than others <i>Despite being a successful doctor, my uncle is very down-to-earth and chats with everyone he meets.</i>	unpretentious, modest, grounded	B2
downplay /ˌdaʊn'pleɪ/ verb down·PLAY	to make something seem less serious or important than it really is <i>Some companies downplay the health risks of their products to protect their profits.</i>	play down, minimise, make light of	C1
doze off /ˌdəʊz 'ɒf/ phrasal verb as used: dozed off	to fall asleep without intending to, especially for a short time <i>I dozed off in front of the television and woke up just as the film was ending.</i>	nod off, drop off, fall asleep	B2
drain /dreɪn/ noun DRAIN	something that uses up a lot of money, time or resources <i>Maintaining an old car can be a constant drain on a student's limited budget.</i>	burden, strain, loss	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
drain /dreɪn/ verb DRAIN as used: drains	to make someone feel very tired and lacking in energy <i>Long video calls with no breaks really drain me, even though I'm just sitting down.</i>	exhaust, wear out, tire	C1
drastically /'dræstɪkli/ adverb DRAS·ti·cal·ly	in a way that is extreme and has a very large effect <i>The price of fresh vegetables has risen drastically in my town over the last couple of years.</i>	dramatically, radically, sharply	C1
draw someone to something /'drɔː ˌsʌmwʌn tə ˈsʌmθɪŋ/ phrase as used: draws me to it	to attract someone and make them interested in something <i>It's the sense of calm in old libraries that draws me to them whenever I visit a new city.</i>	attract, appeal to, pull in	C1
draw the line /,drɔː ðə ˈlaɪn/ idiom	to decide the limit of what is acceptable, beyond which you will not go <i>I'm happy to help friends move house, but I draw the line at lending them large sums of money.</i>	set a limit, put your foot down, set boundaries	C1
drift off /,drɪft ˈɒf/ phrasal verb	to gradually fall asleep, often without noticing it <i>Listening to rain on the roof always helps me drift off after a busy day.</i>	nod off, fall asleep, doze off	B2
driving force /,draɪvɪŋ ˈfɔːs/ collocation	the main thing or person that makes something happen or develop <i>My mother was the driving force behind my decision to apply to university abroad.</i>	motivating factor, impetus, main catalyst	C1
drop the ball /,drɒp ðə ˈbɔːl/ idiom	to make a careless mistake or fail to do something you are responsible for <i>Our group project nearly failed because one member dropped the ball and missed the deadline.</i>	slip up, make a mess of things, let things slide	C1
dry sense of humour /,draɪ ˌsens əv ˈhjuːmə/ collocation	a way of being funny by saying amusing things in a serious, matter-of-fact way <i>My favourite teacher had a dry sense of humour, and it took us weeks to realise when he was joking.</i>	deadpan humour, wry wit, understated humour	C1
dual income /,djuːəl ˈɪnkʌm/ collocation	money earned by both partners in a household, rather than by only one <i>With a dual income, my parents were able to save enough to send us to good schools.</i>	two salaries, double earnings, joint income	C1
durable /'djʊərəbl/ adjective DU·ra·ble	able to last a long time without breaking or becoming worn <i>I prefer buying durable leather shoes, even if they cost more at first.</i>	long-lasting, hard-wearing, sturdy	B2
dynamic /daɪˈnæmɪk/ adjective dy·NAM·ic	full of energy, activity and interaction, and constantly changing <i>I enjoy working in a dynamic team where everyone contributes ideas and nothing feels routine.</i>	lively, energetic, vibrant	B2
ease /iːz/ noun EASE	a relaxed, comfortable feeling without worry or nervousness, as in 'at ease' <i>The interviewer smiled and chatted about the weather, which immediately put me at ease.</i>	comfort, relaxation, calm	B2
ease the pressure /iːz ðə ˈpreʃə/ collocation	to reduce the strain or demand on a system, place or person <i>Building a second bridge across the river would ease the pressure on the old one during rush hour.</i>	relieve the strain, lighten the load, take the pressure off	B2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
echo chamber /ˈekəʊ.tʃeɪmbə/ noun as used: echo chambers	a situation where people only hear opinions that agree with their own, so their views are never challenged <i>If you only follow people who share your views, social media quickly becomes an echo chamber.</i>	filter bubble, closed circle, information bubble	C1
eclectic /ɪˈklektɪk/ adjective e-CLEC-tic	including a wide variety of different styles, ideas or sources <i>The café has an eclectic mix of furniture, with antique chairs next to bright plastic tables.</i>	varied, diverse, wide-ranging	C2
eclipse /ɪˈklɪps/ verb e-CLIPSE as used: eclipsing	to make something seem less important by becoming much more popular or powerful <i>In many towns, big shopping malls have eclipsed the traditional markets that people once relied on.</i>	overshadow, outshine, surpass	C2
eco-tourism /iːkəʊtʊərɪzəm/ noun E-co-tour-ism	travel to natural areas that aims to protect the environment and support local people <i>Eco-tourism in the mangrove forests gives local villagers an income while protecting the wildlife.</i>	green tourism, sustainable tourism, nature tourism	C1
ecological /iːkəˈlɒdʒɪkl/ adjective e-co-LOG-i-cal	connected with the relationship between living things and their natural environment <i>Cutting down the forest for farmland could have serious ecological consequences for the whole region.</i>	environmental, green, natural	C1
ecological stability /iːkəˈlɒdʒɪkl stəˈbɪləti/ collocation	a state in which the natural environment and its living things stay healthy and balanced <i>Protecting wetlands is vital for ecological stability, as they filter water and shelter countless species.</i>	environmental balance, ecosystem health, natural equilibrium	C1
economical /iːkəˈnɒmɪkl/ adjective e-co-NOM-i-cal	saving money because it gives good value or does not waste resources <i>Cooking at home is far more economical than eating out every day, and usually healthier too.</i>	cost-effective, thrifty, money-saving	B2
economically resilient /iːkəˈnɒmɪkli rɪˈzɪliənt/ collocation	able to recover quickly from financial difficulties or economic shocks <i>Countries with a mix of industries tend to be more economically resilient during a global recession.</i>	financially robust, economically strong, able to bounce back	C1
effectively /ɪˈfektɪvli/ adverb ef-FEC-tive-ly	in a way that produces the result you want <i>Making a short to-do list each morning helps me manage my time far more effectively.</i>	efficiently, successfully, productively	B2
efficient /ɪˈfɪʃnt/ adjective ef-FI-cient	working well and quickly without wasting time, money or effort <i>The new metro line has made getting around the city much more efficient for commuters.</i>	productive, streamlined, effective	B2
effortless /ˈefətləs/ adjective EF-fort-less	happening naturally and easily, without seeming to need any effort <i>Some old friends share an effortless understanding, even after years apart.</i>	easy, natural, unforced	C1
egalitarian /iˌɡæliˈteəriən/ adjective e-gal-i-TAR-i-an	based on the belief that all people are equal and should have the same rights and duties <i>My friends and I share the household chores in a fairly egalitarian way, so nobody feels overburdened.</i>	equal, fair, even-handed	C2
egg someone on /ˌeg ˌsʌmwʌn ˈɒn/ phrasal verb as used: egging me on	to strongly encourage someone to keep going or to do something <i>I nearly gave up singing on stage, but my classmates kept egging me on from the front row.</i>	urge on, spur on, cheer on	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
elaborate /ɪˈlæbəreɪt/ adjective e-LAB·o·rate	carefully planned and full of detail, often more complicated than necessary <i>My sister's wedding involved elaborate decorations, three days of ceremonies and hundreds of guests.</i>	intricate, complex, ornate	C1
elated /iˈleɪtɪd/ adjective e-LAT·ed	extremely happy and excited, often because of good news or success <i>My father was elated when I told him I had been offered a place at university.</i>	overjoyed, thrilled, ecstatic	C1
elation /iˈleɪʃn/ noun e-LA·tion	a feeling of great happiness and excitement <i>I'll never forget the elation of crossing the finish line of my first half marathon.</i>	euphoria, joy, exhilaration	C2
electric /ɪˈlektɹɪk/ adjective e-LEC·tric	full of excitement and energy, used to describe an atmosphere <i>When the national team scored in the final minute, the atmosphere in the stadium was electric.</i>	thrilling, charged, exhilarating	C1
eliminate /ɪˈlɪmɪneɪt/ verb e-LIM·i·nate as used: eliminated	to remove something completely so that it no longer exists <i>Online banking has almost eliminated the need to queue at the bank for simple transactions.</i>	remove, get rid of, eradicate	B2
embarrassing /ɪmˈbærəsɪŋ/ adjective em·BAR·rass·ing	making you feel slightly ashamed, awkward or silly <i>Reading my old teenage diary is both funny and a little embarrassing now.</i>	awkward, cringeworthy, humiliating	B2
embedded /ɪmˈbedɪd/ adjective em·BED·ded	firmly fixed as a natural and essential part of something <i>Respect for elders is deeply embedded in our culture, so children learn it from a very young age.</i>	ingrained, rooted, entrenched	C1
embrace /ɪmˈbreɪs/ verb em·BRACE as used: embracing	to accept and start using a new idea or thing with enthusiasm <i>My grandparents surprised everyone by embracing video calls during the lockdown.</i>	adopt, welcome, take up	C1
emotional /ɪˈməʊʃənəl/ adjective e-MO·tion·al	causing people to feel strong emotions, often so that they cry <i>Saying goodbye to my classmates on the last day of school was surprisingly emotional.</i>	moving, touching, poignant	B2
emotional appeal /ɪˌməʊʃənəl əˈpi:l/ collocation	the power to win support by affecting people's feelings rather than their reasoning <i>Charity adverts rely heavily on emotional appeal, often showing sad images of children or animals.</i>	sentimental pull, emotive power, gut appeal	C1
emotional strain /ɪˌməʊʃənəl ˈstreɪn/ collocation	worry and stress that affects your feelings and makes life difficult <i>Caring for a sick relative for years can put enormous emotional strain on a family.</i>	stress, emotional pressure, mental burden	C1
empathetic /ˌempəˈθetɪk/ adjective em·pa·THET·ic	able to understand and share the feelings of other people <i>A good doctor needs to be empathetic as well as knowledgeable, especially when delivering bad news.</i>	understanding, compassionate, sympathetic	C1
empathise /ˈempəθaɪz/ verb EM·pa·thise	to understand how another person feels, as if you were in their situation <i>Having moved schools several times, I can easily empathise with new students who feel lonely.</i>	relate to, identify with, understand	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
empathy /ˈempəθi/ noun EM·pa·thy	the ability to understand and share another person's feelings and experiences <i>Volunteering at the hospital taught me a great deal of empathy for people facing illness.</i>	compassion, understanding, fellow feeling	C1
employability /ɪmˌplɔɪəˈbɪləti/ noun em·ploy·a·BIL·i·ty	the skills and qualities that make someone likely to get and keep a job <i>Internships can greatly improve a graduate's employability, as they show real workplace experience.</i>	job prospects, career prospects, marketability	C1
empower /ɪmˈpaʊə/ verb em·POW·er as used: empowers	to give someone the confidence, skills or authority to act for themselves <i>A good education empowers young women to make their own choices about work and family.</i>	enable, equip, strengthen	C1
empowering /ɪmˈpaʊərɪŋ/ adjective em·POW·er·ing	making you feel more confident and more in control of your own life <i>Learning to drive was incredibly empowering for my mother, who no longer had to rely on others.</i>	liberating, confidence-building, strengthening	C1
empty /ˈempti/ adjective EMP·ty as used: emptier	feeling lonely and lacking life, especially because someone is no longer there <i>After my brother left for university, the house felt strangely empty in the evenings.</i>	hollow, desolate, lifeless	B2
emulate /ˈemjuleɪt/ verb EM·u·late	to copy someone's behaviour because you admire them and want to be like them <i>Many young footballers try to emulate their heroes, copying everything from their skills to their hairstyles.</i>	imitate, follow, model yourself on	C2
enabler /ɪˈneɪblə/ noun en·A·bler	something that makes it possible for other things or goals to happen <i>A reliable internet connection is a key enabler of remote work and online learning.</i>	facilitator, means, catalyst	C2
enabling /ɪˈneɪblɪŋ/ adjective en·A·bling	creating the conditions that make it possible for people to act or succeed <i>Good managers create an enabling atmosphere where staff feel free to suggest new ideas.</i>	supportive, empowering, facilitating	C1
enact /ɪˈnækt/ verb en·ACT	to put a plan or change into action, especially by making it law <i>The government finally enacted a ban on plastic bags after years of public campaigning.</i>	implement, bring in, put into effect	C2
encouraging /ɪnˈkʌrɪdʒɪŋ/ adjective en·COUR·ag·ing	giving someone support, hope and confidence <i>My piano teacher was always encouraging, even when I made the same mistake again and again.</i>	supportive, reassuring, motivating	B2
encouragingly /ɪnˈkʌrɪdʒɪŋli/ adverb en·COUR·ag·ing·ly	used to say that a fact gives you hope or confidence about the future <i>Encouragingly, more and more cafés in my city now offer discounts to customers who bring their own cups.</i>	hopefully, promisingly, reassuringly	C1
encroachment /ɪnˈkrəʊtʃmənt/ noun en·CROACH·ment	the gradual spread of human activity into areas that belong to nature or to others <i>The encroachment of new housing estates on farmland worries many people in my home district.</i>	intrusion, invasion, incursion	C2
endlessly fascinating /ˌendləsli ˈfæsɪneɪtɪŋ/ collocation	so interesting that you never get bored of it <i>I find the history of ancient civilisations endlessly fascinating, and I could read about it for hours.</i>	utterly absorbing, captivating, enthralling	C1

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endure /ɪn'djʊə/ verb en·DURE	to continue to exist for a long time <i>Some folk songs have endured for centuries because they speak to universal human feelings.</i>	last, survive, persist	C1
enduring /ɪn'djʊərɪŋ/ adjective en·DUR·ing	lasting for a very long time <i>The friendship between my grandmother and her childhood neighbour is one of the most enduring I know.</i>	lasting, long-lasting, abiding	C1
energetic /,enə'dʒetɪk/ adjective en·er·GET·ic	having a lot of energy and enthusiasm for activity <i>I feel much more energetic on days when I start with a short walk before breakfast.</i>	lively, active, full of beans	B2
energising /'enədʒaɪzɪŋ/ adjective EN·er·gis·ing	making you feel more lively, alert and full of energy <i>A swim in cold water is surprisingly energising first thing in the morning.</i>	invigorating, refreshing, revitalising	C1
enforce /ɪn'fɔ:s/ verb en·FORCE as used: enforcing	to make sure that people obey a law or rule <i>The city has started enforcing the ban on parking on pavements, with heavy fines for drivers.</i>	impose, apply, implement	C1
engaging /ɪn'geɪdʒɪŋ/ adjective en·GAG·ing	interesting and attractive in a way that holds your attention <i>Our history teacher told such engaging stories that nobody ever looked at the clock.</i>	absorbing, captivating, compelling	C1
engine /'endʒɪn/ noun EN·gine as used: engines	something that powers growth, progress or change <i>Small businesses are the real engine of the local economy, creating most of the jobs in my town.</i>	driver, driving force, powerhouse	C1
engine of prosperity /'endʒɪn əv prɒ'sperəti/ collocation as used: engines of prosperity	something that creates wealth and economic success for a place or group <i>Ports have long been engines of prosperity for coastal cities, bringing trade and jobs.</i>	source of wealth, economic powerhouse, driver of growth	C1
engrossed /ɪn'grəʊst/ adjective en·GROSSED	so interested in something that you give it all your attention <i>I was so engrossed in the documentary that I completely forgot about my dinner in the oven.</i>	absorbed, immersed, captivated	C1
enhance /ɪn'hɑ:ns/ verb en·HANCE	to improve the quality or value of something <i>Good lighting and a few plants can really enhance the atmosphere of a small flat.</i>	improve, enrich, boost	C1
enlightening /ɪn'laɪtnɪŋ/ adjective en·LIGHT·en·ing	giving you new knowledge or a clearer understanding of something <i>Talking to my grandfather about his childhood was genuinely enlightening about how much life has changed.</i>	illuminating, informative, eye-opening	C1
enrich /ɪn'rtʃ/ verb en·RICH	to improve the quality of something by adding something valuable to it <i>Learning a musical instrument can enrich your life in ways you never expect.</i>	enhance, improve, add to	C1
enrich /ɪn'rtʃ/ verb en·RICH as used: enriched	to make people wiser or better off by giving them new knowledge or understanding <i>I felt truly enriched after spending a summer volunteering in a remote village.</i>	improve, benefit, uplift	C1

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enrich /ɪnˈrɪtʃ/ verb en·RICH as used: enriches	to broaden someone's outlook and experience and make their life better <i>Travelling to new places enriches us by showing us other ways of living and thinking.</i>	broaden, enhance, benefit	C1
enriching /ɪnˈrɪtʃɪŋ/ adjective en·RICH·ing	improving your mind or life by giving you new knowledge and experiences <i>Joining a debating society at university was one of the most enriching things I have ever done.</i>	rewarding, fulfilling, worthwhile	C1
enrichment /ɪnˈrɪtʃmənt/ noun en·RICH·ment	the process of improving someone's mind and abilities through wider learning and experience <i>Schools should offer music, drama and sport for personal enrichment, not just exam preparation.</i>	development, growth, betterment	C1
entertain /,entəˈteɪn/ verb en·ter·TAIN as used: entertained	to keep someone interested and amused for a period of time <i>On long car journeys my parents entertained us with word games and old family stories.</i>	amuse, occupy, divert	B2
entirely /ɪnˈtaɪəli/ adverb en·TIRE·ly	completely, or in every way <i>My grandmother does her shopping almost entirely online now, which still surprises me.</i>	completely, wholly, totally	B2
entrepreneurial /,ɒnrəprəʊˈnɜːriəl/ adjective en·tre·pre·NEUR·i·al	having the skills, drive and willingness to take risks that are needed to start businesses <i>My cousin has always been entrepreneurial, selling homemade snacks at school when he was twelve.</i>	enterprising, business-minded, commercially minded	C1
entrepreneurship /,ɒnrəprəʊˈnɜːʃɪp/ noun en·tre·pre·NEUR·ship	the activity of setting up and running your own business, often taking financial risks <i>Many universities now run courses in entrepreneurship to help students turn ideas into companies.</i>	business creation, enterprise, starting a business	C1
enviable /ˈenviəbl/ adjective EN·vi·a·ble	so good or desirable that other people would like to have it too <i>She has an enviable ability to stay calm and cheerful even under enormous pressure.</i>	desirable, admirable, coveted	C1
environmental degradation /ɪnˌvaɪrənˌmentl ˌdeɡrəˈdeɪʃn/ collocation	the process of the natural environment becoming damaged and worse in quality <i>Unregulated mining has caused severe environmental degradation in the hills near my hometown.</i>	environmental damage, ecological harm, pollution	C1
equality of outcome /iˌkwɒləti əv ˈaʊtkʌm/ collocation	a situation where everyone ends up with the same results, such as income or wealth <i>I support equal opportunities, but I think equality of outcome would remove the incentive to work hard.</i>	equal results, identical outcomes, total parity	C2
equip /ɪˈkwɪp/ verb e·QUIP as used: equipping	to give someone the skills or knowledge they need for a particular task <i>First aid courses are brilliant for equipping ordinary people to respond calmly in an emergency.</i>	prepare, train, enable	B2
equip /ɪˈkwɪp/ verb e·QUIP as used: equips	to provide someone with the abilities that will help them in the future <i>Travelling alone equips young people with independence and problem-solving skills.</i>	provide, prepare, arm	B2
equipped /ɪˈkwɪpt/ adjective e·QUIPPED	having the skills or knowledge needed to deal with a particular situation <i>My part-time job left me well equipped to handle difficult customers with patience.</i>	prepared, qualified, ready	B2

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equitable /ˈekwɪtəbl/ adjective EQ·ui·ta·ble	fair and reasonable, treating everyone in an equal way <i>An equitable tax system asks those who earn the most to contribute a larger share.</i>	fair, just, even-handed	C2
equitably /ˈekwɪtəbli/ adverb EQ·ui·ta·bly	in a fair and reasonable way that treats everyone equally <i>In our flat, we split the bills equitably according to the size of each person's room.</i>	fairly, justly, evenly	C2
erode /ɪˈrəʊd/ verb e·RODE	to gradually weaken or destroy something, such as trust or confidence <i>Constant criticism from a manager can slowly erode an employee's confidence.</i>	undermine, wear away, weaken	C1
erode /ɪˈrəʊd/ verb e·RODE as used: eroded	to become gradually weaker and less important over time <i>In many cities, the sense of community has eroded as people move more often.</i>	weaken, decline, wear away	C1
erode /ɪˈrəʊd/ verb e·RODE as used: eroding	to slowly weaken or destroy customs, values or practices <i>Long working hours are gradually eroding the tradition of families eating dinner together.</i>	undermine, wear down, chip away at	C1
erosion /ɪˈrəʊʒn/ noun e·RO·sion	the gradual weakening or loss of something valuable, such as rights or trust <i>Many older people regret the erosion of good manners in public places.</i>	decline, weakening, deterioration	C1
erratic /ɪˈrætɪk/ adjective er·RAT·ic	changing suddenly and often, in a way that is not regular or predictable <i>The bus service in my area is so erratic that I usually cycle to be safe.</i>	unpredictable, irregular, inconsistent	C1
escalate /ˈeskəleɪt/ verb ES·ca·late	to become worse or more serious, often quickly <i>A small disagreement between neighbours can escalate into a serious feud if nobody talks it through.</i>	intensify, worsen, spiral	C1
escapade /ˌeskəˈpeɪd/ noun es·ca·PADE	an exciting adventure, often one that is a bit risky or unusual <i>Getting lost in the mountains with my cousins became a family escapade we still laugh about.</i>	adventure, exploit, caper	C2
essence /ˈesns/ noun ES·sence	the most basic and important quality of something <i>For me, the essence of a good holiday is simply having time to rest with people I love.</i>	core, heart, spirit	C1
ethereal /iˈθəriəl/ adjective e·THE·re·al	extremely light and delicate, seeming almost too beautiful for this world <i>The singer's voice had an ethereal quality that made the whole hall fall completely silent.</i>	otherworldly, delicate, heavenly	C2
ethical /ˈeθɪkl/ adjective ETH·i·cal	morally right and honest in the way you behave or do business <i>I try to buy from ethical brands that pay their workers fairly and treat them well.</i>	principled, moral, honourable	B2
ethical dilemma /ˌeθɪkl dɪˈlemə/ collocation as used: ethical dilemmas	a difficult situation in which you must choose between options that each raise moral problems <i>Doctors often face ethical dilemmas, such as how much to tell a patient about a poor prognosis.</i>	moral dilemma, moral quandary, difficult moral choice	C1

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ethical oversight /ˌeθɪkl 'əʊvəsəɪt/ collocation	the careful supervision of an activity to make sure it is carried out in a morally acceptable way <i>Research involving human volunteers must have strict ethical oversight to protect the participants.</i>	ethical supervision, moral scrutiny, ethical regulation	C1
euphoric /juː'fɔːrɪk/ adjective eu·PHOR·ic	feeling extremely happy and excited, often for a short period <i>The whole team felt euphoric after winning the regional championship for the first time.</i>	elated, ecstatic, overjoyed	C2
evaluate /ɪ'væljuːeɪt/ verb e·VAL·u·ate	to think carefully about something in order to judge its quality, accuracy or value <i>Before choosing a university, it is worth evaluating the course content as well as the reputation.</i>	assess, judge, weigh up	B2
everyday courtesy /ˌevrɪdeɪ 'kɜːtəsi/ collocation	ordinary polite behaviour, such as holding doors open or saying thank you <i>Simple everyday courtesy, like greeting the bus driver, can make a whole neighbourhood feel friendlier.</i>	common politeness, good manners, basic civility	C1
evoke /ɪ'vəʊk/ verb e·VOKE	to bring a feeling, memory or image into your mind <i>The smell of fresh mangoes always evokes memories of summer holidays at my grandparents' house.</i>	stir, conjure up, bring to mind	C1
evolve /i'vɒlv/ verb e·VOLVE	to develop and change gradually over a period of time <i>My taste in music has evolved a lot since my teenage years, and I now enjoy jazz.</i>	develop, change, progress	B2
evolve /i'vɒlv/ verb e·VOLVE as used: evolved	to change naturally over a long time, adapting to new conditions <i>Wedding customs in my country have evolved over the generations, mixing old rituals with modern touches.</i>	develop, adapt, transform	B2
evolve /i'vɒlv/ verb e·VOLVE as used: evolves	to develop and improve, often quickly, into newer forms <i>Because smartphone technology evolves so fast, a phone can feel outdated after just a couple of years.</i>	advances, progresses, moves on	B2
evolve /i'vɒlv/ verb e·VOLVE as used: evolving	to be in a continuing process of gradual change rather than staying fixed <i>Attitudes towards working mothers are evolving, and more fathers now take time off to look after babies.</i>	shifting, developing, changing	B2
exacerbate /ɪg'zæsəbeɪt/ verb ex·AC·er·bate	to make a problem or bad situation even worse <i>Building more roads can actually exacerbate traffic congestion by encouraging people to drive more.</i>	worsen, aggravate, intensify	C2
exact a heavy toll /ɪg,zækt ə ,hevi 'təʊl/ idiom as used: exacts a heavy toll	to cause a lot of harm, damage or suffering <i>Working night shifts for years can exact a heavy toll on a person's health and relationships.</i>	take a heavy toll, cause great damage, do serious harm	C2
exactly the point /ɪg,zæktli ðə 'pɔɪnt/ phrase	precisely the main purpose or reason for something <i>My weekend walks have no goal at all, and that's exactly the point, because I can finally switch off.</i>	the whole idea, precisely the purpose, the whole point	B2
exaggerated /ɪg'zædʒəreɪtɪd/ adjective ex·AG·ger·at·ed	made to seem larger, better or worse than it really is <i>Reports about the dangers of the city were exaggerated, and I felt perfectly safe walking around.</i>	overstated, inflated, overblown	B2

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exasperating /ɪg'zɑːspəreɪtɪŋ/ adjective ex-AS-per-at-ing	extremely annoying, especially because you can do nothing to change the situation <i>It is exasperating when an online form deletes everything you've typed because of one small error.</i>	infuriating, maddening, irritating	C2
excel /ɪk'sel/ verb ex-CEL	to be extremely good at something, or to perform better than most people <i>My sister has always excelled at maths, while I was far happier in literature classes.</i>	shine, stand out, thrive	C1
excellence /'eksələns/ noun EX-cel-lence	the quality of being extremely good at something <i>The restaurant has a reputation for excellence, and people book tables months in advance.</i>	distinction, high quality, brilliance	C1
exceptional /ɪk'sepʃənəl/ adjective ex-CEP-tion-al	much better than average, unusually skilled or impressive <i>Our school football coach had an exceptional ability to bring out the best in every player.</i>	outstanding, remarkable, extraordinary	B2
exclusion /ɪk'skluːʒn/ noun ex-CLU-sion	the situation of being left out of something, such as services or society <i>Without affordable internet, poorer families face digital exclusion from education and job opportunities.</i>	marginalisation, being left out, isolation	C1
excursion /ɪk'skɜːʃn/ noun ex-CUR-sion	a short trip made for pleasure, often as a group <i>Our school organised an excursion to the tea gardens, which was the highlight of the year.</i>	trip, outing, day trip	B2
exhausted /ɪg'zɔːstɪd/ adjective ex-HAUST-ed	extremely tired, with no energy left <i>After a twelve-hour shift at the hospital, my mother comes home completely exhausted.</i>	worn out, drained, shattered	B2
exhaustion /ɪg'zɔːstʃən/ noun ex-HAUS-tion	a state of extreme physical or mental tiredness <i>Many students push themselves to the point of exhaustion in the weeks before final exams.</i>	fatigue, burnout, weariness	C1
exhilarating /ɪg'zɪləreɪtɪŋ/ adjective ex-HIL-a-rat-ing	making you feel extremely happy, excited and full of energy <i>Riding a speedboat across the bay for the first time was absolutely exhilarating.</i>	thrilling, exciting, electrifying	C1
exhilaration /ɪg'zɪlə'reɪʃn/ noun ex-hil-a-RA-tion	a feeling of great excitement and happiness <i>I remember the exhilaration of seeing snow for the very first time on a trip to the mountains.</i>	elation, euphoria, thrill	C2
existential /ˌegzɪ'stenʃl/ adjective ex-is-TEN-tial	threatening the continued existence of something, such as humanity or a way of life <i>For low-lying island nations, rising sea levels are an existential problem, not a distant concern.</i>	life-threatening, fundamental, survival-related	C2
expendable /ɪk'spendəbl/ adjective ex-PEND-a-ble	not considered important, so it can be removed or sacrificed when money is short <i>Art and music classes are often treated as expendable when schools need to cut their budgets.</i>	dispensable, non-essential, replaceable	C2
expertise /ˌekspɜː'tiːz/ noun ex-per-TISE	a high level of knowledge or skill in a particular subject <i>We hired a local guide whose expertise in birdwatching made the trip far more rewarding.</i>	specialist knowledge, skill, proficiency	C1

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exploit /ɪk'splɔɪt/ verb ex·PLOIT as used: exploiting	to use someone unfairly for your own advantage <i>Some apps exploit users' weaknesses, designing features that keep them scrolling for hours.</i>	take advantage of, manipulate, abuse	C1
exploitation /ˌeksplɔɪ'teɪʃn/ noun ex·ploi·TA·tion	the use of natural resources or living things for profit without caring about the harm caused <i>The overfishing of our rivers is a clear example of the exploitation of natural resources.</i>	misuse, abuse, overuse	C1
exploitative /ɪk'splɔɪtətɪv/ adjective ex·PLOIT·a·tive	using people or resources unfairly for your own benefit <i>Many garment workers are trapped in exploitative jobs with long hours and very low pay.</i>	abusive, unfair, predatory	C2
exposure /ɪk'spəʊʒə/ noun ex·PO·sure	the experience of seeing, learning about or taking part in something new <i>Early exposure to different languages makes it much easier for children to pick them up.</i>	experience, contact, introduction	C1
exquisite /ɪk'skwɪzɪt/ adjective ex·QUIS·ite	extremely beautiful and delicate, often made with great skill <i>My grandmother's hand-stitched quilts are exquisite, with tiny patterns telling stories of village life.</i>	beautiful, delicate, superb	C1
external validation /ɪk,stɜːnl ˌvælɪ'deɪʃn/ collocation	approval or praise from other people that makes you feel your efforts are worthwhile <i>Posting every achievement online can become a constant search for external validation.</i>	outside approval, recognition from others, praise	C1
extravagance /ɪk'strævəɡəns/ noun ex·TRAV·a·gance	the habit of spending much more money than is reasonable or necessary <i>Hiring a helicopter for a birthday party seemed like pure extravagance to most of the guests.</i>	overspending, wastefulness, lavishness	C2
extravagant /ɪk'strævəɡənt/ adjective ex·TRAV·a·gant	costing much more money than is reasonable, or being far too elaborate <i>Some couples now choose simple weddings instead of extravagant ceremonies that leave them in debt.</i>	lavish, showy, excessive	C1
eye-opening /'aɪ əpənɪŋ/ adjective EYE·o·pen·ing	surprising and teaching you something you did not know before <i>Volunteering at a homeless shelter was an eye-opening experience that changed how I see my city.</i>	enlightening, revealing, illuminating	C1
fabricated /'fæbrɪkeɪtɪd/ adjective FAB·ri·cat·ed	invented and not true, especially in order to deceive people <i>The story about the celebrity went viral before anyone realised the quotes were completely fabricated.</i>	made-up, fake, invented	C1
facilitation /fə,sɪlɪ'teɪʃn/ noun fa·cil·i·TA·tion	the act of helping a group work or talk together so it can reach its goals more easily <i>Good teachers now see their role as the facilitation of discussion rather than simply lecturing.</i>	guidance, support, coordination	C2
faith /feɪθ/ noun FAITH	trust or confidence in someone's ability or character <i>My first boss put a lot of faith in me, giving me responsibility long before I felt ready.</i>	trust, confidence, belief	B2
fall apart /ˌfɔːl ə'pɑːt/ phrasal verb as used: falling apart	to stop working or fail completely, used about plans, arrangements or organisations <i>Our holiday plans fell apart when the airline cancelled our flight the night before.</i>	collapse, fall through, go wrong	B2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
fall back on /ˌfɔːl ˈbæk ɒn/ phrasal verb	to use something familiar or easy because other options are difficult or unavailable <i>When I'm tired after work, I tend to fall back on simple meals like rice and lentils.</i>	resort to, turn to, rely on	C1
fall into disrepair /ˌfɔːl ˌɪntə ˈdɪsrɪˈpeə/ collocation	to become damaged and in poor condition because nobody looks after it <i>The old cinema in my town fell into disrepair after it closed, and now it's covered in weeds.</i>	deteriorate, decay, become run-down	C1
fall short /ˌfɔːl ˈʃɔːt/ phrasal verb as used: falling short	to fail to reach a standard, target or expectation <i>The new stadium looks impressive, but the transport links fall short of what fans were promised.</i>	disappoint, come up short, underperform	C1
false dilemma /ˌfɔːls dɪˈlemə/ collocation	a situation presented as a choice between two options when other options actually exist <i>Asking whether we should choose the economy or the environment is really a false dilemma.</i>	false choice, false dichotomy, either-or fallacy	C2
far-flung /ˌfɑː ˈflʌŋ/ adjective far-·FLUNG	living or situated a very long distance away, or spread over a wide area <i>Every Eid, relatives from far-flung parts of the world fly home to celebrate together.</i>	distant, remote, faraway	C2
far-reaching /ˌfɑː ˈriːtʃɪŋ/ adjective far-·REACH-ing	having a very wide influence or affecting a great many people and things <i>Artificial intelligence could have far-reaching effects on how we work, learn and communicate.</i>	wide-ranging, extensive, sweeping	C1
fascinating /ˈfæsnɪtɪŋ/ adjective FAS-ci-nat-ing	extremely interesting and holding your attention completely <i>The museum guide told us fascinating stories about the traders who once sailed along our river.</i>	captivating, intriguing, absorbing	B2
fast fashion /ˌfɑːst ˈfæʃn/ collocation	cheap, trendy clothes made quickly and in large quantities, often worn only a few times <i>I've started avoiding fast fashion and buying second-hand clothes that last much longer.</i>	throwaway fashion, disposable clothing, cheap high-street fashion	C1
fast-changing /ˌfɑːst ˈtʃeɪndʒɪŋ/ adjective fast-·CHANG-ing	developing and changing very quickly <i>In a fast-changing job market, workers need to keep updating their skills throughout their careers.</i>	rapidly evolving, dynamic, fluid	B2
fast-paced /ˌfɑːst ˈpeɪst/ adjective fast-·PACED	happening or moving very quickly, often with a lot of pressure <i>Life in the capital is so fast-paced that I really appreciate slow weekends in my village.</i>	hectic, frenetic, rushed	B2
favourably /ˈfeɪvərəbli/ adverb FA-vour-a-bly	in a way that shows approval or a positive opinion <i>Most residents reacted favourably to the plan to turn the empty car park into a garden.</i>	positively, approvingly, well	C1
fear of missing out /ˌfiər əv ˌmɪsɪŋ ˈaʊt/ collocation	anxiety that other people are having enjoyable experiences without you, often caused by social media <i>The fear of missing out makes some students say yes to every party, even before exams.</i>	FOMO, social anxiety, worry about being left out	C1
feasible /ˈfiːzəbl/ adjective FEA-si-ble	possible and reasonable to do or achieve <i>Cycling to work is only feasible if the city builds safe, separate lanes for bikes.</i>	practicable, workable, viable	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
fend for yourself /ˌfend fə ʃɔː'self/ idiom as used: fend for myself	to look after yourself and do things independently, without help from others <i>Living in a student hostel taught me to fend for myself, from cooking to managing my budget.</i>	look after yourself, stand on your own two feet, be self-sufficient	C1
fertile ground /ˌfɜːtaɪl 'graʊnd/ collocation	a situation in which something, often something bad, can easily develop and grow <i>Boredom and a lack of youth facilities can be fertile ground for antisocial behaviour.</i>	breeding ground, hotbed, ideal conditions	C2
fester /'festə/ verb FES·ter	to become more unpleasant or harmful over time because nobody deals with it <i>If you don't talk about a disagreement with a flatmate, resentment will just fester.</i>	worsen, build up, rankle	C2
festivity /fe'stɪvəti/ noun fes·TIV·i·ty	a joyful feeling of celebration, especially at a special event <i>During Pohela Boishakh, the streets are filled with colour, music and a real air of festivity.</i>	celebration, merriment, jollity	C1
few and far between /ˌfjuː ən ˌfɑː bɪ'twiːn/ idiom	not happening or existing very often <i>Good jobs for fresh graduates are few and far between in my home town, so many move away.</i>	rare, scarce, hard to come by	C1
fiddly /'fɪdli/ adjective FID·dly	difficult to do because it involves small objects or delicate, detailed movements <i>Changing the battery in my watch is so fiddly that I always take it to a repair shop.</i>	tricky, awkward, intricate	C1
fiercely competitive /ˌfɪəsli kəm'petətɪv/ collocation	extremely determined to win or to be more successful than others <i>Getting into the top medical colleges is fiercely competitive, so students study for years.</i>	cut-throat, intensely competitive, highly contested	C1
financial security /faɪˌnænsəl sɪ'kjʊərəti/ collocation	the state of having enough money to live comfortably and cope with unexpected costs <i>Many young people choose government jobs because they offer long-term financial security.</i>	economic stability, financial stability, peace of mind about money	B2
find your feet /ˌfaɪnd jə 'fiːt/ idiom as used: found its feet	to become confident and successful in a new situation after a difficult start <i>It took me a few months to find my feet at university, but after that I loved it.</i>	settle in, get into your stride, become established	C1
first-hand /ˌfɜːst 'hænd/ adjective first--HAND	coming directly from personal experience rather than from other people or books <i>Talking to former students gave me first-hand knowledge of what the course is really like.</i>	direct, personal, eyewitness	C1
fixation /fɪk'seɪʃn/ noun fix·A·tion	an unhealthy, excessive interest in one particular thing <i>His fixation on buying the latest phone means he's always short of money for essentials.</i>	obsession, preoccupation, compulsion	C2
flair /fleə/ noun FLAIR	a natural ability to do something well, especially something creative <i>My brother has a real flair for cooking and can make a delicious meal from almost nothing.</i>	talent, gift, knack	C1
fleeting /'fliːtɪŋ/ adjective FLEET·ing	lasting only a very short time <i>We caught a fleeting glimpse of a dolphin before it disappeared beneath the waves.</i>	brief, momentary, passing	C1
flock to /'flɒk tə/ phrasal verb	to go to a place in large numbers <i>Every winter, tourists flock to Cox's Bazar to enjoy the long sandy beach and mild weather.</i>	pour into, crowd into, descend on	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
flourish /'flʌrɪʃ/ verb FLOUR-ish	to develop successfully and be healthy, happy and confident <i>Children tend to flourish when teachers believe in them and give them room to explore.</i>	thrive, prosper, blossom	C1
flourish /'flʌrɪʃ/ verb FLOUR-ish as used: flourishes	to grow or spread quickly because the conditions are favourable <i>Street food culture flourishes in cities where people work long hours and eat on the go.</i>	thrive, grow, boom	C1
flourishing /'flʌrɪʃɪŋ/ adjective FLOUR-ish-ing	developing well and successfully, healthy and full of life <i>The town has a flourishing arts scene, with small galleries and live music every weekend.</i>	thriving, prosperous, booming	C1
fluent /'fluːənt/ adjective FLU-ent	able to speak a language easily, smoothly and accurately <i>After a year working in Madrid, my friend became fluent in Spanish and even dreams in it.</i>	articulate, proficient, at home in	B2
fluid /'fluːɪd/ adjective FLU-id	not fixed and likely to keep changing <i>Plans for the trip are still fairly fluid, so we might end up visiting the hills instead.</i>	flexible, changeable, unsettled	C1
flustered /'flʌstəd/ adjective FLUS-tered	nervous and confused, often because you are in a hurry or under pressure <i>I got completely flustered when the examiner asked an unexpected question and forgot my answer.</i>	rattled, flummoxed, agitated	C1
follow suit /,fɒləʊ 'suːt/ idiom	to do the same thing that someone else has just done <i>When one café on our street started offering free Wi-Fi, all the others quickly followed suit.</i>	do the same, copy, take the same approach	C1
fond memories /,fɒnd 'memərɪz/ collocation	happy memories of past times that you like remembering <i>I have fond memories of flying kites on the rooftop with my cousins every spring.</i>	happy memories, warm recollections, cherished memories	B2
food labelling /'fuːd ,leɪbəlɪŋ/ collocation	information printed on food packaging about ingredients, nutrition and health <i>Better food labelling would help shoppers notice how much hidden sugar is in breakfast cereals.</i>	nutrition labels, ingredient information, product labelling	B2
forensics /fə'rensɪks/ noun fo-REN-sics	scientific methods used to investigate crimes, such as studying fingerprints or DNA <i>Advances in forensics mean that cases once considered unsolvable can now be reopened.</i>	forensic science, criminal investigation, crime science	C2
forgiving /fə'gɪvɪŋ/ adjective for-GIV-ing	willing to forgive people and not stay angry about their mistakes <i>My grandmother has a very forgiving nature and never holds grudges, even when people let her down.</i>	understanding, tolerant, merciful	B2
formative /'fɔːmətɪv/ adjective FOR-ma-tive	having a strong influence on how a person's character or opinions develop <i>The years I spent at boarding school were formative, teaching me independence and discipline.</i>	influential, shaping, developmental	C1
formidable /'fɔːmɪdəbl/ adjective FOR-mi-da-ble	very difficult to deal with and needing a lot of effort or skill <i>Cleaning up the city's polluted rivers is a formidable task that will take decades.</i>	daunting, enormous, tough	C1

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fortunate /'fɔ:tʃənət/ adjective FOR·tu·nate	lucky, especially in having something good that others may not have <i>I feel fortunate to have grown up surrounded by books and parents who encouraged my curiosity.</i>	lucky, blessed, privileged	B2
forward-thinking /,fɔ:wəd 'θɪŋkɪŋ/ adjective for·ward-·THINK·ing	planning for the future and open to new ideas and methods <i>Our forward-thinking headteacher introduced coding classes long before other schools in the area.</i>	progressive, innovative, far-sighted	C1
foster /'fɒstə/ verb FOS·ter	to encourage something good to develop over time <i>Group projects at school can foster teamwork and communication skills that students need later.</i>	encourage, promote, nurture	C1
foster /'fɒstə/ verb FOS·ter as used: fostering	to help an attitude, feeling or idea grow and spread <i>Community gardens are brilliant at fostering a sense of belonging among neighbours.</i>	cultivate, nurture, promote	C1
fragile /'frædʒaɪl/ adjective FRAG·ile	weak and easily damaged or broken <i>After their argument, the peace between the two brothers felt fragile for quite a long time.</i>	delicate, shaky, vulnerable	B2
fragmented /'fræg'mentɪd/ adjective frag·MENT·ed	broken into small, separate parts that are not connected into a whole <i>Scrolling through short clips gives you a fragmented picture of the news rather than the full story.</i>	disjointed, piecemeal, scattered	C1
framework /'freɪmwɜ:k/ noun FRAME·work	a set of rules, ideas or principles used as a structure for decisions or behaviour <i>Clear household rules give teenagers a framework within which they can make their own choices.</i>	structure, system, boundaries	C1
free flow of ideas /,fri: 'fləʊ əv aɪ'diəz/ collocation	the easy, unrestricted exchange of thoughts and knowledge between people or countries <i>Universities depend on the free flow of ideas, which is why international students are so valuable.</i>	open exchange of ideas, sharing of knowledge, intellectual exchange	C1
friction /'frɪkʃn/ noun FRIC·tion	disagreement or tension between people who have different opinions or needs <i>Sharing one bathroom between six people inevitably causes some friction in the mornings.</i>	tension, conflict, discord	C1
from within /frəm wɪ'ðɪn/ phrase	from inside yourself, such as your own mind, feelings or character <i>Real confidence has to come from within, not from compliments or the number of likes you get.</i>	from inside, internally, from yourself	C1
frugal /'fru:gl/ adjective FRU·gal	careful to spend only a little money and avoid waste <i>My grandparents lived a frugal life, mending clothes and growing their own vegetables.</i>	thrifty, economical, careful with money	C2
frugally /'fru:gəli/ adverb FRU·gal·ly	in a way that uses very little money and avoids waste <i>As a student I lived frugally, cooking big pots of dal that lasted most of the week.</i>	thriftily, economically, sparingly	C2
frustrating /frʌ'streɪtɪŋ/ adjective frus·TRAT·ing	making you feel annoyed or upset because you cannot do or change what you want <i>It's frustrating when the internet keeps cutting out in the middle of an important video call.</i>	annoying, exasperating, infuriating	B2

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fuel /'fju:əl/ verb FU·el as used: fuelling	to make something increase or become stronger <i>Cheap flights have fuelled a huge boom in weekend city breaks across Europe.</i>	drive, boost, stoke	C1
fuel feelings of inadequacy /'fju:əl ,fi:liŋz əv ɪn'ædɪkwəsi/ collocation	to make people feel more strongly that they are not good enough <i>Comparing yourself with successful classmates on social media can fuel feelings of inadequacy.</i>	undermine self-esteem, feed insecurity, damage confidence	C2
fuel insecurity /'fju:əl ,ɪnsɪ'kjʊərəti/ collocation	to make people feel more anxious and less confident about themselves <i>Heavily edited adverts can fuel insecurity among teenagers who compare themselves with the models.</i>	feed self-doubt, breed anxiety, undermine confidence	C1
fulfil your potential /fʊl,fɪl jə pə'tenʃl/ collocation as used: fulfil their potential	to achieve everything that you are capable of achieving <i>Scholarships help bright students from poor families fulfil their potential at university.</i>	reach your potential, achieve your full potential, make the most of yourself	C1
fulfilled /fʊl'fɪld/ adjective ful·FILLED	feeling happy and satisfied because you are doing something meaningful <i>Teaching children to read makes my aunt feel more fulfilled than any office job ever did.</i>	satisfied, content, gratified	C1
fulfilling /fʊl'fɪlɪŋ/ adjective ful·FILL·ing	making you feel happy and satisfied because it is meaningful or useful <i>I find volunteering at the animal shelter far more fulfilling than shopping at the weekend.</i>	rewarding, satisfying, worthwhile	C1
fulfilment /fʊl'fɪlmənt/ noun ful·FIL·ment	a feeling of deep satisfaction from doing something meaningful or achieving what you wanted <i>Many people find greater fulfilment in helping others than in earning a high salary.</i>	satisfaction, contentment, sense of achievement	C1
fully present /,fʊli 'preznt/ collocation	giving all your attention to what is happening now, without being distracted <i>When I'm with my grandparents, I put my phone away so I can be fully present.</i>	completely engaged, attentive, in the moment	C1
fundamental /,fʌndə'mentl/ adjective fun·da·MEN·tal	forming the most basic and essential part of something <i>Trust is fundamental to any friendship, and once it's lost, it's very hard to rebuild.</i>	essential, basic, central	B2
fundamental human right /,fʌndə'mentl ,hju:mən 'raɪt/ collocation	a basic freedom or need that every person should have, whoever they are <i>Many people argue that clean drinking water should be treated as a fundamental human right.</i>	basic right, inalienable right, universal entitlement	C1
fundamentally /,fʌndə'mentəli/ adverb fun·da·MEN·tal·ly	in a basic and very important way <i>The internet has fundamentally changed the way students research and complete their assignments.</i>	essentially, profoundly, at heart	C1
fusion /'fju:ʒn/ noun FU·sion	a combination of different styles, ideas or qualities to create something new <i>The restaurant serves a fusion of Bengali and Thai cooking, which works surprisingly well.</i>	blend, mixture, combination	C1
futile /'fju:təl/ adjective FU·tile	having no chance of success or no useful effect <i>Arguing with my uncle about politics is futile, because he never changes his mind.</i>	pointless, useless, vain	C2

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gain momentum /ˌgeɪn mə'mentəm/ <i>idiom</i> as used: gaining momentum	to become stronger, faster or more successful as time passes <i>The campaign to ban plastic straws gained momentum after videos of polluted beaches went viral.</i>	pick up speed, gather pace, build up steam	C1
gain traction /ˌgeɪn 'trækʃn/ <i>idiom</i> as used: gaining traction	to start to become popular or accepted by more people <i>Plant-based diets are gaining traction among young people in my country, especially in cities.</i>	catch on, take off, win support	C1
gamble /'gæmbəl/ <i>noun</i> GAM·ble	a risky action or decision that could bring success or failure <i>Leaving a stable job to open a bakery was a real gamble, but it paid off for my aunt.</i>	risk, leap in the dark, venture	C1
garish /'geəriʃ/ <i>adjective</i> GAR·ish	unpleasantly bright and colourful, in a way that looks cheap or tasteless <i>The new shopping centre is decorated with garish neon signs that spoil the historic street.</i>	gaudy, loud, flashy	C2
gateway /'geɪtweɪ/ <i>noun</i> GATE·way	something that gives you the opportunity to reach or achieve something <i>For many rural students, a scholarship is a gateway to a completely different future.</i>	path, route, passport	C1
generational change /ˌdʒenə'reɪʃənəl 'tʃeɪndʒ/ <i>collocation</i>	a shift in attitudes or habits between one generation and the next <i>The growing popularity of solo travel among women reflects a clear generational change in attitudes.</i>	shift between generations, changing attitudes, cultural shift	C1
generosity /ˌdʒenə'rɒsəti/ <i>noun</i> gen·er·OS·i·ty	the quality of being kind and willing to give time, help or money to others <i>The generosity of our neighbours after the flood, bringing food and blankets, moved everyone deeply.</i>	kindness, big-heartedness, charity	B2
generous /'dʒenərəs/ <i>adjective</i> GEN·er·ous	kind and willing to give help, time or things to others <i>My flatmate is incredibly generous and always shares whatever food his mother sends from home.</i>	kind, giving, big-hearted	B2
genuine /'dʒenjuɪn/ <i>adjective</i> GEN·u·ine	sincere and honestly felt, not pretended <i>What I value most in a friend is genuine interest in how I'm really doing.</i>	sincere, authentic, heartfelt	B2
geometric /ˌdʒi:ə'metrɪk/ <i>adjective</i> ge·o·MET·ric	made up of regular shapes and lines, such as squares, circles and triangles <i>The mosque's walls are covered in intricate geometric tiles in shades of blue and white.</i>	angular, patterned, symmetrical	C1
get caught up /ˌget ˌkɔ:t 'ʌp/ <i>phrase</i> as used: caught up	to become so involved in an exciting event that you share others' emotions <i>During the World Cup, even my grandmother gets caught up in the excitement.</i>	swept up, carried away, absorbed	C1
get the measure of /ˌget ðə 'meɪʒər əv/ <i>idiom</i>	to understand what someone or something is really like, often by watching carefully <i>It took me a few weeks to get the measure of my new manager and her expectations.</i>	size up, suss out, weigh up	C2
gifted /'ɡɪftɪd/ <i>adjective</i> GIFT·ed	having a natural ability to do something very well <i>She was a gifted speaker who could hold a room's attention without notes.</i>	talented, able, accomplished, skilled	B2

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gimmick /'ɡɪmɪk/ noun GIM·mick	a clever feature or idea used mainly to attract attention rather than to be useful <i>Many smartwatch features seem like a gimmick at first, but some turn out to be genuinely useful.</i>	novelty, gadget, stunt, ploy	C1
glamorous /'glæməərəs/ adjective GLAM·or·ous	attractive and exciting in a way that suggests wealth and success <i>Working in fashion looks glamorous on television, but the reality involves long and tiring days.</i>	glittering, dazzling, alluring, exciting	B2
global giant /,gləʊbl 'dʒaɪənt/ collocation as used: global giants	a very large and powerful company that operates in many countries <i>Small local cafés often struggle to compete with global giants that can afford lower prices.</i>	multinational, corporate giant, conglomerate	C1
glued to your screen /gluːd tə jɔː 'skriːn/ idiom as used: glued to their screens	looking at a phone, computer or television for a long time without stopping <i>During the World Cup final, half the office was glued to their screens instead of working.</i>	hooked on your phone, riveted to the screen, absorbed in a device	B2
go back and forth /gəʊ ,bæk ənd 'fɔːθ/ idiom as used: going back and forth	to keep changing your mind between two options without reaching a decision <i>I went back and forth for weeks before deciding which university to apply to.</i>	waver, dither, be torn, vacillate	C1
go out of your way /,gəʊ ,aʊt əv jə 'wei/ idiom as used: went out of their way	to make a special effort to do something helpful for someone <i>My landlord went out of his way to fix the water pump on a public holiday.</i>	make a special effort, bend over backwards, take extra trouble	C1
goodwill /,gʊd'wɪl/ noun good·WILL	friendly, helpful feelings and a wish to treat others kindly <i>Neighbours sharing food during Ramadan is a lovely sign of goodwill in our area.</i>	kindness, benevolence, friendliness, generosity	C1
govern /'gʌvən/ verb GOV·ern as used: governs	to control or strongly influence how something happens or develops <i>Our habits often govern our choices far more than we realise.</i>	control, determine, shape, dictate	C1
governance /'gʌvənəns/ noun GOV·ern·ance	the way a country, organisation or new area of activity is controlled and managed <i>Good governance of social media platforms is essential if young users are to be protected.</i>	regulation, management, oversight, administration	C1
graceful /'ɡreɪsfl/ adjective GRACE·ful	moving in a smooth, controlled and attractive way <i>The dancers were so graceful that the whole performance seemed effortless.</i>	elegant, fluid, poised, flowing	B2
gracious /'ɡreɪʃəs/ adjective GRA·cious	kind, polite and generous, especially in a situation where you did not have to be <i>It was very gracious of my manager to thank the whole team publicly for the project.</i>	courteous, generous, considerate, kind	C1
gradual /'ɡrædʒuəl/ adjective GRAD·u·al	happening slowly over a period of time, rather than suddenly <i>There has been a gradual shift towards online learning in my country over the last decade.</i>	steady, progressive, step by step, slow	B2
grapple with /'ɡræpl wɪð/ phrasal verb	to try hard to understand or deal with a difficult problem or idea <i>Many young graduates grapple with the question of whether to stay at home or move abroad.</i>	wrestle with, tackle, struggle with, get to grips with	C1

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grateful /'greɪtfl/ adjective GRATE·ful	feeling or showing thanks because someone has helped you or something good has happened <i>I'm really grateful to my teachers for encouraging me when I lacked confidence.</i>	thankful, appreciative, indebted	B2
gratifying /'græɪfəɪɪŋ/ adjective GRAT·i·fy·ing	giving you a feeling of pleasure and satisfaction <i>It is gratifying to see a student I helped finally receive an offer from their dream university.</i>	rewarding, satisfying, fulfilling, pleasing	C1
gratitude /'græɪtju:d/ noun GRAT·i·tude	the feeling of being thankful and wanting to show appreciation <i>Writing down three good things each evening is a simple way to practise gratitude.</i>	thankfulness, appreciation, gratefulness	B2
grind to a halt /,graɪnd tu ə 'hɔ:lt/ idiom as used: ground to a halt	to slowly stop moving or making progress <i>Traffic in Dhaka can grind to a halt during heavy monsoon rain.</i>	come to a standstill, stall, stop dead	C1
gripping /'grɪpɪŋ/ adjective GRIP·ping	so exciting or interesting that it holds your attention completely <i>The documentary was so gripping that I watched all six episodes in one weekend.</i>	compelling, enthralling, riveting, absorbing	C1
gross inequality /,grəʊs ,ɪnɪ'kwələti/ collocation	a very large and obviously unfair difference in wealth or opportunities between people <i>Gross inequality between cities and rural areas pushes many young people to migrate for work.</i>	glaring inequality, stark disparity, extreme imbalance	C1
grounded /'graʊndɪd/ adjective GROUND·ed	emotionally stable and sensible, with a calm understanding of what really matters <i>Spending time with my grandparents in the village always makes me feel more grounded.</i>	balanced, centred, level-headed, stable	C1
grounding /'graʊndɪŋ/ adjective GROUND·ing	making you feel calm, stable and connected to what really matters <i>A slow walk by the river after work has a grounding effect on me.</i>	calming, steadying, centring, settling	C1
grounds for hope /,graʊndz fə 'həʊp/ collocation	good reasons to believe that a situation will improve <i>The rapid growth of solar power gives us real grounds for hope about the future.</i>	reason for optimism, cause for hope, basis for optimism	C1
grow into a role /,grəʊ ,ɪntə ə 'rəʊl/ idiom as used: grew into the role	to gradually become more confident and skilled in a new position or job <i>She seemed nervous as a new team leader, but she grew into the role within a few months.</i>	rise to the occasion, find your feet, mature in the job	C1
growing pains /'grəʊɪŋ peɪnz/ idiom	problems that happen when something develops or expands quickly <i>Every fast-growing city faces growing pains such as traffic jams and housing shortages.</i>	teething problems, teething troubles, early difficulties	C1
gruelling /'gru:əlɪŋ/ adjective GRU·el·ling	extremely tiring and difficult, needing great physical or mental effort <i>Preparing for university entrance exams was a gruelling few months, but it was worth it.</i>	exhausting, punishing, arduous, demanding	C1
grumble /'grʌmb/ verb GRUM·ble as used: grumbled	to complain about something in a quiet, bad-tempered way <i>My sister always grumbles about waking up early, but she never misses a class.</i>	complain, moan, mutter, gripe	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
guarantee /ˌɡærən'tiː/ noun guar·an·TEE	something that makes a particular result certain <i>Hard work is important, but it is no guarantee of a well-paid job.</i>	assurance, certainty, promise	B2
guard against /ɡɑːd ə'genst/ phrasal verb	to take care to prevent something bad from happening <i>Parents should guard against children spending too much time online without supervision.</i>	protect against, prevent, avert, beware of	C1
guidance /'gaɪdnz/ noun GUID·ance	help and advice about how to do something, from someone with more experience <i>With some guidance from a good coach, I think anyone can learn to swim as an adult.</i>	advice, direction, instruction, support	B2
gullible /'ɡʌləbl/ adjective GUL·li·ble	too willing to believe what people tell you, so you are easily tricked <i>Some older people are quite gullible when it comes to fake news shared on social media.</i>	naive, credulous, easily fooled, trusting	C2
habitability /ˌhæbɪtə'bɪləti/ noun hab·it·a·BIL·i·ty	the quality of being suitable or good enough for people or animals to live in <i>Rising sea levels could affect the habitability of low-lying coastal areas in Bangladesh.</i>	liveability, suitability for living, viability	C2
habitat /'hæbɪtæt/ noun HAB·i·tat as used: habitats	the natural home or environment of an animal or plant <i>The Sundarbans is a vital habitat for the Bengal tiger and many rare birds.</i>	natural environment, home, ecosystem, territory	B2
haggle /'hæɡl/ verb HAG·gle as used: haggling	to argue with a seller about the price of something to try to pay less <i>Tourists in local markets are often expected to haggle over the price of souvenirs.</i>	bargain, negotiate, barter, drive a hard bargain	C1
hamper /'hæmpə(r)/ verb HAM·per	to make it more difficult for someone or something to act or make progress <i>Poor internet connections can seriously hamper students who study online.</i>	hinder, obstruct, impede, hold back	C1
handout /'hændaʊt/ noun HAND·out as used: handouts	money or goods given free to people in need, often seen as a short-term fix <i>Many experts believe job training helps poor families more than occasional cash handouts.</i>	charity, donation, aid, dole	C1
hard to beat /ˌhɑːd tə 'biːt/ phrase	so good that it is difficult to find anything better <i>For a relaxing evening, a good book and a cup of tea are hard to beat.</i>	second to none, unbeatable, hard to top	B2
hard-earned /ˌhɑːd 'ɜːnd/ adjective hard--EARNED	gained only after a lot of effort, experience or difficulty <i>My parents spent their hard-earned savings on sending me and my sister to university.</i>	well-deserved, dearly won, hard-won	C1
hardship /'hɑːdʃɪp/ noun HARD·ship	a situation of suffering or difficulty, especially from not having enough money <i>Rising food prices have caused real hardship for many low-income families.</i>	difficulty, deprivation, poverty, adversity	B2
hardship /'hɑːdʃɪp/ noun HARD·ship as used: hardships	difficult conditions or problems that people have to face in life <i>My grandparents faced many hardships when they were young, including floods and food shortages.</i>	difficulties, struggles, trials, adversities	B2

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harmonious /hɑ:'məʊniəs/ adjective har-MO·ni·ous	friendly and peaceful, without arguments or disagreement <i>Sharing household chores fairly helps to keep family life harmonious.</i>	peaceful, amicable, cordial, friendly	C1
harrowing /'hærəʊɪŋ/ adjective HAR·row·ing	extremely upsetting and distressing to see, hear or experience <i>The survivors' stories in the museum were harrowing but important to hear.</i>	distressing, traumatic, agonising, heart-rending	C2
harsh /hɑ:ʃ/ adjective HARSH	very difficult and unpleasant to live or work in <i>Farmers in the north often work in harsh conditions during the hottest months.</i>	severe, tough, punishing, brutal	B2
hassle /'hæsl/ noun HAS·sle	a situation that is annoying because it causes problems or takes a lot of effort <i>Booking train tickets online saves me the hassle of queuing at the station.</i>	bother, inconvenience, trouble, nuisance	B2
have some sympathy with /hæv səm 'sɪmpəθi wið/ phrase	to partly agree with or understand someone's opinion or position <i>I have some sympathy with people who say exams put too much pressure on children.</i>	partly agree with, see the point of, understand	C1
hazardous /'hæzədəs/ adjective HAZ·ard·ous	dangerous, especially to people's health or safety <i>Burning plastic waste releases hazardous chemicals into the air.</i>	dangerous, harmful, unsafe, toxic	C1
health-conscious /'helθ kənʃəs/ adjective HEALTH·con·scious	careful about your diet and lifestyle because you want to stay healthy <i>Young people in cities seem more health-conscious these days, with many joining gyms.</i>	health-aware, diet-conscious, mindful of health	B2
heartbroken /'hɑ:tbreʊkən/ adjective HEART·bro·ken	extremely sad and upset because of a loss or disappointment <i>My little nephew was heartbroken when his favourite toy got lost on the bus.</i>	devastated, crushed, distraught, grief-stricken	B2
heartened /'hɑ:tnd/ adjective HEART·ened	feeling more hopeful and encouraged because of something you have seen or heard <i>I was heartened to see so many young volunteers helping after the floods.</i>	encouraged, uplifted, cheered, reassured	C2
heartfelt /'hɑ:tfelt/ adjective HEART·felt	felt or expressed very sincerely and deeply <i>She wrote a heartfelt letter thanking her teacher for believing in her.</i>	sincere, genuine, earnest, deeply felt	C1
heartwarming /'hɑ:twɔ:mɪŋ/ adjective HEART·warm·ing	causing feelings of happiness and kindness <i>It was heartwarming to see neighbours helping an elderly man carry his shopping home.</i>	touching, moving, uplifting, cheering	C1
heated /'hi:tɪd/ adjective HEAT·ed	full of anger and strong feelings, especially during an argument <i>The debate about school uniforms became quite heated among the parents.</i>	angry, fierce, impassioned, stormy	C1
heavily subsidise /,hevili 'sʌbsɪdaɪz/ collocation as used: heavily subsidising	to pay a large part of the cost of something with government money <i>Many countries heavily subsidise public transport to reduce traffic and pollution.</i>	substantially fund, largely finance, support financially	C1

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hedonic treadmill /hiːdɒnɪk ˈtredmɪl/ collocation	the tendency to return to the same level of happiness soon after gaining something new <i>Buying a new phone every year keeps people on a hedonic treadmill of short-lived excitement.</i>	hedonic adaptation, cycle of wanting more, endless chase for pleasure	C2
heightened awareness /ˌhaɪtnd əˈweənəs/ collocation	a greater and stronger understanding of an issue than before <i>The pandemic led to a heightened awareness of the importance of hygiene.</i>	increased awareness, greater consciousness, sharper understanding	C1
helplessness /ˈhelpləsnəs/ noun HELP·less·ness	the feeling of being unable to do anything to change or control a situation <i>Watching the floodwater rise gave many villagers a terrible sense of helplessness.</i>	powerlessness, impotence, vulnerability, despair	C1
heritage /ˈherɪtɪdʒ/ noun HER·it·age	the traditions, history and culture passed down from earlier generations <i>Festivals like Pohela Boishakh help young people stay connected to their cultural heritage.</i>	legacy, inheritance, tradition, roots	B2
heroic /həˈrəʊɪk/ adjective he·RO·ic	showing great courage or doing something very impressive or admirable <i>Nothing I do at work is heroic, but helping a student get a visa feels meaningful.</i>	brave, courageous, valiant, noble	B2
hesitation /ˌhezɪˈteɪʃn/ noun hes·i·TA·tion	a pause or delay before doing or saying something because you are unsure <i>When my friend asked for help moving house, I agreed without hesitation.</i>	pause, reluctance, uncertainty, doubt	C1
high street /ˈhaɪ stri:t/ noun as used: high streets	the main street of a town, where most of the shops and businesses are <i>Many small shops on the high street have closed because people now shop online.</i>	main street, town centre, shopping street	B2
high-density /ˌhaɪ ˈdensəti/ adjective high·DEN·si·ty	having a lot of people or buildings in a small area <i>High-density housing can make better use of limited land in crowded cities.</i>	densely populated, crowded, compact, packed	C1
high-stakes /ˌhaɪ ˈsteɪks/ adjective high·STAKES	involving serious risks or important results if something goes wrong <i>Surgeons and pilots work in high-stakes jobs where a single mistake can be very costly.</i>	high-pressure, critical, risky, crucial	C1
hinder /ˈhɪndə(r)/ verb HIN·der	to make it harder for something to happen or for someone to make progress <i>Constant phone notifications can hinder concentration when you are trying to study.</i>	hamper, obstruct, impede, hold back	C1
hinge on /ˈhɪndʒ ɒn/ phrasal verb	to depend completely on something <i>Whether we travel to Cox's Bazar this year will hinge on the weather.</i>	depend on, rest on, turn on, be contingent on	C2
hinge on /ˈhɪndʒ ɒn/ phrasal verb as used: hinges on	to depend mainly or completely on a particular thing <i>The success of any new policy hinges on how well it is explained to the public.</i>	depends on, rests on, turns on, hangs on	C2
hoarding /ˈhɔːdɪŋ/ noun HOARD·ing	collecting and keeping large amounts of money or goods without using them <i>Panic buying and hoarding of rice pushed prices up during the crisis.</i>	stockpiling, amassing, accumulating, saving up	C2

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hold accountable /ˌhəʊld əˈkaʊntəbl/ <i>collocation</i> as used: held accountable	to make a person or organisation accept responsibility for their actions <i>Factory owners should be held accountable for polluting nearby rivers.</i>	hold responsible, make answerable, call to account	C1
hold back /ˌhəʊld ˈbæk/ <i>phrasal verb</i> as used: held back	to prevent someone from making progress or achieving what they could <i>Many bright students are held back by a lack of money for higher education.</i>	hinder, restrict, hamper, hold down	B2
hold significance /ˌhəʊld sɪɡˈnɪfɪkəns/ <i>collocation</i> as used: holds such significance	to be important or meaningful to someone or in a particular situation <i>The river holds great significance for people in my hometown, as it shapes their daily lives.</i>	matter, be important, carry weight, mean a lot	C1
holistic /həʊˈlɪstɪk/ <i>adjective</i> ho·LIS·tic	dealing with the whole of something rather than only separate parts <i>A holistic approach to education develops students' character as well as their exam results.</i>	comprehensive, integrated, all-round, whole	C2
hollow /ˈhɒləʊ/ <i>adjective</i> HOL·low	without real value, meaning or sincerity <i>Winning felt hollow because I knew the other team had been missing their best player.</i>	empty, meaningless, worthless, shallow	C1
homogenisation /həˌmɒdʒənəɪˈzeɪʃn/ <i>noun</i> ho·mog·en·i·SA·tion	the process of things becoming the same or very similar, losing their differences <i>The spread of global chains has led to a homogenisation of city centres around the world.</i>	standardisation, uniformity, sameness, levelling	C2
homogenise /həˌmɒdʒənəɪz/ <i>verb</i> ho·MOG·en·ise as used: homogenised	to make things the same or similar, so they lose their special differences <i>Global fashion trends have homogenised the way young people dress in many countries.</i>	standardise, make uniform, level out	C2
hone your skills /ˌhəʊn jə ˈskɪlz/ <i>collocation</i> as used: honing my skills	to improve your abilities gradually through practice <i>I've been honing my presentation skills by speaking at small workshops.</i>	sharpen your skills, refine your skills, polish your abilities	C1
hooked /hʊkt/ <i>adjective</i> HOOKED	enjoying something so much that you want to keep doing it <i>After watching one episode of the series, I was completely hooked.</i>	addicted, captivated, obsessed, smitten	B2
horrendous /həˈrendəs/ <i>adjective</i> hor·REN·dous	extremely bad, unpleasant or shocking in quality <i>The queue at the passport office was horrendous, so I had to wait nearly all day.</i>	dreadful, awful, terrible, atrocious	C1
hospitality /ˌhɒspɪˈtæləti/ <i>noun</i> hos·pi·TAL·i·ty	friendly and generous behaviour towards guests or visitors <i>Bangladeshi families are known for their hospitality, always offering guests tea and snacks.</i>	welcome, generosity, warmth, friendliness	B2
hostile /ˈhɒstaɪl/ <i>adjective</i> HOS·tile	unfriendly and aggressive, showing strong disagreement or dislike <i>A hostile working environment can make even a well-paid job feel unbearable.</i>	antagonistic, aggressive, unfriendly, confrontational	C1
hotspot /ˈhɒtspɒt/ <i>noun</i> HOT·spot as used: hotspots	a place that is very popular or busy, especially with tourists <i>Cox's Bazar becomes a tourist hotspot during the winter holidays.</i>	hub, magnet, popular spot, centre	C1

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household /'haʊshəʊld/ noun HOUSE·hold	all the people who live together in one house or flat <i>In our household, everyone gathers for dinner at around nine o'clock.</i>	home, family, family unit, domestic circle	B2
hub /hʌb/ noun HUB as used: hubs	the central and most important place for a particular activity <i>Dhaka is the country's main hub for business, education and the arts.</i>	centre, focal point, heart, nucleus	C1
humane /'hju:'meɪn/ adjective hu·MANE	showing kindness and concern for people or animals and avoiding causing suffering <i>A humane society looks after its elderly and disabled citizens properly.</i>	compassionate, kind, merciful, caring	C2
humanitarian /'hju:,mæni'teəriən/ adjective hu·man·i·TAR·i·an	concerned with reducing human suffering and improving people's lives <i>The refugee situation is a humanitarian crisis that needs international support.</i>	charitable, compassionate, welfare-related, philanthropic	C1
humble /'hʌmbəl/ adjective HUM·ble	not proud and not believing you are more important than other people <i>Despite his success, my old teacher remains humble and approachable.</i>	modest, unassuming, self-effacing, down-to-earth	B2
humbling /'hʌmbliŋ/ adjective HUM·bling	making you realise you are less skilled or important than you thought <i>Losing my first debate competition was humbling, but it made me prepare much harder.</i>	chastening, sobering, eye-opening	C1
humility /'hju:'mɪləti/ noun hu·MIL·i·ty	the quality of not being proud and not thinking you are better than others <i>Great leaders often show humility by admitting their mistakes openly.</i>	modesty, humbleness, self-effacement	C1
hurdle /'hɜ:dl/ noun HUR·dle as used: hurdles	a problem or difficulty that must be dealt with before you can make progress <i>Getting a visa is often the biggest hurdle for students hoping to study abroad.</i>	obstacle, barrier, challenge, stumbling block	C1
hushed /hʌʃt/ adjective HUSHED	very quiet, often because people are speaking softly out of respect <i>The museum hall was hushed as visitors looked at the old photographs.</i>	quiet, silent, muted, still	C1
hustle and bustle /,hʌsl ən 'bʌsl/ idiom	busy, noisy activity with lots of people moving around <i>I enjoy the hustle and bustle of the market, but only for an hour or so.</i>	commotion, bustle, busyness, frantic activity	B2
hybrid /'haɪbrɪd/ adjective HY·brid	combining two different things, such as working at home and in an office <i>Many companies now offer a hybrid schedule, with two days at home and three in the office.</i>	mixed, blended, combined, composite	C1
hysteria /'hɪ'stɪəriə/ noun hys·TE·ri·a	extreme fear or excitement among people that is out of control <i>The media sometimes creates hysteria about new illnesses before the facts are clear.</i>	panic, frenzy, alarm, mania	C1
ideal /'aɪ'di:əl/ noun i·DE·al	the best possible situation or thing that you can imagine <i>For many young couples, the ideal is a small home close to both work and family.</i>	perfect choice, dream, model, best option	B2

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idle /'aɪdl/ adjective ɪ·dle	not busy or doing anything, sometimes in a relaxed way <i>On lazy Friday afternoons, I like to sit idle on the balcony and watch the street below.</i>	inactive, unoccupied, at rest, doing nothing	C1
idolise /'aɪdəlaɪz/ verb ɪ·dol·ise as used: idolising	to admire or love someone so much that you think they are perfect <i>Many teenagers idolise football stars and copy everything they do.</i>	worship, hero-worship, adore, put on a pedestal	C1
idyllic /'ɪdlɪk/ adjective ɪ·DYL·lic	extremely peaceful, beautiful and pleasant, like a perfect place <i>My grandparents' village, with its green fields and ponds, feels almost idyllic in spring.</i>	picturesque, perfect, heavenly, blissful	C1
ignite /'ɪɡnaɪt/ verb ɪɡ·NITE as used: ignites	to cause a strong feeling or interest to start in someone <i>A good teacher can ignite a lifelong love of reading in a child.</i>	spark, kindle, arouse, inspire	C1
ignite /'ɪɡnaɪt/ verb ɪɡ·NITE as used: igniting	to make someone start to feel a strong interest or enthusiasm <i>Travel documentaries helped ignite my interest in other cultures.</i>	spark, kindle, awaken, stir	C1
illusory /'ɪluːsəri/ adjective ɪl·LU·so·ry	seeming real or true but actually false <i>The freedom that credit cards offer is often illusory, because the debt eventually has to be repaid.</i>	deceptive, false, imaginary, misleading	C2
imaginative /'ɪmædʒɪnətɪv/ adjective ɪ·MAG·i·na·tive	able to think of new and creative ideas <i>Children are naturally imaginative, so schools should give them room to be creative.</i>	creative, inventive, original, inspired	B2
imbalance /'ɪm'bæləns/ noun ɪm·BAL·ance	a situation in which two things are not equal or fair in amount or importance <i>There is a clear imbalance between the number of jobs and graduates in my country.</i>	inequality, disparity, mismatch, disproportion	C1
immaculately /'ɪmækjələtli/ adverb ɪm·MAC·u·late·ly	perfectly, with no dirt, mistakes or untidiness at all <i>My mother keeps our flat immaculately clean, especially before guests arrive for Eid.</i>	spotlessly, perfectly, impeccably, flawlessly	C1
immeasurable /'ɪmeʒərəbl/ adjective ɪm·MEAS·ur·a·ble	too large or great to be measured <i>The support my family gave me during my studies was of immeasurable value.</i>	enormous, boundless, incalculable, vast	C1
immediacy /'ɪmiːdiəsi/ noun ɪm·ME·di·a·cy	the quality of being available or happening straight away, without delay <i>The immediacy of social media means rumours can spread within minutes.</i>	instantness, speed, urgency, promptness	C2
immediate surroundings /ɪ.miːdiət sə'raʊndɪŋz/ collocation	the area or environment directly around you <i>Walking without headphones makes me notice my immediate surroundings much more.</i>	local environment, vicinity, surroundings, neighbourhood	C1
immense /'ɪmens/ adjective ɪm·MENSE	extremely large or great in amount or degree <i>Passing my final exams gave me an immense sense of achievement.</i>	enormous, huge, tremendous, vast	C1

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immersed /ɪ'mɜːst/ adjective im-MERSED	completely involved in an activity so that you forget everything else <i>I get so immersed in a good novel that I lose track of time.</i>	absorbed, engrossed, wrapped up, lost	C1
immersion /ɪ'mɜːʃn/ noun im-MER-sion	the method of learning a language by being surrounded by it all the time <i>Living abroad for a year offers the kind of immersion no classroom can match.</i>	total exposure, saturation, deep involvement	C1
immersive /ɪ'mɜːsɪv/ adjective im-MER-sive	making you feel completely involved in an experience, as if you are part of it <i>Virtual reality museums offer an immersive way to explore history.</i>	absorbing, engaging, engrossing, involving	C1
impair /ɪm'peə(r)/ verb im-PAIR	to damage something or make it weaker or less effective <i>Lack of sleep can seriously impair your concentration at work.</i>	damage, weaken, harm, undermine	C1
impeccable /ɪm'pekəbl/ adjective im-PEC-ca-ble	perfect, with no faults or mistakes <i>The hotel staff had impeccable manners and remembered every guest's name.</i>	flawless, perfect, faultless, exemplary	C2
imperative /ɪm'perətɪv/ adjective im-PER-a-tive	extremely important and necessary to do <i>It is imperative that children learn to swim in a country with so many rivers.</i>	essential, vital, crucial, critical	C1
imperative /ɪm'perətɪv/ noun im-PER-a-tive as used: imperatives	something that is extremely important and must be done or considered <i>Protecting public health and keeping the economy running were both imperatives during the pandemic.</i>	priority, necessity, requirement, obligation	C2
impersonal /ɪm'pɜːsənəl/ adjective im-PER-son-al	lacking warmth or friendly human contact <i>Automated customer service lines can feel cold and impersonal.</i>	cold, detached, distant, formal	C1
implication /ɪm'pli'keɪʃn/ noun im-pli-CA-tion as used: implications	a possible effect or result of an action or decision <i>The move to online banking has serious implications for elderly people who cannot use apps.</i>	consequence, ramification, effect, repercussion	C1
impose /ɪm'pəʊz/ verb im-POSE as used: imposed	to force people to accept a rule, system or change <i>Rules that are imposed without discussion rarely win people's support.</i>	enforce, force, dictate, inflict	C1
impression /ɪm'preʃn/ noun im-PRES-sion	the effect that something has on your feelings or memory <i>My first visit to the Sundarbans made a strong impression on me.</i>	impact, effect, influence, mark	B2
impressive /ɪm'presɪv/ adjective im-PRES-sive	causing admiration because of great skill, size or quality <i>It's impressive how quickly my younger sister picks up new subjects.</i>	remarkable, striking, admirable, outstanding	B2
imprudent /ɪm'pruːdnt/ adjective im-PRU-dent	not sensible or wise, especially about money or risks <i>Taking out a large loan to buy the latest phone would be imprudent.</i>	unwise, reckless, rash, foolish	C2

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impulse control /'ɪmpʌls kənˌtrəʊl/ collocation	the ability to stop yourself from acting quickly on a sudden desire <i>Games that reward instant clicks may weaken children's impulse control.</i>	self-control, self-restraint, willpower, self-discipline	C1
impulse purchase /'ɪmpʌls ˌpɜːtʃəs/ collocation as used: impulse purchases	something you buy suddenly without planning or thinking carefully <i>Supermarkets place sweets near the tills to encourage impulse purchases.</i>	impulse buy, spontaneous purchase, unplanned purchase	C1
impulsive /ɪmˈpʌlsɪv/ adjective im·PUL·sive	tending to act suddenly without thinking carefully about the results <i>He made an impulsive decision to quit his job and regretted it a month later.</i>	rash, hasty, reckless, spontaneous	C1
impulsively /ɪmˈpʌlsɪvli/ adverb im·PUL·sive·ly	suddenly and without thinking carefully first <i>I once impulsively booked a trip to Sylhet and ended up having a wonderful time.</i>	rashly, hastily, spontaneously, on a whim	C1
in keeping with /ɪn 'kiːpɪŋ wɪð/ phrase	suitable for or matching a particular style, occasion or tradition <i>The new building is in keeping with the historic architecture of the old town.</i>	consistent with, appropriate to, in line with, suited to	C1
in moderation /ɪn ˌmɒdə'reɪʃn/ phrase	in reasonable amounts, not too much <i>Sweets are fine in moderation, but my dentist warns me not to overdo them.</i>	within limits, sensibly, in reasonable amounts	B2
in print /ɪn 'prɪnt/ phrase	published as a book, newspaper or magazine <i>It was a proud moment to see my first short article in print in the local newspaper.</i>	published, in black and white, on paper	C1
in tandem /ɪn 'tændəm/ phrase	together, at the same time or in cooperation <i>The school and parents should work in tandem to support struggling pupils.</i>	together, side by side, jointly, in parallel	C2
in your element /ɪn jər 'elɪmənt/ idiom as used: in my element	in a situation you enjoy and feel completely comfortable in <i>My father is in his element when he's chatting with customers at a busy market.</i>	in your comfort zone, at home, in your natural habitat	C1
in-depth /ɪn 'depθ/ adjective in-DEPTH	very detailed and thorough, examining all aspects of a subject <i>The course includes an in-depth study of how international markets work.</i>	thorough, detailed, comprehensive, exhaustive	B2
inaction /ɪn'ækʃn/ noun in·AC·tion	failure to do anything, especially when action is needed <i>Government inaction on air pollution has left many residents frustrated.</i>	passivity, inertia, idleness, failure to act	C1
inactivity /ɪnæk'tɪvəti/ noun in·ac·TIV·i·ty	a lack of physical movement or exercise <i>Long hours at a desk and physical inactivity can lead to back problems.</i>	sedentariness, idleness, lack of exercise, immobility	C1
incarceration /ɪnˌkɑːsə'reɪʃn/ noun in·car·cer·A·tion	the state of being kept in prison <i>For minor crimes, community service may be more useful than incarceration.</i>	imprisonment, detention, confinement, custody	C2
incentive /ɪn'sentɪv/ noun in·CEN·tive as used: incentives	something that encourages people to do something, such as a reward or lower tax <i>Tax incentives could encourage more families to install solar panels.</i>	inducement, motivation, encouragement, stimulus	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
incitement /ɪn'saɪtmənt/ noun in-CITE·ment	the act of encouraging people to do something violent or illegal <i>Posting messages that amount to incitement to violence should be illegal online.</i>	provocation, instigation, encouragement, agitation	C2
inclusion /ɪn'kluːʒn/ noun in-CLU·sion	the practice of making sure everyone can take part and is treated fairly <i>Ramps and lifts in public buildings are basic steps towards the inclusion of disabled people.</i>	integration, involvement, participation, acceptance	C1
inclusive /ɪn'kluːsɪv/ adjective in-CLU·sive	welcoming and involving all kinds of people, without leaving anyone out <i>A good school sports day should be inclusive, with events for every ability.</i>	welcoming, open to all, accommodating, all-embracing	C1
incorporate /ɪn'kɔːpəreɪt/ verb in-COR·po·rate as used: incorporating	to include something as part of a larger plan, system or group <i>Many schools now incorporate coding lessons into the primary curriculum.</i>	include, integrate, build in, absorb	C1
indebted /ɪn'detɪd/ adjective in-DEBT·ed	feeling grateful to someone because they have helped you a lot <i>I am deeply indebted to my first manager, who taught me how to deal with clients.</i>	grateful, obliged, beholden, thankful	C2
independence /ˌɪndɪ'pendəns/ noun in-de-PEND·ence	the freedom to live your life and make decisions without relying on others <i>Living in student halls gives young people their first taste of independence.</i>	freedom, self-reliance, autonomy, self-sufficiency	B2
indispensable /ˌɪndɪ'spensəbl/ adjective in-dis-PENS·a·ble	so important or useful that you cannot manage without it <i>A good dictionary app is indispensable for anyone learning a new language.</i>	essential, vital, crucial, necessary	C1
individualism /ˌɪndɪ'vɪdʒuəlɪzəm/ noun in-di-VID·u·al·ism	the belief that personal freedom and independence matter more than the group <i>Western cultures are often said to value individualism more than Asian cultures do.</i>	independence, self-reliance, personal freedom, autonomy	C2
industrialisation /ɪn,dʌstriəl'aɪ'zeɪʃn/ noun in-dus·tri·al·i·SA·tion	the process of developing many factories and industries in a country or region <i>Industrialisation brought jobs to many towns, but it also polluted their rivers.</i>	industrial development, modernisation, mechanisation	C1
inequality /ˌɪnɪ'kwɒləti/ noun in-e·QUAL·i·ty as used: inequalities	an unfair difference in wealth, power or opportunities between groups <i>Online learning exposed inequalities between students with and without internet access.</i>	disparity, imbalance, unfairness, gap	C1
inescapable /ˌɪnɪ'skeɪpəbl/ adjective in-es-CAP·a·ble	impossible to avoid or ignore <i>In a crowded city, noise is almost inescapable, even late at night.</i>	unavoidable, inevitable, inexorable, unescapable	C2
inevitable /ɪn'evɪtəbl/ adjective in-EV·i·ta·ble	certain to happen and impossible to avoid <i>With so many cars on the road, traffic jams during rush hour are inevitable.</i>	unavoidable, certain, inescapable, bound to happen	C1
inevitably /ɪn'evɪtəbli/ adverb in-EV·i·ta·bly	in a way that cannot be avoided or prevented <i>When families gather for Eid, the conversation inevitably turns to marriage plans.</i>	unavoidably, inescapably, naturally, invariably	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
infectious /ɪn'fekʃəs/ adjective in-FEC-tious	quickly spreading to other people, used for feelings such as laughter or joy <i>My nephew's laugh is so infectious that everyone ends up laughing with him.</i>	contagious, catching, irresistible, catchy	C1
inflame /ɪn'fleɪm/ verb in-FLAME as used: inflaming	to make a difficult situation or strong feelings worse <i>Angry comments online only inflame arguments instead of resolving them.</i>	aggravate, worsen, provoke, stoke	C2
inflate /ɪn'fleɪt/ verb in-FLATE	to make prices or amounts higher than they should be <i>Tourist demand can inflate rents so much that local people are pushed out.</i>	raise, push up, increase, boost	C1
information overload /ˌɪnfə'meɪʃn 'əʊvələʊd/ collocation	a situation where there is too much information to understand or deal with <i>Checking several news apps each morning can easily lead to information overload.</i>	data overload, information glut, overstimulation	C1
informed /ɪn'fɔːmd/ adjective in-FORMED	having good knowledge or up-to-date information about something <i>I read the newspaper every morning to stay informed about local issues.</i>	knowledgeable, up to date, aware, well-read	B2
informed decision /ɪn'fɔːmd dɪ'sɪʒn/ collocation as used: informed decisions	a choice made after collecting and understanding the relevant facts <i>Clear food labels help shoppers make informed decisions about what they eat.</i>	educated choice, considered decision, reasoned judgement	B2
infrastructure /'ɪnfəstrʌktʃə(r)/ noun IN-fra-struc-ture	the basic systems a society needs, such as roads, water supply and power <i>The new bridge has greatly improved transport infrastructure in the north of the country.</i>	facilities, public works, systems, services	C1
infringe on /ɪn'frɪndʒ ɒn/ phrasal verb as used: infringes on	to limit or interfere with someone's rights or freedom <i>Security cameras in every street might infringe on people's privacy.</i>	encroach on, violate, intrude on, impinge on	C2
infuriating /ɪn'fjʊəriɪtɪŋ/ adjective in-FU-ri-at-ing	making you extremely angry or annoyed <i>It is infuriating when a website crashes just as you are about to pay.</i>	maddening, exasperating, enraging, irritating	C1
ingenious /ɪn'dʒɪːniəs/ adjective in-GE-nious	very clever and good at inventing new ways of solving problems <i>A local farmer came up with an ingenious way to water his crops using old bottles.</i>	clever, inventive, resourceful, brilliant	C1
ingenuity /ˌɪndʒə'njuːəti/ noun in-ge-NU-i-ty	the ability to think of clever and original ways of solving problems <i>Street vendors show remarkable ingenuity in making the most of tiny spaces.</i>	inventiveness, resourcefulness, creativity, cleverness	C2
ingrained /ɪn'greɪnd/ adjective in-GRAINED	so firmly established that it is very difficult to change <i>Respect for elders is deeply ingrained in Bangladeshi culture.</i>	entrenched, deep-rooted, deep-seated, fixed	C2
ingrained habit /ɪn,greɪnd 'hæbɪt/ collocation as used: ingrained habits	a way of behaving that has become so fixed it is very hard to change <i>Checking my phone first thing in the morning has become an ingrained habit.</i>	deep-rooted habit, entrenched routine, second nature	C2

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inherently /ɪnˈherəntli/ adverb in-HER-ent-ly	as a basic, natural part of something that cannot be separated from it <i>Technology is not inherently good or bad; it depends on how we use it.</i>	intrinsically, fundamentally, essentially, by nature	C1
injustice /ɪnˈdʒʌstɪs/ noun in-JUS-tice as used: injustices	a situation in which people are treated unfairly <i>Many young people use social media to speak out against injustice in their communities.</i>	unfairness, inequity, wrong, discrimination	C1
innate /ɪˈneɪt/ adjective in-NATE	existing in a person from birth rather than learned <i>Some children seem to have an innate sense of rhythm and pick up music effortlessly.</i>	inborn, natural, inherent, instinctive	C2
innocence /ɪˈnɒsns/ noun IN-no-cence	the simple, trusting nature of someone who has little experience of the world <i>I miss the innocence of childhood, when my biggest worry was homework.</i>	naivety, purity, simplicity, guilelessness	B2
inquisitive /ɪnˈkwɪzətɪv/ adjective in-QUIS-i-tive	always wanting to find out about things and asking many questions <i>Inquisitive students often learn more because they are not afraid to ask why.</i>	curious, questioning, enquiring, interested	C1
insecure /ˌɪnsɪˈkjʊə(r)/ adjective in-se-CURE	lacking confidence and feeling anxious about yourself or your situation <i>Constantly comparing yourself with others online can make you feel insecure.</i>	unsure, anxious, unconfident, uncertain	B2
insensitive /ɪnˈsensətɪv/ adjective in-SEN-si-tive	not noticing or caring about other people's feelings <i>Making jokes about someone's weight is insensitive, even if you mean no harm.</i>	tactless, thoughtless, inconsiderate, unfeeling	C1
inseparable /ɪnˈseprəbl/ adjective in-SEP-a-ra-ble	so close as friends that they are almost always together <i>My cousin and I were inseparable during school holidays at our grandparents' village.</i>	devoted, very close, joined at the hip	C1
insidious /ɪnˈsɪdiəs/ adjective in-SID-i-ous	causing harm gradually and secretly, so it is not noticed until it is serious <i>Stress can have an insidious effect on your health over many years.</i>	stealthy, creeping, subtle, pernicious	C2
insight /ˈɪnsaɪt/ noun IN-sight	a clear and deep understanding of a person, situation or subject <i>Talking to former students gives me real insight into life at foreign universities.</i>	understanding, perception, awareness, perspective	C1
insightful /ˈɪnsaɪtfl/ adjective IN-sight-ful	showing a clear and deep understanding of something <i>My grandmother makes insightful comments about people, despite having little formal education.</i>	perceptive, astute, wise, penetrating	C1
insignificant /ˌɪnsɪɡˈnɪfɪkənt/ adjective in-sig-NIF-i-cant	too small or unimportant to be worth considering <i>Refusing plastic bags may seem insignificant, but small habits add up over time.</i>	trivial, negligible, minor, unimportant	C1
inspiring /ɪnˈspaɪərɪŋ/ adjective in-SPIR-ing	making you feel enthusiastic and wanting to do something good <i>Her story of starting a school in her village was truly inspiring.</i>	uplifting, motivating, encouraging, stirring	B2

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instability /ˌɪnstəˈbɪləti/ noun in·sta·BIL·i·ty	a situation that is likely to change suddenly, often causing problems <i>Political instability can discourage foreign companies from investing in a country.</i>	unrest, insecurity, volatility, turmoil	C1
instant gratification /ˌɪnstənt ˌgrætɪfɪˈkeɪʃn/ collocation	the wish to get pleasure or rewards immediately, without waiting <i>Social media apps are designed to offer instant gratification through likes and notifications.</i>	immediate reward, quick satisfaction, instant pleasure	C1
instantaneous /ˌɪnstənˈteɪniəs/ adjective in·stan·TA·ne·ous	happening immediately, without any delay <i>Online bank transfers are now almost instantaneous, even between different banks.</i>	immediate, instant, split-second, prompt	C1
instil /ɪnˈstɪl/ verb in·STIL as used: instilled	to gradually make someone have a feeling, belief or habit <i>My father instilled in me the habit of always being on time.</i>	implant, inculcate, impart, ingrain	C2
instil /ɪnˈstɪl/ verb in·STIL as used: instilling	to gradually make someone develop a quality, value or attitude <i>Team sports are good at instilling discipline and cooperation in children.</i>	fostering, nurturing, inculcating, imparting	C2
instil /ɪnˈstɪl/ verb in·STIL as used: instils	to put a feeling or value into someone's mind over time <i>A good coach instils confidence in young players, not just skills.</i>	builds, implants, fosters, imparts	C2
instinctive /ɪnˈstɪŋktɪv/ adjective in·STINC·tive	based on natural feeling or long experience rather than careful thought <i>Experienced drivers have an instinctive sense of when another car might pull out.</i>	intuitive, natural, automatic, innate	C1
instinctively /ɪnˈstɪŋktɪvli/ adverb in·STINC·tive·ly	naturally and without needing to think about it <i>When the ball came towards her, my sister instinctively put her hands up to catch it.</i>	intuitively, naturally, automatically, spontaneously	C1
instructive /ɪnˈstrʌktɪv/ adjective in·STRUC·tive	giving useful information or teaching you something valuable <i>Visiting a real factory was far more instructive than reading about it in a textbook.</i>	informative, educational, enlightening, illuminating	C1
integral /ˈɪntɪgrəl/ adjective IN·te·gral	so important that something would not be complete or work without it <i>Music is an integral part of every wedding celebration in my country.</i>	essential, fundamental, central, intrinsic	C1
integrate /ˈɪntɪɡreɪt/ verb IN·te·grate	to become part of a group or society and be accepted by it <i>Joining local clubs helps newcomers integrate into a new community more quickly.</i>	fit in, assimilate, settle in, blend in	C1
integrated /ˈɪntɪɡreɪtɪd/ adjective IN·te·grat·ed	with different parts connected so they work well together as one system <i>An integrated ticket system would let passengers use buses and trains with one card.</i>	unified, coordinated, joined-up, combined	C1
integration /ˌɪntɪˈɡreɪʃn/ noun in·te·GRA·tion	the process of people from different groups mixing and living together well <i>Sport can play a big role in the integration of immigrants into a new society.</i>	inclusion, assimilation, unification, cohesion	C1

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integrity /ɪn'tegrəti/ noun in-TEG·ri·ty	the quality of being honest and having strong moral principles <i>A leader with integrity keeps promises even when it is difficult.</i>	honesty, principle, decency, honour	C1
intellectually curious /ɪntəˌlektʃuəli 'kjʊəriəs/ collocation	eager to learn and think about new ideas and subjects <i>Intellectually curious people often enjoy documentaries, podcasts and long conversations.</i>	inquisitive, eager to learn, enquiring	C1
intellectually stimulated /ɪntəˌlektʃuəli 'stimjuleɪtɪd/ collocation	feeling that your mind is active and interested by challenging ideas <i>A good debate at university always left me intellectually stimulated for days.</i>	mentally engaged, mentally challenged, inspired	C1
intend /ɪn'tend/ verb in-TEND	to plan or have a purpose to do something <i>I intend to take a short course in public speaking next year.</i>	plan, aim, mean, propose	B2
intense competition /ɪn'tens ,kɒmpə'tɪʃn/ collocation	very strong rivalry between people or organisations trying to win or gain something <i>There is intense competition for places at the top public universities in Bangladesh.</i>	fierce competition, stiff competition, cut-throat rivalry	B2
intensify /ɪn'tensɪfaɪ/ verb in-TEN-si-fy	to become greater, stronger or more serious <i>Heat waves are likely to intensify as global temperatures continue to rise.</i>	increase, escalate, heighten, strengthen	C1
intentional /ɪn'tenʃənəl/ adjective in-TEN-tion-al	done deliberately and with a clear purpose rather than by chance <i>I've become more intentional about how I spend my evenings, so I read instead of scrolling.</i>	deliberate, purposeful, conscious, planned	C1
intentionally /ɪn'tenʃənəli/ adverb in-TEN-tion-al-ly	deliberately and with a clear purpose <i>I intentionally leave my phone in another room while I work so I can focus.</i>	deliberately, purposely, consciously, on purpose	C1
interconnected /ɪntəˌkəˈnektɪd/ adjective in-ter-con-NECT-ed	closely linked so that each part affects the others <i>Poverty, health and education are interconnected, so improving one often helps the others.</i>	interlinked, interrelated, connected, intertwined	C1
interdependence /ɪntədɪˈpendəns/ noun in-ter-de-PEND-ence	a situation in which people or things depend on each other <i>The interdependence of global economies means a crisis in one country quickly spreads.</i>	mutual dependence, reliance, connectedness, reciprocity	C2
intermittent /ɪntə'mɪtənt/ adjective in-ter-MIT-tent	stopping and starting repeatedly rather than happening continuously <i>Intermittent power cuts in summer make it hard to work from home.</i>	irregular, sporadic, occasional, on and off	C2
internalise /ɪn'tɜːnəlaɪz/ verb in-TER-nal-ise	to accept an attitude or belief so completely that it becomes part of you <i>Children who hear constant criticism may internalise the idea that they are not good enough.</i>	absorb, take on board, assimilate, adopt	C2
internalise /ɪn'tɜːnəlaɪz/ verb in-TER-nal-ise as used: internalising	to accept an idea or value so deeply that it becomes part of how you think <i>Young people may internalise the values of the adults they look up to.</i>	absorb, take on board, embrace, adopt	C2

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interpersonal /ˌɪntəˈpɜːsənəl/ adjective in-ter-PER-sən-əl	connected with the way people communicate and build relationships with each other <i>Good interpersonal skills are essential for anyone working with customers.</i>	social, people, communication, relational	C1
intertwined /ˌɪntəˈtwaɪnd/ adjective in-ter-TWINED	very closely connected so that one cannot be separated from the other <i>In rural areas, family life and farming are closely intertwined.</i>	interlinked, interwoven, entwined, interconnected	C1
intertwined with /ˌɪntəˈtwaɪnd wɪð/ phrase	closely connected with something so that each affects the other <i>For my family, food is intertwined with memories of festivals and gatherings.</i>	bound up with, linked with, interwoven with	C1
intervene /ˌɪntəˈviːn/ verb in-ter-VE NE	to become involved in a situation in order to improve it or stop it getting worse <i>Teachers should intervene early when they notice a student is being bullied.</i>	step in, get involved, interfere, mediate	C1
intimacy /ˈɪntɪməsi/ noun IN-ti-ma-cy	a close, warm and personal relationship between people <i>Long phone calls with my elder sister help us keep the intimacy of our childhood friendship.</i>	closeness, familiarity, affection, bond	C1
intimate /ˈɪntɪmət/ adjective IN-ti-mate	small, quiet and private, making people feel relaxed and close <i>The café is small and intimate, with only a handful of tables and soft lighting.</i>	cosy, snug, private, friendly	C1
intimately /ˈɪntɪmətli/ adverb IN-ti-mate-ly	in a very personal and direct way <i>Farmers are intimately affected by changes in rainfall and temperature.</i>	closely, personally, directly, deeply	C1
intimidating /ɪnˈtɪmɪdeɪtɪŋ/ adjective in-TIM-i-dat-ing	making you feel nervous or less confident <i>Speaking English in front of native speakers felt intimidating at first.</i>	daunting, frightening, overwhelming, off-putting	B2
intonation /ˌɪntəˈneɪʃn/ noun in-to-NA-tion	the rise and fall of the voice when speaking <i>Listening to podcasts has helped me improve my English intonation.</i>	pitch, inflection, tone, cadence	C1
intricate /ˈɪntrɪkət/ adjective IN-tri-cate	having many small parts or details arranged in a complicated way <i>The intricate designs on nakshi kantha quilts can take months to complete.</i>	elaborate, detailed, complex, ornate	C1
intrigued /ɪnˈtriːgd/ adjective in-TRIGUED	very interested in something and wanting to know more about it <i>I was intrigued by a documentary about life on remote islands.</i>	fascinated, curious, interested, captivated	C1
intriguing /ɪnˈtriːɡɪŋ/ adjective in-TRI-guing	very interesting because it is unusual or unexpected <i>The idea of cities without cars is intriguing, although hard to imagine in Dhaka.</i>	fascinating, captivating, compelling, interesting	C1
intrude /ɪnˈtruːd/ verb in-TRUDE	to enter or affect a situation where you are not wanted or welcome <i>I don't like work emails that intrude on my weekends with family.</i>	encroach, interfere, impose, invade	C2
intrusive /ɪnˈtruːsɪv/ adjective in-TRU-sive	getting too involved in someone's private life in an annoying way <i>Some relatives ask intrusive questions about your salary and marriage plans.</i>	prying, nosy, invasive, meddlesome	C1

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intuitive /ɪn'tjuːtɪv/ adjective in-TU-i-tive	based on feelings and instinct rather than on facts or careful thought <i>Good teachers have an intuitive sense of when a student is struggling.</i>	instinctive, innate, natural, instinctual	C1
invaluable /ɪn'væljuəbl/ adjective in-VAL-u-a-ble	extremely useful or helpful, more than can be measured <i>My part-time job at university gave me invaluable experience of dealing with customers.</i>	priceless, indispensable, precious, extremely useful	C1
invasive /ɪn'veɪsɪv/ adjective in-VA-sive	involving unwanted and excessive interference in someone's private life <i>Some apps collect an invasive amount of personal data from their users.</i>	intrusive, prying, nosy, meddlesome	C1
investment vehicle /ɪn'vestmənt ,viːəkl/ collocation	something that people buy mainly to make money from, such as property or shares <i>Many wealthy families treat flats in Dhaka as an investment vehicle rather than a home.</i>	asset, investment, money-maker, financial instrument	C2
invigorating /ɪn'vɪɡəreɪtɪŋ/ adjective in-VIG-or-at-ing	making you feel full of energy and enthusiasm <i>An early morning walk by the river in winter is wonderfully invigorating.</i>	energising, refreshing, revitalising, stimulating	C1
invisibly /ɪn'vɪzəbli/ adverb in-VIS-i-bly	in a way that cannot be seen or noticed <i>Many apps collect our location data invisibly, in the background.</i>	unseen, unnoticed, imperceptibly, behind the scenes	C1
inviting /ɪn'vaɪtɪŋ/ adjective in-VIT-ing	attractive and pleasant, making you want to go there or try it <i>The smell of fresh bread made the little bakery look very inviting.</i>	appealing, attractive, welcoming, tempting	C1
involuntary /ɪn'vɒləntri/ adjective in-VOL-un-tar-y	happening without your choice or against your wishes <i>Involuntary unemployment can seriously damage a person's confidence.</i>	unwilling, forced, unchosen, compulsory	C1
irreplaceable /ˌɪrɪ'pleɪsəbl/ adjective ir-re-PLACE-a-ble	too special or valuable to be replaced by anything else <i>Old family photos are irreplaceable, so I keep copies of them online.</i>	unique, priceless, precious, invaluable	C1
irreversible /ˌɪrɪ'vɜːsəbl/ adjective ir-re-VERS-i-ble	impossible to change back to how it was before <i>Cutting down ancient forests can cause irreversible damage to wildlife.</i>	permanent, irreparable, lasting, irrevocable	C1
irritable /'ɪrɪtəbl/ adjective IR-ri-ta-ble	easily annoyed or made angry <i>I get a bit irritable if I skip lunch on a busy workday.</i>	bad-tempered, short-tempered, grumpy, touchy	C1
isolated /'aɪsəleɪtɪd/ adjective I-so-lat-ed	feeling lonely and cut off from other people <i>Many elderly people feel isolated when their children move to big cities.</i>	lonely, cut off, alone, withdrawn	B2
isolating /'aɪsəleɪtɪŋ/ adjective I-so-lat-ing	making you feel alone and separated from other people <i>Moving to a new city without knowing anyone can be very isolating.</i>	lonely, alienating, solitary, cut off	C1

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jeopardise /'dʒepədəɪz/ verb JEOP·ard·ise as used: jeopardising	to put something at risk of being harmed, lost or destroyed <i>Cheating in exams could jeopardise a student's whole academic career.</i>	endanger, threaten, put at risk, imperil	C2
jittery /'dʒɪtəri/ adjective JIT·ter·y	nervous and anxious, often in a way that makes you unable to relax <i>I always feel jittery on the morning of a big presentation.</i>	nervous, jumpy, edgy, on edge	C2
job displacement /'dʒɒb dɪs,pleɪsmənt/ collocation	the loss of jobs because work is taken over by machines or other changes <i>Governments should offer retraining to people affected by job displacement from automation.</i>	job losses, redundancy, unemployment	C1
job insecurity /'dʒɒb ɪnsɪ,kjʊərəti/ collocation	the worry that you might lose your job or not have regular work <i>Short contracts create job insecurity, which makes it hard for young people to plan ahead.</i>	employment uncertainty, precarious work, job instability	C1
job-ready /,dʒɒb 'redi/ adjective job--READ·y	having the practical skills and experience needed to start working straight away <i>Internships help graduates become job-ready before they finish university.</i>	employable, work-ready, qualified, prepared	C1
joyful /'dʒɔɪfl/ adjective JOY·ful	very happy, or causing people to feel very happy <i>My sister's wedding was a joyful occasion that brought the whole family together.</i>	happy, cheerful, delightful, merry	B2
joyous /'dʒɔɪəs/ adjective JOY·ous	full of happiness and celebration <i>Pohela Boishakh is a joyous festival, with music, colourful clothes and street fairs.</i>	festive, jubilant, joyful, exuberant	C1
jubilant /'dʒu:bɪlənt/ adjective JU·bi·lant	extremely happy and excited because of a success <i>Jubilant fans poured into the streets after Bangladesh won the cricket match.</i>	elated, triumphant, overjoyed, exultant	C2
juggle /'dʒʌɡl/ verb JUG·gle as used: juggling	to try to deal with several activities or responsibilities at the same time <i>Many working parents struggle to juggle their careers and childcare.</i>	balance, manage, handle, multitask	C1
jump at the chance /,dʒʌmp ət ðə 'tʃɑːns/ idiom	to accept an opportunity eagerly and immediately <i>If I were offered a scholarship abroad, I would jump at the chance.</i>	seize the opportunity, leap at the chance, grab the chance	C1
jump in /,dʒʌmp 'ɪn/ phrasal verb	to interrupt or start speaking or acting quickly without waiting <i>In meetings, I try not to jump in before others have finished their point.</i>	interrupt, butt in, chip in, cut in	B2
jump to conclusions /,dʒʌmp tə kən'kluːʒnz/ idiom as used: jumping to conclusions	to decide something too quickly before you know all the facts <i>It's easy to jump to conclusions about people based on a single social media post.</i>	rush to judgement, assume, presume, prejudice	B2
keep a close eye on /,ki:p ə 'kləʊs 'aɪ ɒn/ idiom as used: keep a close eye	to watch or check something carefully and regularly <i>Parents should keep a close eye on what apps their children are using.</i>	monitor, watch closely, keep tabs on, keep track of	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
keep a friendship alive /ki:p ə 'frendʃɪp ə'laɪv/ collocation	to stay in regular contact so that a friendship continues and does not fade <i>Now that my best friend works in Chittagong, we keep our friendship alive with long phone calls every weekend.</i>	stay in touch, maintain a friendship, keep in contact	B2
keep a level head /ki:p ə ,levl 'hed/ idiom	to stay calm and think clearly in a difficult or stressful situation <i>Good leaders manage to keep a level head even when everything around them seems to be going wrong.</i>	stay calm, keep your cool, stay composed	C1
keep a straight face /ki:p ə ,streɪt 'feɪs/ idiom as used: kept a straight face	to manage not to laugh or smile even though something is funny <i>My sister told the joke so seriously that I could hardly keep a straight face.</i>	stop yourself laughing, stay serious, hold back a smile	C1
keep someone going /ki:p səmʊwən 'gəʊɪŋ/ phrase as used: going	to give someone the energy or motivation to continue with something difficult <i>A strong cup of tea in the morning is what keeps me going on busy workdays.</i>	keep someone motivated, sustain, spur on	B2
keep the mind sharp /ki:p ðə 'maɪnd ʃɑ:p/ collocation as used: keeps the mind sharp	to help your brain stay active, alert and able to think quickly <i>My grandfather does a crossword every morning because he believes it keeps the mind sharp.</i>	keep mentally alert, stimulate the brain, exercise the mind	B2
keep your roots alive /ki:p jɔ: 'ru:ts ə'laɪv/ idiom as used: keep our roots alive	to maintain a connection with the culture, traditions and place your family comes from <i>Speaking Bengali at home is one simple way that families living abroad keep their roots alive.</i>	preserve your heritage, stay connected to your origins, honour your traditions	C1
laborious /lə'bu:riəs/ adjective la·BO·ri·ous	needing a lot of slow, careful effort and time <i>Filling in visa forms by hand used to be a laborious task, but most of it is online now.</i>	painstaking, arduous, tedious, time-consuming	C1
laden with /'leɪdn wɪð/ phrase	heavily loaded or filled with a lot of something <i>During Eid the shops are laden with colourful clothes, sweets and gifts for every member of the family.</i>	loaded with, piled with, weighed down with, full of	C1
laid-back /,leɪd 'bæk/ adjective laid·BACK	relaxed and calm, without hurry or worry <i>Life in my home town is much more laid-back than the constant rush of Dhaka.</i>	relaxed, easy-going, unhurried, leisurely	B2
landscaped /'lændskeɪpt/ adjective LAND·scaped	designed and planted in an attractive way, with lawns, trees and paths <i>The new hospital has landscaped gardens where patients and visitors can sit and enjoy some fresh air.</i>	designed, laid out, planted, cultivated	C1
lasting impact /,lɑ:stɪŋ 'ɪmpækt/ collocation	an effect that continues for a long time <i>A single inspiring teacher can have a lasting impact on the way a child sees the world.</i>	long-term effect, enduring influence, permanent mark	B2
lasting impression /,lɑ:stɪŋ ɪm'preʃn/ collocation	a strong memory or feeling that someone or something leaves with you for a long time <i>The kindness of the villagers made a lasting impression on me during my first visit to the Sundarbans.</i>	lasting memory, deep impression, strong impact	B2
lateral /'lætərəl/ adjective LAT·er·al	creative and unusual, approaching a problem in a new and indirect way <i>Some interview questions are designed to test lateral thinking rather than simple knowledge.</i>	creative, inventive, unconventional, imaginative	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
lavish /'lævɪʃ/ adjective LAV-ish	very expensive, large or generous, often more than is necessary <i>Some families spend a fortune on lavish weddings with hundreds of guests and several days of celebrations.</i>	extravagant, luxurious, opulent, sumptuous	C1
lay the foundation /leɪ ʔə faʊn'deɪʃn/ idiom as used: lays the foundation	to create the basic conditions from which something else can develop <i>A good primary education lays the foundation for success in later studies and work.</i>	lay the groundwork, pave the way, set the stage	C1
lead by example /li:d baɪ ɪg'zɑ:mpl/ idiom as used: leads by example	to show others how to behave by doing it yourself <i>A manager who wants punctual staff should lead by example and arrive on time every day.</i>	set an example, be a role model, practise what you preach	B2
lead by example /li:d baɪ ɪg'zɑ:mpl/ idiom as used: led by example	to guide a group by behaving in the way you want others to behave <i>The captain led by example, training harder than anyone else on the team.</i>	set an example, be a role model, practise what you preach	B2
learnable /'lɜ:nəbl/ adjective LEARN-a-ble	able to be learnt or developed through practice and effort <i>Public speaking can feel impossible at first, but it is a learnable skill like any other.</i>	teachable, acquirable, masterable	C1
learning by doing /lɜ:nɪŋ baɪ 'du:ɪŋ/ phrase	learning a skill through practical experience rather than by reading or being told <i>Internships are valuable because they allow students to gain confidence through learning by doing.</i>	hands-on learning, learning through experience, trial and error, practical learning	B2
learning curve /lɜ:nɪŋ kɜ:v/ collocation	the period of time and effort needed to learn something new and difficult <i>Starting my first job involved a steep learning curve, but I picked things up within a few months.</i>	adjustment period, initiation, process of learning	C1
legitimate /lɪ'dʒɪtɪmət/ adjective le-GIT-i-mate	reasonable, acceptable and deserving to be taken seriously <i>Gaming is now recognised by many as a legitimate career, not just a hobby for teenagers.</i>	valid, genuine, justifiable, reasonable	C1
leisurely /'leɪʒəli/ adjective LEI-sure-ly	slow, relaxed and without hurry <i>On Friday mornings we enjoy a leisurely breakfast together before going to the mosque.</i>	unhurried, relaxed, gentle, easy	C1
less fortunate /les 'fɔ:tʃənət/ phrase	having less money, fewer opportunities or worse living conditions than others <i>Many students volunteer to teach reading to children who are less fortunate than themselves.</i>	underprivileged, disadvantaged, needy, poor	B2
lesser-known /lɜ:sə 'nəʊn/ adjective less-er-KNOWN	not as famous or popular as others of the same kind <i>I prefer visiting lesser-known villages because they feel more authentic and far less crowded.</i>	little-known, obscure, off the beaten track, less famous	C1
let down /let 'daʊn/ adjective	disappointed because someone or something did not do what you expected <i>Many fans felt let down when the match was cancelled at the last minute without explanation.</i>	disappointed, disillusioned, dissatisfied	B2
level the playing field /levl ʔə 'pleɪɪŋ fi:ld/ idiom as used: levels the playing field	to create a fair situation in which everyone has the same chances <i>Free online courses help level the playing field for students who cannot afford private tuition.</i>	create equal opportunities, make things fair, even the odds	C1

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level-headed /ˌleɪl ˈhedɪd/ adjective lev·el-HEAD·ed	calm, sensible and able to make good decisions, even in difficult situations <i>My elder sister is the most level-headed person in our family, so we always ask her advice.</i>	sensible, calm, composed, rational	C1
leverage /ˈli:vərɪdʒ/ noun LEV·er·age	the power or influence to make things happen or change <i>Large companies have enormous leverage over suppliers because they buy in such huge quantities.</i>	influence, power, clout, sway	C1
liability /ˌlaɪəˈbɪləti/ noun li·a·BIL·i·ty	a person or thing that causes problems or puts you at a disadvantage <i>A careless player can become a liability to the whole team, however talented he is.</i>	burden, drawback, disadvantage, hindrance	C1
liberated /ˈlɪbəreɪtɪd/ adjective LIB·er·at·ed	feeling free from pressure, rules or worries that had been controlling you <i>After finishing my final exams, I felt completely liberated and spent a week just reading for fun.</i>	free, released, unburdened, relieved	C1
liberating /ˈlɪbəreɪtɪŋ/ adjective LIB·er·at·ing	making you feel free and relieved from pressure or worries <i>Deleting social media apps from my phone for a month was surprisingly liberating.</i>	freeing, refreshing, empowering, releasing	C1
liberty /ˈlɪbəti/ noun LIB·er·ty as used: liberties	a basic right or freedom that people should have, such as free speech <i>Citizens must be careful not to give up important liberties in exchange for a feeling of safety.</i>	freedom, right, civil right	C1
lifeline /ˈlaɪflaɪn/ noun LIFE·line	something that helps you stay connected or supported and that you greatly depend on <i>For elderly people living alone, a weekly phone call from family can be a real lifeline.</i>	support, link, connection, saviour	C1
lifelong loyalty /ˌlaɪflɒŋ ˈlɔɪəlti/ collocation	staying faithful to one employer, brand or person for your whole life <i>My father's generation often showed lifelong loyalty to a single company, which is rare today.</i>	long-term commitment, lasting devotion, enduring allegiance	C1
lifelong pursuit /ˌlaɪflɒŋ pəˈsju:t/ collocation	an activity or goal that someone continues working on for their whole life <i>For my grandfather, reading was a lifelong pursuit that kept him curious well into his eighties.</i>	lifetime passion, ongoing endeavour, lifelong quest	C1
lifesaver /ˈlaɪfseɪvə(r)/ noun LIFE·sav·er	something that helps you a lot in a difficult situation <i>A portable charger was a real lifesaver when my phone died during a long train journey.</i>	godsend, saviour, blessing, boon	B2
lift people out of poverty /lɪft ˈpi:pl əʊt əv ˈpɒvəti/ collocation as used: lifted many from poverty	to improve people's economic situation so that they are no longer poor <i>The garment industry has lifted many families out of poverty by providing steady jobs for women.</i>	raise living standards, alleviate poverty, improve livelihoods	C1
lift somebody's spirits /lɪft ˌsʌmbədɪz ˈspɪrɪts/ idiom as used: lifts my spirits	to make someone feel happier and more hopeful <i>A cup of tea on the balcony during the monsoon rain always lifts my spirits.</i>	cheer somebody up, raise somebody's spirits, brighten somebody's day	B2

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lingua franca /ˌlɪŋɡwə ˈfræŋkə/ noun	a language used for communication between people who speak different first languages <i>At international conferences, English usually serves as the lingua franca among participants.</i>	common language, shared language, world language, global language	C2
linguistic diversity /lɪŋˌɡwɪstɪk daɪˈvɜːsəti/ collocation	the existence of many different languages in a region or in the world <i>Schools can protect linguistic diversity by teaching children in their mother tongue as well as English.</i>	variety of languages, multilingualism, language variety	C1
live on /ˌlɪv ˈɒn/ phrasal verb as used: lives on	to continue to exist or be remembered after a long time <i>My grandmother's recipes live on because my mother still cooks them for every family gathering.</i>	endure, survive, carry on, persist	C1
live up to the hype /lɪv ʌp tə ðə ˈhaɪp/ idiom as used: lived up to the hype	to be as good as people had said or advertised <i>The new café was so popular online, but honestly the food did not live up to the hype.</i>	meet expectations, be as good as expected, deliver	C1
liveability /ˌlɪvəˈbɪləti/ noun live·a·BIL·i·ty	how pleasant, safe and comfortable a place is to live in <i>Green spaces, clean air and reliable transport all add to the liveability of a city.</i>	quality of life, habitability, comfort	C2
liveable /ˈlɪvəbl/ adjective LIVE·a·ble	pleasant and comfortable enough to live in <i>Better public transport and more parks would make Dhaka a far more liveable city.</i>	habitable, pleasant, comfortable, agreeable	C1
livelihood /ˈlaɪvliːhʊd/ noun LIVE·li·hood as used: livelihoods	the way someone earns the money they need to live <i>Many fishermen along the Jamuna depend on the river for their livelihood.</i>	income, living, means of support, source of income	C1
living standards /ˈlɪvɪŋ ˌstændərdz/ collocation	the level of money, comfort and quality of life that people have <i>Living standards in rural areas have risen as roads, electricity and mobile networks have improved.</i>	standard of living, quality of life, prosperity	B2
lobby against /ˈlɒbi əˌɡenst/ phrasal verb	to try to persuade politicians or officials not to support a law or change <i>Tobacco companies have often lobbied against stricter advertising rules.</i>	campaign against, press against, oppose	C1
logical thinking /ˌlɒdʒɪkl ˈθɪŋkɪŋ/ collocation	the ability to reason clearly and reach sensible conclusions step by step <i>Chess is a wonderful game for children because it develops patience and logical thinking.</i>	reasoning, analytical thinking, rational thought, critical thinking	B2
long-held assumption /ˌlɒŋ held əˈsʌmpʃn/ collocation as used: long-held assumptions	a belief that people have accepted as true for a long time without questioning it <i>Remote work challenged the long-held assumption that employees must be in the office to be productive.</i>	established belief, deep-rooted idea, conventional wisdom	C1
longevity /lɒnˈdʒevəti/ noun lon·GEV·i·ty	how long a person lives; long life <i>Some researchers link a simple diet and daily walking to the longevity of people in certain villages.</i>	lifespan, long life, length of life, durability	C1
look back on /ˌlʊk ˈbæk ɒn/ phrasal verb as used: looking back on	to think about something that happened in the past <i>Looking back on my university years, I realise how much I grew as a person.</i>	reflect on, remember, recall, reminisce about	B2

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loosen the grip /ˈluːsn ðə ˈɡrɪp/ <i>idiom</i> as used: loosen the phone's grip	to reduce the strong control or hold that something has over you <i>Turning off notifications is a small step that can loosen the grip social media has on your attention.</i>	reduce the hold, weaken the control, break free from	C1
lose track of time /luːz ˌtræk əv ˈtaɪm/ <i>idiom</i>	to be so busy or interested in something that you forget what time it is <i>When I'm chatting with my grandfather about the old days, I completely lose track of time.</i>	forget the time, be absorbed, be engrossed	B2
lose your temper /luːz ɹɔː ˈtempə(r)/ <i>idiom</i> as used: lose my temper	to suddenly become very angry and show it <i>My father rarely loses his temper, even when customers were rude to him in his shop.</i>	get angry, blow up, fly off the handle	B2
lost in translation /ˌlɒst ɪn trænzˈleɪʃn/ <i>idiom</i>	not fully understood because meaning or feeling disappears when put into another language <i>Some Bengali poems sound beautiful in the original, but much of their charm gets lost in translation.</i>	misunderstood, lost, missed	C1
low-maintenance /ˌləʊ ˈmeɪntənəns/ <i>adjective</i> low-MAIN-te-nance	needing very little care, time or effort to keep in good condition <i>Cacti are ideal for busy people because they are low-maintenance and rarely need watering.</i>	easy to care for, undemanding, hassle-free	C1
lower-income /ˌləʊər ˈɪŋkʌm/ <i>adjective</i> low-er-IN-come	earning less money than average <i>Scholarships give talented students from lower-income families the chance to study at good universities.</i>	low-paid, poorer, less affluent, disadvantaged	C1
lucrative /ˈluːkrətɪv/ <i>adjective</i> LU-cra-tive	making a lot of money; very profitable <i>Some graduates choose lucrative jobs in banking even if they would rather work in education.</i>	profitable, well-paid, high-paying, rewarding	C1
lurk /lɜːk/ <i>verb</i> LURK as used: lurking	to stay quietly in the background, especially as a worry or threat that does not go away <i>Even on holiday, the thought of my unfinished work kept lurking at the back of my mind.</i>	linger, hover, hide, persist	C1
lush /lʌʃ/ <i>adjective</i> LUSH	covered in thick, healthy green plants and grass <i>After the monsoon, the fields around my grandparents' village turn a lush, vivid green.</i>	verdant, green, leafy, luxuriant	C1
luxurious /lʌgˈzʊəriəs/ <i>adjective</i> lux-U-ri-ous	very comfortable, elegant and expensive <i>The hotel room was so luxurious that I hardly wanted to leave it to go sightseeing.</i>	lavish, opulent, plush, sumptuous	B2
luxury /ˈlʌkʃəri/ <i>noun</i> LUX-u-ry	something pleasant but not essential, which people enjoy only occasionally <i>With such a busy job, a free afternoon with a good book feels like a real luxury.</i>	indulgence, treat, extravagance, privilege	B2
magnetic /mæɡˈnetɪk/ <i>adjective</i> mag-NET-ic	very attractive, with a strong power to draw people towards it <i>Some speakers have a magnetic personality that makes everyone in the room want to listen.</i>	captivating, charismatic, alluring, irresistible	C1
magnificent /mæɡˈnɪfɪsnt/ <i>adjective</i> mag-NIF-i-cent	extremely beautiful, grand and impressive to look at <i>The sunset over the Jamuna river is truly magnificent on a clear evening.</i>	splendid, spectacular, breathtaking, stunning	B2

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mainstream /'meɪnstri:m/ adjective MAIN-stream	accepted, used or liked by most people; normal and widespread <i>Online learning has moved from a niche option to a mainstream choice for many students.</i>	conventional, widespread, popular, established	C1
make great strides /meɪk ˌɡreɪt 'straɪdz/ idiom as used: made great strides	to make a lot of progress or improvement <i>Bangladesh has made great strides in girls' education over the past few decades.</i>	make progress, advance, improve significantly	C1
make peace with /meɪk 'pi:s wɪð/ idiom as used: made peace with	to accept a difficult situation calmly and stop feeling upset about it <i>It took me years to make peace with the fact that I would never be a professional cricketer.</i>	come to terms with, accept, be reconciled to	C1
make the best of /meɪk ðə 'best əv/ idiom	to accept a bad situation and try to get as much good from it as possible <i>When the rain ruined our picnic, we made the best of it by playing cards under a shelter.</i>	make the most of, cope with, look on the bright side	B2
make up for /ˌmeɪk 'ʌp fə(r)/ phrasal verb	to do something good to balance a loss or lack of something <i>I try to make up for my busy weekdays by spending every Friday with my family.</i>	compensate for, offset, balance out, atone for	B2
makeshift /'meɪkʃɪft/ adjective MAKE-shift	made quickly from whatever is available, to be used temporarily <i>After the flood, volunteers set up a makeshift school in a community hall.</i>	improvised, temporary, rough-and-ready, stopgap	C1
malice /'mæls/ noun MAL-ice	the wish to hurt or upset someone deliberately <i>I am sure my colleague forgot the meeting by mistake rather than out of malice.</i>	ill will, spite, hostility, bad intentions	C1
malicious /mə'ɪʃəs/ adjective mə-LI-cious	intended to hurt or upset someone <i>Spreading malicious rumours online can seriously damage a person's reputation and mental wellbeing.</i>	spiteful, hurtful, cruel, nasty	C1
malign /mə'laɪn/ adjective mə-LIGN	harmful or evil in nature or effect <i>Some people see social media as a malign influence on teenagers, but I think it depends on how it is used.</i>	harmful, damaging, evil, destructive	C2
manageable /'mænɪdʒəbl/ adjective MAN-age-a-ble	small or easy enough to be dealt with successfully <i>Revising for one hour a day made the huge syllabus feel far more manageable.</i>	achievable, doable, controllable, reasonable	B2
manufactured /ˌmænjʊ'fæktʃəd/ adjective man-u-FAC-tured	created artificially, for example by advertising, rather than natural or genuine <i>Much of the excitement around new phones is manufactured by clever marketing campaigns.</i>	artificial, fabricated, invented, contrived	C1
marginalise /'mɑ:dʒɪnəlaɪz/ verb MAR-gin-al-ise as used: marginalised	to treat a person, group or idea as unimportant and push them to the edge of society <i>Rural communities are often marginalised when big decisions about development are made in the capital.</i>	sideline, exclude, push aside, disregard	C1
marker of success /ˌmɑ:kər əv sək'ses/ collocation as used: markers of success	a sign or symbol that shows a person or thing has done well <i>In my parents' generation, owning land was one of the clearest markers of success.</i>	sign of success, indicator of achievement, status symbol	C1

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master /'mɑ:stə(r)/ verb MAS·ter	to learn how to do something very well <i>It took me almost a year to master driving through busy Dhaka traffic confidently.</i>	perfect, become skilled at, get the hang of	B2
mastery /'mɑ:stəri/ noun MAS·ter·y	great skill or knowledge in a particular subject or activity <i>Her mastery of the sitar came from practising for hours every day since childhood.</i>	expertise, command, proficiency, skill	C1
materialism /mə'tɪəriəlizəm/ noun ma·TE·ri·al·ism	the belief that money and possessions are the most important things in life <i>Constant advertising encourages materialism, making people feel they need the latest gadgets to be happy.</i>	consumerism, acquisitiveness, greed	C1
materialistic /mə,tɪəriə'lɪstɪk/ adjective ma·te·ri·al·IS·tic	caring too much about money and possessions <i>I worry that children growing up surrounded by adverts may become more materialistic than we were.</i>	acquisitive, money-oriented, consumerist, greedy	C1
maturely /mə'tʃʊəli/ adverb ma·TURE·ly	in a sensible and calm way, like a responsible adult <i>When my younger sister failed her driving test, she handled the disappointment very maturely.</i>	sensibly, responsibly, wisely, calmly	C1
maximise /'mæksɪmaɪz/ verb MAX·i·mise as used: maximising	to make something as large or great as possible <i>Many companies focus on maximising profit rather than caring for their workers.</i>	increase, boost, optimise, make the most of	C1
mean the world to somebody /ˌmi:n ðə 'wɜ:ld tə ˌsʌmbədi/ idiom as used: meant the world to me	to be extremely important or precious to someone <i>My grandmother's handwritten letter meant the world to me when I was studying far from home.</i>	mean everything to, be very precious to, be deeply valued by	B2
meaningful /'mi:nɪŋfl/ adjective MEAN·ing·ful	important and valuable in a personal or emotional way <i>Volunteering at a local school gave my weekends a more meaningful purpose.</i>	significant, worthwhile, valuable, special	B2
meaningfully /'mi:nɪŋfəli/ adverb MEAN·ing·ful·ly	in a way that is serious, valuable or deeply felt <i>Families should switch off their phones at dinner so they can talk to each other meaningfully.</i>	deeply, significantly, purposefully, sincerely	C1
mediator /'mi:diətə(r)/ noun ME·di·a·tor	a person who tries to help two sides in a disagreement reach an agreement <i>When my cousins argued about the land, my father acted as a mediator to settle things peacefully.</i>	go-between, peacemaker, arbitrator, intermediary	C1
meditative /'medɪtətɪv/ adjective MED·i·ta·tive	calm and peaceful, helping your mind to relax and focus <i>Walking slowly along the riverbank early in the morning has a meditative effect on me.</i>	contemplative, calming, reflective, soothing	C1
medium /'mi:diəm/ noun ME·di·um	a way of communicating or presenting something, such as television, radio or the internet <i>Podcasts have become a popular medium for learning about history and current affairs.</i>	means, channel, format, platform	C1
melancholy /'melənkəli/ adjective MEL·an·chol·y	feeling or causing a gentle, thoughtful sadness <i>Old photographs of my childhood home always leave me feeling slightly melancholy.</i>	sad, wistful, sorrowful, mournful	C2

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melt away /ˌmelt əˈweɪ/ <i>phrasal verb</i> as used: melted away	to gradually become weaker and then disappear completely <i>As soon as I saw my family waiting at the airport, all my tiredness melted away.</i>	disappear, vanish, fade away, evaporate	C1
memento /məˈmentəʊ/ <i>noun</i> me·MEN·to	a small object that you keep to remind you of a person, place or event <i>I kept the ticket from my first cricket match at the stadium as a memento.</i>	souvenir, keepsake, reminder, token	C1
memorabilia /ˌmemərəˈbɪliə/ <i>noun</i> mem·o·ra·BIL·i·a	objects that people collect because they are linked to a famous person, event or sport <i>My uncle's shop sells old film posters and other cinema memorabilia from the 1970s.</i>	collectibles, souvenirs, mementoes, keepsakes	C1
mental note /ˌmentl ˈnəʊt/ <i>collocation</i>	something you decide to remember without writing it down <i>I made a mental note to call my grandfather as soon as I got home from work.</i>	reminder, note to self, mental reminder	B2
mental shortcut /ˌmentl ˈʃɔːtkʌt/ <i>collocation</i> as used: mental shortcuts	a quick, simple way of thinking that helps you decide fast but can lead to mistakes <i>We often rely on mental shortcuts when shopping, such as assuming that expensive products are better quality.</i>	rule of thumb, heuristic, snap judgement	C1
mere ambition /ˌmɪər æmˈbɪʃn/ <i>collocation</i>	only the desire to succeed, without other qualities such as skill or honesty <i>Mere ambition is not enough to run a business; you also need patience and good judgement.</i>	simple ambition, ambition alone, just drive	C1
merit /ˈmerɪt/ <i>noun</i> MER·it	a good quality or value that deserves praise or attention <i>There is some merit in taking a gap year before university, especially if you work or travel.</i>	value, worth, benefit, virtue	C1
mesmerised /ˈmezməraɪzd/ <i>adjective</i> MES·mer·ised	so interested or amazed by something that you cannot look away <i>The children were mesmerised by the fireworks lighting up the sky on New Year's Eve.</i>	spellbound, captivated, entranced, enthralled	C1
mesmerising /ˈmezməraɪzɪŋ/ <i>adjective</i> MES·mer·is·ing	so beautiful or interesting that you cannot stop watching or listening <i>The sound of rain on a tin roof can be strangely mesmerising at night.</i>	captivating, enchanting, hypnotic, spellbinding	C1
methodical /məˈθɒdɪkl/ <i>adjective</i> me·THOD·i·cal	done in a careful, organised way, following a clear plan <i>My younger sister has a very methodical approach to revision, with colour-coded notes for every subject.</i>	systematic, organised, orderly, structured	C1
micro-credential /ˈmaɪkrəʊ krəˌdenʃl/ <i>noun</i> MI·cro·cre·den·tial as used: micro-credentials	a short qualification that shows you have a specific skill or knowledge <i>Many professionals now earn micro-credentials online to update their skills without leaving their jobs.</i>	short certificate, digital badge, mini-qualification	C2
micromanage /ˈmaɪkrəʊmænɪdʒ/ <i>verb</i> MI·cro·man·age as used: micromanaged	to control every small detail of someone's work instead of trusting them <i>Nobody enjoys being micromanaged, as it suggests the boss has no faith in their abilities.</i>	over-supervise, control excessively, breathe down someone's neck	C1
micromanage /ˈmaɪkrəʊmænɪdʒ/ <i>verb</i> MI·cro·man·age as used: micromanaging	to closely watch and control every small part of what others do at work <i>A good team leader gives clear goals and avoids micromanaging every task.</i>	over-supervise, control excessively, breathe down someone's neck	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
migratory /'maɪgrətri/ adjective MI-gra-to-ry	travelling regularly from one region to another, usually with the seasons <i>Every winter, migratory birds arrive at the wetlands of northern Bangladesh from as far away as Siberia.</i>	travelling, seasonal, wandering, nomadic	C1
milestone /'maɪlstəʊn/ noun MILE-stone	a very important event or stage in someone's life or progress <i>Graduating from university was a major milestone for me and my whole family.</i>	landmark, turning point, achievement, watershed	B2
milestone /'maɪlstəʊn/ noun MILE-stone as used: milestones	a small goal or stage used to measure progress towards a bigger aim <i>Breaking my savings plan into monthly milestones made the target feel much less daunting.</i>	stage, checkpoint, target, step	B2
mimic /'mɪmɪk/ verb MIM-ic	to copy the way someone or something behaves, speaks or looks <i>Parrots can mimic human speech, but they do not understand what the words mean.</i>	imitate, copy, replicate, simulate	C1
mindful /'maɪndfʊl/ adjective MIND-ful	paying calm, careful attention to what you are doing and feeling in the present moment <i>Being mindful while eating helps me enjoy my food more and stop before I overeat.</i>	aware, attentive, conscious, present	C1
mindfully /'maɪndfəli/ adverb MIND-ful-ly	in a careful, aware way, paying attention to what you are doing and why <i>If we shopped more mindfully, we would buy fewer things and waste much less.</i>	consciously, thoughtfully, attentively, deliberately	C1
mindless /'maɪndləs/ adjective MIND-less	done without thinking or needing any mental effort <i>After a long day at work, I sometimes watch mindless comedy shows just to switch off.</i>	unthinking, thoughtless, brainless, automatic	C1
mindless scrolling /,maɪndləs 'skrəʊlɪŋ/ collocation	moving through social media or websites on a phone without really paying attention or purpose <i>I try to replace mindless scrolling before bed with reading a few pages of a novel.</i>	aimless browsing, doomscrolling, passive scrolling	C1
mindset /'maɪndset/ noun MIND-set	a person's general attitude and way of thinking <i>Having a positive mindset helped me stay calm while preparing for my job interview.</i>	attitude, outlook, mentality, frame of mind	B2
mingle /'mɪŋɡl/ verb MIN-gle	to move around and talk to different people at a social event <i>At the wedding reception, I tried to mingle with guests I had never met before.</i>	socialise, mix, circulate, interact	C1
minimalism /'mɪnɪməlɪzəm/ noun MIN-i-mal-ism	a way of living with only the things you really need <i>Since moving into a smaller flat, I have started to appreciate minimalism and owning fewer things.</i>	simplicity, simple living, frugality, austerity	C1
minimise your impact /'mɪnɪmaɪz ʤɔːr 'ɪmpækt/ collocation as used: minimise their impact	to reduce the harmful effect you have on something, such as the environment <i>Tourists can minimise their impact by using refillable water bottles and avoiding plastic bags.</i>	reduce your footprint, lessen the harm, limit the damage	C1
miraculous /mɪ'rækjələs/ adjective mi-RAC-u-lous	very surprising and wonderful, almost impossible to believe <i>The patient made a miraculous recovery that surprised even the most experienced doctors.</i>	extraordinary, amazing, astonishing, incredible	C1

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mischaracterisation /ˌmɪs,kærəktəraɪ'zeɪʃn/ noun mis·char·ac·ter·i·SA·tion	an inaccurate or unfair description of someone or something <i>Calling young people lazy is a mischaracterisation, since many of them work and study at the same time.</i>	misrepresentation, distortion, misportrayal	C2
miscommunication /ˌmɪskə,mjuːnɪ'keɪʃn/ noun mis·com·mu·ni·CA·tion	a failure to share information or ideas clearly, leading to misunderstanding <i>A simple miscommunication about the date meant half the guests arrived a day early.</i>	misunderstanding, mix-up, confusion, crossed wires	C1
misdeed /ˌmɪs'diːd/ noun mis·DEED as used: misdeeds	a wrong, dishonest or illegal action <i>Journalists play an important role in exposing the misdeeds of powerful people.</i>	wrongdoing, misconduct, offence, transgression	C2
miserable /'mɪzrəbl/ adjective MIS·er·a·ble	feeling very unhappy, uncomfortable or low in spirits <i>I felt miserable for days after catching a heavy cold during the rainy season.</i>	unhappy, wretched, down, gloomy	B2
misery /'mɪzəri/ noun MIS·er·y	a state of great unhappiness, discomfort or suffering <i>Long hours in a job you hate can bring years of misery, whatever the salary.</i>	suffering, unhappiness, distress, wretchedness	B2
misguided /ˌmɪs'gaɪdɪd/ adjective mis·GUID·ed	based on wrong ideas or poor judgement <i>It is misguided to think that a university degree guarantees a good job.</i>	mistaken, wrong, ill-judged, foolish	C1
misinterpret /ˌmɪsn'tɜːprɪt/ verb mis·in·TER·pret	to understand the meaning of something wrongly or differently from what was intended <i>Short text messages are easy to misinterpret, so I prefer to call when something is important.</i>	misunderstand, misread, misconstrue, get wrong	C1
mislead /ˌmɪs'liːd/ verb mis·LEAD as used: misled	to make someone believe something that is not true <i>Some adverts mislead customers by making products look far healthier than they really are.</i>	deceive, misinform, fool, delude	C1
mismatch /'mɪsmætʃ/ noun MIS·match	a situation in which two things do not fit or suit each other <i>There is often a mismatch between what universities teach and what employers actually need.</i>	gap, discrepancy, disparity, incompatibility	C1
misrepresent yourself /ˌmɪs,reprɪ'zent ʃɔː'self/ collocation as used: misrepresent themselves	to give a false idea of who you are or what you are like <i>Some job applicants misrepresent themselves on their CVs by exaggerating their experience.</i>	lie about yourself, pretend, give a false impression	C1
missed opportunity /ˌmɪst ˌɒpə'tjuːnəti/ collocation	a chance to do something useful that was not taken <i>Not learning to swim as a child was a missed opportunity that I still regret.</i>	lost chance, wasted opportunity, missed chance	B2
mitigate /'mɪtɪgeɪt/ verb MIT·i·gate	to make something harmful or unpleasant less serious <i>Planting trees along the riverbanks can help mitigate the damage caused by floods.</i>	reduce, lessen, alleviate, ease	C1
mixed blessing /ˌmɪkst 'blesɪŋ/ idiom	something that has both advantages and disadvantages <i>Working from home is a mixed blessing; I save time travelling but miss my colleagues.</i>	double-edged sword, pros and cons, blessing and curse	C1

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mixed-use /ˌmɪkst 'ju:s/ adjective mixed-USE	combining homes, shops, offices and leisure spaces in the same area <i>Mixed-use developments allow people to live close to where they work and shop.</i>	multi-purpose, multifunctional, combined-use	C2
mobilise /'məʊbəlaɪz/ verb MO·bi·lise as used: mobilising	to organise people or resources to work together for a particular purpose <i>Students mobilised quickly to collect warm clothes for families affected by the cold winter.</i>	organise, rally, gather, marshal	C1
model /'mɒdl/ verb MOD·el as used: modelling	to show a behaviour through your own actions so that others learn to copy it <i>Teachers can encourage politeness by modelling it in the way they speak to students.</i>	demonstrate, show, exemplify, set an example of	C1
model integrity /ˌmɒdl ɪn'tegreɪti/ collocation	to show honesty and strong moral principles through your own behaviour so others copy it <i>Leaders who model integrity make it much easier for their employees to act honestly too.</i>	set an example, demonstrate honesty, lead by example	C1
moderation /ˌmɒdə'reɪʃn/ noun mod·er·A·tion	the quality of doing something within reasonable limits, not too much <i>Sweets are fine in moderation, but eating them every day is bad for your teeth.</i>	restraint, balance, self-control, temperance	C1
modernise /'mɒdənaɪz/ verb MOD·ern·ise as used: modernised	to change something so that it is suitable for present-day needs and methods <i>The railway station was modernised last year with digital ticket machines and better waiting rooms.</i>	update, renovate, upgrade, revamp	B2
modernity /mə'dʒ:nəti/ noun mo·DER·ni·ty	the condition of being modern, with new ideas, technology and ways of life <i>Dhaka is a city where ancient traditions and rapid modernity exist side by side.</i>	modern life, the modern age, contemporaneity	C2
modular /'mɒdjələ(r)/ adjective MOD·u·lar	made up of separate units or parts that can be taken or combined individually <i>The university offers a modular course, so students can choose units that match their interests.</i>	flexible, unit-based, component-based, segmented	C1
momentum /mə'mentəm/ noun mo·MEN·tum	the force or energy that keeps an idea or movement growing and developing <i>The campaign to ban plastic bags gained momentum after pictures of blocked drains went viral.</i>	impetus, drive, energy, force	C1
monotonous /mə'nɒtənəs/ adjective mo·NOT·o·nous	boring because it never changes <i>Data entry can be monotonous, so I listen to calm music to keep myself going.</i>	repetitive, tedious, dull, humdrum	C1
moral compass /ˌmɒrəl 'kʌmpəs/ idiom	a person's sense of what is right and wrong, which guides their behaviour <i>My grandmother never went to university, but she has the strongest moral compass of anyone I know.</i>	sense of right and wrong, conscience, principles, values	C1
moral constant /ˌmɒrəl 'kɒnstənt/ collocation as used: moral constants	a moral value or principle that stays the same in every culture and period <i>Honesty and kindness seem to be moral constants that almost every society respects.</i>	universal value, fixed principle, timeless value	C2
morale /mə'rɑ:l/ noun mo·RALE	the level of confidence and enthusiasm in a person or group <i>A few words of praise from the manager did wonders for the team's morale.</i>	spirits, confidence, motivation, team spirit	C1

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morally questionable /ˌmɒrəli ˈkwɛstʃənəbl/ collocation	possibly wrong or dishonest from an ethical point of view <i>Using children in adverts to sell unhealthy snacks is, in my view, morally questionable.</i>	ethically dubious, unethical, dubious, shady	C1
mortgage /ˈmɔːɡɪdʒ/ noun MORT·gage as used: mortgages	a loan from a bank that you use to buy a house or flat and pay back over many years <i>Young couples in big cities often need a mortgage because property prices are so high.</i>	home loan, housing loan, loan	B2
mortifying /ˈmɔːtɪfaɪɪŋ/ adjective MOR·ti·fy·ing	making you feel extremely embarrassed or ashamed <i>It was mortifying to realise I had been calling my new manager by the wrong name all week.</i>	humiliating, embarrassing, shameful, cringeworthy	C2
motivated /ˈməʊtɪveɪtɪd/ adjective MO·ti·vat·ed	keen and willing to work hard to achieve something <i>Students tend to be far more motivated when they can see how lessons connect to real life.</i>	driven, enthusiastic, keen, determined	B2
mounting pressure /ˌmaʊntɪŋ ˈpreʃə(r)/ collocation	pressure that is gradually increasing <i>There is mounting pressure on the government to improve road safety after several serious accidents.</i>	growing pressure, increasing pressure, rising pressure	C1
mouthwatering /ˈmaʊθwɔːtərɪŋ/ adjective MOUTH·wa·ter·ing	looking or smelling so good that you really want to eat it <i>The mouthwatering smell of fresh fish curry drifted from my aunt's kitchen as we arrived.</i>	appetising, delicious, tempting, tasty	C1
moved /muːvd/ adjective MOVED	having strong feelings of sadness or sympathy because of something you see or hear <i>I was deeply moved by the speech my father gave at my sister's wedding.</i>	touched, affected, stirred, emotional	B2
multi-pronged /ˌmʌlti ˈprɒŋd/ adjective mul·ti·PRONGED	using several different methods at the same time to deal with a problem <i>Reducing traffic in Dhaka will need a multi-pronged strategy, including better buses, cycle lanes and flexible work hours.</i>	multifaceted, many-sided, comprehensive, wide-ranging	C2
multifaceted /ˌmʌltiˈfæstɪd/ adjective mul·ti·FAC·et·ed	having many different parts or aspects <i>Climate change is a multifaceted problem that affects health, farming, housing and the economy.</i>	complex, many-sided, varied, diverse	C2
mundane /mʌnˈdeɪn/ adjective mun·DANE	ordinary and not interesting or exciting <i>Listening to podcasts makes mundane chores like washing up and ironing much more bearable.</i>	ordinary, everyday, routine, humdrum	C1
mushroom /ˈmʌʃrʊm/ verb MUSH·room as used: mushroomed	to grow or increase in number very quickly <i>Coaching centres have mushroomed across Bangladesh as parents compete to get their children into top schools.</i>	boom, proliferate, multiply, spring up	C1
mutual understanding /ˌmjuːtʃuəl ˌʌndəˈstændɪŋ/ collocation	a situation in which two or more people understand and respect each other's views and feelings <i>Student exchange programmes promote mutual understanding between young people from different countries.</i>	shared understanding, mutual respect, rapport	C1
mutually beneficial /ˌmjuːtʃuəli ˌbenɪˈfɪʃl/ collocation	helpful or useful to both people or groups involved <i>Partnerships between universities and local businesses can be mutually beneficial.</i>	win-win, advantageous to both, reciprocal	C1

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mutually reinforcing /ˌmjuːtʃuəli ˌriːɪnˈfɔːsɪŋ/ collocation	supporting and strengthening each other <i>Good sleep and regular exercise are mutually reinforcing habits, as each makes the other easier.</i>	complementary, mutually supportive, synergistic	C2
nail-biting /ˈneɪl baɪtɪŋ/ adjective NAIL·bit·ing	extremely exciting and tense because you do not know what will happen <i>The election results were announced late at night after a nail-biting count.</i>	tense, thrilling, suspenseful, gripping	C1
narrow nationalism /ˌnærəʊ ˈnæʃnəlaɪzəm/ collocation	a limited, inward-looking pride in your own country that ignores the interests of others <i>Global problems like pandemics cannot be solved if countries retreat into narrow nationalism.</i>	insularity, chauvinism, jingoism, isolationism	C2
natural heritage /ˌnætʃrəl ˈherɪtɪdʒ/ collocation	the natural features of a country, such as forests, rivers and wildlife, valued and passed on to future generations <i>The Sundarbans mangrove forest is a vital part of Bangladesh's natural heritage.</i>	natural environment, natural resources, wildlife and landscapes	C1
navigate /ˈnævɪgeɪt/ verb NAV·i·gate	to find the right way to deal with a difficult or complicated situation <i>Older people often need help to navigate online banking and government websites.</i>	handle, manage, deal with, find your way through	C1
negativity /ˌnegəˈtɪvəti/ noun neg·a·TIV·i·ty	a gloomy, critical attitude that focuses on bad things rather than good ones <i>I try to avoid spending too much time online because of the negativity in many comment sections.</i>	pessimism, cynicism, gloom, defeatism	C1
neglect /nɪˈgлект/ verb ne·GLECT	to fail to give enough care or attention to something <i>Many students neglect their sleep during exam season, which only makes their performance worse.</i>	ignore, overlook, disregard, pay no attention to	C1
neglect /nɪˈgлект/ verb ne·GLECT as used: neglects	to not give something the attention or care it needs <i>Modern schooling often neglects practical life skills such as cooking and managing money.</i>	overlook, ignore, disregard, fail to attend to	C1
neglected /nɪˈgлектɪd/ adjective ne·GLECT·ed	not given enough attention or care <i>Creative subjects like art and music are often neglected in schools that focus on exam results.</i>	overlooked, ignored, disregarded, undervalued	C1
nerve-racking /ˈnɜːv rækɪŋ/ adjective NERVE·rack·ing	making you feel very nervous and worried <i>Giving my first presentation in English was a nerve-racking experience, but it went better than expected.</i>	stressful, nail-biting, tense, daunting	C1
net effect /ˌnet ɪˈfekt/ collocation	the final overall result after all the positive and negative effects are considered <i>The net effect of the new motorway has been shorter journeys, though some villages have lost farmland.</i>	overall effect, end result, overall outcome, bottom line	C1
neutral /ˈnjuːtrəl/ adjective NEU·tral	neither good nor bad in itself; depending on how it is used <i>Money is neutral; it can do great harm or great good depending on the person who has it.</i>	impartial, value-free, neither good nor bad	B2
neutral third party /ˌnjuːtrəl ˈθɜːd ˈpɑːti/ collocation	a person who is not involved in a disagreement and does not support either side <i>Divorcing couples sometimes find it easier to agree when a neutral third party leads the discussion.</i>	impartial outsider, mediator, independent arbitrator	C1

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niche /niːʃ/ adjective NICHE	interesting to or used by only a small number of people <i>Rock climbing is still a niche sport in Bangladesh, although a few clubs have opened in Dhaka.</i>	specialist, specialised, minority, unusual	C1
nobody else's business /ˌnəʊbədi ˌelsɪz ˈbɪznəs/ idiom	private and not something other people have a right to know about or be involved in <i>How much I earn is nobody else's business, so I never discuss my salary with colleagues.</i>	private matter, none of their concern, personal affair	B2
non-material /ˌnɒn məˈtɪəriəl/ adjective non·ma·TE·ri·al	not related to money or physical possessions <i>Friendship, health and peace of mind are non-material things that contribute greatly to happiness.</i>	intangible, spiritual, emotional, non-physical	C1
non-negotiable /ˌnɒn niˈɡəʊʃiəbl/ adjective non·ne·GO·ti·a·ble	so important that it cannot be changed or given up <i>For me, eight hours of sleep before an important exam is non-negotiable.</i>	essential, fixed, mandatory, must-have	C1
normalise /ˈnɔːməlaɪz/ verb NOR·mal·ise	to make something seem ordinary and acceptable <i>Celebrities who talk openly about stress help normalise asking for support.</i>	make acceptable, destigmatise, make ordinary, legitimise	C1
nostalgia /nɒˈstældʒə/ noun nos·TAL·gia	a happy but slightly sad feeling when you think about the past <i>The smell of rain on dry soil fills me with nostalgia for my childhood in the village.</i>	longing, wistfulness, sentimentality, reminiscence	C1
nostalgic /nɒˈstældʒɪk/ adjective nos·TAL·gic	making you remember happy times in the past with a slightly sad feeling <i>Old Bengali songs from the seventies always make my father feel nostalgic.</i>	sentimental, wistful, reminiscent, longing	C1
nourish /ˈnʌrɪʃ/ verb NOUR·ish	to support and help something grow or become stronger, not only physically <i>Spending time in nature seems to nourish my mind in a way that screens never do.</i>	nurture, feed, sustain, strengthen	C1
nourish /ˈnʌrɪʃ/ verb NOUR·ish as used: nourishing	to feed and strengthen a part of your life or personality so that it can grow <i>Reading fiction is a way of nourishing the imagination, especially for young children.</i>	nurture, feed, sustain, enrich	C1
nourish the soul /ˈnʌrɪʃ ðə ˈsəʊl/ idiom	to give you deep emotional or spiritual satisfaction and happiness <i>Listening to classical music on a quiet evening really seems to nourish the soul.</i>	feed the spirit, uplift, enrich your life	C1
nuance /ˈnjuːɑːns/ noun NU·ance	a small but important difference or qualification in meaning or opinion <i>I agree with most of the argument, but there is one nuance I would like to add.</i>	subtlety, fine distinction, shade of meaning, qualification	C1
nuanced /ˈnjuːɑːnst/ adjective NU·anced	showing an understanding of small but important differences; not simple <i>Good journalism gives a nuanced picture of events instead of dividing people into heroes and villains.</i>	subtle, complex, sophisticated, balanced	C1
nuclear /ˈnjuːkliə(r)/ adjective NU·cle·ar	describing a family of just parents and their children living together <i>In cities, most people now live in nuclear families rather than with grandparents and cousins.</i>	immediate, small, two-generation	B2

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nurture /'nɜ:tʃə(r)/ noun NUR·ture	the care, upbringing and environment that shape how a person develops <i>Personality is influenced by both nature and nurture, so parents play an important role.</i>	upbringing, care, rearing, environment	C1
nurture /'nɜ:tʃə(r)/ verb NUR·ture as used: nurtured	to help a quality, skill or talent develop and grow <i>My primary school teacher nurtured my love of reading by lending me books from her own shelf.</i>	foster, develop, encourage, cultivate	C1
nurture /'nɜ:tʃə(r)/ verb NUR·ture as used: nurtures	to encourage and support the development of a quality or ability <i>A good workplace nurtures talent by giving young employees real responsibility.</i>	foster, cultivate, develop, encourage	C1
nurture /'nɜ:tʃə(r)/ verb NUR·ture as used: nurturing	to take care of something and help it grow <i>My mother spends hours nurturing the plants on our balcony, and they reward her with flowers.</i>	tend, care for, look after, cultivate	C1
obesity /əʊ'bi:səti/ noun o·BE·si·ty	the condition of being extremely overweight in a way that is unhealthy <i>Less outdoor play and more sugary snacks may be contributing to childhood obesity in cities.</i>	excess weight, overweight, corpulence	B2
obligation /ˌɒblɪ'geɪʃn/ noun ob·li·GA·tion	a duty to do something because it is morally or legally right <i>Many young people in Bangladesh feel an obligation to support their parents financially.</i>	duty, responsibility, commitment, sense of duty	B2
observational /ˌɒbzə'veɪʃənəl/ adjective ob·ser·VA·tion·al	based on noticing and commenting on ordinary things in everyday life <i>The comedian's observational jokes about family weddings had the whole audience laughing.</i>	everyday, perceptive, situational	C1
observer /əb'zɜ:və(r)/ noun ob·SERV·er	a person who notices things carefully <i>Writers tend to be keen observers of people, noticing small habits that others ignore.</i>	watcher, noticer, onlooker, spectator	C1
obsession /əb'seɪʃn/ noun ob·SES·sion	something that you think about or do all the time, often too much <i>Cricket is a national obsession in Bangladesh, and the streets empty during big matches.</i>	passion, fixation, preoccupation, craze	C1
obsessive /əb'sesɪv/ adjective ob·SES·sive	thinking about something too much, in a way that is difficult to control <i>My friend is obsessive about keeping his desk tidy and gets upset if anything is moved.</i>	fixated, compulsive, fanatical, preoccupied	C1
obsolete /'ɒbsəli:t/ adjective OB·so·lete	no longer used or needed because something newer and better exists <i>Many older skills, like typing on a typewriter, have become almost obsolete.</i>	outdated, out of date, outmoded, redundant	C1
occasionally /ə'keɪʒnəli/ adverb oc·CA·sion·al·ly	sometimes, but not often or regularly <i>I occasionally treat myself to a meal at a nice restaurant after a particularly busy week.</i>	sometimes, now and then, from time to time, once in a while	B2
of modest means /əv ,mɒdɪst 'mi:nz/ phrase as used: modest means	having only a small amount of money; not rich <i>My parents were of modest means, but they always made sure we had books to read.</i>	of limited means, not well-off, of humble circumstances	C1

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on a whim /ɒn ə 'wɪm/ idiom	suddenly, because you feel like it, without planning <i>We decided on a whim to take the night bus to Cox's Bazar and watch the sunrise.</i>	impulsively, spontaneously, on impulse	C1
on balance /ɒn 'bæləns/ phrase	after considering all the facts and arguments on both sides <i>On balance, I think living in a small town suits me better than living in a big city.</i>	all things considered, overall, taking everything into account	C1
on demand /ɒn dɪ'mɑːnd/ phrase	available whenever someone wants or asks for it <i>Many universities now offer recorded lectures on demand, so students can learn at their own pace.</i>	whenever wanted, at any time, instantly	B2
on multiple fronts /ɒn ,mʌltɪpl 'frʌnts/ phrase	in several different areas or ways at the same time <i>Improving public health requires action on multiple fronts, from diet to clean water.</i>	in several ways, across the board, on many levels	C1
on the go /ɒn ðə 'gəʊ/ idiom	while moving around or doing other things; very busy <i>Busy commuters often have breakfast on the go, eating a snack in a rickshaw or bus.</i>	on the move, while travelling, in a hurry	B2
on the same page /ɒn ðə ,seɪm 'peɪdʒ/ idiom	sharing the same understanding or agreeing about what to do <i>Before planning the trip, my friends and I made sure we were all on the same page about the budget.</i>	in agreement, of one mind, in accord	B2
on your own schedule /ɒn jɔːr ,əʊn 'fedʒuːl/ phrase	at times that you choose yourself, without depending on others <i>Online courses let working people study on their own schedule, often late in the evening.</i>	at your own pace, when it suits you, at your convenience	B2
once-in-a-lifetime /wʌns ɪn ə 'laɪftaɪm/ adjective once-in-a-LIFE-time	very special and unlikely to happen to you again <i>Watching the World Cup final live in the stadium would be a once-in-a-lifetime experience.</i>	unique, unrepeatable, exceptional, one-off	B2
ongoing public funding /ɒŋgəʊɪŋ ,pʌblɪk 'fʌndɪŋ/ collocation as used: ongoing public funds	money from the government that is provided continuously over a long period <i>Museums and public libraries usually depend on ongoing public funding to keep their doors open.</i>	continuous state support, regular government money, sustained funding	C1
open doors /ɒpən 'dɔːz/ idiom	to create new opportunities for someone <i>Speaking good English can open doors to international jobs and scholarships.</i>	create opportunities, open up possibilities, pave the way	B2
open-minded /ɒpən 'maɪndɪd/ adjective o-pen-MIND-ed	willing to listen to and consider new or different ideas and opinions <i>Travelling abroad made me more open-minded about other cultures and ways of life.</i>	receptive, tolerant, broad-minded, unprejudiced	B2
oppression /ə'preʃn/ noun op-PRES-sion	cruel and unfair treatment of people, especially by limiting their freedom <i>The 1952 Language Movement was a stand against cultural oppression.</i>	tyranny, persecution, subjugation, injustice	C1
oppressive /ə'presɪv/ adjective op-PRES-sive	uncomfortably hot and heavy, making you feel tired and uneasy <i>The air before a monsoon storm can feel oppressive, and then the rain finally brings relief.</i>	stifling, suffocating, muggy, sweltering	C1
optimistic /ɒptɪ'mɪstɪk/ adjective op-ti-MIS-tic	hopeful and confident that things will turn out well <i>I'm fairly optimistic that I'll get a scholarship if I keep improving my IELTS score.</i>	hopeful, positive, confident, upbeat	B2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
optimistically /ˌɒptɪˈmɪstɪkli/ adverb op-ti-MIS-ti-cal-ly	looking at the situation in the most hopeful way <i>Optimistically, the new bridge should cut our travel time to Dhaka by at least an hour.</i>	hopefully, positively, in the best case, confidently	C1
ordeal /ɔːˈdiːl/ noun or-DEAL	a very unpleasant, difficult or tiring experience <i>Getting a new passport used to be a real ordeal, with long queues and endless forms.</i>	nightmare, trial, hardship, struggle	C1
original /əˈrɪdʒənəl/ adjective o-RIG-i-nal	new, creative and different from anything done before <i>The judges praised her short film for its original story and unusual camera work.</i>	creative, innovative, inventive, fresh	B2
ornate /ɔːˈneɪt/ adjective or-NATE	decorated with a lot of complicated and detailed patterns <i>The old zamindar houses near Sirajganj have ornate balconies and carved wooden doors.</i>	elaborate, decorative, fancy, embellished	C1
out of necessity /ˌaʊt əv nəˈsesəti/ phrase	because it is necessary, not because you want to <i>Many people learnt to shop online out of necessity during the pandemic and have continued since.</i>	by necessity, because you have to, of necessity	C1
out of reach /ˌaʊt əv ˈriːtʃ/ idiom	too expensive or difficult for someone to get or achieve <i>For many young people, owning a flat in Dhaka is completely out of reach.</i>	unaffordable, unattainable, beyond your means	B2
out of sheer necessity /ˌaʊt əv ˌʃɪə nəˈsesəti/ phrase	only because something is completely necessary and there is no other choice <i>Out of sheer necessity, I learnt to cook when I moved away from home for university.</i>	purely by necessity, because there is no choice, of necessity	C1
out of sight /ˌaʊt əv ˈsaɪt/ idiom	not seen or noticed by others, and so easily forgotten <i>Remote workers sometimes worry that being out of sight will mean being overlooked for promotion.</i>	unnoticed, invisible, out of view	B2
outdated /ˌaʊtˈdeɪtɪd/ adjective out-DAT-ed	old-fashioned and no longer useful or suitable <i>Some schools still use outdated textbooks that do not reflect modern technology.</i>	old-fashioned, obsolete, out of date, dated	B2
outdated conventions /ˌaʊtdeɪtɪd kənˈvenʃnz/ collocation	old customs or rules of behaviour that no longer suit modern life <i>Young couples today often ignore outdated conventions about who should pay for dinner.</i>	old-fashioned customs, obsolete traditions, antiquated norms	C1
outgrow /ˌaʊtˈgrəʊ/ verb out-GROW as used: outgrew	to stop doing or liking something as you become older <i>Most children eventually outgrow their fear of the dark.</i>	grow out of, leave behind, move beyond	C1
outlet /ˈaʊtlet/ noun OUT-let	a way of expressing or releasing strong feelings or energy <i>Writing in a diary has always been a healthy outlet for my worries.</i>	release, channel, means of expression, vent	C1
outlet for stress /ˌaʊtlet fə ˈstres/ collocation	an activity that helps you release stress and feel calmer <i>Playing cricket with friends on Fridays is my main outlet for stress after a busy week.</i>	stress reliever, way to unwind, release valve	C1
outmanoeuvre /ˌaʊtməˈnuːvə(r)/ verb out-ma-NOEU-vre	to gain an advantage over someone by acting more cleverly or skilfully <i>Smaller companies can sometimes outmanoeuvre big rivals by responding faster to customers' needs.</i>	outwit, outsmart, outplay, get the better of	C2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
outpace /ˌaʊtˈpeɪs/ verb out·PACE as used: outpaced	to develop or grow faster than something else <i>Demand for university places has outpaced the number of seats available in public universities.</i>	outstrip, overtake, exceed, surpass	C1
outright /ˌaʊtˈraɪt/ adverb out·RIGHT	completely and immediately, not partly or gradually <i>Rather than banning mobile phones outright, schools could teach students to use them responsibly.</i>	completely, entirely, totally, altogether	C1
outsource /ˈaʊtsɔːs/ verb OUT·source as used: outsourced	to let someone or something else do a job for you instead of doing it yourself <i>Many busy families now outsource cooking and cleaning to paid helpers or delivery apps.</i>	delegate, contract out, hand over, farm out	C1
outweigh /ˌaʊtˈweɪ/ verb out·WEIGH	to be greater or more important than something else <i>For me, the benefits of studying abroad clearly outweigh the cost and the homesickness.</i>	exceed, override, surpass, count for more than	C1
overbearing /ˌəʊvəˈbeərɪŋ/ adjective o·ver·BEAR·ing	trying to control other people in an unpleasant way <i>An overbearing boss can make even a well-paid job feel unbearable.</i>	domineering, controlling, bossy, authoritarian	C1
overconfident /ˌəʊvəˈkɒnfɪdənt/ adjective o·ver·CON·fi·dent	too sure of your own abilities, in a way that leads to mistakes <i>Overconfident drivers often take risks on the highway that cause serious accidents.</i>	cocky, complacent, arrogant, presumptuous	C1
overcrowding /ˌəʊvəˈkraʊdɪŋ/ noun o·ver·CROWD·ing	a situation where too many people are in one place <i>Overcrowding on trains during Eid holidays makes the journey home exhausting.</i>	congestion, crowding, overpopulation, cramming	B2
overemphasis /ˌəʊvəˈemfəˌsɪs/ noun o·ver·EM·pha·sis	giving too much importance or attention to something <i>An overemphasis on exam results can leave students with little time for creativity.</i>	overstatement, excessive focus, undue attention	C1
overhaul /ˈəʊvəhɔːl/ noun O·ver·haul	a complete examination and change of a system in order to improve it <i>The public transport network in Dhaka needs a complete overhaul, not just a few new buses.</i>	revamp, reform, restructuring, shake-up	C1
overindulge /ˌəʊvərɪnˈdʌldʒ/ verb o·ver·in·DULGE as used: overindulging	to have too much of something enjoyable, especially food or drink <i>It's easy to overindulge on sweets during Eid, when every house you visit offers you something.</i>	overeat, overdo it, binge, go overboard	C1
overjoyed /ˌəʊvəˈdʒɔɪd/ adjective o·ver·JOYED	extremely happy and pleased about something that has happened <i>My parents were overjoyed when my younger sister got into a top medical college.</i>	delighted, thrilled, ecstatic, elated	B2
overlook /ˌəʊvəˈlʊk/ verb o·ver·LOOK as used: overlooked	to fail to notice or give proper attention or recognition to someone or something <i>Talented employees are sometimes overlooked for promotion simply because they are quiet.</i>	ignore, neglect, pass over, disregard	C1
overlook /ˌəʊvəˈlʊk/ verb o·ver·LOOK as used: overlooking	to fail to notice or give proper credit to someone or something <i>Employers often overlook older candidates who bring years of practical experience to the job.</i>	ignore, disregard, neglect, miss	B2

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overreach /ˌəʊvəˈri:tʃ/ noun o·ver·REACH	the use of more power or authority than is proper or allowed <i>Many citizens worry about government overreach when new surveillance laws are introduced without public debate.</i>	abuse of power, excess, overstepping	C2
overreliance /ˌəʊvərɪˈlaɪəns/ noun o·ver·re·LI·ance	the state of depending too much on one particular thing <i>An overreliance on smartphones can weaken our ability to remember simple things like phone numbers.</i>	overdependence, excessive dependence, overuse	C1
override /ˌəʊvəˈraɪd/ verb o·ver·RIDE as used: overrides	to become more important than everything else, pushing other concerns aside <i>For many parents, concern for their children's safety overrides every other consideration when choosing a home.</i>	outweigh, take precedence over, supersede, trump	C1
overshadow /ˌəʊvəˈʃædəʊ/ verb o·ver·SHA·dow	to make something seem less important by being more noticeable or successful <i>His brilliant exam results were somewhat overshadowed by his sister's scholarship to a university abroad.</i>	eclipse, outshine, dwarf, dominate	C1
overshadow /ˌəʊvəˈʃædəʊ/ verb o·ver·SHA·dow as used: overshadows	to receive so much attention that something else seems less important <i>In many countries one popular sport tends to overshadow others, leaving them with little funding or media attention.</i>	eclipse, outshine, dwarf, dominate	C1
oversimplification /ˌəʊvəˌsɪmplɪfɪˈkeɪʃn/ noun o·ver·sim·pli·fi·CA·tion	a description that makes something seem simpler than it really is, ignoring important details <i>Saying that young people are simply lazy is an oversimplification of a complex economic situation.</i>	simplification, generalisation, reductionism	C1
oversimplify /ˌəʊvəˌsɪmplɪfaɪ/ verb o·ver·SIM·pli·fy as used: oversimplified	to describe something as simpler than it really is, leaving out important facts <i>News reports often oversimplify climate science, which leaves viewers confused about what is actually happening.</i>	simplify too much, gloss over, generalise, reduce	C1
overspend /ˌəʊvəˈspend/ verb o·ver·SPEND	to spend more money than you intended or can afford <i>I always make a shopping list before going to the market so that I don't overspend.</i>	splurge, spend beyond your means, overindulge	B2
overstate /ˌəʊvəˈstet/ verb o·ver·STATE as used: overstated	to describe something as more important or serious than it really is <i>The benefits of social media for teenagers are sometimes overstated by the companies that run these platforms.</i>	exaggerate, overemphasise, inflate, blow out of proportion	C1
oversupply /ˈəʊvəsəplaɪ/ noun O·ver·sup·ply	a situation where there is more of something than is needed <i>An oversupply of new flats in the city has actually made rents slightly more affordable for young workers.</i>	surplus, glut, excess	C1
overthink /ˌəʊvəˈθɪŋk/ verb o·ver·THINK	to think about something too much, in a way that causes worry or delay <i>I tend to overthink small decisions, like what to say in an email to a new client.</i>	overanalyse, dwell on, agonise over, worry excessively	B2
overwhelm /ˌəʊvəˈwelɪn/ verb o·ver·WHELM	to be so strong or powerful that something else is defeated or swamped <i>Fast food chains can overwhelm small family restaurants that have served local dishes for generations.</i>	swamp, overpower, engulf, crush	C1
overwhelmed /ˌəʊvəˈwelmd/ adjective o·ver·WHELMED	feeling that you have too much to deal with and cannot cope <i>During exam season, many students feel overwhelmed by the amount of material they have to revise.</i>	swamped, snowed under, stressed, overloaded	B2

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overwhelming /ˌəʊvəˈwelmɪŋ/ adjective o·ver·WHELM·ing	so great or difficult that it is hard to deal with <i>Moving to a new city alone can be overwhelming at first, but it usually gets easier with time.</i>	daunting, crushing, overpowering, too much to handle	B2
overwhelmingly /ˌəʊvəˈwelmɪŋli/ adverb o·ver·WHELM·ing·ly	in most respects or to a very great degree <i>Public opinion was overwhelmingly in favour of building a new bridge across the river.</i>	predominantly, largely, mainly, by and large	C1
overwork /ˌəʊvəˈwɜ:k/ noun o·ver·WORK	the act of working too hard or for too many hours <i>Chronic overwork can damage both your health and your relationships with the people you love.</i>	burnout, overexertion, excessive work	C1
ownership /ˈəʊnəʃɪp/ noun OWN·er·ship	a sense of personal responsibility for a task and its results <i>When students take ownership of their learning, they tend to stay motivated for much longer.</i>	responsibility, accountability, control	C1
packed to the rafters /ˌpækt tə ðə ˈrɑ:ftəz/ idiom	extremely full of people, with no space left <i>The wedding hall was packed to the rafters, with relatives arriving from every corner of the country.</i>	jam-packed, crammed, full to bursting, overflowing	C2
panic /ˈpænɪk/ noun PAN·ic	a sudden strong feeling of fear that stops you thinking clearly <i>I felt a moment of panic when I realised I had left my passport at home.</i>	alarm, fear, dread, anxiety	B2
panoramic /ˌpænəˈræmɪk/ adjective pan·o·RAM·ic	showing or giving a wide view of a large area <i>From the top of the hill you get a panoramic view of the river winding through the countryside.</i>	sweeping, wide, all-round, expansive	C1
paradox /ˈpærədɒks/ noun PAR·a·dox	a situation that seems strange because it combines two opposite features <i>It's a paradox that we have more ways to communicate than ever, yet many people feel lonelier.</i>	contradiction, puzzle, irony, anomaly	C1
paradoxically /ˌpærəˈdɒksɪkli/ adverb par·a·DOX·i·cal·ly	in a way that seems surprising because it is the opposite of what you would expect <i>Paradoxically, having too much free time can make people less productive than having a busy schedule.</i>	ironically, surprisingly, contrary to expectations	C1
paralysed /ˈpærəlaɪzd/ adjective PAR·a·lysed	so affected by a feeling that you are unable to act or decide <i>Some graduates are so paralysed by the fear of choosing the wrong career that they delay applying for jobs.</i>	frozen, immobilised, crippled, stuck	C1
paralysing /ˈpærəlaɪzɪŋ/ adjective PAR·a·lys·ing	making someone unable to act or make decisions <i>For a nervous speaker, the fear of forgetting their words can be absolutely paralysing.</i>	crippling, debilitating, immobilising, overwhelming	C1
paramount /ˈpærəmaʊnt/ adjective PAR·a·mount	more important than anything else <i>When choosing a school for their children, most parents consider safety and good teaching paramount.</i>	supreme, of utmost importance, overriding, crucial	C1
parental controls /pəˈrentl kənˈtrəʊlz/ collocation	settings on devices or apps that let parents limit what children can see or do <i>My elder sister uses parental controls on her tablet so her son only watches cartoons suitable for his age.</i>	content filters, child safety settings, screen time restrictions	B2
passive /ˈpæsɪv/ adjective PAS·sive	accepting or receiving things without taking an active part <i>Watching television is quite a passive activity compared with playing a sport or learning an instrument.</i>	inactive, inert, uninvolved	B2

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pastime /'pɑːstaɪm/ noun PAS·time	an activity that you do regularly for enjoyment in your free time <i>Flying kites on rooftops is a popular pastime for children in Bangladesh during the spring.</i>	hobby, leisure activity, recreation, diversion	B2
pastime /'pɑːstaɪm/ noun PAS·time as used: pastimes	activities that people do regularly for enjoyment in their free time <i>Board games and card games were common pastimes in rural areas long before smartphones arrived.</i>	hobby, leisure activity, recreation, diversion	B2
patch of land /ˌpætʃ əv 'lænd/ collocation	a small area of ground, often used for growing things <i>My grandfather grows chillies and aubergines on a small patch of land behind the village house.</i>	plot, allotment, piece of ground, strip of land	B2
paternalistic /pəˈtɜːnəlɪstɪk/ adjective pə·ter·nal·IS·tic	controlling people supposedly for their own good and limiting their freedom to choose <i>Some people think banning sugary drinks is paternalistic, arguing that adults should decide what they consume.</i>	overprotective, controlling, nannying, patronising	C2
patience /'peɪjns/ noun PA·tience	the ability to stay calm and not get annoyed when something takes a long time <i>Teaching my grandmother to use a smartphone took a lot of patience, but she can now video call us.</i>	tolerance, forbearance, calmness, endurance	B2
patient /'peɪjnt/ adjective PA·tient	able to stay calm and understanding without getting annoyed <i>A good teacher needs to be patient with students who take longer to grasp new ideas.</i>	tolerant, understanding, forbearing, calm	B2
patriotism /'pætriətɪzəm/ noun PAT·ri·ot·ism	love for your country and a feeling of pride in it <i>On Victory Day you can feel a strong sense of patriotism as people wave flags and sing the national anthem.</i>	national pride, love of country, loyalty, nationalism	C1
peace of mind /ˌpiːs əv 'maɪnd/ idiom	a feeling of calm because you are not worried about anything <i>Having some savings in the bank gives me peace of mind in case something unexpected happens.</i>	reassurance, calm, security, serenity	B2
peaceful escape /ˌpiːsfl ɪ'skeɪp/ collocation	a calm place or activity that lets you get away from stress or noise <i>For me, a quiet walk along the river is a peaceful escape from the pressures of work.</i>	retreat, haven, refuge, sanctuary	B2
pedestrian area /pəˈdestriən 'eəriə/ collocation as used: pedestrian areas	parts of a town where cars are not allowed so people can walk freely <i>More pedestrian areas in the city centre would make shopping far more pleasant and much safer for families.</i>	pedestrian zone, car-free zone, walkway	B2
pedestrianise /pəˈdestriənəɪz/ verb pe·DES·tri·an·ise as used: pedestrianised	to close a street to traffic so that only people on foot can use it <i>If the council decided to pedestrianise the main market street, small shops would probably attract more customers.</i>	make car-free, close to traffic, ban cars from	C1
people-facing /'piːpl ˌfeɪsɪŋ/ adjective PEO·ple·fa·cing	involving direct contact and communication with other people as a main part of the work <i>My job is very people-facing, since I spend most of the day advising students and their parents.</i>	client-facing, customer-facing, public-facing	C1
perceptive /pə'septɪv/ adjective per·CEP·tive	quick to notice and understand things that others might not notice <i>My grandmother is remarkably perceptive and always knows when something is bothering me, even before I speak.</i>	observant, insightful, astute, sharp	C1

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perfectly reasonable /ˌpɜːfɪktli ˈriːznəbl/ collocation	completely fair, sensible and easy to justify <i>It's perfectly reasonable for young people to want some independence once they start earning.</i>	entirely sensible, completely fair, quite justified	B2
period of adjustment /ˌpɪəriəd əv əˈdʒʌstmənt/ collocation	a time during which people get used to a new situation <i>Most international students go through a period of adjustment before they feel at home in a new country.</i>	transition, settling-in period, adaptation phase	B2
permanence /ˈpɜːmənəns/ noun PER·ma·nence	the state of lasting for a very long time or for ever <i>Many people in my country value the permanence of owning land, since it can be passed down through generations.</i>	stability, durability, continuity, endurance	C1
permeate /ˈpɜːmiət/ verb PER·me·ate	to spread through every part of something <i>A positive attitude at work can permeate the whole office and make everyone more cooperative.</i>	pervade, spread through, fill, saturate	C2
perpetual /pəˈpetʃuəl/ adjective per·PET·u·al	never ending, or seeming to continue for ever <i>Living in a big city can feel like a perpetual race against traffic, deadlines and noise.</i>	constant, endless, never-ending, continual	C1
perpetually /pəˈpetʃuəli/ adverb per·PET·u·al·ly	all the time, or in a way that seems never to stop <i>My younger sister is perpetually busy with her studies, so we rarely get to watch a film together.</i>	constantly, continually, forever, always	C1
perpetuate /pəˈpetʃueɪt/ verb per·PET·u·ate	to make a bad situation or belief continue for a long time <i>Advertisements that show only very thin models can perpetuate unrealistic ideas about beauty.</i>	prolong, maintain, sustain, keep alive	C2
perseverance /ˌpɜːsɪˈvɛərəns/ noun per·se·VER·ance	continued effort to achieve something despite difficulties or slow progress <i>Learning a new language as an adult takes a great deal of perseverance, especially when progress feels slow.</i>	persistence, determination, tenacity, grit	C1
persevere /ˌpɜːsɪˈvɪə(r)/ verb per·se·VERE	to keep trying to do something even though it is difficult <i>If you persevere with daily practice, your speaking fluency will improve more than you might expect.</i>	persist, keep going, stick with it, carry on	C1
persevere /ˌpɜːsɪˈvɪə(r)/ verb per·se·VERE as used: persevered	to continue with an activity despite difficulty, rather than giving up <i>She failed her driving test twice but persevered and finally passed on her third attempt.</i>	persist, keep at it, stick with it, carry on	C1
persist /pəˈsɪst/ verb per·SIST	to continue to exist or happen over a long period <i>Although many people now shop online, the tradition of visiting local bazaars before Eid is likely to persist.</i>	endure, continue, last, carry on	C1
persistence /pəˈsɪstəns/ noun per·SIS·tence	the quality of continuing to try to achieve something despite difficulty <i>It took real persistence to get my first job, as I applied to dozens of companies before anyone replied.</i>	perseverance, determination, tenacity, doggedness	C1
persistent /pəˈsɪstənt/ adjective per·SIS·tent	continuing to exist for a long time and difficult to get rid of <i>Traffic congestion is a persistent problem in Dhaka, and it seems to get worse every year.</i>	ongoing, continuing, chronic, stubborn	C1
personal touch /ˌpɜːsənl ˈtʌtʃ/ collocation	a small detail that makes something feel friendly, individual and special <i>A handwritten note adds a personal touch to any gift, however small or inexpensive it is.</i>	individual touch, human element, special feature	B2

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personalised /'pɜːsənəlaɪzd/ adjective PER·son·al·ised	pecially chosen or made for a particular person <i>Online learning platforms can give students personalised feedback based on their individual strengths and weaknesses.</i>	individualised, tailored, customised, bespoke	B2
pervasive /pə'veɪsɪv/ adjective per·VA·sive	present everywhere and affecting many parts of life <i>Social media has become so pervasive that it's hard to find anyone under thirty without an account.</i>	widespread, ubiquitous, prevalent, omnipresent	C2
pessimistic /,pesɪ'mɪstɪk/ adjective pes·si·MIS·tic	expecting bad things to happen or believing the worst about something <i>Some older people are pessimistic about the future, but I think my generation has many reasons for hope.</i>	negative, gloomy, cynical, defeatist	B2
petrified /'petrɪfaɪd/ adjective PET·ri·fied	extremely frightened, often so much that you cannot move <i>I was petrified the first time I had to give a presentation in English in front of the whole class.</i>	terrified, scared stiff, horrified, frozen with fear	C1
phenomenal /fə'nɒmɪnl/ adjective phe·NOM·e·nal	extremely good, impressive or great in size <i>The growth of online learning over the last few years has been phenomenal, especially in developing countries.</i>	remarkable, extraordinary, outstanding, exceptional	C1
philanthropy /fɪ'læntərəpi/ noun phi·LAN·thro·py	the practice of giving money and help to people in need or to good causes <i>Philanthropy by wealthy business owners has funded many schools and hospitals in rural parts of the country.</i>	charity, benevolence, generosity, charitable giving	C2
phubbing /'flʌbɪŋ/ noun PHUB·bing	ignoring the people you are with by looking at your phone instead <i>Phubbing at the dinner table is one habit my family tries hard to avoid, so we keep our phones in another room.</i>	phone snubbing, ignoring others for your phone, being glued to your phone	C2
picturesque /,pɪktʃə'resk/ adjective pic·tur·ESQUE	pretty and attractive, especially in a natural or old-fashioned way <i>The tea gardens of Sylhet are incredibly picturesque, with neat green rows stretching across the rolling hills.</i>	scenic, charming, pretty, idyllic	C1
pile up /,paɪl 'ʌp/ phrasal verb as used: piling up	to increase in amount until it becomes difficult to deal with <i>If I don't reply to emails every day, they soon pile up and I feel completely behind.</i>	accumulate, mount up, build up, stack up	B2
pit against /,pɪt ə'ɡenst/ phrasal verb as used: pitting them against	to set two people or things in competition or opposition with each other <i>Pitting science against the arts in schools is pointless, since both develop valuable ways of thinking.</i>	set against, play off against, match against, oppose	C1
pivotal /'pɪvətl/ adjective PIV·o·tal	of great importance because other things depend on it <i>Finishing university was a pivotal moment in my life, as it gave me the confidence to start working.</i>	crucial, critical, decisive, key	C1
place excessive weight on /,pleɪs ɪk'sesɪv 'weɪt ɒn/ collocation as used: placed excessive weight on	to treat something as much more important than it really should be <i>Some employers place excessive weight on university grades and ignore practical skills learned outside the classroom.</i>	overemphasise, overvalue, put too much stress on	C1
playful /'pleɪfl/ adjective PLAY·ful	light-hearted and fond of having fun and joking <i>My nephew is so playful that he turns even brushing his teeth into a game.</i>	fun-loving, light-hearted, mischievous, jokey	B2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
playing field /'pleɪŋ fi:ld/ idiom	the conditions in which people compete, especially how fair or equal they are <i>Free online courses help create a more level playing field for students who cannot afford private tuition.</i>	competitive conditions, situation, arena	C1
pleasure /'pleʒə(r)/ noun PLEA·sure as used: pleasures	something that gives you a feeling of happiness or enjoyment <i>A hot cup of tea on a rainy afternoon is one of my favourite small pleasures.</i>	joy, delight, treat, comfort	B2
plunder /'plʌndə(r)/ verb PLUN·der as used: plundering	to take or use natural resources in a greedy and damaging way <i>Large companies should not be allowed to plunder forests for timber without replanting what they cut down.</i>	exploit, loot, pillage, strip	C2
pocket of calm /,pɒkɪt əv 'kɑ:m/ collocation	a short, quiet period or small peaceful place within a busy time <i>My morning cup of tea on the balcony is a pocket of calm before the chaos of the working day.</i>	moment of peace, oasis of calm, breathing space, haven	C1
pockets of time /,pɒkɪts əv 'taɪm/ collocation	small periods of free time available within a busy day <i>I use small pockets of time, like my bus journey to work, to listen to podcasts in English.</i>	spare moments, free moments, gaps in your day	C1
poignant /'pɔɪnjənt/ adjective POIG·nant	causing strong feelings of sadness, emotion or regret <i>Visiting my grandfather's old school was a poignant experience, as he told me stories of friends who had passed away.</i>	moving, touching, emotional, heart-rending	C1
polarised /'pəʊləraɪzd/ adjective PO·lar·ised	divided into two groups with completely opposite opinions <i>Debates about social issues online are often so polarised that people stop listening to each other entirely.</i>	divided, split, opposed, entrenched	C1
polished /'pɒlɪʃt/ adjective POL·ished	smart, elegant and carefully presented <i>Candidates with a polished appearance and confident manner tend to make a stronger first impression at interviews.</i>	smart, refined, well-groomed, professional	C1
political will /pə,lɪtɪkl 'wɪl/ collocation	the determination of politicians and governments to take action on something <i>Cleaning up our rivers is possible, but it requires real political will and long-term investment.</i>	government commitment, political determination, resolve	C1
pollination /,pɒlə'neɪʃn/ noun pɒ·li·NA·tion	the transfer of pollen between plants, usually by insects, so they can produce fruit or seeds <i>Without bees and other insects to carry out pollination, many fruit and vegetable crops would fail.</i>	fertilisation, cross-pollination	C1
portion size /'pɔ:ʃn saɪz/ collocation as used: portion sizes	the amount of food served to one person at a meal <i>Restaurants in the city have increased their portion sizes, which may be encouraging people to overeat.</i>	serving size, helping, serving	B2
pose a real threat /,pəʊz ə ,rɪəl 'θret/ collocation as used: poses a real threat	to be a genuine and serious danger to someone or something <i>Plastic waste in our rivers poses a real threat to fish and the families who depend on fishing.</i>	endanger, jeopardise, put at risk, be a serious danger	B2
possess /pə'zes/ verb pos·SESS	to have or own something, such as a quality, skill or knowledge <i>Good leaders possess the ability to listen carefully before making important decisions.</i>	have, hold, own, be endowed with	B2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
powerful hold /ˌpaʊəfl 'həʊld/ collocation	strong control or influence over someone's thoughts or behaviour <i>Cricket has a powerful hold on people in my country, and whole streets go quiet during important matches.</i>	strong influence, grip, sway, control	C1
powerlessness /ˌpaʊələsnəs/ noun POW-er-less-ness	the feeling of being unable to control or change a situation <i>Watching floods destroy villages on the news can create a sense of powerlessness among ordinary citizens.</i>	helplessness, impotence, vulnerability	C1
practical /ˈpræktɪkl/ adjective PRAC-ti-cal	suitable and useful for a particular purpose or situation <i>A small motorbike is more practical than a car in crowded towns, where parking is almost impossible.</i>	useful, functional, convenient, sensible	B2
pragmatism /ˈprægmətɪzəm/ noun PRAG-ma-tism	dealing with things in a sensible, realistic way rather than following ideals <i>Choosing a university often involves some pragmatism, such as considering job prospects as well as personal interests.</i>	realism, practicality, common sense, sensibleness	C2
precarious /prɪ'keəriəs/ adjective pre-CAR-i-ous	not safe or secure, and likely to go wrong <i>Many freelance workers live in a precarious financial situation, never knowing how much they will earn next month.</i>	risky, insecure, unstable, uncertain	C1
precariousness /prɪ'keəriəsnəs/ noun pre-CAR-i-ous-ness	the state of being uncertain, insecure and likely to change for the worse <i>The precariousness of short-term contracts makes it difficult for young workers to plan their futures.</i>	insecurity, instability, uncertainty	C2
precious /ˈpreʃəs/ adjective PRE-cious	very valuable and important to you, often for emotional reasons <i>Old family photos have become precious to me since my grandparents started getting older.</i>	treasured, cherished, valued, dear	B2
predetermined /ˌpri:di'tɜ:mɪnd/ adjective pre-de-TER-mined	decided or fixed in advance so that it cannot be changed <i>I don't believe a child's future is predetermined by their family background, although it certainly matters.</i>	fixed, preordained, set in advance, inevitable	C1
predominantly /prɪ'dɒmɪnəntli/ adverb pre-DOM-i-nant-ly	mostly, mainly or for the most part <i>My hometown is predominantly agricultural, although small factories have opened on the outskirts recently.</i>	mainly, mostly, largely, chiefly	C1
prefabricated /ˌpri:'fæbrɪkeɪtɪd/ adjective pre-FAB-ri-cat-ed	built from parts made in a factory and quickly put together on site <i>Prefabricated homes can be built in weeks, which could help families who lose their houses in floods.</i>	modular, factory-built, ready-made, prefab	C1
preferable /ˈprefrəbl/ adjective PREF-er-a-ble	better or more suitable than something else <i>For long journeys, I find the train preferable to the bus because I can read comfortably.</i>	better, more desirable, more suitable, superior	B2
premature death /ˌpremətʃə 'deθ/ collocation as used: premature deaths	death that happens much earlier than normal, often from a preventable cause <i>Smoking remains one of the leading causes of premature death, which is why many governments tax cigarettes heavily.</i>	early death, untimely death, preventable death	C1
premium /ˈpri:miəm/ noun PRE-mi-um	great value or importance given to something, as in placing a premium on it <i>Many companies now place a premium on teamwork and communication skills when hiring graduates.</i>	high value, importance, priority, emphasis	C1

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preserve /prɪ'zɜ:v/ verb pre-SERVE	to keep something safe and prevent it from being lost or damaged <i>It's important to preserve traditional crafts like pottery so younger generations can still learn them.</i>	protect, safeguard, maintain, conserve	B2
preserve /prɪ'zɜ:v/ verb pre-SERVE as used: preserving	to keep a memory or moment so that it is not forgotten <i>Writing a diary is a lovely way of preserving memories that might otherwise fade over the years.</i>	capture, record, keep, save	B2
pressing /'presɪŋ/ adjective PRESS-ing	needing to be dealt with immediately; urgent <i>With the application deadline only a week away, finishing my personal statement is my most pressing task.</i>	urgent, critical, crucial, high-priority	C1
pressing issue /,presɪŋ 'ɪʃu:/ collocation	a serious problem that needs attention immediately <i>Air pollution has become a pressing issue in Dhaka, affecting the health of millions of residents.</i>	urgent problem, burning issue, major concern	C1
prestige /pre'sti:ʒ/ noun pres-TIGE	respect and admiration given to something because of its success or high status <i>Some students choose a university for its prestige rather than for the quality of the course they want.</i>	status, standing, reputation, kudos	C1
prestigious /pre'stɪdʒəs/ adjective pres-TI-gious	respected and admired as being very important or of high quality <i>Getting a scholarship to a prestigious university abroad is the dream of many students I work with.</i>	renowned, esteemed, reputable, highly regarded	C1
prevalent /'prevələnt/ adjective PREV-a-lent	existing very commonly among a group of people or at a particular time <i>Online shopping has become increasingly prevalent in Bangladesh, even in smaller towns.</i>	widespread, common, pervasive, rife	C1
prevention /prɪ'venʃn/ noun pre-VEN-tion	action taken to stop something bad, such as crime, from happening <i>Crime prevention programmes for young people are often cheaper and more effective than building new prisons.</i>	deterrence, avoidance, forestalling	B2
preventive /prɪ'ventɪv/ adjective pre-VEN-tive	intended to stop something harmful before it happens <i>Regular health check-ups are a simple preventive measure that can catch problems early.</i>	preventative, precautionary, protective, pre-emptive	C1
price tag /'praɪs tæg/ noun	the cost of something, especially when it is high <i>Studying abroad comes with a hefty price tag, so many families take out loans to cover the fees.</i>	cost, price, expense, charge	B2
priceless /'praɪsləs/ adjective PRICE-less	so valuable, especially emotionally, that no price could be put on it <i>The letters my grandfather wrote to my grandmother are priceless to our whole family.</i>	invaluable, precious, irreplaceable, treasured	B2
primary culprit /,praɪməri 'kʌlpɪt/ collocation	the main cause of a problem or of something bad <i>Plastic bags are often seen as the primary culprit behind blocked drains during the monsoon.</i>	main cause, chief offender, root cause	C1
prioritise /praɪ'brətaɪz/ verb pri-OR-i-tise	to decide that something is more important than other things and deal with it first <i>During exam season, my sister has to prioritise revision over seeing her friends.</i>	put first, rank, give precedence to, focus on	B2
prioritise /praɪ'brətaɪz/ verb pri-OR-i-tise as used: prioritised	to treat something as more important and give it more attention or resources <i>I hope that cycle lanes will be prioritised in future city planning, as roads are getting more dangerous.</i>	favour, emphasise, give priority to, put first	B2

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prioritise /praɪ'ɒrətaɪz/ verb pri-OR-i-tise as used: prioritises	to put one thing before others because it is considered more important <i>A good manager prioritises the wellbeing of the team as well as the company's targets.</i>	put first, value above, emphasise, favour	B2
prioritise ruthlessly /praɪ,ɒrətaɪz 'ru:θləsli/ collocation as used: prioritising ruthlessly	to focus firmly on the most important tasks and drop less important ones <i>When you have too many deadlines at once, you have to prioritise ruthlessly and ignore anything non-essential.</i>	focus on essentials, be strict about priorities, cut non-essentials	C1
pristine /'prɪsti:n/ adjective PRIS-tine	in its original condition, completely clean and unspoilt <i>Parts of the Sundarbans remain pristine, with dense mangrove forest stretching as far as the eye can see.</i>	unspoilt, untouched, immaculate, virgin	C1
privacy paradox /,prɪvəsi 'pærədɒks/ collocation	the gap between people saying they value privacy and still sharing personal data freely <i>The privacy paradox explains why people complain about data collection yet happily accept every app's terms and conditions.</i>	privacy contradiction, privacy gap	C2
privilege /'prɪvəlɪdʒ/ noun PRIV-i-lege	a special honour or opportunity that makes you feel lucky <i>It was a real privilege to meet my favourite author at a book fair in Dhaka last year.</i>	honour, pleasure, advantage	B2
privileged /'prɪvəlɪdʒd/ adjective PRIV-i-leged	having special advantages because of wealth or social position <i>Private tutoring is often available only to privileged families, which widens the gap between rich and poor students.</i>	wealthy, advantaged, well-off, elite	C1
prized /praɪzd/ adjective PRIZED	highly valued and wanted by many people <i>Fluent English and digital skills are highly prized by employers in almost every industry today.</i>	valued, treasured, esteemed, sought-after	C1
procrastinate /prə'kræstɪneɪt/ verb pro-CRAS-ti-nate	to delay doing something you should do, usually because it is boring or unpleasant <i>I used to procrastinate before exams, but now I set small daily goals to stay on track.</i>	put off, delay, dawdle, stall	C1
productive /prə'dʌktɪv/ adjective pro-DUC-tive	achieving a lot or leading to good, useful results <i>I find I'm most productive early in the morning, before the office gets noisy.</i>	efficient, effective, fruitful, constructive	B2
productive citizen /prə'dʌktɪv 'sɪtɪzn/ collocation as used: productive citizens	a member of society who works and contributes positively to the community <i>Good vocational training helps young people become productive citizens who can support themselves and their families.</i>	contributing member of society, active citizen, useful member of society	C1
proficient /prə'fɪʃnt/ adjective pro-FI-cient	skilled and experienced at doing something <i>Most office jobs nowadays require you to be proficient in basic computer programs like spreadsheets.</i>	skilled, competent, adept, capable	C1
profitable /'prɒfɪtəbl/ adjective PROF-it-a-ble	bringing financial gain or other benefit <i>Many farmers have switched to growing vegetables because they are more profitable than rice.</i>	lucrative, financially rewarding, money-making, beneficial	B2

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profound /prə'faʊnd/ adjective pro·FOUND	very great, deep or intense in its effect <i>Moving to a new country can have a profound effect on the way you see your own culture.</i>	deep, significant, far-reaching, considerable	C1
profound appeal /prə'faʊnd ə'pi:l/ collocation	a deep and strong attraction that something has for someone <i>For many city workers, simple village life holds a profound appeal, with its fresh air and slower pace.</i>	deep attraction, strong allure, great charm	C1
profound influence /prə'faʊnd 'ɪnfluəns/ collocation	a very strong and lasting effect on someone or something <i>My grandfather has had a profound influence on my values, especially honesty and hard work.</i>	deep impact, strong effect, major influence	C1
progression /prə'ɡreʃn/ noun pro·GRES·sion	a gradual move or development from one stage to the next <i>Moving from assistant to team leader felt like a natural progression after three years in the same company.</i>	development, advancement, next step, evolution	C1
progressive /prə'ɡresɪv/ adjective pro·GRES·sive	supporting new, modern ideas and methods <i>Our school had a progressive headteacher who encouraged debates and group projects instead of pure memorisation.</i>	forward-thinking, modern, enlightened, innovative	C1
progressive taxation /prə'gresɪv tæk'seɪʃn/ collocation	a tax system in which people who earn more pay a higher rate of tax <i>Supporters of progressive taxation argue that it funds public services fairly by asking more from the wealthy.</i>	graduated tax, tiered taxation, graduated income tax	C2
prohibition /ˌprəʊɪ'bɪʃn/ noun pro·hi·BI·tion as used: prohibitions	a rule or law that forbids something <i>Most religions share prohibitions against lying and stealing, which suggests some values are universal.</i>	ban, restriction, taboo, embargo	C1
proliferate /prə'ɪfəreɪt/ verb pro·LIF·er·ate	to increase rapidly in number or spread quickly <i>Coffee shops have started to proliferate in Dhaka, especially in areas popular with students.</i>	multiply, mushroom, spread, increase rapidly	C2
promising /'prɒmɪsɪŋ/ adjective PROM·is·ing	showing signs of being successful or good in the future <i>Early signs are promising, and the new metro rail seems to be reducing travel times for commuters.</i>	encouraging, hopeful, positive, auspicious	B2
promotable /prə'məʊtəbl/ adjective pro·MOT·a·ble	likely or suitable to be given a higher position at work <i>Showing initiative and helping colleagues are qualities that make an employee genuinely promotable.</i>	upwardly mobile, deserving promotion, high-potential	C2
prompt /prɒmpt/ verb PROMPT	to cause someone to take action or make a decision <i>The floods last year prompted the local council to repair the river embankment.</i>	spur, trigger, motivate, encourage	C1
prone /prəʊn/ adjective PRONE	likely to suffer from something or be affected by it <i>Elderly people living alone are more prone to loneliness, especially if their children have moved away.</i>	susceptible, liable, vulnerable, inclined	C1
pronounced /prə'naʊnst/ adjective pro·NOUNCED	very noticeable or strongly marked <i>The difference between city and village lifestyles is quite pronounced in Bangladesh, especially in terms of technology.</i>	marked, noticeable, striking, distinct	C1

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propaganda /ˌprɒpəˈgændə/ noun prop·a·GAN·da	biased or misleading information used to promote a political cause or point of view <i>During wartime, governments often use films and posters as propaganda to shape public opinion.</i>	disinformation, publicity, spin, indoctrination	C1
proponent /prəˈpɒnənt/ noun pro·PO·nent as used: proponents	a person who supports an idea or course of action <i>Proponents of online learning say it gives rural students access to teachers they would never otherwise meet.</i>	supporter, advocate, champion, backer	C2
proportionate /prəˈpɔːʃənət/ adjective pro·POR·tion·ate	in the correct relationship in size or amount to something else <i>Punishments should be proportionate to the crime, so minor offences shouldn't lead to long prison sentences.</i>	proportional, fair, commensurate, corresponding	C1
prosperity /prɒˈsperəti/ noun pros·PER·i·ty	the state of being successful and comfortable, especially financially <i>Better roads and bridges have brought new prosperity to many towns along the Jamuna.</i>	wealth, affluence, success, wellbeing	C1
protective /prəˈtektɪv/ adjective pro·TEC·tive	wanting to keep someone you care about safe from harm <i>My father is very protective of my younger sister and always asks who she's going out with.</i>	caring, watchful, vigilant, defensive	B2
provocative /prəˈvɒkətɪv/ adjective pro·VOC·a·tive	intended to cause a strong reaction, especially anger or excitement <i>Some news websites use provocative headlines simply to attract clicks and shares.</i>	inflammatory, controversial, sensational, provoking	C1
provoke thought /prəˌvʊk 'θɔːt/ collocation	to make people think seriously and carefully about something <i>A good documentary should not only entertain but also provoke thought about important social issues.</i>	stimulate reflection, make people think, spark discussion	C1
prudence /ˈpruːdns/ noun PRU·dence	careful good judgement that avoids unnecessary risks <i>My father's financial prudence meant our family always had savings for emergencies.</i>	caution, good sense, wisdom, carefulness	C2
prudent /ˈpruːdnt/ adjective PRU·dent	careful and sensible, especially when making decisions about money <i>It's prudent to compare prices at a few shops before buying an expensive phone.</i>	sensible, careful, cautious, thrifty	C1
pry /praɪ/ verb PRY	to try too hard to find out private details about someone's life <i>My neighbours are friendly, but they never pry into our family matters, which I really appreciate.</i>	snoop, nose around, meddle, be nosy	C1
public good /ˌpʌblɪk ˈɡʊd/ collocation	something that benefits everyone in society and should be available to all <i>Clean air is a public good, so governments have a duty to protect it for everyone.</i>	common good, public benefit, shared resource	C1
pull factor /ˈpʊl ˌfæktə(r)/ collocation	something that attracts people to move to a particular place <i>Better healthcare is a major pull factor that draws families from villages to district towns.</i>	attraction, incentive, draw, lure	C1
purposeful /ˈpɜːpəsfl/ adjective PUR·pose·ful	having a clear aim and a sense of meaning <i>Volunteering at weekends makes my free time feel more purposeful than just scrolling on my phone.</i>	meaningful, worthwhile, focused, determined	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
purposefully /'pʊ: pəs'fəli/ adverb PUR·pose·ful·ly	with a clear aim, in a deliberate and considered way <i>When technology is used purposefully in classrooms, it can make lessons much more engaging.</i>	deliberately, intentionally, thoughtfully, with intent	C1
pursue /pə'sju:/ verb pur·SUE	to try to achieve or follow something over a period of time <i>I hope to pursue a master's degree abroad once I have saved enough money.</i>	seek, strive for, chase, go after	B2
pursuit /pə'sju:t/ noun pur·SUIT	the act of trying to achieve or obtain something <i>The pursuit of wealth alone rarely makes people happy in the long term.</i>	quest, search, chase	C1
put aside /,pʊt ə'saɪd/ phrasal verb	to save an amount of money regularly for a particular purpose <i>I try to put aside a little money each month to help with my sister's university fees.</i>	save, set aside, put by, reserve	B2
put into perspective /,pʊt ,ɪntə pə'spektɪv/ idiom as used: into perspective	to help you judge how important or serious something really is <i>Visiting a children's hospital put my own small problems into perspective.</i>	put in context, keep things in proportion, give a sense of proportion	C1
put someone at ease /,pʊt ,sʌmwʌn ət 'i:z/ idiom as used: put me at ease	to make someone feel relaxed and comfortable in a situation <i>A good interviewer tries to put candidates at ease with some friendly small talk at the start.</i>	relax, reassure, make comfortable, calm	B2
quaint /kweɪnt/ adjective QUAINT	attractive and charming in an unusual or old-fashioned way <i>The village has a quaint little tea stall where old men gather every afternoon to chat.</i>	charming, old-fashioned, picturesque, quirky	C1
quantifiable /'kwɒntɪfaɪəbl/ adjective QUAN·ti·fi·a·ble	able to be measured or expressed as a number <i>Exam results are quantifiable, but qualities like creativity and kindness are much harder to measure.</i>	measurable, calculable, countable, assessable	C1
quiet dignity /,kwaɪət 'dɪgnəti/ collocation	a calm, serious and respectable quality that does not seek attention <i>My grandmother faced every hardship with quiet dignity, never complaining even when times were difficult.</i>	calm composure, understated grace, poise	C1
quintessentially /,kwɪntɪ'senʃəli/ adverb quin·tes·SEN·tial·ly	in a way that is a perfect, typical example of something <i>Drinking sweet milky tea at a roadside stall is a quintessentially Bangladeshi experience.</i>	typically, classically, archetypally, characteristically	C2
raise the profile of /,reɪz ðə 'prəʊfaɪl əv/ collocation as used: raise a festival's profile	to make something more widely known and noticed by the public <i>Hosting an international cricket match can raise the profile of a small city and attract tourists.</i>	publicise, promote, put on the map, boost awareness of	C1
rally round /,ræli 'raʊnd/ phrasal verb	to come together to help and support someone who is in difficulty <i>When our neighbour's house was flooded, everyone in the street rallied round to help clean it up.</i>	pull together, come to the aid of, support, help out	C1
rarity /'reərəti/ noun RAR·i·ty as used: a rarity	something that does not happen or exist very often, so it is unusual <i>Genuinely quiet streets are a rarity in my city, so I really value the early mornings.</i>	an exception, an uncommon thing, a novelty	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
rarity /'reərəti/ noun RAR-i·ty	something that is unusual and does not happen often <i>In a busy city, a completely quiet evening at home is a rarity for most families.</i>	unusual thing, exception, oddity, uncommon occurrence	C1
rational /'ræʃnəl/ adjective RA-tion·al	based on clear thinking and reason rather than emotion <i>It's hard to make rational decisions about money when you're feeling stressed or tired.</i>	logical, reasonable, sensible, level-headed	C1
reachable /'ri:tʃəbl/ adjective REACH·a·ble	able to be contacted, for example by phone or message <i>My manager expects us to be reachable by phone during office hours, even when we're out meeting students.</i>	contactable, available, accessible, on call	C1
reactive /'ri:æktiv/ adjective re·AC·tive	responding to problems after they happen rather than preventing them <i>Our city's approach to flooding is too reactive; it should invest in drainage before the monsoon arrives.</i>	responsive, after the fact, defensive	C1
read social cues /,ri:d ,səʊʃl 'kju:z/ collocation	to understand how others are feeling from their behaviour, expressions and tone <i>Children who play with others regularly learn to read social cues, like noticing when a friend is upset.</i>	pick up on signals, read the room, interpret body language	C1
readily /'redtli/ adverb READ-i·ly	quickly and willingly, without hesitation <i>Most people readily accept cookies on websites without reading what information is being collected.</i>	willingly, easily, gladly, without hesitation	C1
real-world play /,riəl wɜ:ld 'pleɪ/ collocation	children playing physically with objects and people rather than on screens <i>Experts often recommend real-world play, like building with blocks or running outside, for young children's development.</i>	hands-on play, physical play, offline play	C1
reap /'ri:p/ verb REAP as used: reaps	to get something good as a result of your own efforts or investment <i>If you study consistently from the start of the year, you will reap the rewards at exam time.</i>	gain, obtain, receive, harvest	C1
reason through /,ri:zn 'θru:/ phrasal verb	to think about something carefully and logically in order to reach a conclusion <i>Good teachers let students reason through problems themselves instead of simply giving them the answer.</i>	think through, work out, analyse, figure out	C1
reasoning /'ri:zənɪŋ/ noun REA·son·ing	the process of thinking logically about something to form a judgement <i>Maths develops logical reasoning, which is useful in everyday decisions like planning a monthly budget.</i>	logic, thinking, analysis, rationale	B2
reassure /,ri:ə'ʃʊə(r)/ verb re·as·SURE	to say or do something to make someone feel less worried <i>I called my mother to reassure her that I had arrived safely in Dhaka.</i>	comfort, calm, put someone's mind at rest, encourage	B2
reassuring /,ri:ə'ʃʊəriŋ/ adjective re·as·SUR·ing	making you feel less worried or anxious <i>It's reassuring to know that my family will always support me, whatever I decide to do.</i>	comforting, encouraging, heartening, calming	B2
rebalance /,ri:'bæləns/ verb re·BAL·ance	to change something so that its different parts are more equal or fair <i>Many young professionals are trying to rebalance their lives by spending less time at work and more with family.</i>	readjust, redress, even out, restore balance	C1

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receptive /rɪ'septɪv/ adjective re·CEP·tive	willing to listen to and accept new ideas or suggestions <i>My father was surprisingly receptive when I suggested he try online banking.</i>	open-minded, responsive, amenable, open	C1
recharge /,ri:'tʃɑ:dʒ/ verb re·CHARGE	to rest and relax in order to regain your energy <i>I usually spend Friday afternoons at home with a book, which helps me recharge after a long week.</i>	rest, unwind, refresh yourself, recuperate	B2
recharge your batteries /,ri:,tʃɑ:dʒ jɔ: 'bætəriz/ idiom as used: recharge my batteries	to rest and relax so that you feel full of energy again <i>A weekend at my grandparents' village home is the perfect way to recharge my batteries.</i>	unwind, rest up, refresh yourself, recuperate	B2
reckless /'rekləs/ adjective RECK·less	acting without thinking about the possible dangers or consequences <i>Driving fast on the highway during heavy rain is reckless and puts other people in danger too.</i>	rash, careless, impulsive, foolhardy	C1
reclaim /rɪ'kleɪm/ verb re·CLAIM	to get back something that was lost or taken away <i>Turning off work notifications at weekends has helped me reclaim time for my family and hobbies.</i>	recover, regain, take back, win back	C1
recognition /,rekəg'nɪʃn/ noun rec·og·NI·tion	praise and appreciation for someone's work or achievements <i>Teachers often work long hours without much recognition, which can make them feel undervalued.</i>	appreciation, acknowledgement, credit, praise	B2
reconcile /'rekənsaɪl/ verb REC·on·cile	to become friendly with someone again after a disagreement <i>After months of not speaking, the two brothers finally reconciled at their father's birthday dinner.</i>	make up, make peace, patch things up, reunite	C1
reconcile /'rekənsaɪl/ verb REC·on·cile as used: reconciles	to find a way for two opposing needs or ideas to exist together <i>Good city planning reconciles the need for new housing with the need to protect green spaces.</i>	harmonise, balance, square, accommodate	C1
redistribute /,ri:dɪ'strɪbjʊ:t/ verb re·dis·TRIB·ute	to share something out in a different way, usually so it is fairer <i>Some economists believe governments should redistribute wealth by investing more in schools in poorer regions.</i>	reallocate, share out, spread, redirect	C1
redistribute /,ri:dɪ'strɪbjʊ:t/ verb re·dis·TRIB·ute as used: redistributing	to move resources to different people or places so they are shared more fairly <i>Redistributing funding towards rural hospitals could greatly improve healthcare for people far from big cities.</i>	reallocate, share out, spread, redirect	C1
redistribution /,ri:dɪ'strɪ'bju:ʃn/ noun re·dis·tri·BU·tion	the act of spreading something across different people or places in a new way <i>The growth of remote work may lead to a redistribution of jobs from capital cities to smaller towns.</i>	reallocation, spreading out, dispersal, shift	C1
redress /rɪ'dres/ verb re·DRESS	to correct something that is wrong or unfair <i>Scholarships for students from poor families help redress the imbalance in access to higher education.</i>	correct, rectify, put right, remedy	C2
reductive /rɪ'dʌktɪv/ adjective re·DUC·tive	making something complex seem much simpler than it really is <i>Judging a school only by its exam results is reductive, as it ignores sport, arts and character.</i>	simplistic, oversimplified, narrow, limited	C2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
redundant /rɪˈdʌndənt/ adjective re·DUN·dant	no longer needed, especially of workers whose jobs are replaced by machines <i>Some bank clerks have become redundant as more customers manage their accounts through mobile apps.</i>	unnecessary, obsolete, surplus to requirements, superfluous	C1
refine /rɪˈfaɪn/ verb re·FINE as used: refined	to improve an idea or belief by making small changes over time <i>Travelling and meeting new people has helped me refine my views on what really matters in life.</i>	improve, polish, hone, perfect	C1
reflection /rɪˈflekʃn/ noun re·FLEC·tion	careful, quiet thought about something, especially your own life or experiences <i>Walking alone by the river gives me time for reflection after a stressful week.</i>	contemplation, thought, introspection, meditation	C1
reflective /rɪˈflekʃɪv/ adjective re·FLEC·tive	thinking deeply and carefully about things <i>Reading novels encourages a more reflective attitude, helping people understand lives very different from their own.</i>	thoughtful, contemplative, introspective, meditative	C1
refreshed /rɪˈfrefʃt/ adjective re·FRESHED	feeling less tired and more energetic than before <i>After a short nap in the afternoon, I wake up feeling refreshed and ready to work again.</i>	revitalised, energised, reinvigorated, restored	B2
refreshing /rɪˈfrefʃɪŋ/ adjective re·FRESH·ing	making you feel more energetic and less tired or hot <i>A cold glass of lemon juice is wonderfully refreshing on a hot summer afternoon.</i>	invigorating, revitalising, reviving, energising	B2
register /ˈredʒɪstə(r)/ noun REG·is·ter as used: registers	a style of language suited to a particular situation, such as formal or informal <i>IELTS candidates need to use an appropriate register and avoid slang when writing formal letters.</i>	style, tone, level of formality, language variety	C2
regulation /ˌregjuˈleɪʃn/ noun reg·u·LA·tion	official rules or control over an activity, usually by a government <i>Stricter regulation of street food vendors could reduce illnesses caused by poor hygiene.</i>	control, oversight, rules, supervision	B2
rehabilitation /ˌriːəˌbɪlɪˈteɪʃn/ noun re·ha·bil·i·TA·tion	helping offenders change their behaviour and return to normal life in society <i>Education and job training in prisons are key to rehabilitation, giving offenders a real chance to change.</i>	reform, reintegration, correction	C1
reinforce /ˌriːɪnˈfɔːs/ verb re·in·FORCE as used: reinforces	to make an idea, belief or feeling stronger <i>Parents who read regularly reinforce the message that books are enjoyable, not just something for school.</i>	strengthen, support, bolster, consolidate	C1
reintegration /ˌriːɪntɪˈgreɪʃn/ noun re·in·te·GRA·tion	the process of returning to society and becoming accepted in it again <i>Community support is vital for the reintegration of former prisoners, who often struggle to find work.</i>	rehabilitation, resettlement, reinstatement	C2
reinterpret /ˌriːɪnˈtɜːpriːt/ verb re·in·TER·pret as used: reinterpreted	to present or understand something in a new or different way <i>Young designers often reinterpret traditional sarees with modern colours and patterns.</i>	reimagine, rework, reinvent, adapt	C1
reinvigorated /ˌriːɪnˈvɪɡəreɪtɪd/ adjective re·in·VIG·or·at·ed	full of new energy and enthusiasm <i>After a week's holiday by the sea, I came back to work feeling completely reinvigorated.</i>	revitalised, refreshed, re-energised, rejuvenated	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
rejuvenate /rɪ'dʒuːvəneɪt/ verb re·JU·ve·nate	to make someone feel fresher, healthier and more energetic <i>A few days in the countryside always rejuvenate me after months of city life.</i>	revitalise, refresh, restore, reinvigorate	C1
rejuvenated /rɪ'dʒuːvəneɪtɪd/ adjective re·JU·ve·nat·ed	feeling fresh, healthy and full of energy again <i>My parents came back from their trip to Cox's Bazar looking relaxed and rejuvenated.</i>	revitalised, refreshed, renewed, invigorated	C1
rejuvenating /rɪ'dʒuːvəneɪtɪŋ/ adjective re·JU·ve·nat·ing	making you feel fresh, healthy and full of energy <i>Swimming in the early morning is a rejuvenating way to start the day.</i>	revitalising, refreshing, invigorating, restorative	C1
relentless /rɪ'lentləs/ adjective re·LENT·less	continuing without stopping or becoming less intense <i>The relentless noise of car horns in Dhaka can be exhausting if you're not used to it.</i>	unremitting, incessant, persistent, non-stop	C1
reliable /rɪ'laɪəbl/ adjective re·LI·a·ble	able to be trusted to do what is expected or promised <i>A reliable friend is someone who turns up when they say they will, even when it's inconvenient.</i>	dependable, trustworthy, consistent, steady	B2
reliance on fossil fuels /rɪ,laɪəns ɒn 'fɒsl ˌfjuːəlz/ collocation	depending heavily on coal, oil and gas for energy <i>Reducing our reliance on fossil fuels will require major investment in solar and wind power.</i>	dependence on fossil fuels, fossil fuel use, carbon dependence	C1
reliant /rɪ'laɪənt/ adjective re·LI·ant	needing something or someone in order to function or succeed <i>Many students have become so reliant on calculators that they struggle with simple mental arithmetic.</i>	dependent, relying, hooked	C1
relic /'relɪk/ noun REL·ic	an old object kept because of its historical or emotional value <i>My grandfather's old radio sits on a shelf like a relic from a completely different era.</i>	heirloom, keepsake, memento, artefact	C1
relieve pressure on /rɪ,liːv 'prefə(r) ɒn/ collocation as used: relieve pressure	to reduce the demands or strain on a system, place or person <i>Building a new bridge would relieve pressure on the old one, which is always crowded with lorries.</i>	ease the strain on, lighten the load on, take the pressure off	C1
religiously /rɪ'lɪdʒəsli/ adverb re·LI·gious·ly	regularly and carefully, without ever failing to do it <i>My mother religiously waters her rooftop plants every evening, except when the monsoon rain does it for her.</i>	faithfully, without fail, conscientiously, regularly	C1
relocate /,rɪːləʊ'keɪt/ verb re·lo·CATE as used: relocating	to move to a new place to live or work <i>Many families relocate to Dhaka for better job opportunities, even though living costs are much higher.</i>	move, resettle, migrate, move house	B2
reluctantly /rɪ'lʌktəntli/ adverb re·LUC·tant·ly	in a way that shows you do not really want to do something <i>I reluctantly agreed to give a speech at my cousin's wedding, although I was quite nervous.</i>	unwillingly, grudgingly, hesitantly, half-heartedly	B2
rely solely on /rɪ,laɪ 'səʊlli ɒn/ collocation as used: relying solely on	to depend on only one thing without using anything else <i>Students shouldn't rely solely on textbooks; podcasts and conversations can improve their English too.</i>	depend only on, rely exclusively on, lean entirely on	C1

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remarkable /rɪ'mɑ:kəbl/ adjective re-MARK·a·ble	unusual or surprising in a way that deserves attention <i>The speed at which mobile banking spread across rural Bangladesh has been truly remarkable.</i>	extraordinary, striking, notable, impressive	B2
remarkably /rɪ'mɑ:kəbli/ adverb re-MARK·a·bly	to an unusual or surprising degree <i>The new metro is remarkably clean and punctual, which has made my commute much easier.</i>	exceptionally, surprisingly, extraordinarily, strikingly	B2
remarkably adaptable /rɪ,mɑ:kəbli ə'dæptəbl/ collocation	surprisingly able to change and adjust to new situations <i>Children are remarkably adaptable and often settle into new schools faster than their parents expect.</i>	exceptionally flexible, highly versatile, surprisingly resilient	C1
reminisce /,remɪ'nɪs/ verb rem-i·NISCE	to talk or think about pleasant experiences from the past <i>Whenever my uncles visit, they love to reminisce about their childhood in the village.</i>	look back, recall, remember fondly, reflect	C1
reminisce /,remɪ'nɪs/ verb rem-i·NISCE as used: reminiscing	to talk together about pleasant shared memories from the past <i>My sister and I spent the evening reminiscing about the games we played as children during Eid.</i>	looking back, recalling old times, taking a trip down memory lane	C1
remote /rɪ'məʊt/ adjective re·MOTE	far away from towns, cities and other people <i>Some remote villages in the hill tracts still have no reliable electricity or internet connection.</i>	isolated, distant, far-flung, out-of-the-way	B2
render ineffective /,rendər ɪnɪ'fektɪv/ collocation as used: render efforts ineffective	to cause actions or attempts to fail to produce the intended result <i>Poor maintenance can render expensive new water pumps ineffective within just a few months.</i>	undermine, nullify, defeat, make useless	C2
renewal /rɪ'nju:əl/ noun re·NEW·al	a feeling of new life, energy and a fresh start <i>Pohela Boishakh is a time of renewal, when people wear new clothes and hope for a better year.</i>	rebirth, revival, regeneration, fresh start	C1
repair /rɪ'peə(r)/ verb re·PAIR as used: repairing	to improve a relationship or situation that has been damaged <i>It took several honest conversations to repair my friendship with a colleague after a silly argument.</i>	mend, restore, heal, fix	B2
repairable /rɪ'peərəbl/ adjective re·PAIR·a·ble	able to be fixed when broken or damaged <i>Older phones were more easily repairable, whereas many modern devices have to be replaced when they break.</i>	fixable, mendable, restorable	C1
repatriate /ri:'pætriət/ verb re·PAT·ri·ate as used: repatriating	to bring people, money or skills back to their home country <i>Some governments offer tax incentives to repatriate talented scientists who have been working overseas.</i>	bring home, send back, return	C2
repercussion /,ri:pə'kʌʃn/ noun re·per·CUS·sion as used: repercussions	an effect, usually a bad one, that happens as a result of an action <i>Cutting down forests has serious repercussions, from worse flooding to the loss of wildlife.</i>	consequence, effect, fallout, knock-on effect	C2

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repetitive /rɪˈpetətɪv/ adjective re·PET·i·tive	saying or doing the same thing too many times, so it becomes boring <i>Factory work can be very repetitive, which is why some workers find it hard to stay motivated.</i>	monotonous, tedious, dull, samey	B2
replicate /ˈreplɪkeɪt/ verb REP·li·cate	to do or make something again in exactly the same way <i>Restaurants abroad rarely manage to replicate the taste of real home-cooked Bengali food.</i>	reproduce, copy, recreate, duplicate	C1
replicate /ˈreplɪkeɪt/ verb REP·li·cate as used: replicated	to repeat or copy something so that it happens again elsewhere or on a larger scale <i>A successful small project in one village may not be easily replicated across the whole country.</i>	reproduce, repeat, copy, scale up	C1
repurpose /ˌrɪˈpɜːpəs/ verb re·PUR·pose	to change something so that it can be used for a different purpose <i>My mother likes to repurpose old glass jars as containers for spices and lentils.</i>	reuse, adapt, convert, recycle	C1
reputable /ˈrepjətəbl/ adjective REP·u·ta·ble	having a good reputation and trusted by people <i>It's safer to apply through a reputable agency that has a long record of helping students.</i>	respected, trustworthy, reliable, established	C1
resentment /rɪˈzentmənt/ noun re·SENT·ment	a feeling of anger because you think you have been treated unfairly <i>Unequal pay between colleagues doing the same job can lead to resentment in the workplace.</i>	bitterness, grudge, indignation, ill feeling	C1
reservation /ˌrezəˈveɪʃn/ noun res·er·VA·tion as used: reservations	a feeling of doubt about whether something is good or right <i>I have some reservations about online degrees, as students may miss out on campus life.</i>	doubt, misgiving, hesitation, qualm	C1
reserved /rɪˈzɜːvd/ adjective re·SERVED	quiet and slow to show feelings or opinions to other people <i>My younger sister is quite reserved around strangers, but she's very chatty with close friends.</i>	quiet, shy, introverted, reticent	B2
resilience /rɪˈzɪliəns/ noun re·SIL·ience	the ability to recover quickly and keep going after difficulties <i>Farmers along the river show remarkable resilience, rebuilding their homes after every flood season.</i>	toughness, strength, adaptability, grit	C1
resilient /rɪˈzɪliənt/ adjective re·SIL·ient	able to survive difficult conditions and remain strong <i>Small family businesses in my town proved resilient during the pandemic, adapting by delivering goods to homes.</i>	robust, tough, durable, hardy	C1
resist /rɪˈzɪst/ verb re·SIST	to stop yourself from doing or having something that you want <i>I find it almost impossible to resist a plate of hot samosas on a rainy afternoon.</i>	refuse, abstain from, hold out against, turn down	B2
reskill /ˌrɪˈskɪl/ verb re·SKILL	to learn new skills so that you can do a different job <i>Workers whose jobs are automated will need support to reskill for roles in growing industries.</i>	retrain, upskill, learn new skills	C1
resolved /rɪˈzɒlvd/ adjective re·SOLVED	firmly determined to do something <i>After failing the exam once, she was resolved to pass it the second time, whatever it took.</i>	determined, set on, committed, intent	C2

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resonate /'rezəneɪt/ verb RES·o·nate	to produce a deep, full sound that continues and vibrates <i>The call to prayer seemed to resonate through the quiet streets early in the morning.</i>	reverberate, echo, vibrate, ring	C1
resonate /'rezəneɪt/ verb RES·o·nate as used: resonated	to seem meaningful to someone because it matches their own experiences or feelings <i>The film's story about a family leaving their village really resonated with my parents.</i>	strike a chord, connect, touch, appeal	C1
resource depletion /rɪˌzɔːs dɪ'pliːʃn/ collocation	the using up of natural resources such as water or forests faster than they can be replaced <i>Resource depletion is a real concern in Bangladesh, where groundwater levels are falling in some areas.</i>	exhaustion of resources, overexploitation, depletion of natural resources	C1
resourceful /rɪˌzɔːsfl/ adjective re·SOURCE·ful	good at finding clever ways to solve problems with what is available <i>My mother is incredibly resourceful and can make a delicious meal from whatever is left in the kitchen.</i>	inventive, ingenious, enterprising, creative	C1
responsibility /rɪˌspɒnsə'bɪləti/ noun re·spon·si·BIL·i·ty	a duty or task that you are expected to do <i>Looking after elderly parents is seen as a family responsibility in most Bangladeshi households.</i>	duty, obligation, task, role	B2
rest on your achievements /ˌrest ɒn ʃɔːr ə'tʃiːvmənts/ idiom	to stop making an effort because you are satisfied with what you have already achieved <i>Even after winning the award, she refused to rest on her achievements and started planning her next project.</i>	rest on your laurels, become complacent, coast	C1
restless /'restləs/ adjective REST·less	unable to stay still or relaxed because you are bored, impatient or anxious <i>After a week at home during the holidays, I started to feel restless and wanted to travel somewhere.</i>	fidgety, impatient, on edge	B2
restorative /rɪ'stɔrətɪv/ adjective re·STOR·a·tive	making you feel healthier, calmer and full of energy again <i>A quiet weekend in my grandparents' village is always restorative after a busy month at work.</i>	refreshing, rejuvenating, revitalising, healing	C1
resurface /ˌrɪː'sɜːfɪs/ verb re·SUR·face	to appear again after being hidden or forgotten for some time <i>Old habits often resurface when people are under pressure, even after years of trying to change.</i>	reappear, re-emerge, come back	C1
resurgence /rɪ'sɜːdʒəns/ noun re·SUR·gence	a situation in which something becomes popular or active again after a period of decline <i>There has been a resurgence in vinyl records among young music fans who enjoy the warmer sound.</i>	revival, comeback, renewal, resurrection	C1
retain /rɪ'teɪn/ verb re·TAIN	to keep information in your memory <i>I retain new vocabulary much better when I use the words in real conversations.</i>	remember, keep, hold on to	B2
retreat /rɪ'triːt/ noun re·TREAT	a quiet, private place where you go to relax and escape from daily pressures <i>The small balcony of our flat is my retreat on hot evenings, with a cup of tea and a book.</i>	haven, sanctuary, refuge, hideaway	C1
reupholster /ˌrɪːʌp'həʊlstə/ verb re·up·HOL·ster as used: reupholstered	to put new padding and a new fabric cover on a chair or sofa <i>Instead of throwing away my grandfather's old armchair, we decided to reupholster it in a bright new fabric.</i>	re-cover, refurbish, restore	C2

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reverence /ˈrevərəns/ noun REV·er·ence	a feeling of deep respect and admiration for something <i>Visitors speak in whispers inside the old mosque, out of reverence for the place.</i>	deep respect, awe, veneration, admiration	C2
reverse the trend /rɪˈvɜːs ðə ˈtrend/ phrase	to change a pattern of development so that it starts moving in the opposite direction <i>Better facilities in rural schools could help reverse the trend of families moving to the capital.</i>	turn the tide, turn things around, halt the decline	C1
revitalise /ˌriːˈvaɪtəlaɪz/ verb re·VI·tal·ise as used: revitalised	to give new life, energy and activity to a place <i>The new riverside park has revitalised an area that most people used to avoid.</i>	rejuvenate, regenerate, breathe new life into, revive	C1
revitalise /ˌriːˈvaɪtəlaɪz/ verb re·VI·tal·ise as used: revitalising	to bring new economic activity and life to an area or community <i>Local festivals can play a big role in revitalising small towns that young people have left.</i>	regenerate, rejuvenate, reinvigorate	C1
revive /rɪˈvaɪv/ verb re·VIVE	to make an old custom or tradition popular or active again <i>Some young artists in Dhaka are trying to revive traditional crafts like nakshi kantha embroidery.</i>	bring back, restore, resurrect, reintroduce	C1
revive /rɪˈvaɪv/ verb re·VIVE as used: reviving	to become popular or active again after a period of decline <i>Interest in board games seems to be reviving as families look for ways to spend time away from screens.</i>	make a comeback, recover, pick up	C1
revolutionary /ˌrevəˈluːʃənəri/ adjective rev·o·LU·tion·ar·y	involving a completely new idea that causes a great change <i>Mobile phones were a revolutionary invention for farmers, who could suddenly check market prices themselves.</i>	groundbreaking, radical, innovative, pioneering	B2
revolutionise /ˌrevəˈluːʃənəɪz/ verb rev·o·LU·tion·ise	to completely change something in a way that greatly improves it <i>Many people believe artificial intelligence will revolutionise the way doctors diagnose diseases.</i>	transform, overhaul, reshape	C1
revolutionise /ˌrevəˈluːʃənəɪz/ verb rev·o·LU·tion·ise as used: revolutionised	to completely change the way something is done, usually for the better <i>Online shopping has revolutionised how people in small towns buy clothes and electronics.</i>	transform, reshape, overhaul	C1
revolutionise /ˌrevəˈluːʃənəɪz/ verb rev·o·LU·tion·ise as used: revolutionising	to change the way something is done completely and in a positive way <i>Video calls are revolutionising the way families stay in touch when relatives live abroad.</i>	transform, reinvent, reshape	C1
rewarding /rɪˈwɔːdɪŋ/ adjective re·WARD·ing	giving you satisfaction and pleasure because it feels useful or worthwhile <i>Helping students get their visas approved is the most rewarding part of my job.</i>	satisfying, fulfilling, gratifying, worthwhile	B2
richness /ˈrɪtʃnəs/ noun RICH·ness	the quality of being full of interesting variety, depth and meaning <i>Travelling helped me appreciate the richness of cultures very different from my own.</i>	depth, abundance, fullness, variety	C1

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rigid /'rɪdʒɪd/ adjective RIG·id	strict and not able to be changed or adapted to different situations <i>A rigid timetable can make it difficult for working students to attend every class.</i>	inflexible, strict, fixed, unbending	C1
rise to the occasion /,raɪz tə ði ə'keɪʒn/ idiom	to deal successfully with a difficult situation by doing better than expected <i>My younger sister was nervous before her exam, but she rose to the occasion and did brilliantly.</i>	meet the challenge, step up, rise to the challenge	C1
ritual /'rɪtʃuəl/ noun RIT·u·al	something you do regularly in the same way, often because it gives you pleasure <i>Drinking tea with my father after Friday prayers has become a little family ritual.</i>	routine, habit, custom, tradition	B2
riverbank erosion /'rɪvəbæŋk ɪ,rəʊʒn/ collocation	the gradual wearing away of land at the edge of a river by moving water <i>Every monsoon, riverbank erosion forces some families along the Jamuna to move their homes further inland.</i>	bank erosion, river erosion, land loss along rivers	C1
roam /rəʊm/ verb ROAM	to walk or travel around freely without a fixed plan <i>When I was younger, I loved to roam the narrow lanes of the old town with my cousins.</i>	wander, ramble, stroll around, drift	B2
root cause /,ru:t 'kɔ:z/ collocation as used: root causes	the basic, underlying reason why a problem exists <i>To reduce poverty in villages, we need to address the root causes, such as poor schooling and a lack of jobs.</i>	underlying cause, source, origin	C1
rooted /'ru:td/ adjective ROOT·ed	feeling a strong sense of belonging to a particular place or community <i>Even after years in Dhaka, my elder sister still feels rooted in Sirajganj.</i>	settled, attached, grounded, established	C1
rooted in /'ru:td ɪn/ phrase	based on or coming from something as its origin <i>Many of our festivals are rooted in the farming calendar and the changing seasons.</i>	based on, grounded in, stemming from, founded on	C1
rote learning /,rəʊt 'lɜ:nɪŋ/ collocation	learning by repeating things until you remember them, without really understanding them <i>Rote learning might help students pass exams, but it rarely teaches them to think critically.</i>	memorisation, learning by heart, repetition drills	C1
rounded /'raʊndɪd/ adjective ROUND·ed	balanced and complete, with a good variety of experiences or qualities <i>Sports and hobbies help children become more rounded individuals, not just good exam takers.</i>	well-rounded, balanced, complete, all-round	C1
rudimentary /,ru:di'mentri/ adjective ru·di·MEN·ta·ry	very basic and not well developed <i>My knowledge of cooking is rudimentary, so I can only make rice and a simple omelette.</i>	basic, elementary, limited, crude	C2
rule of law /,ru:l əv 'lɔ:/ collocation	the principle that everyone, including leaders, must obey the same laws <i>Foreign investors look for countries where the rule of law is respected and contracts are enforced.</i>	legal order, justice system, legality	C1
ruthless /'ru:θləs/ adjective RUTH·less	determined to get what you want without caring if you hurt others <i>Some businesses become so ruthless in chasing profit that they ignore their workers' wellbeing.</i>	merciless, cold-blooded, heartless, cut-throat	C1
ruthlessly /'ru:θləsli/ adverb RUTH·less·ly	in a very firm and determined way, without letting less important things distract you <i>When exams approached, my sister ruthlessly cut back on social media to focus on revision.</i>	firmly, strictly, decisively, unsentimentally	C1

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safeguard /'seɪfgɑ:d/ verb SAFE·guard	to protect something carefully so that it is not lost or harmed <i>I try to safeguard my evenings for family time, even when work gets busy.</i>	protect, guard, preserve, shield	C1
safeguard /'seɪfgɑ:d/ verb SAFE·guard as used: safeguarding	to protect people or things from harm or danger <i>Schools have an important role in safeguarding children's wellbeing, both online and offline.</i>	protect, defend, secure	C1
safety net /'seɪftɪ net/ collocation as used: safety nets	government help that protects people from falling into extreme poverty <i>Pensions and unemployment benefits act as a safety net for people who suddenly lose their income.</i>	social security, welfare support, protection	C1
sanctuary /'sæŋktʃuəri/ noun SANC·tu·ar·y	a peaceful place where you feel safe and can escape from stress <i>For me, the riverside path near my home is a sanctuary from noise and deadlines.</i>	haven, refuge, retreat, oasis	C1
satellite city /'sætəlaɪt ,sɪti/ collocation as used: satellite cities	a smaller city built near a large one to reduce pressure on it <i>Building satellite cities around Dhaka could ease traffic and housing shortages in the centre.</i>	satellite town, new town, commuter town	C2
satisfaction /,sætɪs'fækʃn/ noun sat·is·FAC·tion	a pleasant feeling you get when you achieve something or get what you wanted <i>There is real satisfaction in finishing a long novel you almost gave up on.</i>	fulfilment, contentment, gratification, pride	B2
satisfying /'sætɪsfɑɪɪŋ/ adjective SAT·is·fy·ing	giving you a feeling of pleasure because you have achieved something <i>Seeing a student finally receive an offer letter is incredibly satisfying for me.</i>	rewarding, gratifying, fulfilling, pleasing	B2
scale of influence /,skeɪl əv 'ɪnfluəns/ collocation	how widely and powerfully someone can affect people or events <i>Because of their scale of influence, large companies can change industry standards far faster than individuals.</i>	reach, sphere of influence, clout, power	C1
scar /ska:/ noun SCAR as used: scars	lasting emotional damage caused by an unpleasant experience <i>Bullying at school can leave emotional scars that affect a person's confidence for years.</i>	trauma, emotional damage, wound	C1
sceptical /'skeptɪkl/ adjective SCEP·ti·cal	tending to doubt whether something is true until there is good evidence <i>I am always sceptical of adverts that promise you can learn a language in two weeks.</i>	doubtful, questioning, distrustful, unconvinced	C1
scramble /'skræmbəl/ verb SCRAM·ble as used: scrambling	to rush to do something quickly and in a disorganised way <i>I hate scrambling to pack my bag on the morning of a trip, so I prepare the night before.</i>	rush, hurry, struggle, dash	C1
scrap heap /'skræp hi:p/ noun	a place where things that are no longer wanted are thrown away <i>My old bicycle was heading for the scrap heap until my father repaired it.</i>	rubbish dump, junkyard, landfill	C1
scratch the surface /,skrætʃ ðə 'sɜ:fɪs/ idiom as used: scratched the surface	to deal with only a very small part of a subject or experience <i>I spent three days in Chittagong, but I felt I had only scratched the surface of the city.</i>	only touch on, barely begin, skim the surface	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
screen-bound /'skri:n baʊnd/ adjective SCREEN·bound	spending most of the time using screens such as phones, computers or TVs <i>In the monsoon season, children can become quite screen-bound because they cannot play outside.</i>	screen-dependent, glued to screens, housebound, device-focused	C2
scribble /'skribl/ verb SCRIB·ble	to write something quickly and carelessly <i>During lectures I used to scribble ideas in the margins of my textbook.</i>	jot down, scrawl, note down	B2
scrolling /'skrəʊlɪŋ/ noun SCROLL·ing	moving continuously through content on a phone or computer screen <i>I set a timer on my phone to stop endless scrolling before bed.</i>	browsing, swiping, surfing	B2
scrutinise /'skru:tənaɪz/ verb SCRU·tin·ise	to examine something very carefully to find mistakes or check it is true <i>I always scrutinise university websites carefully before recommending a course to a student.</i>	examine, inspect, analyse, study closely	C1
scrutiny /'skru:təni/ noun SCRU·ti·ny	careful and critical attention from other people <i>Politicians face intense public scrutiny, so every comment they make is analysed.</i>	examination, inspection, close attention, observation	C1
seamless /'si:mləs/ adjective SEAM·less	happening smoothly without any problems or interruptions <i>The online visa application was surprisingly seamless, and I received a reply within a week.</i>	smooth, effortless, trouble-free, flawless	C1
seamlessly /'si:mləsli/ adverb SEAM·less·ly	smoothly and naturally, without any obvious join or difficulty <i>Good teachers seamlessly combine humour and discipline in the classroom.</i>	smoothly, effortlessly, naturally	C1
seasonal employment /,si:zənl ɪm'plɔɪmənt/ collocation	work that is available only at certain times of the year <i>The rice harvest provides seasonal employment for many labourers in rural Bangladesh.</i>	seasonal work, temporary jobs, casual work	C1
secluded /sɪ'klu:dɪd/ adjective se·CLUD·ed	quiet, private and hidden away from other people <i>We found a secluded spot by the river where we could chat without any noise.</i>	isolated, hidden, tucked away, private	C1
second-hand /,sekənd 'hænd/ adjective sec·ond·-HAND	previously owned or used by someone else <i>Most of my textbooks at university were second-hand, which saved me a lot of money.</i>	used, pre-owned, pre-loved	B2
sedentary /'sedntri/ adjective SED·en·ta·ry	involving a lot of sitting and very little physical activity <i>Because my job is so sedentary, I make a point of walking by the river every evening.</i>	inactive, desk-bound, stationary	C1
sedentary lifestyle /,sedntri 'laɪfstɑɪl/ collocation	a way of living that involves a lot of sitting and little exercise <i>Office workers can counter a sedentary lifestyle by taking short walks during their breaks.</i>	inactive lifestyle, lack of exercise, couch potato lifestyle	C1
seductive /sɪ'dʌktɪv/ adjective se·DUC·tive	very attractive and tempting, making you want something <i>The idea of becoming rich overnight through online trading is seductive but usually unrealistic.</i>	tempting, alluring, appealing, enticing	C1
see it through /,si: ɪt 'θru:/ phrasal verb as used: seeing it through	to continue with a difficult task until it is finished <i>Writing my final project was exhausting, but I was determined to see it through.</i>	follow through, persevere, stick it out, finish the job	C1

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seemingly endless /ˌsiːmɪŋli ˈendləs/ collocation	appearing to continue for ever, with no end in sight <i>In the monsoon, there are seemingly endless days of rain when the streets turn into streams.</i>	never-ending, interminable, unending	C1
selective /sɪˈlektɪv/ adjective se·LEC·tive	careful about what you choose, only accepting things that are good for you <i>I have become more selective about the news I read, focusing on reliable sources.</i>	choosy, discerning, particular, careful	C1
self-assurance /ˌself əˈʃʊərəns/ noun self·as·SUR·ance	confidence in yourself and your abilities <i>Giving presentations at university gave me a self-assurance I never had at school.</i>	confidence, self-confidence, poise, assurance	C1
self-assured /ˌself əˈʃʊəd/ adjective self·as·SURED	confident in your own abilities and calm in how you behave <i>My younger sister has become much more self-assured since she started giving presentations in class.</i>	confident, poised, self-possessed, assured	C1
self-aware /ˌself əˈweə/ adjective self·a·WARE	having a clear understanding of your own feelings, strengths and weaknesses <i>Keeping a journal has made me more self-aware about what triggers my stress.</i>	reflective, introspective, insightful	C1
self-censor /ˌself ˈsensə/ verb self·CEN·sor	to avoid saying or writing what you think because you fear criticism or punishment <i>Many people self-censor on social media because they worry their employer might see their posts.</i>	hold back, bite your tongue, keep quiet	C2
self-control /ˌself kənˈtrəʊl/ noun self·con·TROL	the ability to control your emotions and desires <i>It takes real self-control to leave your phone in another room while studying.</i>	willpower, self-discipline, restraint, self-restraint	B2
self-defeating /ˌself dɪˈfiːtɪŋ/ adjective self·de·FEAT·ing	causing more problems and preventing you from achieving what you want <i>Skipping sleep to study more is self-defeating, because a tired brain cannot learn properly.</i>	counterproductive, futile, self-destructive	C2
self-directed /ˌself dəˈrektɪd/ adjective self·di·RECT·ed	able to organise and manage your own learning or work without supervision <i>Online courses suit self-directed learners who can set their own goals and deadlines.</i>	independent, self-motivated, autonomous, self-driven	C1
self-discipline /ˌself ˈdɪsəplɪn/ noun self·DIS·ci·pline	the ability to make yourself do things you should do, even when it is difficult <i>Learning a language on your own requires a great deal of self-discipline and patience.</i>	willpower, self-control, determination, dedication	C1
self-expression /ˌself ɪkˈspresjən/ noun self·ex·PRES·sion	the showing of your personality, feelings or ideas through art, clothes or activities <i>For many young people, music is an important form of self-expression.</i>	creativity, individuality, personal expression	C1
self-imposed /ˌself ɪmˈpəʊzd/ adjective self·im·POSED	created by yourself rather than by others <i>Many of the limits we feel are self-imposed, such as believing we are too old to learn.</i>	voluntary, self-inflicted, self-created	C1
self-interest /ˌself ˈɪntrəst/ noun self·IN·ter·est	concern only for your own advantage rather than for others <i>Countries often act out of self-interest rather than cooperating on global problems.</i>	selfishness, self-serving motives, personal gain	C1
self-reliant /ˌself rɪˈlaɪənt/ adjective self·re·LI·ant	able to do things and make decisions without needing help from others <i>Living in a hostel taught me to be more self-reliant, from managing money to cooking.</i>	independent, self-sufficient, autonomous	C1

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self-sufficient /ˌself səˈfɪʃnt/ adjective self·suf·FI·cient	able to provide what you need yourself without relying on others <i>My grandparents are almost self-sufficient in vegetables because they grow most of what they eat.</i>	self-reliant, independent, self-supporting	C1
self-taught /ˌself ˈtɔ:t/ adjective self·TAUGHT	having learned a skill by yourself rather than from a teacher <i>My cousin is a self-taught guitarist who learned entirely from online videos.</i>	self-educated, autodidactic, self-made	B2
selfless /ˈselfləs/ adjective SELF·less	caring more about other people's needs than your own <i>Nurses often show selfless dedication, working long shifts to care for strangers.</i>	unselfish, altruistic, generous, self-sacrificing	C1
seniority /ˌsiːniˈɒrəti/ noun se·ni·OR·i·ty	a higher position or rank gained by working somewhere for a long time <i>In many companies, promotions still depend more on seniority than on actual performance.</i>	rank, status, standing, precedence	C1
sensational /senˈseɪʃənəl/ adjective sen·SA·tion·al	presented in a shocking way to attract attention rather than to inform <i>Some news websites use sensational headlines just to get more clicks.</i>	lurid, shocking, dramatic, melodramatic	C1
sensationalism /senˈseɪʃənəlɪzəm/ noun sen·SA·tion·al·ism	reporting news in a shocking or exaggerated way to attract attention <i>Responsible journalists avoid sensationalism, even when it would attract a bigger audience.</i>	exaggeration, scaremongering, tabloid journalism, hype	C2
sense of loss /ˌsens əv ˈlɒs/ collocation	a feeling of sadness because something or someone important is no longer there <i>When my best friend moved abroad, I felt a deep sense of loss for months.</i>	grief, emptiness, sadness	C1
sense of occasion /ˌsens əv əˈkeɪʒn/ collocation	a feeling that an event is special and important <i>Wearing new clothes on Eid morning gives the whole day a real sense of occasion.</i>	grandeur, ceremony, festive atmosphere	C1
sense of ownership /ˌsens əv ˈəʊnəʃɪp/ collocation	a feeling of responsibility for something because you helped to create or manage it <i>Letting students choose their own projects gives them a stronger sense of ownership over their learning.</i>	responsibility, personal investment, commitment	C1
sense of perspective /ˌsens əv pəˈspektɪv/ collocation	the ability to judge how important things really are, without exaggerating problems <i>Spending time with my grandparents always gives me a sense of perspective about my own worries.</i>	balanced view, sense of proportion, clarity	C1
sense of self /ˌsens əv ˈself/ collocation	your understanding of who you are and what makes you unique <i>Moving to a new country can challenge your sense of self in unexpected ways.</i>	identity, self-image, self-identity	C1
sensible /ˈsensəbl/ adjective SEN·si·ble	reasonable and based on good judgement <i>Saving part of your salary each month is a sensible habit to start early.</i>	wise, reasonable, practical, prudent	B2
sensible compromise /ˌsensəbl ˈkɒmprəmaɪz/ collocation	a reasonable solution in which each side accepts less than it originally wanted <i>Working from home two days a week seemed a sensible compromise between my needs and my manager's.</i>	happy medium, middle ground, reasonable trade-off	C1
sensitively /ˈsensətɪvli/ adverb SEN·si·tive·ly	in a careful way that avoids upsetting or offending people <i>Disappointing exam results should be discussed sensitively, especially with younger students.</i>	tactfully, gently, diplomatically, considerately	C1

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sentimental /,sentɪ'mentl/ adjective sen-ti-MEN-tal	expressing strong, tender emotions, sometimes in a slightly exaggerated way <i>My father is not a sentimental man, but he kept every card we made him as children.</i>	emotional, soppy, romantic, nostalgic	B2
sentimental value /,sentɪ'mentl 'væljuː/ collocation	importance something has for you because of personal memories, not its price <i>My grandmother's old shawl is worn out, but it has huge sentimental value for my mother.</i>	emotional value, personal significance, special meaning	B2
serene /sə'reɪn/ adjective se-RENE	calm, peaceful and completely untroubled by noise or worry <i>Early in the morning, the river looks completely serene, with only a few fishing boats on it.</i>	tranquil, peaceful, calm, placid	C1
settle on /'setl ɒn/ phrasal verb as used: settling on	to decide on or choose something after considering other options <i>After visiting several universities, my cousin finally settled on one in Manchester.</i>	decide on, choose, opt for, agree on	B2
shared humanity /,ʃeəd hjuː'mænəti/ collocation	the qualities, needs and feelings that all people have in common <i>Disasters often remind us of our shared humanity, as strangers rush to help each other.</i>	common humanity, human solidarity, kinship	C1
shared mobility /,ʃeəd məʊ'bɪləti/ collocation	transport services that people share, such as car sharing, bike hire or ride-hailing <i>Shared mobility schemes like bike hire could cut traffic in crowded city centres.</i>	car sharing, ride-sharing, shared transport	C2
sharp /ʃɑːp/ adjective SHARP as used: sharpest	able to think quickly and clearly <i>My grandfather is in his eighties, but his mind is still remarkably sharp.</i>	alert, quick, keen, clear-headed	B2
sheepish /'ʃiːpɪʃ/ adjective SHEEP-ish	slightly embarrassed because you have done something silly or wrong <i>He gave me a sheepish smile when he realised he had forgotten my birthday.</i>	embarrassed, abashed, shamefaced, awkward	C2
sheer enthusiasm /,ʃɪər ɪn'θjuːziæzəm/ collocation	complete and genuine eagerness, used to emphasise how strong it is <i>The children's sheer enthusiasm made the small village festival feel incredibly lively.</i>	pure enthusiasm, boundless energy, eagerness, zeal	C1
shift the burden /,ʃɪft ðə 'bɜːdn/ phrase	to move a responsibility or problem onto someone else <i>Raising university fees would simply shift the burden of education costs onto families.</i>	pass the buck, offload the problem, transfer responsibility	C1
shifting values /,ʃɪftɪŋ 'væljuːz/ collocation	beliefs and priorities in society that are gradually changing <i>Shifting values mean that many young couples now share household chores more equally.</i>	changing attitudes, evolving values, changing priorities	C1
short-lived /,ʃɔːt 'lɪvd/ adjective short-LIVED	lasting only a short time <i>My interest in learning the guitar was short-lived, as I gave up after a month.</i>	brief, temporary, fleeting, momentary	C1
short-sighted /,ʃɔːt 'saɪtɪd/ adjective short-SIGHT-ed	not thinking carefully about the future effects of something <i>Cutting education budgets to save money is short-sighted, as it harms the economy later.</i>	unwise, ill-considered, imprudent, narrow-minded	C1

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shoulder /'ʃəʊldə/ verb SHOUL·der as used: shouldering	to accept a burden or responsibility <i>In many families, the eldest child ends up shouldering responsibility for their parents' care.</i>	bear, take on, carry, accept	C1
shoulder /'ʃəʊldə/ verb SHOUL·der as used: shoulders	to take on and deal with a heavy workload or duty <i>When our manager left suddenly, my colleague shouldered most of her workload for weeks.</i>	bear, carry, take on	C1
show off /,ʃəʊ 'ɒf/ phrasal verb	to proudly let people see something you have <i>During Eid, children love to show off their new clothes to relatives and neighbours.</i>	display, flaunt, parade, exhibit	B2
showcase /'ʃəʊkeɪs/ verb SHOW·case	to show the best qualities of someone or something in a way that attracts attention <i>The national museum showcases the country's history through art, clothing and old photographs.</i>	highlight, present, display, feature	C1
shut out /,ʃʌt 'aʊt/ phrasal verb	to stop a sound or light from entering a place <i>I wear headphones on the bus to shut out the noise and read in peace.</i>	block out, keep out, exclude	B2
sideline /'saɪdlaɪn/ verb SIDE·line as used: sidelined	to treat something as unimportant and give it less attention <i>Music and art are often sidelined in schools that focus only on exam results.</i>	marginalise, push aside, neglect, downplay	C1
signature piece /'sɪɡnətʃə pi:s/ collocation	an item of clothing or object that is closely linked with a person's style <i>Her bright red scarf has become a signature piece that everyone recognises her by.</i>	trademark item, staple, hallmark	C1
significance /'sɪɡ'nɪfɪkəns/ noun sig·NIF·i·cance	the special meaning or importance that something has for someone <i>The date has great significance for our family, because my parents got married on that day.</i>	meaning, importance, value, relevance	B2
silent killer /,saɪlənt 'kɪlə/ collocation	something that causes serious harm or death gradually, without obvious warning signs <i>High blood pressure is often called a silent killer because many people do not notice any symptoms.</i>	hidden danger, invisible threat, stealthy threat	C1
sincere /'sɪn'sɪə/ adjective sin·CERE	honest and really meaning what you say <i>Her thank-you note was short but sincere, and it genuinely touched me.</i>	genuine, heartfelt, honest, earnest	B2
single-handedly /,sɪŋɡl 'hændɪdli/ adverb sin·gle·HAND·ed·ly	by yourself, without help from anyone else <i>My father built up his shop almost single-handedly, starting with very little money.</i>	alone, unaided, on your own, by yourself	C1
single-minded /,sɪŋɡl 'maɪndɪd/ adjective sin·gle·MIND·ed	focused on only one aim, often ignoring everything else <i>Athletes need a single-minded focus to succeed, but it can cost them their social life.</i>	determined, focused, resolute, dogged	C1
sinister /'sɪnɪstə/ adjective SIN·is·ter	seeming evil, harmful or dishonest <i>There was nothing sinister about the strange noise; it was only a cat on the roof.</i>	evil, menacing, threatening, dark	C1

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sink in /ˌsɪŋk ˈɪn/ phrasal verb	to become fully understood or remembered <i>It took a few days for the good news to really sink in.</i>	register, be absorbed, be understood, hit home	C1
sink into /ˌsɪŋk ˈɪntə/ phrasal verb	to sit or lie down in something soft and relax completely <i>After a long day at work, I love to sink into the sofa with a cup of tea.</i>	settle into, relax into, nestle into	B2
sit with discomfort /sɪt wɪð dɪsˈkɒmfət/ phrase as used: sit with that discomfort	to accept an unpleasant feeling calmly instead of trying to avoid it <i>Learning to sit with discomfort helped me cope far better with the stress of exams.</i>	tolerate discomfort, accept the feeling, ride it out	C2
sizeable /ˈsaɪzəbl/ adjective SIZE·a·ble	fairly large in size or number <i>A sizeable number of students from my town now go abroad for their master's degrees.</i>	considerable, substantial, large, significant	C1
skilful /ˈskɪfl/ adjective SKIL·ful	showing great ability and expertise <i>The tailor was so skilful that he altered my suit in less than an hour.</i>	expert, accomplished, adept, masterly	B2
skilled trade /ˌskɪld ˈtreɪd/ collocation as used: skilled trades	a practical job, such as plumbing or electrical work, that needs special training <i>Young people should know that skilled trades like carpentry can offer a stable income.</i>	craft, technical trade, vocational occupation	C1
skilled workforce /ˌskɪld ˈwɜːkfɔːs/ collocation	workers who have the training and abilities needed for their jobs <i>Foreign companies are attracted to countries with a skilled workforce and good infrastructure.</i>	trained workers, qualified labour, talent pool	C1
skills-based hiring /ˌskɪlz beɪst ˈhaɪərɪŋ/ collocation	choosing employees mainly for their practical abilities rather than their degrees <i>Skills-based hiring could open doors for talented people who never had the chance to attend university.</i>	competency-based recruitment, skills-first hiring, merit-based hiring	C2
slip away /ˌslɪp əˈweɪ/ phrasal verb as used: slipping away	to pass quickly without being noticed <i>When I start watching videos online, whole evenings can slip away without me realising.</i>	pass by, disappear, vanish, fly by	C1
slippery slope /ˌslɪpəri ˈsləʊp/ idiom	a course of action that is likely to lead to worse and worse results <i>Borrowing money for small luxuries can be a slippery slope towards serious debt.</i>	downward spiral, dangerous path, thin end of the wedge	C1
soak up /ˌsəʊk ˈʌp/ phrasal verb	to enjoy and experience the atmosphere of a place fully <i>On my first trip to Cox's Bazar, I just sat on the beach to soak up the atmosphere.</i>	absorb, take in, savour, immerse yourself in	B2
soaring /ˈsɔːrɪŋ/ adjective SOAR·ing	rising very quickly to a high level <i>Soaring rents in Dhaka mean that many young workers have to share flats.</i>	rocketing, skyrocketing, escalating, spiralling	C1
social cohesion /ˌsəʊʃl kəʊˈhiːʒn/ collocation	the sense of unity and cooperation among people in a society <i>Community festivals help build social cohesion by bringing different groups together.</i>	community spirit, unity, solidarity, togetherness	C1
social fabric /ˌsəʊʃl ˈfæbrɪk/ collocation	the relationships and shared values that hold a society together <i>Rapid urbanisation can weaken the social fabric of villages as young people move away.</i>	fabric of society, social ties, community bonds	C1

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social glue /ˌsəʊʃl 'gluː/ collocation	something that keeps people connected and helps a community stay united <i>Sharing food during Eid acts as a social glue between neighbours of different backgrounds.</i>	bond, unifying force, binding force, common ground	C1
social mobility /ˌsəʊʃl məʊ'bɪləti/ collocation	the ability of people to move to a higher social or economic position <i>Scholarships increase social mobility by giving poorer students access to top universities.</i>	upward mobility, opportunity, advancement	C1
social safety net /ˌsəʊʃl 'seɪftɪ net/ collocation	government support that protects people who lose their income or face hardship <i>A strong social safety net helps families survive when the main earner loses their job.</i>	welfare system, social security, social protection	C1
socialise /'səʊʃəlaɪz/ verb SO·cial·ise	to spend time with other people for enjoyment <i>Weekends are my main chance to socialise, usually over tea with old school friends.</i>	mix, mingle, hang out, get together	B2
societal /sə'saɪətəl/ adjective so·CI·e·tal	relating to society and the way it is organised <i>Loneliness among older people is a growing societal problem in many countries.</i>	social, communal, public, collective	C1
solemn /'sɒləm/ adjective SOL·emn	serious and respectful, especially in connection with death or remembrance <i>The ceremony on Victory Day was solemn, and everyone stood in silence to remember the martyrs.</i>	sombre, grave, serious, dignified	C1
solidarity /ˌsɒlɪ'dærəti/ noun sol·i·DAR·i·ty	support and unity between people who share the same interests or feelings <i>After the floods, neighbours showed great solidarity by sharing food and shelter.</i>	unity, mutual support, togetherness, fellowship	C1
solitary /'sɒlətri/ adjective SOL·i·tar·y	done alone or involving working alone <i>Writing a novel is a largely solitary activity, which suits people who enjoy their own company.</i>	lone, isolated, individual, lonely	C1
solitude /'sɒlɪtjuːd/ noun SOL·i·tude	the state of being alone, especially when you enjoy it <i>I enjoy a little solitude in the early morning before the rest of the family wakes up.</i>	privacy, seclusion, peace and quiet, isolation	C1
soothing /'suːðɪŋ/ adjective SOOTH·ing	making you feel calm and relaxed <i>The sound of rain on the roof during the monsoon is incredibly soothing.</i>	calming, relaxing, comforting, restful	B2
sophisticated /sə'fɪstɪkətɪd/ adjective so·PHIS·ti·cat·ed	stylish, elegant and showing good taste <i>My elder sister has a sophisticated sense of style, choosing simple colours and elegant fabrics.</i>	elegant, refined, stylish, chic	B2
sought-after /'sɔːt ɑːftə/ adjective SOUGHT·af·ter	wanted by many people because of being very good or rare <i>Engineers with good communication skills are highly sought-after in today's job market.</i>	in demand, desirable, popular, coveted	C1
soul-destroying /'səʊl dɪstrɔɪɪŋ/ adjective SOUL·de·stroy·ing	extremely boring or depressing, making you lose all enthusiasm <i>Doing the same data entry for eight hours a day would be soul-destroying for me.</i>	mind-numbing, depressing, demoralising, tedious	C2
soulless /'səʊlləs/ adjective SOUL·less	lacking human feeling, warmth or character <i>Some new shopping malls feel soulless compared with the lively old markets.</i>	lifeless, characterless, cold, bland	C1

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sound /saʊnd/ adjective SOUND	sensible, reliable and likely to be right <i>My father gave me sound advice about saving money when I got my first job.</i>	reliable, sensible, wise, solid	C1
sourcing /'sɔːsɪŋ/ noun SOURC·ing	the process of finding and obtaining materials or products from a supplier <i>Many cafés now advertise the ethical sourcing of their tea and coffee.</i>	procurement, supply, purchasing	C1
spark /spɑːk/ verb SPARK	to cause something to start or develop <i>A good documentary can spark lively discussions in class about environmental issues.</i>	trigger, prompt, ignite, generate	C1
spark someone's interest /,spɑːk ˌsʌmwʌnz 'ɪntrəst/ collocation as used: sparked my interest	to make someone start to feel curious about something <i>A school trip to the Sundarbans first sparked her interest in wildlife.</i>	poke someone's interest, arouse someone's curiosity, capture someone's imagination	C1
spectacular /'spek'tækjələ/ adjective spec·TAC·u·lar	extremely impressive and exciting to look at <i>The sunset over the Jamuna can be spectacular, with the sky turning orange and pink.</i>	breathtaking, stunning, dramatic, magnificent	B2
speculation /,spekju'leɪʃn/ noun spec·u·LA·tion	buying property or goods in the hope of selling them later at a profit <i>Property speculation has made flats in the city centre unaffordable for many local families.</i>	speculative investment, gambling, risky investment	C2
speculative /'spekjələtɪv/ adjective SPEC·u·la·tive	based on guesses rather than facts or proof <i>Predictions about what daily life will be like in a hundred years are highly speculative.</i>	theoretical, hypothetical, conjectural, uncertain	C2
spellbound /'spelbaʊnd/ adjective SPELL·bound	so interested or amazed that you cannot think about anything else <i>The children sat spellbound as my grandmother told them old folk tales.</i>	captivated, enthralled, mesmerised, entranced	C1
splash out /,splæʃ 'aʊt/ phrasal verb	to spend a lot of money on something you do not really need <i>For my mother's birthday, we decided to splash out on dinner at a nice restaurant.</i>	splurge, spend lavishly, treat yourself	C1
split your time /,splɪt jɔː 'taɪm/ phrase as used: splitting their time	to divide your time between two or more places or activities <i>Many students split their time between their studies and part-time work.</i>	divide your time, juggle, balance	B2
spontaneous /'spɒn'teɪniəs/ adjective spɒn·TA·ne·ous	doing things without planning them in advance <i>Our best trip was a spontaneous weekend in Sylhet that we planned the night before.</i>	impulsive, unplanned, impromptu, spur-of-the-moment	B2
sprout /'sprəʊt/ verb SPROUT as used: sprouted	to begin to grow and produce new shoots <i>After the first monsoon rains, green shoots sprouted everywhere in the fields.</i>	germinate, shoot up, come up, bud	C1
squabble /'skwɒbl/ verb SQUAB·ble as used: squabbling	to argue noisily about something unimportant <i>My nephew and his friends were squabbling over who should have the red toy car.</i>	bicker, quarrel, argue, wrangle	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
stability /stə'biləti/ noun sta·BIL-i·ty	a situation in which your life, job or income is secure and not likely to change <i>Many graduates choose government jobs because they offer long-term financial stability.</i>	security, steadiness, permanence, certainty	B2
staff turnover /,stɑ:f 'tɜ:nəʊvə/ collocation	the rate at which employees leave a company and are replaced <i>Good training and fair pay are the best ways to reduce staff turnover.</i>	employee turnover, attrition, churn	C1
stagnate /stæg'neɪt/ verb stag·NATE	to stop developing or improving <i>If you never try anything new at work, your skills can quickly stagnate.</i>	stand still, go nowhere, become stale, decline	C1
stagnation /stæg'neɪʃn/ noun stag·NA·tion	a state in which there is no growth, development or progress <i>Staying in the same role for too long can lead to career stagnation.</i>	standstill, inactivity, lack of progress, inertia	C1
stale /steɪl/ adjective STALE	no longer interesting or exciting because it has been done too often <i>After three years in the same job, my routine started to feel stale.</i>	dull, boring, repetitive, monotonous	C1
stand firm /,stænd 'fɜ:m/ phrase	to refuse to change your decision or opinion despite pressure <i>My sister stood firm when her friends pressured her to skip classes.</i>	hold your ground, stick to your guns, refuse to budge	C1
standard of living /,stændəd əv 'lɪvɪŋ/ collocation	the level of comfort and wealth that a person or family has <i>The standard of living in many Bangladeshi towns has improved noticeably in recent decades.</i>	quality of life, living standards, well-being	B2
staple /'steɪpl/ noun STA·ple	something basic and important that is used or worn regularly <i>A plain white shirt is a staple in almost every man's wardrobe.</i>	essential, basic item, mainstay, must-have	C1
stark /stɑ:k/ adjective STARK	very clear, obvious and often unpleasant <i>There is a stark contrast between the busy streets of Dhaka and the calm of my grandparents' village.</i>	striking, sharp, obvious, clear-cut	C1
static /'stætɪk/ adjective STAT·ic	not moving, changing or interactive <i>Old-fashioned websites with static pages are much less engaging than interactive apps.</i>	unchanging, motionless, fixed, lifeless	C1
stay true to /,steɪ 'tru: tə/ phrase as used: staying true to	to continue to act according to your beliefs, values or character <i>Even after becoming famous, the singer stayed true to her roots and still performs folk songs.</i>	remain faithful to, be loyal to, keep to	C1
steadily /'stedəli/ adverb STEAD·i·ly	gradually and at a regular, even rate <i>My English has improved steadily since I started reading a newspaper every morning.</i>	gradually, consistently, progressively	B2
steer /stiə/ verb STEER as used: steering	to guide or influence someone or something in a particular direction <i>Parents often end up steering their children towards careers like medicine or engineering.</i>	guide, direct, influence, nudge	C1

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steer behaviour /ˌstiə bɪˈheɪvjə/ collocation	to influence people so that they act in a particular way <i>Plastic bag charges are a simple way to steer behaviour towards reusable bags.</i>	influence behaviour, guide behaviour, nudge people	C1
stem from /ˈstem frɒm/ phrasal verb as used: stems from	to come from or be caused by something <i>Much of my interest in education stems from watching my younger sister study so hard.</i>	arise from, originate in, result from, come from	C1
step outside your comfort zone /ˌstep ʌtˌsaɪd ʒɔː ˈkɒmfət zəʊn/ idiom as used: step outside my comfort zone	to try something new or difficult that makes you feel uncomfortable <i>Joining the debate club forced me to step outside my comfort zone and speak in public.</i>	push yourself, challenge yourself, take a risk	B2
stereotype /ˈsteriətaɪp/ noun STER·e·o·type	a fixed but often wrong idea that many people have about a group <i>The stereotype that boys are better at maths than girls is simply not true.</i>	cliché, generalisation, preconception, label	B2
steward /ˈstjuːəd/ noun STEW·ard as used: stewards	a person who looks after something valuable responsibly for others <i>Farmers are stewards of the land, so they must protect the soil for the next generation.</i>	guardian, custodian, caretaker, keeper	C2
stewardship /ˈstjuːədʃɪp/ noun STEW·ard·ship	the careful and responsible management of something <i>Good stewardship of our rivers is essential to protect fishing communities.</i>	management, custodianship, care, guardianship	C2
stick with /ˈstɪk wɪð/ phrasal verb	to continue doing something rather than giving up <i>Learning the harmonium is hard at first, but if you stick with it, you improve quickly.</i>	persevere with, keep at, continue with, persist with	B2
stifle /ˈstaɪfl/ verb STI·fle	to stop something from developing or happening <i>Too many strict rules at school can stifle children's creativity and curiosity.</i>	suppress, restrict, hold back, smother	C1
stifling /ˈstaɪflɪŋ/ adjective STI·fling	limiting freedom and making you feel restricted <i>Some young people find small-town life stifling and dream of moving to a big city.</i>	restrictive, oppressive, suffocating, constraining	C1
stigma /ˈstɪgmə/ noun STIG·ma	strong feelings of disapproval that society has about something, often unfairly <i>There is still a stigma around asking for help with depression in many communities.</i>	shame, disgrace, prejudice, taboo	C1
stigmatise /ˈstɪgmətaɪz/ verb STIG·ma·tise	to treat someone or something as shameful or unacceptable, often unfairly <i>We should not stigmatise students who choose vocational training instead of university.</i>	label, shame, discredit, brand	C2
stigmatise /ˈstɪgmətaɪz/ verb STIG·ma·tise as used: stigmatised	to make people see something unfairly as less respectable or worthy <i>In the past, divorce was heavily stigmatised, but attitudes have gradually softened.</i>	look down on, frown upon, discredit	C2
stillness /ˈstɪlnəs/ noun STILL·ness	a state of calm, quiet and lack of movement <i>I love the stillness of the river just before sunrise, when even the birds are quiet.</i>	calm, quiet, tranquillity, peace	C1

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stilted /'stɪltɪd/ adjective STILT·ed	not natural or relaxed, often awkward and too formal <i>Our first conversation was a bit stilted, but we soon relaxed and started laughing.</i>	awkward, forced, unnatural, wooden	C2
stimulating /'stɪmjuleɪtɪŋ/ adjective STIM·u·lat·ing	full of interesting ideas that make you think <i>I find discussions with international students stimulating because they see things so differently.</i>	thought-provoking, engaging, interesting, inspiring	B2
stimulus /'stɪmjələs/ noun STIM·u·lus	something that encourages activity, especially growth in the economy <i>Building a new bridge acted as a stimulus for trade in the surrounding districts.</i>	boost, incentive, spur, impetus	C1
stir genuine emotion /,stɜːˌdʒenjuɪn ɪ'məʊʃn/ collocation	to make people feel real, strong feelings <i>A well-written song can stir genuine emotion even in listeners who do not understand the language.</i>	move people, touch the heart, evoke real feeling	C1
strain /streɪn/ verb STRAIN	to put too much pressure on something, causing it harm <i>Constantly eating out can strain your budget more than you expect.</i>	overstretch, overburden, tax, stretch	C1
strain /streɪn/ verb STRAIN as used: strained	to damage a relationship by creating tension or difficulty <i>Long working hours can strain relationships between couples who rarely see each other.</i>	damage, put pressure on, weaken	C1
strategic /strə'tiːdʒɪk/ adjective stra·TE·gic	carefully planned to achieve a particular long-term aim <i>Choosing a university is a strategic decision that can shape your whole career.</i>	planned, calculated, deliberate, tactical	C1
strategic investment /strə'tiːdʒɪk ɪn'vestmənt/ collocation	spending money on something carefully chosen to bring long-term benefits <i>Improving rural internet access would be a strategic investment in the country's future.</i>	long-term investment, calculated investment, smart investment	C1
streamline /'striːmlaɪn/ verb STREAM·line as used: streamlined	to make a process simpler and more efficient <i>Online forms have streamlined the university application process for many students.</i>	simplify, rationalise, speed up	C1
stress-free /,stres 'friː/ adjective stress·FREE	free from worry, pressure or anxiety <i>Booking tickets early made our holiday to Cox's Bazar almost completely stress-free.</i>	relaxed, easy, trouble-free, carefree	B2
stretch /stretʃ/ verb STRETCH as used: stretches	to make someone use all their skills and abilities <i>I like tasks that stretch me, because they help me learn faster.</i>	challenge, test, push	C1
stretched /stretʃt/ adjective STRETCHED	having too much to do with not enough time or resources <i>During the application season, everyone at our office feels stretched and exhausted.</i>	overstretched, overloaded, overworked, under pressure	C1
strike a healthy balance /,straɪk əˌhelθi 'bæləns/ idiom as used: strikes a healthy balance	to find a sensible middle point between two different needs <i>It is important to strike a healthy balance between screen time and outdoor activities.</i>	find a middle ground, get the balance right, balance	C1

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strike up /ˌstraɪk ˈʌp/ phrasal verb	to start a conversation or friendship with someone <i>On long train journeys, I often strike up a conversation with the person next to me.</i>	start, begin, initiate, open	C1
striking /ˈstraɪkɪŋ/ adjective STRIK-ing	very noticeable, unusual and easy to see <i>The most striking thing about the old palace was its beautiful pink colour.</i>	noticeable, remarkable, dramatic, conspicuous	B2
structural /ˈstrʌktʃərəl/ adjective STRUC-tur-al	relating to the way society or an economy is organised, not individual choices <i>Unemployment among graduates is partly a structural problem, not just a lack of effort.</i>	systemic, institutional, underlying, fundamental	C1
stubborn /ˈstʌbən/ adjective STUB-born	difficult to get rid of or change <i>A stubborn cough kept me away from work for almost a week.</i>	persistent, tenacious, hard to shift	B2
studious /ˈstjuːdiəs/ adjective STU-di-ous	encouraging serious study; quiet and focused <i>The café near the university has a studious atmosphere, full of students with laptops and books.</i>	scholarly, academic, bookish, focused	C1
stunning /ˈstʌnɪŋ/ adjective STUN-ning	extremely beautiful or impressive to look at <i>The view of the tea gardens from the hills in Sylhet was stunning.</i>	gorgeous, breathtaking, spectacular, beautiful	B2
subsidise /ˈsʌbsɪdaɪz/ verb SUB-si-dise as used: subsidised	to pay part of the cost of something so that it is cheaper for people <i>Public transport should be subsidised so that students and low earners can travel cheaply.</i>	fund, support financially, finance, underwrite	C1
subsidy /ˈsʌbsədi/ noun SUB-si-dy as used: subsidies	money given by a government to reduce the cost of something <i>Farm subsidies help keep the price of rice and fertiliser affordable for ordinary families.</i>	grant, financial aid, funding, allowance	C1
substantial /səbˈstænʃl/ adjective sub-STAN-tial	having real depth, value and importance <i>A long weekend newspaper article offers far more substantial analysis than a short news alert.</i>	meaningful, solid, significant, weighty	C1
substitute /ˈsʌbstɪtjuːt/ noun SUB-sti-tute	something used in place of another thing <i>Online lessons can be useful, but they are no substitute for a good teacher in the room.</i>	replacement, alternative, stand-in	B2
subtle /ˈsʌtl/ adjective SUB-tle	not obvious; difficult to notice or describe <i>There are subtle differences between British and American English that learners often miss.</i>	delicate, fine, understated, slight	C1
succumb /səˈkʌm/ verb suc-CUMB	to be unable to resist pressure or temptation <i>During Ramadan, it is hard not to succumb to the delicious street food at iftar.</i>	give in, yield, surrender, cave in	C2
sufficiency /səˈfɪnsi/ noun suf-FI-cien-cy	the idea of having enough, rather than always wanting more <i>My grandparents live by a philosophy of sufficiency, owning very little and wasting nothing.</i>	adequacy, enough, moderation, contentment	C2

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suffocating /ˈsʌfəkeɪtɪŋ/ adjective SUF·fo·cat·ing	making you feel trapped, restricted and unable to be free <i>Constant supervision from parents can feel suffocating to teenagers who want more independence.</i>	stifling, oppressive, claustrophobic, restrictive	C1
superficial /ˌsuːpəˈfɪʃl/ adjective su·per·FI·cial	not deep or thorough; considering only obvious or surface things <i>Taking photos at every tourist spot can make travel feel superficial rather than meaningful.</i>	shallow, surface-level, cursory, hasty	C1
superficially /ˌsuːpəˈfɪʃli/ adverb su·per·FI·cial·ly	in a way that is not deep, detailed or thorough <i>Many people read news headlines only superficially and never check the full story.</i>	shallowly, cursorily, briefly, on the surface	C1
superstitious /ˌsuːpəˈstɪʃəs/ adjective su·per·STI·tious	believing in luck, magic or signs that cannot be explained by reason <i>My grandmother is a little superstitious and never cuts her nails after dark.</i>	credulous, irrational, fearful of bad luck	C1
supervision /ˌsuːpəˈvɪʒn/ noun su·per·VI·sion	the act of watching over someone to make sure they are safe or behaving properly <i>Young children should only use the internet under adult supervision.</i>	monitoring, oversight, guidance, control	B2
supplant /səˈplɑːnt/ verb sup·PLANT as used: supplanted	to replace something older or less modern <i>In many homes, smartphones have supplanted radios as the main source of news.</i>	replace, displace, supersede, take the place of	C2
supplement /ˈsʌplɪmənt/ noun SUP·ple·ment	something added to improve or complete something else <i>Language apps are a useful supplement to classroom learning, but not a replacement.</i>	addition, complement, extra, add-on	C1
supportive /səˈpɔːtɪv/ adjective sup·POR·tive	giving help, encouragement and kindness to someone <i>My parents have always been supportive of my plan to study abroad one day.</i>	encouraging, helpful, caring, understanding	B2
suppress /səˈpres/ verb sup·PRESS	to stop yourself from showing or expressing a feeling <i>It is not healthy to suppress your anger for too long; talking about it usually helps.</i>	hold back, bottle up, repress, conceal	C1
suppress individuality /səˈpres ˌɪndɪˌvɪdʒuˈæləti/ collocation	to prevent people from expressing their own unique personality or ideas <i>Very strict school rules can sometimes suppress individuality among students.</i>	stifle individuality, enforce conformity, crush creativity	C1
surplus /ˈsɜːpləs/ noun SUR·plus	more of something than is needed <i>There is a surplus of mangoes in the summer, so prices drop sharply at the markets.</i>	excess, oversupply, glut, surfeit	C1
surveillance /sɜːˈveɪləns/ noun sur·VEIL·lance	careful and continuous watching of a person, often by cameras, media or authorities <i>Many cities now use camera surveillance to reduce crime in busy public areas.</i>	monitoring, observation, scrutiny, watch	C1
susceptible /səˈseptəbl/ adjective sus·CEP·ti·ble	easily influenced or affected by something <i>Children are especially susceptible to advertising, as they rarely question what they see.</i>	vulnerable, prone, open, easily influenced	C1

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suspense /sə'spens/ noun sus·PENSE	a feeling of nervous excitement or anxiety while waiting for something to happen <i>The suspense of waiting for my exam results kept me awake for several nights.</i>	anticipation, tension, uncertainty, nervousness	B2
sustain /sə'steɪn/ verb sus·TAIN	to keep something going over a long period <i>It is hard to sustain motivation when you study alone without any clear deadline.</i>	maintain, keep up, continue, preserve	C1
sustain /sə'steɪn/ verb sus·TAIN as used: sustaining	to keep an activity or habit going over a long period <i>Sustaining a reading habit is easier if you always keep a book in your bag.</i>	maintain, keep up, continue	C1
sustain /sə'steɪn/ verb sus·TAIN as used: sustains	to keep a relationship alive by making continuous effort <i>Regular phone calls are what sustain my close relationship with my elder sister in Dhaka.</i>	maintain, nurture, keep alive, support	C1
sustainability /sə'steɪnə'bɪləti/ noun sus·tain·a·BIL·i·ty	using resources in a way that does not harm the environment for future generations <i>More companies are hiring experts in sustainability to reduce waste and energy use.</i>	environmental responsibility, eco-friendliness, conservation, green practices	B2
sustainable /sə'steɪnəbl/ adjective sus·TAIN·a·ble	causing little or no damage to the environment and able to continue for a long time <i>Using cloth bags instead of plastic ones is a small but sustainable change anyone can make.</i>	eco-friendly, green, environmentally friendly	B2
sustainably /sə'steɪnəbli/ adverb sus·TAIN·a·bly	in a way that can continue without causing damage to people or the environment <i>Fish stocks in the Bay of Bengal must be managed sustainably to protect future catches.</i>	responsibly, in an eco-friendly way, carefully	C1
sustenance /'sʌstənəns/ noun SUS·te·nance	food and drink that keeps people alive <i>For many farming families, rice is not just sustenance but a central part of their culture.</i>	nourishment, food, nutrition	C2
sway /sweɪ/ verb SWAY	to influence someone's opinion or decision <i>Celebrity endorsements can easily sway young people's decisions about what to buy.</i>	influence, persuade, affect, win over	C1
sweat the small things /ˌswet ðə 'smɔːl θɪŋz/ idiom	to worry too much about minor problems that are not important <i>My grandfather always tells me not to sweat the small things and to focus on what really matters.</i>	fret over trifles, make a mountain out of a molehill, worry needlessly	C2
sweltering /'sweltərɪŋ/ adjective SWEL·ter·ing	so hot that you feel very uncomfortable <i>In the sweltering heat of April, I try to stay indoors in the afternoons.</i>	boiling, scorching, stifling, baking	C1
switch off /ˌswɪtʃ 'ɒf/ phrasal verb	to stop thinking about work or problems and relax <i>Walking by the river after work helps me switch off and forget about deadlines.</i>	unwind, relax, wind down, disconnect	B2
symbolic /sɪm'bɒlɪk/ adjective sym·BOL·ic	representing an important idea or quality <i>Laying flowers at the memorial is a symbolic act of respect for those who died.</i>	representative, emblematic, significant, meaningful	C1

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symbolic importance /sɪmˌbɒlɪk ɪmˈpɔːtns/ collocation	value that something has because of what it represents rather than its practical use <i>The Shaheed Minar has great symbolic importance for Bangladeshis because it honours the Language Movement.</i>	symbolic significance, emblematic value, meaning	C1
systemic change /sɪˌstemɪk ˈtʃeɪndʒ/ collocation	a basic change to the way a whole system or organisation works <i>Reducing plastic waste requires systemic change, not only individual people recycling at home.</i>	structural change, fundamental reform, large-scale reform	C1
tackle corruption /ˈtækəl kəˈrʌpʃn/ collocation	to make a determined effort to deal with dishonest behaviour by people in power <i>Digital payment systems can help tackle corruption by making every transaction easy to trace.</i>	fight corruption, combat corruption, crack down on corruption	C1
tact /tækt/ noun TACT	the ability to deal with difficult or sensitive situations without upsetting people <i>Giving feedback to a nervous student requires tact, so I always start with what they did well.</i>	diplomacy, discretion, sensitivity	C1
tactfully /ˈtæktfəli/ adverb TACT·ful·ly	in a careful and sensitive way that avoids upsetting or offending others <i>My manager tactfully pointed out a few mistakes in my report without embarrassing me in front of colleagues.</i>	diplomatically, sensitively, discreetly	C1
tactless /ˈtæktləs/ adjective TACT·less	saying or doing things that are likely to upset people because you lack sensitivity <i>Asking someone how much they earn at a family gathering can seem rather tactless in my culture.</i>	insensitive, blunt, undiplomatic, thoughtless	C1
tailor /ˈteɪlə(r)/ verb TAI·lor	to adapt something so that it suits a particular person's needs or purpose <i>At our consultancy, we tailor each application to the student's goals rather than using one template.</i>	adapt, customise, adjust, personalise	C1
take a toll /ˌteɪk ə ˈtɒl/ idiom as used: take a serious toll	to have a serious harmful effect on someone's health, wellbeing or situation over a period of time <i>Working long night shifts for years can take a toll on your sleep and your relationships.</i>	damage, harm, wear down, have an adverse effect	C1
take a toll /ˌteɪk ə ˈtɒl/ idiom as used: taking a heavy toll	to cause serious damage or harm, especially gradually over time <i>Constant noise from the construction site is taking a toll on everyone in our building.</i>	damaging, harming, wearing down, draining	C1
take a toll /ˌteɪk ə ˈtɒl/ idiom as used: taking a serious toll	to have a damaging effect on people's health or happiness over a long period <i>Spending hours on screens every night can take a toll on children's eyesight and sleep.</i>	damaging, harming, hurting, wearing down	C1
take charge /ˌteɪk ˈtʃɑːdʒ/ phrase	to take control of a situation and responsibility for dealing with it <i>When our team leader fell ill before the deadline, I had to take charge and organise everyone.</i>	take control, step up, take the lead, assume responsibility	B2
take for granted /ˌteɪk fə ˈɡrɑːntɪd/ idiom	to assume something is normal or obvious without thinking about it or noticing it <i>Many of us take clean water for granted until the supply is cut off for a day.</i>	assume, overlook, underappreciate, not value	B2
take for granted /ˌteɪk fə ˈɡrɑːntɪd/ idiom as used: take it for granted	to fail to appreciate the value of something because you have always had it <i>Young people often take their parents' support for granted until they move away from home.</i>	underappreciate, undervalue, overlook, not value	B2

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take for granted /ˌteɪk fə ˈgrɑːntɪd/ <i>idiom</i> as used: take things for granted	to fail to notice or appreciate the good things in your life because they are always there <i>Travelling to poorer regions taught me not to take things like electricity and schooling for granted.</i>	underappreciate, overlook, undervalue, be complacent about	B2
take for granted /ˌteɪk fə ˈgrɑːntɪd/ <i>idiom</i> as used: taking for granted	to fail to recognise or value something because it seems normal and always available <i>Doing chores at home stops children from taking for granted the effort their parents make every day.</i>	overlooking, under appreciating, assuming, ignoring	B2
take for granted /ˌteɪk fə ˈgrɑːntɪd/ <i>idiom</i> as used: took for granted	to accept something as a normal part of life without realising how lucky you are to have it <i>As children, we took for granted that our grandparents would always be there to tell us stories.</i>	assumed, accepted without question, never questioned, overlooked	B2
take something in your stride /ˌteɪk ˈsʌmθɪŋ ɪn jə ˈstraɪd/ <i>idiom</i> as used: take that in my stride	to deal calmly with a difficulty and not let it upset or worry you <i>My younger sister takes exam pressure in her stride, which I really admire.</i>	cope with, handle calmly, shrug off, accept	C1
take the plunge /ˌteɪk ðə ˈplʌndʒ/ <i>idiom</i>	to finally decide to do something important or risky after thinking about it for a while <i>After years of hesitation, my cousin finally took the plunge and started his own business.</i>	go for it, commit, bite the bullet, dive in	C1
take your breath away /ˌteɪk jə ˈbreθ əweɪ/ <i>idiom</i> as used: takes your breath away	to be so beautiful or impressive that it surprises and amazes you <i>The view of the Sundarbans at sunrise would take anyone's breath away.</i>	amaze, astonish, stun, dazzle	C1
taken aback /ˌteɪkən əˈbæk/ <i>phrase</i>	very surprised or shocked by something unexpected <i>I was taken aback when my old teacher remembered my name after ten years.</i>	startled, surprised, stunned, shocked	C1
talk a good game /ˌtɔːk ə ˈɡʊd ˈɡeɪm/ <i>idiom</i>	to talk confidently about being able to do something without actually being able to do it well <i>Some job candidates talk a good game in interviews but struggle once they start the actual work.</i>	talk big, be all talk, boast, bluff	C2
tangible /ˈtændʒəbl/ <i>adjective</i> TAN·gi·ble	real and clear enough to be noticed or measured, not just imagined <i>Learning English gave me tangible benefits, such as a better job and far more confidence.</i>	real, concrete, noticeable, measurable	C1
tangible connection /ˌtændʒəbl kəˈnekʃn/ <i>collocation</i>	a real, physical link to someone or something, often through an object you can hold <i>My grandfather's old watch is a tangible connection to the years he spent working in Dhaka.</i>	physical link, concrete bond, real tie	C1
tangible link /ˌtændʒəbl ˈlɪŋk/ <i>collocation</i>	a real object or thing that physically connects you to a person, place or time <i>Old family photographs provide a tangible link between younger generations and their ancestors.</i>	concrete connection, physical reminder, real tie	C1
tax evasion /ˈtæks ɪˌveɪʒn/ <i>noun</i>	the illegal act of deliberately not paying the taxes that you owe <i>Governments are using digital payment records to make tax evasion much harder for businesses.</i>	tax fraud, tax dodging, non-payment of tax	C1
tax unhealthy options /ˌtæks ʌnˈhelθi ˈɒpʃnz/ <i>collocation</i> as used: taxing unhealthy options	putting a government charge on unhealthy food or drink to discourage people from buying it <i>Some countries have reduced sugar consumption by taxing unhealthy options such as fizzy drinks.</i>	levying sugar taxes, penalising junk food, imposing health taxes	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
teaching moment /'ti:tʃɪŋ ,məʊmənt/ noun as used: teaching moments	an ordinary situation that gives a good chance to teach someone a lesson <i>When my nephew broke a toy, my sister turned it into a teaching moment about honesty.</i>	learning opportunity, lesson, educational opportunity	C1
tear down /,teə 'daʊn/ phrasal verb as used: torn down	to destroy a building completely, often to build something new in its place <i>Several old colonial buildings in Dhaka have been torn down to make space for shopping centres.</i>	demolish, knock down, raze, pull down	B2
tech-savviness /,tek'sævɪnəs/ noun tech·SAV·vi·ness	skill and confidence in using modern technology such as computers and smartphones <i>Her tech-savviness made her the person everyone in the office asked for help with new software.</i>	digital literacy, technical know-how, computer skills	C1
tedious /'ti:diəs/ adjective TE·di·ous	boring because it continues for a long time or is repetitive <i>Filling in visa forms can be tedious, but one small mistake can delay the whole application.</i>	boring, monotonous, dull, tiresome	B2
temperament /'temprəmənt/ noun TEM·per·a·ment	a person's natural character, especially how they usually feel and react <i>My father has a calm temperament, so he rarely raises his voice even under pressure.</i>	nature, disposition, character, personality	C1
temperament /'temprəmənt/ noun TEM·per·a·ment as used: temperaments	the different natural characters of people, shown in how they usually behave and react <i>Teachers need to adapt their approach because children in one class have very different temperaments.</i>	natures, dispositions, personalities, characters	C1
tension /'tenʃn/ noun TEN·sion	a feeling of worry or unfriendliness between people who disagree or do not trust each other <i>Sharing a small flat with relatives can sometimes create tension over chores and noise.</i>	strain, friction, conflict, unease	B2
terrified /'terɪfaɪd/ adjective TER·ri·fied	extremely frightened or scared of something that might happen <i>I was terrified before my first IELTS speaking test, but the examiner turned out to be very friendly.</i>	petrified, scared stiff, frightened, panic-stricken	B2
terrifying /'terɪfaɪɪŋ/ adjective TER·ri·fy·ing	making you feel extremely frightened <i>Crossing a busy Dhaka road for the first time can be quite terrifying for visitors.</i>	frightening, scary, alarming, daunting	B2
test of character /ˌtest əv 'kærəktə(r)/ collocation	a difficult situation that shows how honest, strong or good a person really is <i>Losing his job was a real test of character, but he stayed positive and retrained as a teacher.</i>	moral challenge, trial, measure of integrity	C1
textile waste /ˌtekstaɪl 'weɪst/ collocation	clothes and fabric that are thrown away rather than reused or recycled <i>Donating old clothes instead of throwing them in the bin is a simple way to cut down on textile waste.</i>	clothing waste, fabric waste, discarded clothing	C1
the beating heart /ðə ,bi:tɪŋ 'hɑ:t/ idiom	the most important and lively central part of a place or group <i>The local bazaar is the beating heart of our town, full of noise and colour every morning.</i>	centre, hub, core, focal point	C1
the burden falls unevenly /ðə ,bɜ:dn fɔ:lz ʌn'i:vnlɪ/ phrase as used: burden falls unevenly	some people have to carry much more of the difficulty or cost than others <i>In many households, the burden falls unevenly, with women doing most of the housework.</i>	the load is shared unfairly, some bear more than others, responsibility is unequal	C2

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the circumstances of one's birth /ðə ˌsɜːkəmstənsɪz əv wʌnz ˈbɜːθ/ <i>phrase</i> as used: circumstances of their birth	the family, place and social situation a person is born into <i>A good education system should ensure that the circumstances of one's birth do not decide one's future.</i>	background, family origins, starting point in life	C1
the company you keep /ðə ˈkʌmpəni juː ˈkiːp/ <i>idiom</i>	the people you choose to spend time with, who influence your behaviour and reputation <i>My mother always said you are judged by the company you keep, so choose your friends wisely.</i>	your friends, your circle, your associates, social circle	C1
the lungs of a city /ðə ˈlʌŋz əv ə ˈsɪti/ <i>idiom</i> as used: lungs of a city	parks and green areas that provide clean air and space for people in a city <i>Ramna Park is often described as one of the lungs of Dhaka, offering fresh air amid the traffic.</i>	green lungs, green spaces, urban oases	C1
the pendulum has swung /ðə ˈpendjələm hæz ˈswʌŋ/ <i>idiom</i>	opinion or practice has moved from one extreme to the opposite extreme <i>Schools used to be very strict, but now the pendulum has swung towards giving students much more freedom.</i>	opinion has shifted, the tide has turned, things have reversed	C2
the thrill of the hunt /ðə ˌθrɪl əv ðə ˈhʌnt/ <i>idiom</i> as used: thrill of the hunt	the excitement of searching for something that is hard to find <i>Part of the fun of second-hand bookshops is the thrill of the hunt for a rare old edition.</i>	excitement of the search, buzz of searching, joy of discovery	C1
the wronged party /ðə ˌrɒŋd ˈpɑːti/ <i>phrase</i>	the person who has been treated unfairly or harmed in a dispute <i>In any fair settlement, the wronged party should receive a sincere apology and some compensation.</i>	victim, injured party, aggrieved person	C2
therapeutic /ˌθerəˈpiːtɪk/ <i>adjective</i> ther·a·PEU·tic	having a relaxing effect that makes you feel calmer and happier <i>Gardening on the balcony is surprisingly therapeutic after a stressful day at work.</i>	relaxing, calming, soothing, restorative	C1
thorough /ˈθʌrə/ <i>adjective</i> THOR·ough	careful and complete, paying attention to every detail <i>A thorough check of your documents before submitting a visa application can save weeks of delay.</i>	meticulous, careful, painstaking, rigorous	B2
thoroughly /ˈθʌrəli/ <i>adverb</i> THOR·ough·ly	completely or very much, used to emphasise a feeling <i>We thoroughly enjoyed the boat trip on the Jamuna, despite the sudden rain.</i>	completely, really, utterly, totally	B2
thought-provoking /ˈθɔːt prəvəʊkɪŋ/ <i>adjective</i> THOUGHT·pro·vok·ing	making people think seriously and carefully about a subject <i>Our teacher showed us a thought-provoking documentary about climate change and rising sea levels.</i>	stimulating, intriguing, insightful, challenging	C1
thoughtful /ˈθɔːtfl/ <i>adjective</i> THOUGHT·ful	showing that you care about other people and think about their needs <i>It was very thoughtful of my colleague to bring me soup when I was unwell.</i>	considerate, kind, caring, attentive	B2
thoughtfulness /ˈθɔːtflnəs/ <i>noun</i> THOUGHT·ful·ness	the quality of caring about others and considering what they would like <i>I was moved by the thoughtfulness of my students, who wrote me a card before leaving.</i>	consideration, kindness, care, attentiveness	C1
threshold /ˈθreʃhəʊld/ <i>noun</i> THRESH·old	the level or point at which something starts to change or have an effect <i>Beyond a certain threshold, earning more money does not seem to make people much happier.</i>	level, limit, point, cut-off	C1

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thrilled /θrɪld/ adjective THRILLED	extremely pleased and excited about something <i>My parents were thrilled when my younger sister got the top results in her class.</i>	delighted, overjoyed, ecstatic, elated	B2
thrilling /ˈθrɪlɪŋ/ adjective THRILL·ing	extremely exciting to watch or experience <i>The last over of the final was so thrilling that nobody at the tea stall could sit still.</i>	exciting, exhilarating, gripping, electrifying	B2
thrive /θraɪv/ verb THRIVE	to grow, develop or be successful in a strong and healthy way <i>Small local businesses can thrive when communities choose to shop close to home.</i>	flourish, prosper, blossom, do well	C1
throwaway culture /ˈθrəʊəweɪ ˌkʌltʃə(r)/ collocation	a way of living in which people use things briefly and then throw them away <i>Repairing phones and shoes instead of replacing them is one way to resist throwaway culture.</i>	disposable culture, consumerism, wastefulness	C1
thunderous /ˈθʌndərəs/ adjective THUN·der·ous	extremely loud, like the sound of thunder <i>The speech ended with thunderous applause that lasted for several minutes.</i>	deafening, booming, roaring, ear-splitting	C1
tide of misinformation /ˌtaɪd əv ˌmɪsɪnfəˈmeɪʃn/ collocation	a large and growing amount of false information that spreads widely <i>During elections, fact-checking websites try to hold back a rising tide of misinformation on social media.</i>	flood of false news, wave of fake news, deluge of falsehoods	C1
tidy /ˈtaɪdi/ adjective TI·dy	neat and arranged in good order <i>I work much better at a tidy desk, so I clear it every evening before leaving.</i>	neat, orderly, organised, uncluttered	B2
time capsule /ˈtaɪm ˌkæpsjuːl/ noun	something that preserves and shows what life or a person was like at a particular time <i>My old school diary is a kind of time capsule, full of worries that now seem funny.</i>	snapshot, record of the past, memento, keepsake	C1
time-honoured /ˈtaɪm ˌɒnəd/ adjective TIME·hon·oured	respected and followed for a long time because it is traditional <i>Visiting relatives on Eid morning is a time-honoured custom in most Bangladeshi families.</i>	traditional, age-old, long-established, customary	C1
time-poor /ˌtaɪm ˈpɔː(r)/ adjective time·POOR	having very little free time because you are so busy <i>Many time-poor professionals now rely on food delivery apps rather than cooking at home.</i>	busy, overstretched, hard-pressed, overworked	C2
time-saver /ˈtaɪm ˌseɪvə(r)/ noun TIME·sav·er	something that helps you do things more quickly and saves you time <i>Online banking has been a real time-saver for my father since he retired.</i>	shortcut, convenience, efficiency	C1
timeless /ˈtaɪmləs/ adjective TIME·less	not affected by changes in time or fashion, and so always relevant <i>Tagore's poems feel timeless because they deal with love, loss and the beauty of nature.</i>	enduring, ageless, classic, everlasting	C1
tip into /ˈtɪp ˌɪntə/ phrasal verb	to change, often suddenly, into a worse state or condition <i>Healthy competition between classmates can easily tip into unhealthy rivalry if teachers are not careful.</i>	turn into, slide into, descend into, become	C2
togetherness /təˈgeðənəs/ noun to·GETH·er·ness	a pleasant feeling of being close to other people, especially family or friends <i>Sharing iftar every evening during Ramadan gives our family a wonderful sense of togetherness.</i>	closeness, unity, solidarity, companionship	C1

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tolerant /'tɒlərənt/ adjective TOL·er·ant	willing to accept other people's opinions or behaviour even if you disagree with them <i>Living in a big city has made many young people more tolerant of different lifestyles.</i>	open-minded, accepting, patient, broad-minded	B2
torn /tɔ:n/ adjective TORN	unable to decide between two options because both have good points <i>I am torn between studying in Canada and staying at home to gain more work experience.</i>	undecided, in two minds, conflicted, divided	C1
torrential /tə'renʃl/ adjective tor·REN·tial	used to describe rain that falls very heavily <i>Torrential rain flooded the streets near my office, so most of us worked from home the next day.</i>	heavy, pouring, lashing, driving	C1
touched /tʌtʃt/ adjective TOUCHED	feeling happy and grateful because of someone's kindness <i>I was deeply touched when my students sent me messages of thanks after getting their visas.</i>	moved, affected, grateful, stirred	B2
touching /'tʌtʃɪŋ/ adjective TOUCH·ing	causing feelings of sympathy, warmth or tender emotion <i>It was touching to see my grandfather teaching my nephew how to fly a kite.</i>	moving, heart-warming, poignant, affecting	B2
toxic /'tɒksɪk/ adjective TOX·ic	very unpleasant and harmful to people's feelings or wellbeing <i>Some online comment sections have become so toxic that many people simply avoid them.</i>	harmful, poisonous, nasty, hostile	B2
track someone down /,træk 'sʌmwʌn ,dʌʊn/ phrasal verb as used: tracked the owner down	to find someone after searching for them for some time <i>It took me a week, but I finally tracked down my old school friend through social media.</i>	find, locate, trace, hunt down	B2
trade-off /'treɪd ɒf/ noun TRADE--off	a balance between two things, where gaining one means losing some of the other <i>Living in the city centre involves a trade-off between convenience and much higher rent.</i>	compromise, balance, exchange, sacrifice	C1
trade-off /'treɪd ɒf/ noun TRADE--off as used: trade-offs	disadvantages you accept in return for gaining certain benefits <i>Choosing a cheaper university abroad can mean some trade-offs in location and facilities.</i>	compromises, sacrifices, downsides, costs	C1
trait /treɪt/ noun TRAIT as used: traits	a particular quality that forms part of someone's character <i>Patience is one of the most valuable traits a teacher can have.</i>	characteristic, quality, attribute, feature	B2
tranquil /'træŋkwɪl/ adjective TRAN·quil	calm, quiet and peaceful, without noise or disturbance <i>Early in the morning, before the traffic starts, our neighbourhood is surprisingly tranquil.</i>	peaceful, serene, calm, still	C1
tranquillity /træŋ'kwɪləti/ noun tran·QUIL·li·ty	a state of peace, quiet and calm <i>Many city dwellers visit the countryside at weekends to enjoy some tranquillity away from the noise.</i>	peace, calm, serenity, stillness	C1
transactional /træn'zækʃənəl/ adjective trans·AC·tion·al	based only on what each person can get from the other rather than on real feeling <i>Some networking events feel very transactional, with everyone just collecting business cards.</i>	businesslike, impersonal, self-serving, calculated	C2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
transcend /træn'send/ verb tran·SCEND	to go beyond the usual limits or differences of something <i>Curiosity and a love of learning can transcend generations, linking grandparents and grandchildren.</i>	go beyond, rise above, surpass, overcome	C2
transcend /træn'send/ verb tran·SCEND as used: transcends	to go beyond and not be limited by differences such as language or culture <i>Great football matches transcend national rivalries and bring strangers together in celebration.</i>	goes beyond, rises above, surpasses, overcomes	C2
transferable /træns'fɜ:rəbl/ adjective trans·FER·a·ble	able to be used successfully in different jobs, places or situations <i>The negotiation experience I gained in sales is transferable to almost any other career.</i>	adaptable, portable, applicable, versatile	C1
transferable skills /træns,fɜ:rəbl 'skɪlz/ collocation	abilities, such as communication or teamwork, that are useful in many different jobs <i>Volunteering helped my sister build transferable skills like leadership and time management.</i>	soft skills, portable skills, general abilities	C1
transform /træns'fɔ:m/ verb trans·FORM as used: transformed	to change something completely, usually in a positive way <i>Mobile banking has transformed the way people in rural Bangladesh send and receive money.</i>	revolutionise, change completely, overhaul, reshape	B2
transformative /træns'fɔ:mətɪv/ adjective trans·FOR·ma·tive	causing a major and usually positive change <i>Studying abroad can be a transformative experience that changes how you see your own country.</i>	life-changing, revolutionary, radical, profound	C1
transition /træn'zɪʃn/ noun tran·SI·tion	the process of changing from one state or situation to another <i>The transition from university to full-time work was harder than I had expected.</i>	change, shift, move, changeover	B2
transition away from /træn'zɪʃn ə'wei frəm/ phrasal verb as used: transitioning away from	gradually stopping using one thing and moving towards something different <i>Many factories are transitioning away from coal and installing solar panels on their roofs.</i>	phasing out, moving away from, shifting from, abandoning	C1
translate into action /trænz,leɪt ,ɪntə 'ækʃn/ collocation	to result in practical steps being taken, rather than only ideas or words <i>Promises about cleaner rivers rarely translate into action unless citizens keep up the pressure.</i>	lead to action, be put into practice, turn into deeds	C1
translate well /trænz,leɪt 'wel/ phrase as used: translate very well	to work successfully when moved to a different situation, form or setting <i>Some classroom activities do not translate well to online lessons, especially group discussions.</i>	adapt well, transfer easily, work well	C1
transnational /,trænz'næʃnəl/ adjective trans·NA·tion·al	involving several countries or crossing national borders <i>Climate change and pandemics are transnational problems that no single government can solve alone.</i>	international, global, cross-border, multinational	C2
transparency /træns'pærənsi/ noun trans·PAR·en·cy	an honest and open way of working so that people can see what is being done <i>Students trust our consultancy because we are clear about fees, so transparency really matters to us.</i>	openness, honesty, clarity, accountability	C1
transparent /træns'pærənt/ adjective trans·PAR·ent	open and honest about what you think or do, without hiding anything <i>Companies should be transparent about how they use the personal data they collect.</i>	open, honest, candid, frank	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
transparently /træns'pærəntli/ adverb trans·PAR·ent·ly	in an open way that allows people to see exactly what is happening <i>Public funds should be spent transparently so that citizens can see where their taxes go.</i>	openly, honestly, clearly, accountably	C1
travel light /,trævl 'laɪt/ idiom as used: travel lighter	to carry very few things with you when you go somewhere <i>I always travel light when I visit my sister in Dhaka, taking just a small backpack.</i>	pack light, carry less, take little luggage	C1
treasure /'treʒə(r)/ verb TREA·sure	to value something very highly because it is special to you <i>I treasure the letters my grandfather wrote to me while I was at university.</i>	cherish, value, prize, hold dear	B2
treasure trove /'treʒə trəʊv/ noun	a person or place that is full of valuable or interesting things <i>The old library in our town is a treasure trove of local history books and maps.</i>	goldmine, storehouse, wealth, rich source	C1
treasured /'treʒəd/ adjective TREA·sured	highly valued and loved because of personal importance <i>One of my most treasured memories is watching the sunset over the Jamuna with my grandfather.</i>	cherished, precious, prized, beloved	C1
trendy /'trendi/ adjective TREN·dy	fashionable and popular, especially with young people <i>Rooftop restaurants have become trendy places for young people to celebrate birthdays.</i>	fashionable, stylish, popular, in vogue	B2
trial and error /,traɪəl ənd 'erə(r)/ idiom	trying different methods and learning from mistakes until you find one that works <i>I learnt to cook my mother's dal through trial and error, with a few burnt pots along the way.</i>	experimentation, learning by doing, testing	B2
trivialise /'trɪviəlaɪz/ verb TRIV·i·al·ise	to make something seem less important or serious than it really is <i>Jokes about mental illness can trivialise the real struggles that many people face.</i>	belittle, minimise, play down, downplay	C2
troubling /'trʌblɪŋ/ adjective TROUB·ling	causing worry, concern or unease <i>It is troubling that so many young graduates cannot find jobs that match their qualifications.</i>	worrying, disturbing, concerning, upsetting	C1
trump /trʌmp/ verb TRUMP as used: trumping	to be more important than something else, or to beat it <i>In my view, safety should always trump convenience when it comes to public transport.</i>	outweigh, override, take precedence over, beat	C2
turbulent /'tɜːbjələnt/ adjective TUR·bu·lent	full of confusion, difficulty and sudden change <i>My first year living alone was turbulent, but it taught me how to manage money and stress.</i>	chaotic, unstable, troubled, stormy	C1
ubiquitous /juː'bɪkwɪtəs/ adjective u·BIQ·ui·tous	seeming to be everywhere or very common at the same time <i>Smartphones have become ubiquitous, even among elderly people in remote villages.</i>	everywhere, omnipresent, pervasive, widespread	C2
unattainable /,ʌnə'teɪnəbl/ adjective un·at·TAIN·a·ble	impossible to achieve or reach <i>For many young couples, buying a flat in Dhaka now seems almost unattainable.</i>	impossible, out of reach, unachievable, unrealistic	C1

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unbearable /ʌn'beərəbl/ adjective un·BEAR·a·ble	too unpleasant or painful to deal with or accept <i>The noise from the construction next door became unbearable, so I started working at a café.</i>	intolerable, unendurable, insufferable, excruciating	B2
uncanny /ʌn'kæni/ adjective un·CAN·ny	strange and difficult to explain, often because it is surprisingly accurate <i>My sister has an uncanny knack for guessing what gift I want before I mention it.</i>	remarkable, extraordinary, mysterious, eerie	C1
uncertainty /ʌn'sɜ:tnti/ noun un·CER·tain·ty	a state of not knowing what will happen in the future <i>Waiting for visa decisions causes a lot of uncertainty for students and their families.</i>	doubt, unpredictability, insecurity, unease	B2
unchecked /ʌn'tʃekt/ adjective un·CHECKED	not controlled or stopped from growing or spreading <i>If pollution in our rivers continues unchecked, fishing communities will suffer badly.</i>	uncontrolled, unrestrained, unchallenged, rampant	C1
unchecked licence /ʌntʃekt 'laɪns/ collocation	complete freedom to behave however you like, without any limits or responsibility <i>Freedom of speech does not mean unchecked licence to spread hatred about other groups.</i>	unlimited freedom, free rein, carte blanche, total permissiveness	C2
uncomfortable truth /ʌn,kʌmfətl 'tru:θ/ collocation	a fact that is true but unpleasant or embarrassing to accept <i>The uncomfortable truth is that most of us waste far more food than we realise.</i>	hard fact, harsh reality, bitter truth, inconvenient truth	C1
uncommon /ʌn'kɒmən/ adjective un·COM·mon	rare; not happening or found very often <i>It is not uncommon for students to change their chosen subject after the first year.</i>	rare, unusual, infrequent, scarce	B2
unconditional /ʌnkən'dɪʃən/ adjective un·con·DI·tion·al	complete and given freely, without expecting anything in return <i>Most parents give their children unconditional love, even when they make serious mistakes.</i>	wholehearted, total, absolute, unreserved	C1
unconventional /ʌnkən'venʃən/ adjective un·con·VEN·tion·al	different from what is usually done or generally accepted <i>My cousin took an unconventional route into teaching, working as a photographer first.</i>	unusual, unorthodox, original, innovative	C1
uncooperative /ʌnkəs'ɒpərətɪv/ adjective un·co·OP·er·a·tive	unwilling to help or work together with others <i>The landlord was uncooperative about fixing the leak, so we eventually moved out.</i>	unhelpful, obstructive, difficult, awkward	C1
uncritically /ʌn'krɪtɪkli/ adverb un·CRIT·i·cal·ly	without questioning or judging whether something is true or good <i>Many people share news stories uncritically, without checking whether they come from reliable sources.</i>	blindly, unquestioningly, naively, credulously	C2
undeniably /ʌndɪ'naɪəbli/ adverb un·de·NI·a·bly	in a way that is certainly true and cannot be disputed <i>Online learning is undeniably convenient, but it cannot fully replace a good teacher.</i>	certainly, unquestionably, clearly, indisputably	C1
under one roof /ʌndə ,wʌn 'ru:f/ idiom	all in the same building or place <i>The new shopping centre brings groceries, clothes shops and a cinema under one roof.</i>	in one place, together, all in one building	C1
under threat /ʌndə 'θret/ phrase	in danger of being harmed, damaged or destroyed <i>Many traditional crafts in Bangladesh are under threat as young people move to the cities.</i>	in danger, at risk, endangered, vulnerable	B2

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underemployment /ˌʌndəˈɪmpˌlɔɪmənt/ noun un·der·em·PLOY·ment	a situation where people work in jobs below their skills or for fewer hours than they want <i>Underemployment is common among graduates who end up in jobs that do not need a degree.</i>	job mismatch, partial unemployment, overqualification	C2
underlying /ˌʌndəˈlaɪɪŋ/ adjective un·der·LY·ing	real and basic, though not obvious at first <i>Rather than just treating symptoms, a good doctor tries to find the underlying cause of an illness.</i>	fundamental, basic, root, deep-seated	C1
underlying social roots /ˌʌndəˈlaɪɪŋ ,səʊʃl 'ruːts/ collocation	the deep, basic social causes of a problem, such as poverty or lack of education <i>Tackling drug addiction means looking at its underlying social roots, like unemployment and family breakdown.</i>	root causes, social causes, fundamental origins	C2
undermine /ˌʌndəˈmaɪn/ verb un·der·MINE	to gradually make something weaker or less effective <i>Constant criticism from parents can undermine a child's confidence over time.</i>	weaken, erode, damage, sabotage	C1
undermine /ˌʌndəˈmaɪn/ verb un·der·MINE as used: undermines	to damage something gradually so that it becomes weaker or fails <i>Cheating in exams undermines the whole purpose of education and devalues honest students' results.</i>	weakens, erodes, damages, sabotages	C1
underpin /ˌʌndəˈpɪn/ verb un·der·PIN as used: underpins	to support something or form the basis of it <i>Trust underpins every good relationship between a consultant and a client.</i>	support, form the basis of, strengthen, reinforce	C2
underrated /ˌʌndəˈreɪtɪd/ adjective un·der·RAT·ed	better or more important than people generally think <i>Walking is an underrated form of exercise that almost anyone can enjoy.</i>	undervalued, overlooked, underappreciated	C1
understated /ˌʌndəˈsteɪtɪd/ adjective un·der·STAT·ed	simple and attractive in a quiet way, without being bright or showy <i>I prefer understated furniture in plain wood rather than anything bright or flashy.</i>	subtle, restrained, simple, low-key	C2
undervalued /ˌʌndəˈvæljuːd/ adjective un·der·VAL·ued	not given the importance or respect it deserves <i>Care workers are often undervalued despite the vital work they do every day.</i>	underrated, underappreciated, overlooked, unrecognised	C1
underwhelming /ˌʌndəˈwelmɪŋ/ adjective un·der·WHELM·ing	disappointing because it is less impressive than expected <i>The film had excellent reviews, but I found the ending rather underwhelming.</i>	disappointing, unimpressive, anticlimactic, lacklustre	C1
undiminished /ˌʌndɪˈmɪnɪʃt/ adjective un·di·MIN·ished	not reduced or made weaker in any way <i>Even in his eighties, my grandfather's love of reading remains undiminished.</i>	unchanged, unabated, as strong as ever, undimmed	C2
undivided /ˌʌndɪˈvaɪdɪd/ adjective un·di·VID·ed	complete and given only to one person or thing, used especially about attention <i>When a student is explaining a problem, I try to give them my undivided attention.</i>	complete, full, total, wholehearted	C1
unduly disempowering /ʌnˌdjuːli ˌdɪsɪmˈpəʊəɪŋ/ collocation	making people feel more powerless than is fair or necessary <i>Telling young people that nothing they do can change society is unduly disempowering.</i>	excessively discouraging, needlessly defeatist, overly limiting	C2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
unevenly /ʌn'i:vnlɪ/ adverb un·E·ven·ly	in a way that is not equal or fair between different people or places <i>Good schools are unevenly spread across the country, with most concentrated in big cities.</i>	unequally, disproportionately, unfairly, irregularly	C1
unfiltered /ʌn'fɪltəd/ adjective un·FIL·tered	honest and natural, not changed to make it more acceptable or polished <i>Children often give unfiltered opinions, which can be both funny and embarrassing for their parents.</i>	raw, honest, uncensored, candid	C1
unforgettable /ˌʌnfə'getəbl/ adjective un·for·GET·ta·ble	so special or impressive that you will always remember it <i>Our family trip to Cox's Bazar was unforgettable, especially watching the sunset on the beach.</i>	memorable, remarkable, extraordinary, haunting	B2
unfounded /ʌn'faʊndɪd/ adjective un·FOUND·ed	not based on facts or evidence <i>Fears that video calls would end face-to-face friendship have proved largely unfounded.</i>	baseless, groundless, unjustified, unsupported	C1
unhindered /ʌn'hɪndəd/ adjective un·HIN·dered	without anything stopping, blocking or slowing you down <i>Wide pavements allow pedestrians to walk unhindered, without having to step into the road.</i>	unimpeded, unobstructed, unrestricted, free	C2
unhurried /ʌn'hʌrɪd/ adjective un·HUR·ried	relaxed and slow, without any feeling of rush <i>I love the unhurried pace of village life, where people stop to chat by the pond.</i>	leisurely, relaxed, easy-going, slow	C1
uniform /'ju:nɪfɔ:m/ adjective U·ni·form	the same everywhere, without variety or difference <i>Modern shopping centres look fairly uniform, whether you are in Dhaka, Dubai or London.</i>	identical, standardised, homogeneous, alike	C1
unifying /'ju:nɪfaɪɪŋ/ adjective U·ni·fy·ing	bringing people together so that they feel united <i>Pohela Boishakh is a unifying celebration that people of every faith in Bangladesh enjoy.</i>	uniting, bonding, cohesive, harmonising	C1
unimaginable /ˌʌnɪ'mædʒɪnəbl/ adjective un·i·MAG·i·na·ble	impossible to imagine or think of as real <i>Video calling my sister every night would have been unimaginable when I was a child.</i>	inconceivable, unthinkable, unbelievable, incredible	C1
uninterrupted /ˌʌn,ɪntə'rʌptɪd/ adjective un·in·ter·RUPT·ed	continuous, without being stopped or disturbed <i>I need at least two hours of uninterrupted study to make proper progress on an essay.</i>	continuous, undisturbed, unbroken, constant	C1
unity /'ju:nəti/ noun U·ni·ty	a state of being joined together or in agreement <i>The flood relief effort showed remarkable unity among neighbours who barely knew each other.</i>	solidarity, harmony, togetherness, oneness	B2
universally /ˌju:nɪ'vɜ:səli/ adverb u·ni·VER·sal·ly	by everyone or in every place and situation <i>A warm smile is universally understood, whatever language you speak.</i>	everywhere, generally, globally, by all	C1
universally applicable /ˌju:nɪ,vɜ:səli ə'plɪkəbl/ collocation	suitable or relevant for every person or situation <i>Strict study timetables work for some students, but that approach is not universally applicable.</i>	relevant to all, suitable for everyone, one-size-fits-all	C2
unjust /ˌʌn'dʒʌst/ adjective un·JUST	not fair or morally right <i>It seems unjust that rural students have fewer chances simply because of where they live.</i>	unfair, wrong, inequitable, unjustified	C1

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unlikely places /ʌnˈlaɪkliˈpleɪsɪz/ collocation	places where you would not normally expect to find something <i>Great street food can often be found in the most unlikely places, like a tiny stall behind a bus stop.</i>	unexpected places, surprising locations, odd corners	C1
unmatched /ʌnˈmætʃt/ adjective un·MATCHED	better than all others of the same kind <i>The hospitality in our village is unmatched; guests are always fed before anyone else.</i>	unrivalled, unequalled, unparalleled, peerless	C1
unmediated /ʌnˈmiːdiːtɪd/ adjective un·ME·di·at·ed	direct, without anything such as technology coming between people <i>Camping without phones gave us a rare chance for unmediated conversation around the fire.</i>	direct, immediate, first-hand, personal	C2
unmoored /ʌnˈmɔːd/ adjective un·MOORED	feeling lost and without direction, support or purpose <i>After graduating, I felt a little unmoored until I found a job that gave my days structure.</i>	adrift, lost, rootless, directionless	C2
unparalleled /ʌnˈpærəleɪd/ adjective un·PAR·al·leled	greater or better than anything else of its kind <i>The internet gives students unparalleled access to lectures from top universities around the world.</i>	unmatched, unequalled, unprecedented, unrivalled	C2
unpolluted /ʌnpəˈluːtɪd/ adjective un·pol·LUT·ed	clean and not damaged by dirty or harmful substances <i>The air in the hills of Bandarban feels fresh and unpolluted compared with Dhaka.</i>	clean, pure, uncontaminated, pristine	C1
unprecedented /ʌnˈpresɪdɪntɪd/ adjective un·PREC·e·dent·ed	never having happened or existed before, or much greater than ever before <i>The pandemic caused unprecedented disruption to schools and universities across the world.</i>	unheard of, unparalleled, extraordinary, record	C1
unpredictable /ʌnpriˈdɪktəbl/ adjective un·pre·DICT·a·ble	likely to change suddenly, so you cannot know what will happen <i>The weather during the monsoon is so unpredictable that I always carry an umbrella.</i>	changeable, erratic, uncertain, variable	B2
unpretentious /ʌnpriˈtenʃəs/ adjective un·pre·TEN·tious	simple and natural, not trying to seem more important or impressive <i>My favourite restaurant is an unpretentious family place with plastic chairs and excellent biryani.</i>	modest, simple, down-to-earth, humble	C2
unrelenting /ʌnrɪˈlentɪŋ/ adjective un·re·LENT·ing	continuing strongly without stopping or becoming less severe <i>The unrelenting heat in April makes it hard to concentrate without a fan.</i>	relentless, constant, incessant, persistent	C2
unrestricted /ʌnrɪˈstriktɪd/ adjective un·re·STRICT·ed	not limited or controlled in any way <i>Giving young children unrestricted screen time can affect their sleep and concentration.</i>	unlimited, unrestrained, uncontrolled, free	C1
unrivalled /ʌnˈraɪvld/ adjective un·RI·valled	better than any other of the same kind <i>For fresh river fish, the market near the ghat is unrivalled in our town.</i>	unmatched, unequalled, unparalleled, second to none	C1
unspoilt /ʌnˈspɔɪlt/ adjective un·SPOILT	still natural and beautiful, not changed by building or tourism <i>Saint Martin's Island still has some beautiful unspoilt beaches away from the hotels.</i>	untouched, pristine, natural, undeveloped	C1
unspoken /ʌnˈspəʊkən/ adjective un·SPO·ken	understood without being said in words <i>Between old friends there is often an unspoken agreement to support each other in hard times.</i>	tacit, implicit, silent, understood	C1

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unstructured /ʌn'strʌktʃəd/ adjective un·STRUC·tured	without a fixed plan, rules or organisation <i>Children benefit from unstructured time, when they can invent their own games without adults directing them.</i>	free, unplanned, informal, unorganised	C1
unsustainable /ˌʌnsə'steɪnəbl/ adjective un·sus·TAIN·a·ble	not able to continue at the same level without causing damage <i>Working twelve hours a day, seven days a week is simply unsustainable in the long run.</i>	untenable, harmful, unworkable, damaging	C1
untamed /ˌʌn'teɪmd/ adjective un·TAMED	wild and natural, not controlled or changed by people <i>The untamed forests of the Sundarbans are home to Bengal tigers and countless birds.</i>	wild, natural, unspoilt, uncultivated	C1
untouched /ʌn'tʌtʃt/ adjective un·TOUCHED	not changed, affected or damaged by something <i>Some remote villages remain almost untouched by modern development, with no paved roads at all.</i>	unaffected, unspoilt, pristine, undisturbed	C1
unverified /ʌn'verɪfaɪd/ adjective un·VER·i·fied	not yet checked or proved to be true <i>Journalists should never publish unverified claims, however exciting the story seems.</i>	unconfirmed, unproven, unsubstantiated	C1
unwavering /ʌn'weɪvərɪŋ/ adjective un·WA·ver·ing	staying strong and firm without changing or becoming weaker <i>My parents' unwavering support gave me the courage to change careers.</i>	steadfast, firm, constant, unshakeable	C1
unwind /ˌʌn'waɪnd/ verb un·WIND	to relax after a period of work or stress <i>On Friday evenings I like to unwind with a cup of tea and a good novel.</i>	relax, de-stress, chill out, wind down	B2
unworkable /ʌn'wɜ:kəbl/ adjective un·WORK·a·ble	not practical and unlikely to succeed <i>A ban on all private cars would be unworkable in a city with such poor public transport.</i>	impractical, unfeasible, unrealistic, impossible	C1
up to date /ˌʌp tə 'deɪt/ phrase	having or knowing the latest information about something <i>I follow a few education blogs to keep up to date with changes in visa rules.</i>	informed, current, abreast, in the loop	B2
upend /ʌp'end/ verb up·END	to change something completely, often in a way that causes problems <i>A sudden illness in the family can upend all your plans in a single week.</i>	overturn, disrupt, turn upside down, upset	C2
upkeep /'ʌpki:p/ noun UP·keep	the work and cost of keeping something in good condition <i>A large garden looks lovely, but its upkeep takes a lot of time every weekend.</i>	maintenance, care, repairs, running costs	C1
uplifting /ˌʌp'lɪftɪŋ/ adjective up·LIFT·ing	making you feel happier and more hopeful <i>I find stories of ordinary people helping strangers truly uplifting.</i>	inspiring, heart-warming, encouraging, cheering	C1
urban fabric /ˌɜ:bən 'fæbrɪk/ collocation	the physical structure of a city, including its buildings, streets and open spaces <i>Old markets and narrow lanes are an important part of Old Dhaka's urban fabric.</i>	cityscape, built environment, urban landscape	C2
urban planning /ˌɜ:bən 'plænɪŋ/ collocation	the design and organisation of how towns and cities are built and developed <i>Better urban planning could reduce flooding by leaving more open ground for rainwater to drain.</i>	town planning, city planning, urban design	C1

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utilitarian /juːtɪlɪˈteəriən/ adjective u·til·i·TAR·i·an	focused only on being useful or practical rather than on enjoyment or beauty <i>Many office buildings are purely utilitarian, with little thought given to comfort or appearance.</i>	practical, functional, pragmatic, no-frills	C2
valued /ˈvæljuːd/ adjective VAL·ued	considered important and appreciated by others <i>Employees work harder when they feel valued rather than simply being told what to do.</i>	appreciated, respected, cherished, esteemed	B2
values-driven /ˈvæljuːz ,drɪvən/ adjective VAL·ues·driv·en	guided mainly by moral beliefs and principles rather than price or convenience <i>Values-driven consumers are more likely to choose brands that treat their workers fairly.</i>	principled, ethical, conscience-led, mission-led	C2
vanish /ˈvæniʃ/ verb VAN·ish	to disappear or stop existing completely <i>Many old village traditions may vanish unless younger generations learn them.</i>	disappear, fade away, die out, evaporate	B2
vanish /ˈvæniʃ/ verb VAN·ish as used: vanishes	to pass or disappear very quickly without being noticed <i>Whenever I start scrolling on my phone, the whole evening seems to vanish without my noticing.</i>	disappears, slips away, flies by, evaporates	B2
vanish /ˈvæniʃ/ verb VAN·ish as used: vanishing	to stop existing completely and disappear <i>Traditional handloom weaving is slowly vanishing as factory-made cloth becomes cheaper.</i>	disappearing, dying out, fading away, dwindling	B2
vanish mysteriously /ˈvæniʃ mɪˈstəriəsli/ collocation as used: mysteriously vanished	to disappear suddenly in a way that nobody can explain <i>Every time I buy a new umbrella, it seems to vanish mysteriously within a few weeks.</i>	disappear without trace, go missing, inexplicably disappear	C1
vast /vɑːst/ adjective VAST	extremely large in size, area or amount <i>The Bay of Bengal looks so vast from the beach that it seems to go on for ever.</i>	huge, immense, enormous, boundless	B2
versatile /ˈvɜːsətaɪl/ adjective VER·sa·tile	able to be used in many different ways or situations <i>A plain white shirt is versatile because you can wear it to work or out with friends.</i>	adaptable, flexible, multipurpose, all-purpose	C1
versatility /ˌvɜːsəˈtɪləti/ noun ver·sa·TIL·i·ty	the ability to be used for many different purposes <i>The versatility of rice in Bengali cooking means it appears in both main dishes and desserts.</i>	adaptability, flexibility, range, usefulness	C1
viable /ˈvaɪəbl/ adjective VI·a·ble	able to work successfully in practice <i>Solar power has become a viable option for many rural homes that are not connected to the grid.</i>	workable, feasible, practical, realistic	C1
vibrant /ˈvaɪbrənt/ adjective VI·brant	very bright and strong in colour <i>The streets are full of vibrant decorations and coloured lights during the Eid holidays.</i>	bright, vivid, colourful, dazzling	C1
vigilance /ˈvɪdʒɪləns/ noun VIG·i·lance	careful and continuous attention to notice possible danger or problems <i>Online banking requires constant vigilance, because scammers keep inventing new tricks.</i>	watchfulness, alertness, caution, attentiveness	C1

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vigilant /'vɪdʒɪlənt/ adjective VIG-i-lant	always watchful and careful to notice problems or danger <i>Parents need to stay vigilant about the apps and games their children download.</i>	watchful, alert, careful, attentive	C1
vision /'vɪʒn/ noun VI-sion	a clear idea of what you want to achieve or how things could be in the future <i>Our founder had a clear vision of making overseas study affordable for students from small towns.</i>	goal, aim, plan, foresight	B2
visual language /,vɪʒuəl 'læŋɡwɪdʒ/ collocation	a way of communicating ideas and meanings through images, colours and styles rather than words <i>Advertisers use a powerful visual language of colour and imagery to attract young buyers.</i>	visual communication, imagery, symbolism	C2
visual shorthand /,vɪʒuəl 'ʃɔːthænd/ collocation	a quick way of expressing an idea through a simple image or symbol <i>A thumbs-up emoji has become a visual shorthand for agreement in most workplace chats.</i>	visual cue, symbol, quick sign	C2
vital life skill /,vaɪtl 'laɪf skɪl/ collocation	an essential ability that everyone needs for daily life or personal safety <i>Managing a budget is a vital life skill that schools should teach before students leave home.</i>	essential skill, basic survival skill, key ability	C1
vital outlet /,vaɪtl 'aʊtlet/ collocation	an essential way of releasing emotions, stress or energy <i>For my younger sister, painting is a vital outlet when exam pressure builds up.</i>	important release, essential escape, means of expression	C1
vitality /vaɪ'tæləti/ noun vi-TAL-i-ty	energy, liveliness and strength that make a place or person feel active <i>New cafés and weekend markets have brought fresh vitality to the old part of our town.</i>	energy, liveliness, vigour, dynamism	C1
vivid /'vɪvɪd/ adjective VIV-id	very bright and strong in colour <i>The painted rickshaws of Bangladesh are famous for their vivid colours and detailed designs.</i>	bright, brilliant, vibrant, colourful	B2
void /vɔɪd/ noun VOID	a feeling of emptiness because something important is missing from your life <i>When my elder sister moved to Dhaka after her wedding, her absence left a void at home.</i>	emptiness, gap, vacuum, hole	C1
volatile /'vɒlətaɪl/ adjective VOL-a-tile	likely to change suddenly and unpredictably, especially for the worse <i>Food prices in local markets can be volatile, especially after floods damage the crops.</i>	unstable, unpredictable, changeable, erratic	C1
voluntary /'vɒləntəri/ adjective VOL-un-tar-y	done because you choose to, not because you are forced <i>Taking part in the survey is voluntary, so no student has to answer the questions.</i>	optional, willing, freely chosen, non-compulsory	B2
vulnerability /,vʌlnərə'bɪləti/ noun vul-ner-a-BIL-i-ty as used: vulnerabilities	weaknesses that make something easy to harm, damage or attack <i>Relying on a single export industry is one of the biggest vulnerabilities in a developing economy.</i>	weaknesses, risks, flaws, exposure	C1
vulnerable /'vʌlnərəbəl/ adjective VUL-ner-a-ble	easily harmed physically, emotionally or financially <i>Elderly people living alone are especially vulnerable during extreme heat.</i>	at risk, exposed, defenceless, susceptible	B2

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wake-up call /'weɪk ʌp ,kɔ:l/ noun	an event that makes people realise there is a serious problem that must be dealt with <i>Failing my first mock exam was a wake-up call that made me change my study habits.</i>	warning, alarm bell, eye-opener, reality check	C1
walkable /'wɔ:kəbl/ adjective WALK·a·ble	safe and pleasant enough to walk around rather than drive <i>Our town centre is quite walkable, so I rarely need a rickshaw to run errands.</i>	pedestrian-friendly, accessible on foot, compact	C1
wanderlust /'wɒndəlɪst/ noun WAN·der·lust	a strong desire to travel and explore new places <i>Reading travel blogs always fills me with wanderlust, even when I have no trip planned.</i>	desire to travel, restlessness, itchy feet	C2
warm up /,wɔ:m 'ʌp/ phrasal verb	to become more friendly, relaxed or enthusiastic after a slow start <i>Shy students often warm up once they realise the class is friendly and nobody will laugh at them.</i>	relax, loosen up, open up, come out of your shell	C1
warmth /'wɔ:mθ/ noun WARMTH	friendliness and kindness towards other people <i>Visitors to our village are often struck by the warmth of the people, who invite strangers for tea.</i>	friendliness, kindness, hospitality, affection	B2
warrant /'wɒrənt/ verb WAR·rant as used: warrants	to make an action necessary or appropriate <i>The rise in road accidents warrants stricter speed limits near schools.</i>	justify, deserve, merit, call for	C2
wary /'weəri/ adjective WA·ry	careful because you think there may be danger or problems <i>I am always wary of online job offers that promise huge salaries for very little work.</i>	cautious, suspicious, careful, distrustful	C1
wasteful /'weɪstfl/ adjective WASTE·ful	using more of something than necessary, or throwing it away carelessly <i>Leaving lights and fans on in empty rooms is wasteful and expensive.</i>	extravagant, uneconomical, careless, inefficient	B2
watch the world go by /,wɒtʃ ðə ,wɜ:ld ɡəʊ 'baɪ/ idiom	to relax and look at the people and activity around you <i>On holiday, I love sitting in a riverside café and just watching the world go by.</i>	people-watch, sit back, observe, relax	C1
wearable /'weərəbl/ noun WEAR·a·ble as used: wearables	an electronic device worn on the body, such as a smartwatch or fitness tracker <i>Many of my colleagues use wearables to count their steps and monitor their sleep.</i>	smartwatch, fitness tracker, wearable tech	C1
weave around /,wi:v ə'reʊnd/ phrasal verb as used: weaving around	to move around obstacles by changing direction again and again <i>Motorbikes kept weaving around the buses, which made the journey feel rather dangerous.</i>	zigzagging, dodging, swerving, threading your way	C1
weave into /,wi:v 'ɪntə/ phrasal verb as used: woven into	to include something as a natural, closely connected part of something else <i>Religious festivals are deeply woven into the rhythm of daily life in Bangladesh.</i>	integrated into, incorporated into, built into, embedded in	C1
weigh /wei/ verb WEIGH as used: weighing	to consider something carefully by comparing its advantages and disadvantages <i>After weighing the cost of a car against the convenience, my father decided to keep using rickshaws.</i>	assessing, considering, evaluating, balancing	C1

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
weigh up /ˌweɪ ˈʌp/ phrasal verb	to consider the advantages and disadvantages of something before deciding <i>Before choosing a university, students should weigh up tuition fees, location and job prospects.</i>	consider, assess, evaluate, compare	B2
welcome shift /ˌwelkəm ˈʃɪft/ collocation	a positive change that people are pleased to see <i>The growth of cycle lanes in some cities is a welcome shift away from car dependence.</i>	positive change, good development, encouraging trend	C1
welcoming /ˌwelkəmɪŋ/ adjective WEL·com·ing	friendly to people who arrive, making them feel accepted <i>Our neighbours were very welcoming when we moved in, bringing sweets and offering help.</i>	friendly, hospitable, warm, inviting	B2
welfare /ˈwelfeə(r)/ noun WEL·fare	the health, comfort and happiness of a person or animal <i>Animal welfare groups campaign for better treatment of working horses and street dogs.</i>	wellbeing, health, protection, comfort	C1
well connected /ˌwel kəˈnektɪd/ phrase	having good transport links to other places <i>I chose a flat that is well connected by bus, so getting to work takes only twenty minutes.</i>	accessible, conveniently located, easy to reach	C1
well-deserved /ˌwel dɪˈzɜːvd/ adjective well·de·SERVED	fully earned because of hard work or good qualities <i>After months of overtime, my colleague finally got a well-deserved promotion.</i>	earned, merited, justified, rightful	C1
well-planned transition /ˌwel plænd trænˈzɪʃn/ collocation	a carefully organised change from one system or situation to another <i>Moving to digital exams needs a well-planned transition so that no students are left behind.</i>	managed change, orderly shift, careful changeover	C1
well-rounded /ˌwel ˈraʊndɪd/ adjective well·ROUND·ed	balanced and including a good variety of experiences or activities <i>Universities abroad often look for well-rounded applicants with interests outside their studies.</i>	balanced, varied, all-round, complete	C1
wholesome /ˈhəʊlsəm/ adjective WHOLE·some	good for your health; healthy and nourishing <i>My mother believes a wholesome breakfast of eggs, bread and fruit sets you up for the day.</i>	nutritious, healthy, nourishing, good for you	C1
wickedness /ˈwɪkɪdnəs/ noun WICK·ed·ness	the quality of being morally bad or evil <i>Folk tales often show how kindness is rewarded and wickedness is eventually punished.</i>	evil, cruelty, immorality, malice	C2
widen inequality /ˌwaɪdn ˌɪnɪˈkwɒləti/ collocation	to make the gap between rich and poor, or advantaged and disadvantaged, bigger <i>Expensive private tutoring can widen inequality between students from wealthy and poor families.</i>	increase the gap, deepen disparity, worsen inequality	C1
widen the gulf /ˌwaɪdn ðə ˈɡʌlf/ idiom as used: widens that gulf	to make the difference or lack of understanding between two groups bigger <i>Refusing to talk about difficult subjects at home can widen the gulf between parents and teenagers.</i>	deepen the divide, increase the gap, drive apart	C2
widen your reach /ˌwaɪdn jə ˈriːtʃ/ collocation as used: widened our reach	to increase the number of people or places you can connect with or influence <i>Posting videos online has helped village craftsmen widen their reach to buyers abroad.</i>	expand your audience, extend your influence, broaden your network	C1

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widespread adoption /ˌwaɪdspred əˈdɒpʃn/ collocation	the use of something new by a large number of people or organisations <i>Cheaper batteries could lead to the widespread adoption of electric rickshaws in Bangladesh.</i>	mass uptake, broad acceptance, general use	C1
wield /wiːld/ verb WIELD	to have and use power or influence <i>Social media influencers wield considerable power over what young people choose to buy.</i>	exercise, exert, hold, possess	C2
wield /wiːld/ verb WIELD as used: wields	to have and use power or influence over other people <i>In many villages, the local council chairman wields more influence than any distant official.</i>	exercises, exerts, holds, possesses	C2
wind down /waɪnd ˈdaʊn/ phrasal verb	to relax gradually after a period of work or activity <i>I usually wind down in the evening by walking along the river with a friend.</i>	relax, unwind, de-stress, switch off	B2
window-shopping /ˈwɪndəʊ ˌʃɒpɪŋ/ noun WIN·dow·shop·ping	looking at goods in shops without intending to buy anything <i>On Friday afternoons, my sister and I sometimes go window-shopping at the new mall.</i>	browsing, looking around, just looking	B2
wisdom /ˈwɪzdəm/ noun WIS·dom	the ability to make good judgements based on experience and knowledge <i>I often turn to my grandmother's wisdom when I have a difficult decision to make.</i>	good sense, insight, judgement, understanding	B2
with something in mind /wɪð ˈsʌmθɪŋ ɪn ˈmaɪnd/ phrase as used: with the monsoon in mind	while considering the heavy rains of the monsoon season when planning or designing something <i>Farmers in our area plant their crops with the monsoon in mind, choosing rice that tolerates flooding.</i>	considering the rains, allowing for the monsoon, planning for the wet season	C1
withdraw /wɪðˈdrɔː/ verb with·DRAW	to become quieter and avoid spending time with other people <i>Teenagers who are being bullied often withdraw from friends and family without explaining why.</i>	retreat, pull back, isolate yourself, shut yourself off	C1
within reach /wɪˌðɪn ˈriːtʃ/ phrase	possible to achieve or obtain <i>With a scholarship, studying for a master's degree abroad finally felt within reach.</i>	achievable, attainable, possible, realistic	C1
witty /ˈwɪti/ adjective WIT·ty	clever and funny in the way you use words <i>Our English teacher was so witty that even grammar lessons made us laugh.</i>	clever, amusing, humorous, quick-witted	C1
wordplay /ˈwɜːdpleɪ/ noun WORD·play	clever or funny use of words, especially words with more than one meaning <i>Bengali poetry is full of wordplay that is almost impossible to translate into English.</i>	puns, word games, verbal wit, play on words	C1
worth every penny /ˌwɜːθ ˌevri ˈpeni/ idiom	so good or useful that it fully justifies the money you paid <i>My noise-cancelling headphones were expensive, but they have been worth every penny on long bus journeys.</i>	great value, money well spent, a good investment	C1
worth its weight in gold /ˌwɜːθ ɪts ˌweɪt ɪn ˈɡəʊld/ idiom	so useful or valuable that it is almost impossible to do without <i>During the monsoon, a sturdy umbrella that does not turn inside out is worth its weight in gold.</i>	invaluable, priceless, extremely useful, precious	C1
worthwhile /ˌwɜːθ ˈweɪl/ adjective worth·WHILE	useful or valuable enough to justify the time, money or effort <i>Volunteering at the local school was a worthwhile way to spend my weekends last year.</i>	valuable, beneficial, rewarding, useful	B2

Word	Meaning & example	Synonyms	Level
worthy /'wɜːði/ adjective WOR·thy	deserving respect, support or effort <i>Cleaning up our local riverbank is a worthy cause that everyone in the town can support.</i>	deserving, admirable, commendable, praiseworthy	C1
written record /,rɪtɪn 'rekɔːd/ collocation	information kept in writing so that it can be checked later <i>I always ask clients to confirm deadlines by email so we have a written record of what was agreed.</i>	documentation, paper trail, record, note	B2
youthful /'juːθfl/ adjective YOUTH·ful	having the energy, freshness and qualities typical of young people <i>Despite being in his eighties, my grandfather has a youthful curiosity about new technology.</i>	young, lively, energetic, vigorous	C1